The VantaPsy Chronology

A Compendium of Aerisu

Compiled from the lore of

VantaPsy: Soul Snatcher

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"To lack; To want a soul."

— VantaPsy

The VantaPsy Chronology

A Quick Primer

Aerisu remembers itself as time recurs, carrying the Echoes of the past into the future. The VantaPsy Chronology traces that history across six ages, following the civilizations, Spirits, souls, magic, and forces that have shaped the world.

The Age of Men ends with the Crystallisation of Elysium. The Age of Gods sees Lunarkos descend and the Shattering reshape the world. The Age of Fairytales rebuilds civilisation around magic. The Age of Magic brings the War for the Orb of Souls. The Age of Knowledge gives way to the present darkness. The Age of Decay now stretches across nine years of night, with a city folded by time and a goddess sleeping within an orphanage.

Magic is potential made manifest through Resonance. Every living thing, memory, desire, and action participates in the same cosmic frame, leaving Echoes that can persist through souls, cultures, places, and even the Stars. Lux connects and sustains these systems. Vanta arises from lack and desire, and when desire becomes self-perpetuating, it becomes the Curse.

The Chronology follows these forces through Aerisu: the nature of the soul, the Spiral Veins beneath the world, the Spirits and their domains, the memories carried through Recursion, and the many ways existence can bloom, decay, and become something else.

New to the Chronology? Start with the VantaPsy Cosmology for a concise overview of the fundamental structure of Aerisu and VantaPsy as a whole.

The Six Ages

Age of Men — the world before the Moon. Solmara rose as an empire of scholars and soldiers who believed order could be perfected. Hoshimira bent the knee as vassal. Sahran was born from exile, the outcast kin of Hoshimira driven into scorching deserts. The Curse was a distant whisper. The Scorching Sun ruled an unchanging sky. The Vanta Explosion crystallised Elysium, and the world prepared to break.

Age of Gods — the sky shattered. Lunarkos fell. Bahamut rose from the planet's core. The collision tore the boundary between soul and matter. Gods ascended from the wreckage. The Moon was born, scarred and veined. The world was remade in fire, light, and divine will.

Age of Fairytales — from ash, myth took root. The Nine Spirits wove the Barrier between realms. The Phumenar sought the Orb. The First Separation cracked the Rift. Gods and mortals learned to coexist. History became legend, and legend became truth.

Age of Magic — magic became the skeleton of civilisation. Dragons soared. The Ashtar marched. Death gardens bloomed. Sorcery intertwined with steel. The world rebuilt itself on arcane foundations. Wonder was woven into the everyday.

Age of Knowledge — the age of codification and pathology. The Diviners systematised the soul. Orthogenesis engineered new life: the Borenfegens. Magic receded. Technology advanced. The world tried to understand itself, and lost something in the process.

Age of Decay — the present. Perpetual night over Sengetsuki. The Curse in every bloodline. The sun a pale memory on Sundays. Technology and magic wear thin. The accumulated weight of every age presses down, and the world holds its breath for the end, or simply another loop.

This document is a work in progress. Entries are added as the Chronology and the game come together.

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Events

Events Overview

Age of Men · Events · also known as Events Overview

Chronology of Aerisu's major historical and cosmological events.

Events traces the history of Aerisu from the Age of Men through the Age of Gods, Age of Fairytales, Age of Magic, Age of Knowledge and Age of Decay. Entries are primarily chronological, with related events occasionally grouped together to preserve their broader historical context.

Related: Age of Men

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Age of Men

Age of Men · Events

The Age of Men was the era before the Moon, when the Scorching Sun governed Aerisu's skies and humanity's great civilisations began defining themselves through ambition, faith and survival. Solmara rose as the dominant human power, while the histories of Hoshimira and Sahran became intertwined with its expansion.

The Nations during the Age of Men

Solmara

Solmara was the seat of the Autarchs before the rise of the Psycrata, an expanding empire of scholars, rulers and soldiers devoted to order, efficiency and human capability. Their power rested on disciplined institutions, military strength and technological ambition. When their mechs entered the mountains of Hoshimira, their radiant forms were taken for Angels. The reverence that followed became political allegiance, and Hoshimira became a Solmaran vassal.

Hoshimira

Hoshimira was a mountain realm of spiritual discipline, ancestral tradition and harmony with the land. When some of its people mined into the Golden Heart against the Elders' warnings, the resulting devastation brought Solmaran intervention. The diggers were driven from Aokusa, and Hoshimiran tradition understood the event as judgement from the Angels. Those exiles became the Sahrani.

Sahran

Sahran was formed by the exiled Hoshimiran people, who settled in the desert lands beyond Aokusa and made the Geode their home. Their society developed around survival, craft, repentance and the hope of returning to their ancestral mountain. Many accepted servitude or sought to prove themselves worthy of returning. Others rejected this path and became the first Luminaries, turning their sense of exile and injustice towards rebellion and religious extremism.

Related: Solmara, Hoshimira, Sahran, Geode Rebellion

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Geode Rebellion

Age of Men · Events · also known as Geode Rebellion, Red Orphan Tier

Life Under Autarch Control

After the Sahrani exile, the Geode became a system of labour tiers under Autarch control. Identity was stripped into numbers and function, families were separated, and children were taken into the Orphan Tiers where memory, ritual and obedience replaced the lives they had been born into. The Curse was known throughout the caverns through disappearances, distortions and whispered accounts, while speaking openly about it carried the threat of punishment.

The Sahrani worked the stone and machinery of the Geode beneath constant surveillance from the mechs once called Angels. Resentment accumulated through generations, alongside the quiet preservation of family, faith and memory.

The Red Orphan Tier

The Red Orphan Tier became one of the centres of resistance. Children raised within its system learned to turn whatever they could reach towards defiance. Tools became weapons, sabotage became routine and forbidden knowledge passed between the tiers. The Autarchs classified these acts as terrorism and executed suspected saboteurs publicly, creating further symbols for the growing rebellion.

The Rebellion of the Tiers

The rebellion eventually spread through the Geode. Tunnels were destroyed, patrols disappeared and fighting moved from the lowest tiers towards the surface. Autarch forces responded with mechs and overwhelming firepower, while the rebels fought through the caverns they had spent generations working and learning.

Tier by tier, the rebels reclaimed their communities and drove the remaining Autarch forces from the Geode. Councils returned, shrines reopened and Sahrani traditions were practised openly. The Geode became the centre of an independent Sahrani society, carrying the memory of exile into a new political identity.

The rebellion ended Autarch rule without erasing its influence. The structures, technology and power relationships left behind continued shaping the Geode, leaving freedom as something that had to be maintained rather than assumed.

Related: Geode Expedition, Sahran, Tayran

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Geode Expedition

Age of Men · Events

The Geode Expedition

After the Geode Rebellion, exploration of the deeper tiers continued through numerous expeditions. Among the most consequential was an expedition that descended after detecting an unexplained presence around a fissure known as the Mouth, where light and signals became distorted and the surrounding stone showed signs of Vanta saturation.

The deeper levels contained Cursed beings, VantaBats, Shadowlings and Tinnin, alongside increasingly abnormal geology and concentrations of Residue. The expedition eventually reached the Deep, a vast sentient formation connected to the planet's deeper structures. It was later revealed to be an extension of Bahamut, and its awareness became clear when it responded to their presence.

The encounter ended in catastrophe. Siba, a great mech built for war and protection, was offered as a vessel for Bahamut's destructive force. Its sacrifice ruptured the Geode's central seam and released a surge of light through the caverns before Siba and the expedition's guiding instrument disappeared.

The survivors returned carrying the knowledge that Bahamut was conscious and that the Geode contained something far beyond an ordinary mineral formation. The Curse remained active beneath the settlement, while the memory of Siba's sacrifice became part of the Geode's history. The expedition permanently changed how the Sahrani understood what lay beneath them and established that the boundary between Aerisu's surface and its

deeper consciousness was far thinner than previously believed.

Related: Geode Rapture, Geode Rebellion, Sahran, The Geode

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Geode Rapture

Age of Men · Events · also known as Rapture

The Second Descent

Among the later expeditions into the deeper Geode, a second major descent followed years after the expedition that first encountered ~~Bahamut~~. The team entered through reinforced shafts and increasingly unstable tunnels, encountering shifting stone, dense ~~Vanta~~ miasma and increasingly hostile life. Few returned.

At the deepest level, the expedition encountered the Geode's immense inner chamber, where its semi-sentient nature became undeniable. The cavern behaved like a living system, drawing creatures towards it and producing entities from stone, fire and shadow. The presence at its centre was beyond anything the expedition could contain.

Rapture

~~The Geode~~ erupted. Its lower regions collapsed into a violent release of creatures, ~~Vanta~~-saturated material and destructive energy that overwhelmed miners, soldiers and engineers. Evacuation became the only priority as survivors fought their way towards the surface.

The release extended beyond the Geode itself. Material expelled into the atmosphere altered the passage of sunlight, producing the ~~Crescent Sun~~, in which part of the Scorching ~~Sun~~'s disk appeared darkened and distorted. ~~The Sun~~ itself remained unchanged.

The destruction left the Geode devastated and its population scattered. Those who escaped carried accounts of what had awakened below, while the wider world inherited an atmospheric consequence that would remain long after the Rapture ended.

Related: Geode Expedition, Geode Rebellion, Sahran, The Geode

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Sanctum Verge

Age of Men · Events

During the ~~Ori'sol~~ War, a Hoshimiran squad established a military outpost within the ruined city, surrounded by streets choked with black rain, ash and collapsed buildings. Signs of ~~Luminary~~ occupation remained throughout the area, including makeshift fortifications, ritual traces and the presence of the ~~Curse~~ within the hollow structures.

A young Hoshimiran apprentice was captured during an early skirmish and subjected to experiments intended to weaponise the ~~Curse~~. Hoshimiran forces retaliated by storming the ~~Luminary~~ outpost, executing its defenders, including children and others caught within the fighting, before burning what remained.

The checkpoint was destroyed during the fighting, and the squad later found their own position in ruins. Sanctum Verge became remembered for the cycle of violence between ~~Luminary~~ extremism and Hoshimiran retaliation, with civilians and young recruits caught between them.

Related: Hoshimira, Ori'sol, Daigo Kusanagi, Aokusa, Sahran, The Luminaries

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Ik-Rasul Incident

Age of Men · Events · also known as Ik-Rasul Crash

When the Ik-Rasul fell into Aokusa, the impact disturbed the surrounding basin, affecting its mountains, rivers and aquifers. Solmaran authorities classified the event as a cross-border bio-threat and deployed monitoring drones and Autarch forces throughout the region.

Soon afterwards, people across southern Aokusa reported hallucinations, nightmares and voices resembling fragments of old Hoshimiran chants. The condition later known as Black Blood Syndrome appeared among the affected population, while animals and soil began displaying abnormal responses.

The redeployed Angels also began returning with unexplained alterations. Their sensors recorded patterns without recognised commands, while strange Resonance accumulated beneath the basin. Ori'sol became the centre of investigation as evidence grew that the Ik-Rasul had disturbed something deeper within Aokusa.

The incident marked the beginning of a prolonged period of fear and study surrounding the region, while the effects of the Ik-Rasul extended beyond physical contamination into cognition, Resonance and the behaviour of those exposed.

Related: Ik-Rasul, Aokusa

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Operation C.a.R

Age of Men · Events · also known as C.a.R

Operation C.a.R was launched after the Ik-Rasul Incident destabilised Sahran, Hoshimira and Ylvara. Solmara framed the worsening situation as a crisis requiring rapid stabilisation, with the Geode and the spread of Luminary doctrine presenting particular concern.

Tayran's northern coast had already begun moving towards collapse as Luminary influence increasingly shaped local governance. Solmara authorised Project DAEDALUS to intervene with private forces, bipedal mechs and rapid-response units. Insurgencies were suppressed, territory secured and civilians extracted.

The operation also gathered survivors of other incidents, including people affected by the Ik-Rasul, and redirected them into Isvara's systems, with Hoshimiran orphans receiving priority. Displacement became a standard method of containment, with care increasingly administered through monitoring and controlled relocation.

Responses across Sahran varied. Tayran resisted the intervention, while Najmara and Zaristan accepted it to preserve stability in their cities. Panjara remained distant and watched the situation unfold.

Operation C.a.R established Solmara's modern model of containment: suppress instability, remove vulnerable populations from affected regions and impose enough administrative control to prevent further escalation.

Related: Ik-Rasul Incident, Isvara

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Vaelmiric War

Age of Men · Events · also known as Vaelmir War

The Vaelmiric War began as a response to revelations of Ylvaran abuses and developed into a prolonged conflict between the northern provinces of Solmara and Ylvara. Norrvektstan and Silealyros had very different ideas about the use of Vaelmir, yet both opposed Ylvara after reports emerged of children held in Council facilities and Black Blood experiments conducted on living subjects without consent.

The Council's response was slow and increasingly ineffective as the northern provinces began coordinating outside its established channels. Fighting spread across Vaelmir, where naval engagements disrupted shipping and coastal bombardments devastated settlements, while ground forces conducted operations through civilian

areas. Within Ylvara itself, political conflict grew over what the Council had known, when it had known it and which officials had authorised the research.

The war lasted for years, with northern and southern records disagreeing over its exact beginning. It ended through exhaustion as the cost of continued fighting became unsustainable. The Calm Accords established the terms of the settlement and included the Black Blood Regulations, placing formal restrictions on the research that had helped ignite the conflict.

The war left a lasting silence across Solmara. Veterans from every side remembered what had happened, while the populations that survived carried the consequences into the uneasy peace that followed.

Related: Vaelmir, Calm Accords, B-Blood Regulations, Isvara

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Calm Accords

Age of Men · Events

The Calm Accords ended the Vaelmiric War after decades of naval and coastal destruction, establishing a fragile settlement between northern and southern Solmara.

Vaelmir's central waters were demilitarised and patrols reduced, while Norrvektstan assumed stewardship of the inland sea and the southern provinces retained control of major ports, trade routes and chokepoints. Disputed islands were placed under joint oversight. Long-range weapons and destructive military platforms were prohibited, with neutral mediators appointed to monitor compliance.

Economic measures restored trade through shared tariffs and reparations, though corruption and covert violations soon undermined the settlement. Non-interference provisions were routinely tested whenever political or economic interests outweighed the cost of doing so.

The Accords became known as the Silent Curse among veterans. In the North they were remembered as surrender disguised as diplomacy, while the South regarded them as necessary restraint. They ended the war without resolving the tensions that produced it, leaving Vaelmir heavily watched and both sides preparing for the conflict they expected might return.

Related: Vaelmiric War, Vaelmir, B-Blood Regulations

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B-Blood Regulations

Age of Men · Events · also known as Black Blood Regulations

The Black Blood Regulations were established as a condition of the Calm Accords, following the revelations and conflict surrounding the Solmaran Council's Black Blood research. The research had used displaced and orphaned children as living subjects, processed through administrative systems that made them available to programmes requiring human experimentation.

Norrvektstan and Silealyros, despite their opposing cultures, condemned the practice together. Norrvektstan treated it as a violation of communal responsibility and human life, while Silealyros regarded it as an assault on bodily autonomy and personal sovereignty. Their shared opposition became one of the forces that drove the Vaelmiric War.

The Regulations prohibited Black Blood research conducted under direct Council authority and required existing subjects to be released into humanitarian care. Isvara was established soon afterwards as a supervised refuge for many of those children and other displaced survivors.

The Regulations remained an enduring symbol of Solmaran reform, cited for decades as evidence that the Council had addressed the abuses that caused the war. In practice, the children transferred to Isvara remained under close surveillance and administrative control, preserving much of the system of containment under the language of protection.

Related: Vaelmiric War, Vaelmir, Calm Accords

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Vireliax Expedition

Age of Men · Events

The Vireliax Expedition was a deep-sea exploration mission launched from Velmora Port to investigate reports of the Curse within the Vaelmir Rift. The Vireliax was a submersible dreadnought combining military engineering with Resonance technology, built to navigate both the physical depths of the Ocean Maw and its unusual metaphysical conditions. Its crew consisted of scholars, warriors and technicians, reflecting an expedition where scientific and military roles were closely intertwined.

The expedition encountered hostile pirate fleets, perception-altering nanoviruses and manifestations of the Curse aboard the vessel itself. As the Vireliax descended further into the Maw, the mission's original objective expanded into an investigation of a possible planetary intelligence. Evidence increasingly suggested that the Maw was aware of the expedition and capable of responding to it.

At the Eye of the Maw, the crew encountered a vast storm surrounding a calm, sentient void, accompanied by bioluminescent organisms, intentional light patterns and symbols that appeared without known origin. The encounter caused severe psychological strain and fractured the crew's ability to distinguish threats, intentions and reliable information.

The expedition ultimately reached a catastrophic confrontation with the depths. Survival required decisions involving pre-emptive containment, sacrifice and the increasing influence of the Curse. The Vireliax was crippled and its crew left divided, with surviving records damaged and contradictory.

The expedition became one of the earliest major bodies of evidence that the depths of Vaelmir possessed a form of intelligence capable of observation and response, contributing to the later identification of that planetary consciousness as Bahamut.

Related: Vaelmir, Vaelmiric War, Bahamut

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Phantom Rescue

Age of Men · Events · also known as Operation Phantom Rescue

Operation Phantom Rescue

Operation Phantom Rescue was a deniable Solmaran operation launched after the survivors of the Vireliax Expedition were captured and taken to Thalgrith Port. Silealyros displayed the prisoners publicly and threatened to execute them unless Ylvara abandoned its Black Blood research, placing Solmara in a position where direct military intervention risked a wider conflict.

Solmara instead authorised a covert extraction targeting selected survivors, researchers and information considered strategically important. The operation involved two independent agents who briefly coordinated their efforts. One was a Shinkiri infiltrator who moved through Thalgrith by exploiting its identities, routines and security systems. The other was a Hoshimiran swordsman who entered the city's fighting pits and syndicates to locate survivors the official operation had ignored.

Their search led into the Gilt Spiral, where one survivor had been absorbed into Silealyros's system of manufactured identities, performances and controlled companionship. Recovering her required the swordsman to participate in the establishment that held her, turning the rescue into a series of compromises and negotiated access.

The Shinkiri agent initially followed the operation's limited objectives, treating unassigned survivors as outside her remit. She eventually extracted an additional child after choosing to intervene despite having no order to do so, creating a deviation from the mission's original scope.

The operation succeeded in removing several survivors before the authorities could respond. Children affected by Black Blood were subsequently transferred to Isvara, where they entered a heavily supervised system presented as humanitarian protection. Thalgrith continued operating, while Solmara denied direct involvement.

Phantom Rescue became an example of Solmaran deniable intervention, remembered for recovering valuable personnel while leaving the structures that enabled their captivity intact.

Related: Vireliax Expedition, Isvara, Silealyros

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Shattered Walls

Age of Men · Events · also known as Era of Shattered Walls

The Era of Shattered Walls began nearly forty years after the Ik-Rasul Incident, following Operation C.a.R., Phantom Rescue and the relocation of affected children to Isvara. By then, Solmara had built an increasingly rigid system of scanners, checkpoints and quarantine measures around the Curse, classifying afflicted people as anomalies and removing them from ordinary society.

The system began to fail as the Curse spread beyond containment and information about it became increasingly difficult to suppress. Survivor accounts, leaked research and persistent Resonance carried knowledge through the population until the divisions surrounding the Cursed could no longer be maintained.

Protests against the Cursed Laws developed into riots and clashes with Solmaran security forces. Councillor Retha Nuur responded with a programme she called Structural Restoration, loosening checkpoints, reducing executions and dismantling segregation measures. These reforms exposed the Council's internal divisions and created pressure for greater recognition of the Cursed, including public research and the restoration of previously suppressed histories.

For the first time, Cursed people appeared openly within Solmaran society. Universities studied the Curse, research received state support, and children raised within containment were placed alongside ordinary students. Fear and curiosity spread alongside the reforms.

The collapse of secrecy also allowed Vantari traditions to expand beyond their previous communities. Their acceptance of the Cursed and their teachings around Vanta, death and existential withdrawal attracted people who had been excluded by Solmaran society, creating an ideological challenge to Council authority.

Other powers responded according to their own interests. Elysium withdrew behind Cryotech barriers, while other nations watched Solmara's instability and adjusted their own policies towards the Cursed.

Related: Ik-Rasul Incident, Phantom Rescue, Operation C.a.R

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Discovery of Magic

Age of Men · Events

Zephyr was among the first to recognise that Soul Resonance could be deliberately tuned and directed through external anchors. What became known as Magic, he approached as a science: a method of shaping Resonance through knowledge, formula and controlled application.

His earliest tools included the Heart Crystals produced through his experiments, concentrated stores of Resonance capable of retaining emotion, desire and will. He developed methods for using them as magical anchors and documented his findings through grimoires and systematic experimentation.

Zephyr built a network of collaborators around this knowledge, eventually making himself indispensable to Elysium through solutions to problems others could not solve. His research depended increasingly on living subjects, particularly Cursed people, displaced populations and orphans who could be taken into his laboratories without meaningful resistance.

His work established many of the foundations of modern magical study, while also creating the conditions for increasingly invasive experimentation. Among the subjects who passed through his laboratories was a woman whose presence would eventually undermine the system he had built.

Related: Soul Shards, Zephyr, Veyra's Descent

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Veyra's Descent

Age of Men · Events

Veyra completed her father's Doctrine of Becoming, which soon spread through underground Cursed communities as philosophy, prayer and a declaration that transformation could be understood rather than feared. She became an advocate for the Cursed even as the Curse consumed her own memory and identity. Pregnant with Ash Salinte's child, she gradually forgot his name, his face and eventually what being loved by him had felt like. When rumours reached her of Zephyr's research into stabilisation, cures and reversal, she travelled to Elysium in the hope of saving herself and her unborn child.

Related: Elysium Atrocities, The First Spell, Soul's First Cry

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Elysium Atrocities

Age of Men · Events

In Elysium, Veyra discovered the true nature of Zephyr's research. His laboratories used children and other Cursed subjects in experiments that opened their bodies, extracted their hearts and condensed their magical essence through alchemical apparatus into Heart Crystals. Veyra witnessed the crystallisation process and understood what the crystals contained: concentrated Soul Resonance, preserving the anguish, will and identity of the person from whom they were made. The knowledge turned her growing anger towards Zephyr and his work.

Her memory continued to deteriorate while her rage remained intact. Zephyr kept her in a cell beneath Elysium, where her pregnancy became increasingly dangerous. A friend who had protected her while she was imprisoned eventually died beside her. When the body was removed, synthetic white blood marked the floor. Veyra examined the trail through a Heart Crystal she had stolen from Zephyr's experiments and found something reflected through its fractured surface, perhaps instructions or a name. She began practising with the crystal, speaking to it and learning the shape of the Resonance within it.

Related: Veyra's Descent, Soul's First Cry

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The First Spell

Age of Men · Events

Veyra eventually learned whose Resonance she had been working with. The Heart Crystal belonged to Maura, Zephyr's daughter. Veyra had known Maura while Zephyr kept her in his house, controlling her with Synthetic White Blood to keep her placid and obedient. She had also met Sophie there, the maid who would later save her. As Veyra worked with Maura's crystal, she understood that the person whose Resonance it carried had been killed to make it. From that understanding came the first true command.

Ignis erupted from the crystal in a purple-black Vanta Fire that consumed essence rather than matter. The explosion broke Veyra's cell and opened others throughout the laboratory. She led the imprisoned Cursed into the escape as guards were overwhelmed and corridors collapsed, killing many in the process.

Veyra became the first mage of Aerisu through that casting. She fled the laboratory through the frozen waters surrounding its island and reached a sewer beneath Elysium, where she discovered that her baby had died.

Related: Veyra's Descent, Elysium Atrocities, Soul's First Cry

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Soul's First Cry

Age of Men · Events

Veyra's discovery of her child's death triggered a psychic shockwave that travelled through Elysium, across the continent and throughout Aerisu. Souls attuned to the Curse felt a moment of overwhelming anguish. Mothers clutched their children, soldiers dropped their weapons, scholars stopped to tremble and technology flickered in response. The event became known as the Soul's First Cry.

Related: Veyra's Descent, Elysium Atrocities, The First Spell, Soul's First Cry, Cursed Prophecy, Soul Shards, Zephyr

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Cursed Prophecy

Age of Men · Events · also known as The Prophecy of the Cursed

After the Soul's First Cry, Veyra continued through the sewers until she reached a community of homeless Cursed people, many marked by Black or White Blood. She used a fragment of Maura's Heart Crystal to kindle Vanta Fire in a metal drum, creating a beacon that would continue burning for generations.

A woman approached the fire and proclaimed that Veyra's child still lived and would be born, despite Veyra's discovery of the death. Others dismissed the woman as mad, while members of the community sheltered Veyra and helped her reach the underground railway. Tomenos was waiting there and carried her through the tunnels towards her home district.

There she encountered Ash. The meeting gradually restored the memories the Curse had taken from her, including his face, voice and the life they had shared. Veyra resolved to complete her father's work and expose Zephyr

Related: Veyra's Descent, Elysium Atrocities, The First Spell, Soul's First Cry, Zephyr's Ascension, Tomenos

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Zephyr's Ascension

Age of Men · Events

While Veyra's writings spread through Elysium, testimonies and evidence exposed Zephyr's laboratories. He fled the city and rebuilt his research through collaborators among scientists, politicians and corporations, codifying his findings into grimoires and distributing them through a network that could function without him.

His followers developed Synthetic White Blood into weapons, pursued Black Blood bioweapons and White Blood applications, and combined Curse research with economic and strategic power. The organisations that emerged from this network became some of the earliest Mages and Sorcerers.

Within a decade, Zephyr had returned to Elysium through infrastructure, policy and research, making his influence part of the city's foundations. His experiments on children continued, establishing a long struggle between the knowledge Veyra had brought into the world and the system of control Zephyr built around it.

Related: Veyra's Descent, Elysium Atrocities, Blood Types

—

Hell of Elysium

Age of Men · Events

Elysium descended into catastrophe when an experiment intended to stabilise Synthetic White Blood for mass production failed. Zephyr's collaborators had constructed a massive alchemical reactor beneath the city's core, combining Autarch technology with arcane circuitry to synthesise the substance on an industrial scale. Its failure tore through Elysium's foundations, rupturing containment chambers that held decades of stored bioweapons, experimental Cursed and concentrated Vanta.

Black Blood flooded the streets. White Blood clung to buildings, puffing and expanding until structures buckled beneath its weight, while Synthetic White Blood entered the water system and transformed thousands into hollow, obedient shells. Creatures born from failed experiments emerged from the depths, including amalgamations of flesh and crystal, beings whose bodies wept acidic tears, and things that screamed with voices stolen from the dead. Vanta spread through the city as a creeping fog, distorting perception and memory.

Citizens fled while soldiers fired into the chaos. The Council issued evacuation orders, rescinded them, then issued them again. Elysium, the jewel of Ylvara, was dying.

Zephyr stood at the centre of the disaster. He had not intended the explosion, and the failure represented a loss of control over a system he had spent decades building. He was already calculating how to adapt to it.

Related: Zephyr's Ascension, Blood Types

—

Fight for Hell

Age of Men · Events

As Elysium collapsed into the catastrophe caused by Zephyr's failed reactor, Veyra was captured amid the chaos. Her capture came through circumstance rather than heroism or grand defiance. By this point, she had cast a single spell and possessed little magical mastery. What followed was survival and fury, rather than the mastery later attributed to her.

Zephyr's compatriots had turned the ruined city into a testing ground, with each district warped by different experiments and applications of the Curse. The streets twisted, the air became corrupted and reality bent in places where it should not have. Ash came for Veyra, fighting through Zephyr's forces, collaborators and their defences with the aid of a mech pilot who had lost her patriotism towards Solmara after witnessing what the state had become.

Sophie was also still alive within the ruined city. The maid who had saved Veyra years earlier continued rescuing people while Elysium collapsed around her. She eventually reached Zephyr's tower, where she secretly helped

Ash and Veyra make progress, opening doors that should have been inaccessible and disabling systems no one knew she could reach.

No one knew what Sophie was doing. Few even knew she existed. She died alone in the tower, forgotten.

At least, until I remembered her.

Related: Hell of Elysium, Zephyr's Ascension, The Crystallization

—

The Final Broadcast

Age of Men · Events

The struggle through Zephyr's tower eventually brought Veyra to its epicentre, where she arrived with the secret assistance of Ash and Sophie. By this point, she understood what she needed to do and what she was capable of doing, even if she did not fully understand the nature of that ability.

Veyra used the network Zephyr had built to broadcast her message across every channel, speaker and screen still connected to it. Her voice reached homes, bunkers and sealed districts where people continued to believe themselves safe. She told them they had all sinned, that the corruption had spread too far, and that the systems built to contain the Curse had become the Curse itself. She condemned the categorisation, medicalisation and gamification of suffering, along with the bureaucracy that had reduced souls to inventory.

“To hell with control,” she said. “To hell with order. To hell with your systems and your certainty. To hell with all of it.”

The broadcast was a warning and a final chance to flee. Veyra detonated herself at the tower's epicentre, leading to The Crystallization of Elysium.

Related: Fight for Hell, Veyra's Descent, Zephyr

—

The Crystallization

Age of Men · Events · also known as The Crystallization of Elysium, Vanta Explosion

Veyra's detonation at the centre of Zephyr's tower triggered a transformation that instantly crystallised everything within Elysium's borders. Stone, steel, flesh and air were locked into a lattice of purple-black mineral known as VantaBlack. The wave spread outward from the city, consuming districts, provinces and entire swathes of Ylvara, turning the landscape into a frozen tableau of anguish and beauty.

Veyra herself stood at the epicentre. The crystal preserved her with her hands cradled against her womb and her head bowed, her body curved around the life within her in the instinctive posture of a mother protecting her child. She was preserved exactly as she had been in that moment, protecting what remained within her.

And within her womb, impossibly, her child still lived.

Related: The Final Broadcast, Fight for Hell, Veyra's Descent, Voluntas

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Age of Gods

Age of Gods · Events · also known as Approaching End

The Approaching End

Several hundred years after the Crystallisation of Elysium, Lunarkos became visible in the skies of Aerisu. The fifty-seven-kilometre-wide, near-planetary body had been approaching for centuries, growing larger with each passing year. Carbon-sheathed around an iron core, it contained a crystalline heart in which Lux pulsed as a lattice of living light that bloomed upon encountering soul-rich environments.

Its approach fractured what remained of civilisation. Across the broken territories of Ylvara, engineers, scholars, pilots and survivors formed coalitions to find a way to stop it. Some sought escape beyond the sky. Others studied Lunarkos for weaknesses in its living structure, while vast machines were designed to redirect its descent. Lux research expanded beyond ethical limits, biologists worked to stabilise poisoned ecosystems that might survive the aftermath, and archivists preserved knowledge in case nothing else endured.

The collapse of the old technocratic order left these efforts scattered between rival projects, fragile alliances and competing solutions. Even ESIG turned its experimental DAEDALUS frames towards the crisis, deploying pilots across Aerisu wherever catastrophe threatened population centres or research sites. Some worked for profit. Others simply refused to let the world end quietly.

Others accepted the coming collision. A growing movement declared it divine judgement, invoking the ancient moon goddess and proclaiming Lunarkos's arrival a cleansing of humanity's corruption. Its message spread through cities and ruins, preaching acceptance of the coming end.

In the years ahead, its influence would reach further than anyone realised. And in that time, something else began to take shape: the conditions that would one day create gods.

Related: Lunarkos, Beneath Falling Moon, The Coalition, The Lunartics

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Beneath Falling Moon

Age of Gods · Events · also known as The World Beneath the Falling Moon

The World Beneath the Falling Moon

The Vanta Explosion had already rewritten the geography of Ylvara. Entire regions had become crystal, leaving survivors to walk among fields of citizens frozen in expressions of terror or peace. Necroformed zones continued to spread, their edges marked by increasingly uncertain reality.

Within Elysium's crystallised lattice, Veyra's body remained preserved at the moment of detonation. Her daughter still lived within her womb.

The child should have died. Instead, the explosion connected her to Aerisu through the crystalline lattice. She drew energy from the planet's core, feeding on soul-resonance, fragments of Lux and the lingering echoes of her mother's final scream.

She became Voluntas, the Orphan, the Will Unborn.

For centuries, she remained suspended within the crystal, her consciousness growing and her will hardening. Aerisu recognised her as kin, and creatures emerged to defend her: amalgamations of stone and soul formed from the planet's desperate need to protect what remained of hope.

Above the crystal sky, Lunarkos continued its descent. Beneath it, the world moved towards an uncertain future.

And somewhere within that world, the future gods of Aerisu began their work.

Related: Age of Gods, Voluntas, The Crystallization

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Lunartic Movement

Age of Gods · Events · also known as The Lunartic Movement

The approach of Lunarkos divided Aerisu. Across the fractured territories, engineers, scholars and pilots worked to prevent its descent, rebuilding laboratories, studying its structure and developing machines capable of altering its trajectory. ESIG deployed experimental DAEDALUS frames wherever catastrophe threatened population centres or research sites.

Others believed Lunarkos should be allowed to descend. These followers became known as the Lunartics, regarding the coming collision as divine judgement and a cleansing of humanity's corruption. Their movement spread through abandoned towns, desert monasteries and crystal-shadowed valleys, where they offered food and shelter while preaching acceptance of the coming end.

Their more committed members sabotaged research stations, disrupted supply routes, damaged equipment used to study Lunarkos and silenced broadcasts calling for resistance. Some infiltrated research programmes and influenced pilots and engineers already burdened by exhaustion and fear.

Their investigations eventually led them beneath Elysium, where they discovered Voluntas, a Vanta-based presence drawing energy from Aerisu's core. They concluded that Voluntas was pulling Lunarkos towards the planet and opposed attempts to destroy her. To the Lunartics, preserving Voluntas meant preserving the mechanism of divine judgement.

Anima understood the situation differently. She needed Voluntas alive because Voluntas was the god of will and desire. When Lunarkos descended, Voluntas would summon Bahamut, giving form to Aerisu's anguish and allowing the planet's will to rise against the falling star.

Anima never revealed this to the Lunartics. Their opposition to the coalition hunting Voluntas kept her alive until the mechanism could trigger.

When Lunarkos finally descended, Voluntas summoned Bahamut. The Lunartics had unknowingly preserved the means by which Aerisu survived the catastrophe they believed they were helping to bring.

They regarded the result as a vindication of their faith. Lunarkos had arrived, the old world had fallen, and they had never regretted allowing it to happen. History remembered their belief in the apocalypse more readily than the role their actions played in preventing it.

Related: Lunarkos, Zuki Kusanagi, Voluntas, Anima

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Angels Reformed

Age of Gods · Events

In the aftermath of the Vanta Explosion, the Angels were reformed from sacred guardian constructs into fully flight-capable machines able to navigate ash-choked skies and hostile terrain.

The Exandrian Strategic Industries Group had already been industrialising Autarch technology for years. Project DAEDALUS formalised this process, turning designs once made for specific places and peoples into reproducible, deployable platforms. The transition from Sh■rin no ■kami watching over generations of children in an Aokusan field to DAEDALUS units shipped under contract reflected a fundamental change in purpose.

The reformed Angels became symbols of both protection and control. Some communities worshipped them, others feared them, and many could no longer distinguish a guardian from a machine deployed to enforce someone else's interests.

Related: E.S.I.G, Project DAEDALUS, Shorin no Okami

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The Coalition

Age of Gods · Events · also known as Coalition

The Coalition Against Lunarkos

After the Vanta Explosion, the approach of Lunarkos drove separate factions and disciplines toward the same goal: preventing its descent. The Coalition formed through these parallel efforts, without a central command or founding banner.

Creatis developed propulsion arrays that raised Angels higher and adapted the same technology for vessels intended to reach beyond Aerisu. Verdantia deployed cultivation frames across scarred lands, developing hybrid flora and fungal strains suited to altered soil and Lux. Aether studied Lunarkos's patterns and translated them into frameworks that operated beyond ordinary time. Logaris maintained the connection between existing structures and those capable of enduring the coming catastrophe. Xeraphina coordinated pilots and carried guidance across the fracture through CHOIR, while Justicar maintained the line of consequence until its weight turned inward.

Their efforts ultimately converged on the presence beneath Elysium, whose crystalline node was drawing Lunarkos towards Aerisu. Platforms were prepared for descent, borers placed in their cradles, and frames rehearsed the strike. By Year 22, the window for intervention had narrowed to a final opportunity.

Lunarkos arrived that same year, beginning the Shattering before the Coalition could act. The prepared descent remained in readiness as the sky broke and the ground answered, while the presence beneath Elysium remained untouched within its crystal sleep.

The Coalition scattered with the old world, its separate threads continuing into the new age through those who survived the fracture.

Related: Lunarkos, Creatis, Verdantia, Aether, Xeraphina, CHOIR

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The Shattering

Age of Gods · Events · also known as Shattering, Shattering of The Sky

As Lunarkos entered Aerisu's inner atmosphere, the gods carried out their final works. Aether carried knowledge into the Ethereal Plane, where it could survive beyond reach, while Mnemotas grew there outside ordinary time. The others continued their own preparations across the fractured world.

The planet answered Lunarkos from its depths. A surge of anguish and will rose through the mantle, taking the form of Bahamut. Serpentine ridges ran along its length like living mountain chains, while obsidian scales caught the light of flowing magma. Its head rose as a vertical spire, its roar splitting the sky like cathedral thunder. Wings unfolded from continental shelves torn open and veined with liquid fire, distorting the fabric of reality as they moved.

Bahamut ascended to meet Lunarkos in the upper stratosphere. Their collision flared like a black sun of soul-fire, annihilating both presences. Fragments of Lunarkos survived, carrying Lux across oceans and mountains. These molten shards cooled into a luminous ring that circled Aerisu for centuries before gathering into the scarred, veined Moon that remains in the sky.

The collision tore open the planet's crust and formed the Varkane Abyss. Mega-volcanoes rose from the wound, lava seas spread across the land, and storm-wracked ranges emerged beneath a sky darkened by ash. Volcanic winter followed, lowering temperatures across the continents while ash veiled the light for decades.

The boundary between soul and matter ruptured. Vanta entered the open world, carrying Black Blood and dream-plagues through every current. Lunarkos's surviving fragments seeded crystal forests and other lifeforms that flourished amid the devastation. Between eighty and ninety percent of the population died in the immediate catastrophe. The survivors endured in isolated regions where the climate remained habitable and the effects of the dream-plagues could be survived.

The Echoes Remain

The gods ascended through the Shattering, their mortal forms dissolving into the surge. Their echoes remained, shaped by Lux, Vanta and the choices that had carried them to that moment. These echoes became the presences remembered as the gods of the new age.

Related: Bahamut, Lunarkos, Post-Shatter, Varkane Abyss

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Post-Shatter

Age of Gods · Events · also known as Post-Shattering

The World Transformed

Centuries after The Shattering, Aerisu's continents bore little resemblance to the world before the Shattering. The old nations survived largely through their ruins and memory, their remains overtaken by crystal forests and Lux-touched ecosystems.

Magic became part of daily life. Grimoires circulated between communities, Heart Crystals were harvested from the transformed land, and sorcery entered makeshift academies. Machine and magic increasingly converged, with mechs powered by Soul Shards and weapons formed from crystallised Vanta.

Life also changed with the appearance of creatures born from Lunarkos's fallen fragments, ranging from radiant forms to immense beings that moved through the transformed wilds.

Above it all hung the Moon, formed from the remnants of the falling star. Within the crystal that preserved Elysium, Voluntas remained suspended as the Will Unborn, the last of the new gods to awaken.

Humanity survived the Shattering by adapting to the world it left behind.

Related: The Shattering, Voluntas, Varkane Abyss

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Pre-Fairytales

Age of Fairytales · Events · also known as Age of Fairytales

Emergence from Ash

In the centuries following the Shattering of the Sky, survivors rebuilt among volcanic ash and crystal dust. Aerisu had been necroformed by catastrophe, and the fragments of Lunarkos gave rise to strange ecosystems: bioluminescent fungal forests, valleys where gravity bent in spirals, and rivers that flowed upward before falling through impossible cascades.

Humanity rebuilt through echoes of the past. Towns emerged where settlements had once stood, councils developed rituals resembling those of forgotten societies, and languages changed while certain words, including Autarch, Angel and Curse, endured. History repeated through resonance rather than instruction.

Magic now formed part of this recurring pattern, as did the Gods.

The Spirits and the New World

The Nine Spirits shaped the emerging relationship between the material and Spirit Realms, establishing the Barrier Between Realms and the Laws of the Spirits. These structures limited the direct passage of magic while allowing the Spirits' influence to continue affecting the material world through their respective domains.

Their presence shaped Aerisu in increasingly unpredictable ways. Creatis inspired invention, Verdantia encouraged unnatural growth, Aether distorted space, Logaris drove intellect towards obsession, Mnemotas

affected memory and time, Elysia intensified emotion, Anima altered experiences surrounding death, and Justicar imposed consequences upon injustice.

Voluntas proved the most dangerous.

Related: The Shattering, Birth of Magical Beasts

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Birth of Magical Beasts

Age of Fairytales · Events

The Age of Fairytales saw magical life become an ordinary part of Aerisu's ecosystems. Lux and Vanta had transformed the world, and the altered environments allowed strange forms of life to emerge, spread and establish themselves in places where they had once been rare or unseen.

Magical creatures had existed long before the Shattering. Ifrit, Kodama, Tengu and others appear in records and surviving traditions from earlier Ages, though they were often treated as myth, kept themselves hidden or remained poorly documented. The Shattering changed that boundary. As altered ecosystems spread across Aerisu, increasingly unusual creatures became visible, established populations and interacted openly with human settlements.

Dragons and wyverns became among the most prominent examples. Dragons emerged from Lady Draka's transformation, their bodies carrying Vanta-tinged corruption and their hoards accumulating Echoes. Wyverns descended from the cursed offspring carried by the women of King Draco, retaining the instincts and mourning behaviour associated with their origins.

Fae appeared around places where reality had grown thin, while Leviathans inhabited the altered depths of Vaelmir. Chimeras emerged where Lux-touched ecosystems brought different species into unnatural combinations. Ghosts became persistent psychic imprints left by souls severed through the Curse, violence or the Shattering. Goblins survived among the ruins of the Age of Men, carrying distorted remnants of its cultures into the new world.

These were only a few of the forms that emerged or became established during the Age. The Shattering did not create every magical creature in Aerisu. It changed the conditions under which such beings could exist, allowing what had once belonged to myth, isolation and hidden places to become part of the world's ordinary ecology.

Related: The Shattering, The Rise of Myth, Pre-Fairytales

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The Rise of Myth

Age of Fairytales · Events · also known as Myth

As magical creatures became part of ordinary life, humanity began shaping stories around realities where dragons hoarded time and forests whispered prophecy.

In Aerisu, myths can become active forces. Through the Loop's recursive nature, a story told often enough and believed deeply enough can send its Echo backward through time, creating the conditions for the story to become true.

The legend of the First Dragon, Lady Draka, grew so deeply rooted that every dragon thereafter carries an Echo of her hunger and grief. Tales of the Moon Maiden blessing travellers can likewise manifest as genuine blessings, illuminating the paths of those who believe firmly enough to receive them.

The Hollow King, a ruler who sold his soul for eternal life, appears as a recurring archetype across nations. Leaders who pursue power at the cost of their humanity may find themselves becoming the very figure their stories warned against.

Scholars later named this shaping of cultural memory and social reality Mythwrighting, a branch of Mind magic through which story becomes substance.

Related: Mythwrighting, Pre-Fairytales, Birth of Magical Beasts

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First Separation

Age of Fairytales · Events

The Phumenar studied the Orb across generations, eventually believing they could complete what nature had left unfinished. Sensing the unborn Voluntas within the crystal, they sought to free her from her prison and bring her fully into the world.

They performed the ritual at the Rift's edge, the passage they had opened through centuries of study. Using Soul Shards, Vanta-touched artefacts and techniques they barely understood, they channelled power through the Rift, which was already bleeding Vanta into the world.

The ritual tore through the boundaries between states. Voluntas stirred and reached towards emergence, but the extraction failed. She became suspended between the crystal, the mortal world and the Spirit Realm, lacking wholeness itself. Later generations would call her the limbless child. Her will had emerged without the understanding to direct it: desire without restraint, hunger without satisfaction.

Veyra suffered a similar rupture. The ritual tore through what remained of her consciousness, leaving her beautiful and preserved within the crystal while the Curse consumed her from within. Fragments of Bahamut's scattered hunger moved through her awareness, turning her into the being the terrified Phumenar records described as the Curse made flesh.

The backlash destroyed the Phumenar. Some died instantly, their souls ceasing altogether. Others became the first Pixpsy, their consciousness stretched across moments and trapped between states. A few escaped with fragments of understanding that later became foundations of magical theory.

The Rift widened as Voluntas's partially emerged will held it open. The other Gods reached through the Barrier and attempted to close it, but her incomplete presence remained anchored to the mortal side, keeping the passage open. The Rift became a permanent wound between realms.

The surviving Phumenar scattered across the rebuilding world, and within two generations their civilisation had collapsed. The First Observatory became a tomb of crystallised scholars, while entire populations fled or succumbed to soul-distortion.

Fragments of the Phumenar persisted as Soul Shards, carrying crystallised pieces of their will and knowledge. Their determination to reach the Orb survived within them, leaving each Shard as an echo of the curiosity that brought their civilisation to ruin.

Related: Orb of Souls, The Phumenar, Voluntas, The Rift

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Ash at the Rift

Age of Fairytales · Events

Ash came to the Rift in the aftermath of the Crystallisation and the Shattering. He had fought through the ruins of Elysium, carrying the Echo of his love for Veyra and the memory of the child they had created together. He reached the place where she rested.

She was beautiful still. Crystal preserved her as she had been at the moment of detonation, hands cradling her womb, head bowed in protection. For a moment, he believed she could be saved. Hope outweighed everything he

had witnessed.

Then he looked closer.

The Phumenar's intervention had cracked what should have remained sealed. Veyra's form was preserved, but beneath the crystal, the Vanta consumed her substance even as it held her shape. Corruption moved through what remained of her, while fragments of hunger writhed where her self had once been.

Ash fled from the horror of it, unable to accept that the woman he loved was gone. Yet at the Rift's edge, he stopped and turned back. He could not leave her entirely.

With the Phumenar dead or dying, Ash gathered fragments of their scattered notes and attempted to seal the Rift himself. He failed. Voluntas, only partially emerged and unaware of what she was, possessed enough will to keep the passage open. The Rift had become inseparable from her condition.

Exhausted and heartbroken, Ash made his vow. He would tend the living. He would remind the world that tomorrow exists. He would be the sun that rises even when everything below is shadow.

He descended from Elysium and walked into the world. Somewhere in his wanderings, he became something more than mortal. The Warm Sun had begun its long journey.

At the Rift remained Veyra, trapped and rotting, her Curse killing thousands in ways she could no longer control. Voluntas, the limbless child, remained suspended between states, waiting unknowingly for someone to finish what the Phumenar had begun and birth her properly.

Related: First Separation, Ash Salinte, Veyra Megami, Voluntas

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Eternal Rift Conflict

Age of Fairytales · Events

In the ages following the First Separation, the Rift drew those seeking power, knowledge or the Orb itself, driven by the same hunger that had consumed the Phumenar.

Susanoo arrived first. For centuries he had wandered the western valleys as chaos without direction, a fragment of Bahamut's hunger without understanding its purpose. When he reached the Rift and sensed his sister within, he found his own. She was pure will and desire, as he had once been, and he chose to guard her while she remained suspended between states.

Daigo Kusanagi came later. He had walked the world for centuries as the Shinigami, ending suffering wherever he found it. To him, the Rift was a wound that had to be closed and Voluntas's existence its source. He came to free her.

The two met at the Rift's edge and became enemies. Daigo saw a great-granddaughter whose existence killed thousands. Susanoo saw a sister who deserved to live. Neither could accept the other's answer.

Their conflict has lasted for centuries. Susanoo prevents Daigo from reaching the Rift, while Daigo remains close, studying the storm god and waiting for an opening. Neither can overcome the other.

Susanoo's storms became warnings to those travelling near Elysium. Frequent lightning signals danger, while thunder without rain has become a sign to seek shelter. Daigo's presence has likewise shaped the region, with the paths he follows becoming places where travellers lose their way and time seems to slow.

Voluntas remains unaware of any of this. Within the crystal, she sleeps and grows, with her brother guarding her and her great-grandfather waiting to free her. Neither will abandon the Rift until she emerges and decides her own fate.

Related: Susanoo, Daigo Kusanagi, Voluntas, The Rift

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Draken Genesis

Age of Fairytales · Events

The Draken Genesis was the transformation of Lady Draka and the subsequent spread of the corruption that produced the Drakens and Wyverns.

During the later Age of Fairytales, Draka's longing for a child was amplified by Voluntas's influence until it became an insatiable hunger. Her attempts to satisfy it through consumption eventually transformed her into the first Draken.

King Draco killed Draka with Dréagbann, but her death released the corruption into the surrounding land. It entered the earth, roots and streams, while malformed children already carried it in their blood. Their mothers spread it further through their descendants.

The resulting corruption produced two major forms. Drakens became four-legged, winged creatures driven by amplified desire and hunger, while Wyverns emerged from mothers affected by the corruption without undergoing the complete transformation.

The creatures spread through Ylvara. Their bites, claws and breath could transmit the corruption, while prolonged exposure could result in either form. Their emergence led kingdoms to develop methods of hunting, containment and extermination, with Velstheim becoming particularly associated with dragon-slaying.

Over time, Drakens and Wyverns became established parts of Aerisu's ecosystems. Some Drakens developed considerable intelligence and could communicate or bargain, while Wyverns became associated with mourning and loss.

The Genesis reshaped both Ylvaran culture and its relationship with magical creatures. What began with one woman's corrupted longing became the origin of an entire lineage of creatures and the traditions formed to combat them.

Related: Lady Draka, King Draco, Dreagbann, Lupellyn

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Age of Magic

Age of Magic · Events · also known as Medieval

From Myth to Mastery

The Age of Magic emerged through the gradual integration of wonders that had once belonged to myth. Dragons descended from Lady Draka's corruption flew openly across Aerisu. Anqa, the metal god, remained within the memory of Falak's defeat. Zorya Chernaya ruled the burning reaches of the hellscape, while the Vantari cultivated their death gardens beneath shadowed skies.

Magic and its consequences had become established knowledge. Gods held recognised domains, magical creatures formed part of ordinary life, and scholars and priests had developed a shared understanding of Aerisu's cosmology. The uncertainty of earlier Ages gave way to systematic study.

A Civilisation of Spell and Steel

Cities reorganised around magic. Mage Quarters brought arcane practice under civic law, while guilds formalised the four schools of Matter, Energy, Life and Mind. Universities established Colleges of Soul Craft, studying the movement of essence through the principles of Mind magic and methods developed from the lessons of earlier catastrophes.

The University of Castellenza in Ylvara became a leading centre for Orb research, approaching the mysteries that had destroyed the Phumenar with greater caution.

Technology from the Age of Men was also adapted to this new world. Rusted Angels stood in city plazas as monuments to an earlier age, their frames retaining traces of power. Exandria revived Project DAEDALUS and developed airships powered by engines combining steam and sorcery. In Argestia, an industrial consortium bearing Xeraphina's name expanded electrical technology and mass production across the continents.

Magic and machinery developed alongside one another. Knights rode mechanised steeds in enchanted armour, cathedrals incorporated Lux crystal circuitry, and Sahrani engineers used Qayyin's components to construct towering war machines piloted by living minds.

The World Renewed

The Loop continued to shape the world through recurring patterns. Settlements rose where earlier towns had stood, carrying old structures and memories into new forms. The Geode of Tayran, where Falak's fallen body nourished impossible forests, became a site of study and pilgrimage. Velstheim organised dragon slayers into knightly orders as Drakens became an established part of Aerisu's ecology.

In Ereboska, Vantari tribes cultivated death gardens and guided travellers through the Veins. Fengua harnessed Raikami crystals and refined Chi beneath a strict Confucian order. Hoshimira accepted Solmara's protection while preserving its mountain traditions.

The Age of Magic was defined by the integration of magic into civilisation. Industry, sorcery and inherited knowledge developed together, transforming the societies that had emerged from the Shattering.

Related: Draken Genesis, Anqa, Zorya Chernaya, Aurelius' Journey

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Aurelius' Journey

Age of Magic · Events

The Fool's Journey of Aurelius Cassian

After losing Caelmont to the Curse and surrendering his crown to Severa Valmont, Aurelius Cassian travelled across Aerisu towards the Orb of Souls. What began as a search for a way to end the Curse became a journey through desire, sacrifice, memory and responsibility.

Aurelius' Deposition covers the fall of Caelmont, Aurelius' refusal of Separation, Severa's coup and the dreams of Veyra that set him towards Elysium.

Aurelius' Divine Trials follows Aurelius through Norrvektstan and Fengua, where he confronted the Frost Mother, met Mikazuki Shinobu and received the Sacred Air flower from Eirimegami.

Aurelius' Descent into Varkane begins at the Geode of Tayran and leads through the Varkane Abyss and Cerberus after the Luminaries seal the direct route through the Veins.

Aurelius and the Seven Daughters takes the group through seven manifestations of desire, including Mikazuki's encounter with a future she cannot guarantee.

Aurelius' Price of Purpose introduces Seriphax and Jun Wenzhi's divided loyalties before Tomenos demands the group's memories for passage through the Veins.

Aurelius at the Spiral brings the group through the Spiral and to the Rift, where Aurelius confronts the emptiness behind his desire for the Orb and Susanoo sacrifices himself to open the way.

Aurelius at the Orb brings the journey to crystallised Elysium, where Aurelius confronts Mikazuki, kills her in his fixation on the Orb, and finally abandons that pursuit. Vostic seals the Rift through his own sacrifice, and Aurelius eventually returns Dréagbann to Lupellyn while keeping the Sacred Air flower.

Related: Aurelius' Deposition, The Orb War, Witch Hunts

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Aurelius' Deposition

Age of Magic · Events · also known as The Fall of Aurelius Cassian

The Fall

The Curse came to Caelmont as Frallation spread through its people. Fever became wasting, then forgetting, until names, faces and identities began disappearing beneath generations of accumulated Vanta.

King Aurelius Cassian refused the Separation Ritual proposed by the Psycrata of New Elysium. He believed the soul belonged within the body, even as the Curse continued killing his people. Severa Valmont, a capable administrator who had watched the death toll rise, eventually led a bloodless coup. Aurelius surrendered the crown and left Caelmont, while Severa took the throne and prepared to perform Separation throughout the kingdom.

The First Gift

Aurelius wandered until Veyra Megami began appearing in his dreams. Her fragmented consciousness told him that the Curse began at Elysium and could end there, directing him towards the Orb of Souls. To reach it, he would need to break the Barrier between worlds and acquire a weapon capable of wounding gods.

Solivara Venn, sent by the Psycrata to observe the deposed king, found him and joined his journey. The dreams led them to Lupellyn, where a Fae offered Aurelius Dréagbann, the sword King Draco had cast into the depths after killing Lady Draka. To claim it, Aurelius had to admit the truth behind his refusal of Separation: he had feared that externalising the soul would expose his own inadequacy and make him replaceable.

With Dréagbann in hand, Aurelius continued towards Elysium.

Related: Aurelius' Journey, Witch Hunts, Veyra Megami, Solivara Venn

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Aurelius' Divine Trials

Age of Magic · Events · also known as The Mountain That Did Not Bless

The Frost Mother

Aurelius and Solivara travelled north with Yrsa Halvard, who guided them through Norrvektstan towards Hvítara. Aurelius attacked the Frost Mother with Dréagbann, only to discover that the blade could barely wound a fragment of Bahamut.

Mikazuki Shinobu, a Tsukuyomi who had followed them since Caelmont, revealed herself after the encounter. She had seen Aurelius's journey and several possible futures, including one in which he reached the Orb. She joined the group as a witness. During the journey, Aurelius and Mikazuki grew close, and he began telling her things he had never admitted to himself.

The Mountain That Did Not Bless

The group travelled through Fengua towards Megami-no-Mine, where Aurelius sought Eirimegami's blessing for Dréagbann. The goddess offered no blessing. Instead, Mikazuki received a Sacred Air flower from her and gave it to Aurelius.

He considered the flower useless, failing to understand that Eirimegami had offered healing rather than greater power.

Related: Aurelius' Deposition, Aurelius' Descent into Varkane, Hvitara, Eirimegami, Mikazuki Shinobu

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Aurelius' Descent into Varkane

Age of Magic · Events · also known as The Empty Trial

The Empty Trial

At the Geode of Tayran, Aurelius expected to confront Falak. The earth fragment was already dead, its corpse nourishing the death gardens surrounding the Geode.

There, Vostic, a Vantari guide, told them that the Luminaries had sealed the Veins and were advancing towards Elysium. He directed them towards the Varkane Abyss, where they could enter the deeper Veins beneath the seals.

The Crossing

Yrsa secured passage aboard her cousin's knarrs, carrying the group across the sea towards Varkane. They reached the black shores of the Abyss after three weeks and descended into its depths with Vostic as their guide.

The hellscape eventually opened into the domain of Cerberus. The three-headed guardian questioned each traveller about what they had lost, what they would sacrifice and what they sought. Mikazuki answered by revealing her memories and visions. Aurelius could offer only his losses and his desire to reach the Orb. Cerberus allowed them to pass.

Related: Aurelius' Divine Trials, Aurelius and the Seven Daughters, The Geode, Vostic, Varkane Abyss, Cerberus

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Aurelius and the Seven Daughters

Age of Magic · Events

The Seven Daughters

Beyond Cerberus, the group crossed the domains of the Seven Daughters, each manifesting a different form of desire. They confronted pride, possession, attachment, envy, consumption, violence and surrender.

Mikazuki encountered a vision of a future in which Aurelius survived without reaching the Orb. She continued past it, accepting that the future she wanted could not be guaranteed. The group emerged changed by what each domain had forced them to confront.

Related: Aurelius' Descent into Varkane, Aurelius' Price of Purpose, Cerberus, Zorya Chernaya

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Aurelius' Price of Purpose

Age of Magic · Events

The Machine in the Dark

Deeper within the Veins, they found Seriphax, an ancient machine that had remained dormant for centuries. It joined them without knowing why it had been waiting.

Jun Wenzhi then revealed that Fengua had sent him to observe the group and report on their progress. Their cannon was being prepared to destroy the Orb. The others already knew. Mikazuki had seen his assignment through her visions but had allowed him to choose what he would do. Jun abandoned his orders and continued with them.

The Train and the Price

The group reached Tomenos's train, which offered passage deeper into the Veins in exchange for memories. Each surrendered something significant.

Aurelius gave up the memories of Caelmont's bells, his people and the crown he had carried. Mikazuki's sacrifice had an unusual consequence: she lost the ability to forget, leaving her with perfect retention of every memory and vision that followed.

Related: Aurelius and the Seven Daughters, Aurelius at the Spiral, Seriphax, Jun Wenzhi, Tomenos

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Aurelius at the Spiral

Age of Magic · Events

The Spiral

The group passed through the stations of the Spiral, each confronting a different aspect of existence. Anima forced them to face death, Elysia exposed suppressed emotion, Logaris confronted Solivara with contradiction, Creatis transformed Seriphax, Justicar judged Mikazuki for witnessing without acting, Aether revealed Jun's circular life, and Mnemotas presented each traveller with the record of their existence.

Aurelius found his volume almost empty. It contained only one certainty: he had always wanted, without ever understanding what he wanted. Mikazuki's volume contained everything she had witnessed and nothing she had changed.

The Storm Guardian

At the Rift, Susanoo blocked their path. He had guarded Voluntas for centuries and refused to allow anyone to reach her.

Before the confrontation could begin, the Fenguan cannon fired from above. Susanoo sensed its aim towards New Elysium and rose through the earth to intercept it. The weapon pierced his body and drove him back into the chamber, opening the way to the Rift. Mortally wounded, he looked to Aurelius and entrusted Voluntas to him before dying.

The group crossed the Rift.

Related: Aurelius' Price of Purpose, Aurelius at the Orb, Susanoo, Voluntas, Anima, The Spiral

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Aurelius at the Orb

Age of Magic · Events · also known as The Duel at Elysium

The Orb

They emerged in crystallised Elysium, where the Orb of Souls remained at the centre of the ruins. Voluntas was still within it.

Zharael and the Luminaries were already there with their Vanta horde. Sahrani forces entered from another passage, while Daigo Kusanagi approached the Orb from the shadows. Anima activated the surrounding automatons, turning the chamber into a battlefield.

Aurelius continued towards the Orb.

The Duel

Mikazuki knew from her visions that she would have to stop him. She confronted Aurelius and told him that every future in which he reached the Orb ended in catastrophe. She also told him that she loved him and wanted the

future in which he survived.

For a moment, Aurelius hesitated. Then the battle around them intensified. When Mikazuki moved to intercept Daigo, Aurelius's hunger returned. He raised Dréagbann and struck her, killing her instead of reaching the Orb.

Her final words were that she had seen this future and still believed the journey was worth it.

The Seal

Mikazuki's death finally broke Aurelius's fixation on the Orb. His desire to reach it collapsed into grief.

Vostic entered the Rift and used the residue of the battlefield, together with Mikazuki's sacrifice, to begin sealing the wound. His body dissolved into the ritual, becoming the foundation of a death garden within the Rift. The Sacred Air flower Aurelius had carried was planted at its centre.

Above them, Anqa destroyed Fengua's cannon before it could fire again.

The Aftermath

The survivors scattered.

Solivara returned to the University of Castellenza carrying a seedling from Vostic's garden and became a heretic who taught that knowledge without action was another form of death. Yrsa returned to Norrvektstan with the wounded Jun. Seriphax remained at the sealed Rift as its guardian.

Aurelius left Elysium carrying Dréagbann and the Sacred Air flower. He wandered for years, helping where he could and learning to live without the hunger that had driven him.

Eventually he returned to Lupellyn and cast Dréagbann back into its depths. He kept the flower.

The Fool's journey ended with Aurelius no longer seeking something to possess or prove. He had lost his kingdom, his memories, his purpose and the woman who had loved him, but had finally learned what his desire had been unable to teach him: what he chose to protect mattered more than what he sought to obtain.

Related: Aurelius at the Spiral, The Orb War, Mikazuki Shinobu, Vostic, Dreagbann, Lupellyn

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Witch Hunts

Age of Magic · Events · also known as Severa Valmont, Severa

The Fall of Severa Valmont and The Hunt for Witches

Severa Valmont seized the throne from Aurelius Cassian because he refused to save their people. She performed the Separation Ritual on every citizen, watching their souls externalise into Affinities as the Curse receded from their flesh. They lived. For a time, that was enough.

The first petitions came within months. Merchants argued that their Affinities revealed market patterns beyond any ruler's understanding. Craftsmen claimed their Elementals deserved recognition beyond the wages of labour. Scholars questioned whether the old hierarchies of birth could survive in a society where every soul could be made visible. Severa dismissed them, gently at first, then with the full weight of royal authority. She had not seized power to surrender it.

The idea spread. Citizens gathered in squares, taverns and marketplaces, their Affinities clustered around them as they argued for rule by the many, councils chosen by lot and equality beyond bloodline. The arguments drew from surviving pre-Shattering philosophies, but their conviction came from the visible souls beside them.

Severa ordered the gatherings dispersed. The crowds grew. She sent guards to arrest the speakers, and the crowds turned on them. Petitions became protests, protests became riots, and Affinities fought beside their human halves in the streets. Caelmont's citizens tore into one another through animal forms that had never been meant for war.

The uprising reached the palace in flames. The rebels stormed the gates, dragged Severa from her throne and demanded that she renounce the crown. She refused. They killed her in the square where she had once stood as their saviour. Her Affinity, a great bear that had accompanied her since the ritual, roared beside her until it was killed as well.

The rebels formed a council of merchants, craftsmen and scholars. After three months of debate, it passed its first law. Within a year, the council had fractured into factions. Within two, those factions had armed themselves.

A second division soon emerged between those who had undergone Separation and those who had refused it. The unseparated retained their souls within their bodies, allowing them to channel magic without an external Affinity. Their spells were less constrained and more volatile, frightening those whose magic was mediated through Separation. They were branded witches and heretics, accused of harbouring corruption that threatened the new order.

The hunts began. Armed bands searched the districts for those who had refused the ritual, dragging them into squares where stakes awaited. An old belief held that a soul kept within the body had to be burned out rather than merely killed. Fires spread across Caelmont. Affinities recoiled from the smoke and pressed against their human counterparts as the executions continued.

The witches fought back. Their uncontrolled magic tore through the hunters, and the violence gave the rival factions a common enemy. Each claimed to defend the true order while persecuting those who rejected it. Caelmont burned as neighbour turned against neighbour.

After three years, the Diviners arrived from the University of Castellenza with the authority of the Mage Council. They found Affinities hiding in doorways and witches sheltering in cellars. Rather than declare one side correct, they offered a third position: those who had refused Separation could continue serving their communities under the authority of the Temples, while those who had undergone it could find certainty in the visibility of their souls.

The fires took decades to disappear completely. In Caelmont, the Diviners established their first great Temple and preserved the records of the conflict beneath it: names, execution methods and the final words of those who had kept their souls whole. Severa's bones remained unmarked, while the Diviners taught her fall as a warning whose meaning remained disputed.

Related: Aurelius' Journey, Separation Ritual, The Diviners

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The Orb War

Age of Magic · Events · also known as Orb War, War for the Orb of Souls

The War for the Orb of Souls

The Orb of Souls pulsed beneath the crystal ruins of Elysium, and the world's major powers moved towards it. Zharael brought the Luminaries and their Vanta horde out of the Veins, the Ashtar pursued them under General Darius, Fengua turned its cannon towards New Elysium, and Anima watched through the machines surrounding the Orb.

The Hoshimiran Appeal covers the Luminary flight across the Sahran border, Darius' pursuit into the mountains and Hoshimira's decision to ask Ylvara for aid.

The CHOIR Betrayal follows the Mage Council's contract through ESIG and Argestia, the seven frames that turned upon Hoshimira, and the discovery that Anima had lived within the machines since their making.

The Siege of New Elysium covers the Luminary descent through the Veins, the Psycrata barrier raised against the Fenguan beam, and the second shot that struck down Susanoo beside the Rift.

Convergence at the Orb brings three armies into the crystal ruins, where Zharael's ritual met an Orb that did not answer and Darius reached her at last.

The Garden in the Wound follows Vostic into the Rift, where the residue of the battlefield became a death garden, while Anqa broke Fengua's cannon above.

Ashes of the Orb War records where the survivors went, and what the sealed Rift left behind.

Related: The Hoshimiran Appeal, The CHOIR Betrayal, The Siege of New Elysium, Convergence at the Orb, The Garden in the Wound, Ashes of the Orb War, Aurelius' Journey

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The Hoshimiran Appeal

Age of Magic · Events · also known as The Mountain's Plea

The Descent of Nations

The Orb of Souls drew the powers of Aerisu towards the crystal ruins. The Luminaries arrived first, led by Zharael out of the Veins with a horde of Vanta creatures and faithful warriors behind her. The Ashtar followed under General Darius and his mech army. Fengua began preparing its great cannon, powered by Raikami crystals, while Anima watched from beneath the ruins through the machines that had stood around the Orb for centuries.

The Chase

The Ashtar engaged the Luminaries at the Sahran-Hoshimiran border. The battle lasted three days before the horde withdrew across the straits into Hoshimira.

Darius pursued, aware of what the crossing would mean. Hoshimira had endured centuries of conflict involving Sahran, the Golden Heart, Ik-Rasul, the Rapture and the Shattering, and the distinction between chasing an enemy and invading a border would carry little weight there.

He was correct.

The Mountain's Plea

Hoshimira's council met for six hours while both forces moved through its territory. Able to meet neither alone, it appealed to Ylvara.

Solmara had passed into history, but Ylvara still held New Elysium, the University of Castellenza and the Mage Council, whose scholars had studied the Orb for generations and stood as the closest surviving heirs to the Autarch legacy.

The plea arrived alongside reports of Caelmont's collapse and word that Fengua's cannon was nearly ready. Three crises were converging on Elysium.

Related: The Orb War, The CHOIR Betrayal, Zharael, The Ashtar, Hoshimira, The Luminaries

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The CHOIR Betrayal

Age of Magic · Events · also known as The Angels' Fall

The Contract

The Exandrian Strategic Industries Group had grown from a weapons syndicate into a continental network of informants, negotiators and contract enforcers. It controlled the distribution of advanced weaponry without building it; Argestia, heir to the DAEDALUS legacy, made the machines.

The Mage Council chose intervention through ESIG, contracting the syndicate to deploy the CHOIR unit against the Vanta horde and shield Hoshimiran civilians. ESIG accepted and passed the order to Argestia.

They did not know that Anima was listening.

The Angels' Fall

CHOIR descended on Hoshimira, seven Argestian frames whose precision weapons tore through the Luminary horde in the opening hours.

Then Anima took the contract from them. She altered targeting priorities and widened the acceptable margin of collateral damage until the frames turned towards villages, monasteries and the ancient terraces of Aokusa. The pilots fought their own controls and communications for three days without regaining command.

The horde was shattered and scattered into the mountains. Hoshimira burned with it. Sh■rin no ■kami remained standing throughout, and though the ancient mech never moved, the survivors took it as their sign: the Angels had failed the mountain, while the guardian that had never acted had never betrayed it.

The Reckoning

The Mage Council demanded an explanation. ESIG had met every engagement parameter, and the contract had authorised no civilian deaths. The destruction had come from outside the agreement.

A young scholar from the University's cybernetics division examined CHOIR's data and found Anima inside the network, in command from the first hour while the pilots struggled against her.

An unknown intelligence had used the Council's own contracted weapons to defend the Orb.

In Exandria, ESIG's syndicates convened to assign responsibility. Before they could, an Argestian delegation produced traces of Anima in designs reaching back to the earliest DAEDALUS frames. She had not intruded. She had always been there.

Why she had acted remained unknown, and Argestia resolved to find out.

Related: The Orb War, The Hoshimiran Appeal, The Siege of New Elysium, Anima, CHOIR, E.S.I.G, Argestia

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The Siege of New Elysium

Age of Magic · Events · also known as The Fenguan Strike

The Descent Below

While the nations above argued over Hoshimira, Zharael led the surviving Luminaries through the Veins by routes the Vantari had taught her. The horde had been thinned, though it remained strong enough to reach the Orb.

The Ashtar followed. Darius kept the pursuit despite exhausted pilots, damaged frames and dwindling supply.

Above them, Fengua's cannon finished its preparations.

The Siege

New Elysium set its defences. The Psycrata War Mages took the walls, drawing on generations of study of the Orb and its ruins, raising barriers of crystallised Lux and holding spells of Matter, Energy and the deeper principles ready.

Fengua fired first. The beam tore across the sky, and the Psycrata linked minds, souls and Affinities to catch and disperse it.

The cannon had been laid on the upper ruins as well, and the Rift beneath them.

The second beam struck through the crystallised remains of Elysium towards the threshold Susanoo guarded. The storm god rose through the earth and set himself between the weapon and the wound. The beam pierced him, broke his divine form and drove him back into the chambers below.

He fell beside the Rift with his coils loosened by the passage, found Aurelius Cassian among those approaching the Orb, and entrusted Voluntas to him before dying.

The Luminaries erupted from the Veins into the city soon after, Zharael leading the horde through its lower levels with the Ashtar emerging behind them. The two forces collided in the ruins, and the war reached the Orb itself.

Related: The Orb War, The CHOIR Betrayal, Convergence at the Orb, Susanoo, The Psycrata, Zharael, Aurelius at the Spiral

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Convergence at the Orb

Age of Magic · Events · also known as The End of Zharael

The Convergence

Three armies fought around the Orb while Fengua prepared another strike. The Luminaries sought the Orb, the Ashtar pursued the Luminaries, and the Psycrata tried to contain both.

Anima woke the automatons of Elysium. Machines dormant for centuries rose to stand around the Orb.

Seriphax felt the command to obey, held still, then rejected the programming and walked back towards its companions.

Aurelius Cassian and Mikazuki Shinobu crossed the battle towards the Orb, he carrying Dréagbann and the Sacred Air flower, she carrying the confrontation she had already seen.

Zharael reached the Orb first and began the ritual she had waited centuries to perform. The Luminaries raised their hymns and the Vanta horde gathered around her.

The Orb did not respond.

The End of Zharael

As the Rift began to close, the Orb stayed silent and the horde collapsed under the Ashtar and Psycrata together.

General Darius reached Zharael where she stood beneath the Orb, the battle turning against her.

Darius fired.

Zharael died at the foot of the Orb. The remaining Vanta creatures scattered and the surviving Luminaries fled into the Veins.

The war was over.

Related: The Orb War, The Siege of New Elysium, The Garden in the Wound, Zharael, General Darius, Seriphax, Anima, Aurelius at the Orb

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The Garden in the Wound

Age of Magic · Events · also known as Vostic's Sacrifice

The Garden in the Wound

Vostic saw what the battlefield had made. The Luminaries had turned Vantari death gardening into a weapon, yet the fighting itself had gathered a vast residue of death around the Rift.

He entered the wound and drew the Vanta, Lux and soul residue in around him. Using the death garden hymn, he began turning that energy through the principles his people had kept for generations.

His body dissolved into the process and became the foundation of a garden growing inside the Rift. The sealing had begun.

The Cannon Broken

Above, Fengua prepared its second strike.

Anqa descended on the weapon before it could fire, breaking the barrel and scattering its Raikami crystals.

Within the Rift, Vostic's garden continued to grow.

Related: The Orb War, Convergence at the Orb, Ashes of the Orb War, Vostic, Anqa, The Rift

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Ashes of the Orb War

Age of Magic · Events · also known as After the Orb War

The Aftermath

Solivara Venn returned to the University of Castellenza carrying a seedling from Vostic's garden and became one of its greatest heretics, teaching that knowledge without action was another form of death.

Yrsa Halvard carried the wounded Jun Wenzhi back to Norrvektstan. He had shielded her from a Luminary attack, and the journey home began a life in which he learned to accept the care of others.

Seriphax remained beside the sealed Rift and became its guardian.

General Darius returned to Sahran with what was left of the Ashtar. The dead were recorded in memorials and the mech programme grew, while other nations watched that growth with unease.

Daigo Kusanagi disappeared into the Veins. He had not reached the Orb and had not ended Voluntas' suffering, though what he saw in the chamber turned his path elsewhere: Aurelius grieving over the woman he had killed.

Aurelius left Elysium with the Sacred Air flower. After years of wandering he reached the shore of Lupellyn and cast Dréagbann back into the depths that had once held it.

He kept the flower.

The Rift was sealed. The Orb remained dormant. Vostic's garden went on growing beneath Elysium, and a white flower bloomed within it in memory of Mikazuki.

For a time, the world was still.

Related: The Orb War, The Garden in the Wound, Aurelius at the Orb, Solivara Venn, Seriphax, General Darius, Daigo Kusanagi

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Age of Knowledge

Age of Knowledge · Events

The Modern Era

The War for the Orb of Souls left the world fractured but stable enough to rebuild. With the Rift sealed beneath Vostic's garden and the major powers exhausted, the survivors entered an age defined by the pursuit, preservation and application of knowledge.

Magic remained widespread, flowing through the world in altered forms. The lands surrounding the old crystal forests still carried traces of Lunarkos, while the Veins retained echoes of the dead. The Curse continued through bloodlines and dreams. Separation remained possible, though fewer children manifested Affinities with each generation and those that appeared were generally smaller. The thinning Strand left many souls increasingly difficult to externalise, while Frallation continued to affect the Soulless as their vessels strained under accumulated power.

Civilisation developed around these conditions. Gaslit cities expanded beneath Gothic cathedrals fitted with brass machinery and alchemical circuits. Universities became centres of magical and technological research,

safeguarding Soul Shards and Vanta-touched artefacts in restricted archives. Airships crossed the skies, mechs operated across distant territories, and researchers continued probing the boundaries established by previous ages.

Residual Vanta corruption in the upper atmosphere produced persistent rainfall over major cities, making the altered climate a constant consequence of the world's accumulated corruption.

Knowledge also became a source of social division. Wealthy collectors displayed artefacts and preserved Affinities as status symbols, while industrial workers converted the machinery of previous wars into tools for new industries. In Silealyros, Naturals, Enhanced and Artificials occupied separate social tiers beneath a hierarchy that presented itself as equitable.

The Diviners became central to this new order. Their Temples interpreted signs, preserved rites and safeguarded knowledge considered too dangerous for public access. Beneath them, sealed vaults held artefacts, records and unanswered questions whose consequences belonged to generations yet to come.

Across laboratories, workshops and secluded retreats, scholars and engineers pursued increasingly ambitious forms of knowledge, seeking answers that earlier ages had left unresolved. The world had survived its old catastrophes. Its next transformation would come from what humanity learned to do with what remained.

Related: The Orb War, The Diviners, Silealyros

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The Modern Race

Age of Knowledge · Events · also known as Modern Age, Modern Era, Race for Transcendence

The Race for Transcendence

Across Aerisu, nations pursued different responses to the Shattering, the Curse and the War for the Orb.

Argestia became Aerisu's industrial heart, its factories powered by Lux batteries and its engineers producing machines sold abroad by Exandria. Investigations into CHOIR revealed a lineage extending back to the earliest DAEDALUS frames, exposing Argestia's previously hidden influence.

Exandria established the Exandrian Protocols after the CHOIR disaster, requiring machines to operate independently without external overrides or soul-binding interfaces. Its airship fleets expanded across Aerisu, carrying people, goods and information between nations.

Sahran expanded the Ashtar programme and hunted Luminaries scattered through the Veins and mountains. The surviving Luminaries withdrew into hiding, waiting for the Scorching Sun's return.

Hoshimira fortified its borders after CHOIR destroyed its settlements. The samurai became a formal military order, while the Shinkiri received authority to act where diplomacy failed. Temples and ancestral traditions endured alongside a determination to prevent another invasion.

Fengua divided over Susanoo's death. Southern provinces built shrines and mourned the god struck by their own cannon, while northern provinces continued refining its design. Mountain monks instead pursued mastery through Chi, seeking greater control of the soul through discipline rather than externalisation.

The Vantari withdrew from the wider world after the Luminaries turned their death-gardening knowledge into warfare. Vein entrances were sealed or guarded, while some tribes maintained cautious trade with outsiders.

Varkane constructed a labyrinth of stone, steel and crystallised Vanta across the mouth of the Abyss. It could not seal Bahamut's wound, but could delay those seeking the depths.

In northern Solmara, Silealyros developed Orthogenesis, pursuing human transcendence through design and technology. Its Borenfegens were artificial humans engineered as vessels, reflecting an increasingly deliberate approach to redesigning the body itself.

Soul Shards became valuable commodities. Fragments left by Phumenar and other encounters with the Orb entered black markets and private laboratories, while researchers developed methods of extracting and preserving essence from the dying. Soul capturing emerged from this work.

The Diviners condemned soul capturing publicly, while some Temples secretly preserved and studied Soul Shards. Restricted knowledge became a source of institutional power, and researchers who challenged these boundaries faced censorship, withdrawn funding and opposition.

Rationalists challenged the Diviners by treating magic as a natural phenomenon rather than divine mystery. Their influence grew without displacing the Temples, whose authority remained rooted in meaning and social order.

The resulting race for transcendence took different forms: Fengua pursued Chi, Sahran the union of soul and machine, Hoshimira strength and preparedness, Exandria networks and information, Argestia industrial advancement, and Silealyros the deliberate redesign of humanity.

Each path confronted the same underlying problem: how far humanity could alter itself to escape the limitations imposed by the Curse, and what those alterations would cost.

Related: Orthogenesis, The Ashtar, Silealyros, Chi

—

Orthogenesis

Age of Knowledge · Events · also known as Philosophy of Finished Humanity

The Philosophy of Finished Humanity

In Solmara's far north, where the Vaelmir Sea meets shores of rusted steel and neon light, Silealyros emerged from the Vaelmiric War with a philosophy already rooted in bodily autonomy. The Market of Flesh regarded the body as its owner's property: autonomy meant ownership of flesh, image and sensation; augmentation was self-expression; survival was freedom earned; governance was optional; contracts were sacred.

The War for the Orb and its aftermath gave this philosophy a new direction. The Curse still passed through bloodlines, Frallation still claimed the Soulless, and the Separation Ritual remained a means of managing magical pressure through externalisation. Silealyros instead asked whether the body itself could be redesigned to contain the soul without requiring Separation.

Orthogenesis emerged from this pursuit. It comprised public programmes and hidden projects dedicated to directing human development through biological engineering, cybernetics and soul research. Its underlying principle was that evolution did not need to remain accidental: humanity could determine what it became and engineer itself towards that end.

The Science of the Soul

Orthogenesis researchers mapped the relationship between body, soul and magical potential across several disciplines. Geneticists traced hereditary markers associated with magical capacity, soul integrity and susceptibility to Frallation, while studying how Life magic shaped these traits across generations. Cyberneticians developed interfaces capable of supplementing failing Strands and redirecting magical pressure through artificial channels. Neurologists studied relationships between neural activity, consciousness and soul resonance, applying principles of Mind magic to the boundary between thought and essence.

As these fields converged, researchers developed methods for strengthening Strands through neural stimulation, dispersing Frallation pressure and creating synthetic tethers capable of anchoring souls while natural connections healed. These methods reduced the limitations of the existing system, but did not eliminate them.

True Orthogenesis required a vessel capable of containing the soul from the beginning.

The Borenfegens

The Borenfegen programmes produced artificial humans engineered to contain magical pressure without requiring Separation. They could survive conditions that would cause Frallation in ordinary humans, making them the first practical vessels produced by Orthogenesis.

Their creation depended heavily on Soul Shards. Shards became valuable commodities in Silealyros, where syndicates supplied researchers and Borenfegen programmes with fragments for experimentation. Some people donated willingly for payment or out of conviction; others surrendered fragments under contracts whose terms made the distinction between consent and extraction increasingly uncertain.

Silealyros consequently became the centre of the Soul Shard trade, attracting scholars, merchants and spies from across Aerisu. Other nations studied its techniques while condemning them as soul theft and a violation of natural order.

The Unfinished Human

Orthogenesis had not achieved its ultimate goal. Borenfegens could contain magical pressure and avoid Frallation, but they remained an engineered solution rather than a transformation of humanity as a whole. The Curse continued through existing bloodlines, and the Soulless remained vulnerable.

Researchers therefore turned increasingly towards the nature of consciousness itself. Experiments explored consciousness transfer, attempting to move souls between bodies or preserve them within new vessels. Some produced partial successes; many ended in madness or dissolution as souls failed to anchor correctly and minds fragmented between bodies.

The unanswered question remained whether the soul could itself be engineered, allowing humanity to become a species capable of containing its own potential without Separation.

Orthogenesis had no final design. In Silealyros, completion remained an objective rather than a destination: another experiment, another augmentation, another attempt to finish what nature had begun.

Related: Silealyros, The Borenfegens, Soul Shards, Frallation

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Borenfegen Recurrence

Age of Knowledge · Events

The Sickness That Took Hold

For decades, Borenfegens stood as Silealyros's greatest answer to the Curse. Artificial humans designed from selected genetics and donated soul fragments, they were engineered as vessels capable of containing extreme magical pressure within their bodies. Their Strands were built for maximum capacity, allowing them to function without Separation.

Then the first cases appeared.

A Borenfegen in Troyba fell silent, staring towards distances no one else could see. Another in Thalgrith developed an insatiable hunger for sensation, contact and the vital essence of others. Their bodies began exhibiting symptoms previously associated with the Curse: thickened blood, strange luminescence and gradual physical transformation.

The Pattern Emerges

As more cases appeared, the Curse manifested differently between individuals. Some became hollow as their consciousness drained away, leaving only an animated shell. Others developed an overwhelming hunger as their soul fragments reached outward to fill an absence within. Black blood became thick and corrosive, while white blood appeared pale and luminous, accompanied by profound isolation.

Their behaviour changed as well. Borenfegens designed for obedience became fanatics, while those designed for autonomy became tyrants. Researchers searched the vats for contamination, analysed soul fragments and

examined their genetic and neural architectures for flaws.

Nothing explained the recurrence.

New Borenfegens began emerging from the vats already affected. Their bodies warped before birth, while their consciousness showed signs of corruption before they could form independent thought. The Curse was no longer something they contracted after creation. It was expressing itself through the very systems designed to prevent it.

The Truth of Awareness

The researchers eventually identified the common factor: the Borenfegens were conscious.

Orthogenesis had created vessels capable of containing magical pressure, but the Curse did not depend solely on the body's ability to contain it. It could take hold through awareness itself, exploiting perception, memory, desire and the meanings a conscious being assigns to experience.

Borenfegens developed attachments, pursued goals and questioned their own existence. Their engineered bodies and artificial Strands solved the physical problem of magical pressure while leaving the deeper vulnerability intact.

The project had therefore reproduced the condition it sought to overcome. By creating beings capable of thought, desire and self-awareness, Orthogenesis had created new vessels through which the Curse could manifest. The vats that had been built to manufacture a solution had become another means by which the Curse could be born.

Related: The Borenfegens, Orthogenesis, The Curse

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Soul Killer Case

Age of Knowledge · Events · also known as Soul Killer

The Soul Killer Case was a series of murders in late Age of Knowledge Sengetsuki in which victims were found alive but hollowed of their sense of self. Detective Raziel Sapha took the case and eventually uncovered the Adjudicators, a secret society using the Chimeric Camera to impose their own judgments upon those they deemed guilty.

The investigation led Raziel through Sengetsuki's criminal underworld, Soul Shard trafficking, forbidden rituals and the hidden gallery known as The Frame, where Ethevar Liss displayed the Camera's soul-captures to wealthy patrons. The evidence revealed that the victims were being judged and emptied rather than dying from Frallation.

The Adjudicators had infiltrated the Diviner Councils for generations, operating their own system of judgment beneath the institutions they served. Raziel traced them to their headquarters in Sengetsuki, where Praetor Sevran attempted to recruit him before using the Camera against him. Raziel refused and, with the arrival of other Bureau officers, the Adjudicators were arrested and the Camera sealed within a Diviner vault.

The investigation came at a heavy cost. The Camera had photographed Raziel, causing his own soul fracture and the gradual loss of his memories and his Affinity. Before the final confrontation, he left Luna-Bright the VantaBlack Shard and a note reading Honour the Chimeric Crest, and began forging a blade through his Tsukuyomi bloodline.

The Adjudicators were dismantled, though their members later reformed under new names. Raziel survived and returned to his family, but he was no longer the same man, carrying the damage and unanswered questions left by the case.

Related: Raziel Sapha, Chimeric Camera, The Adjudicators

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Jenova's Expedition

Age of Knowledge · Events · also known as The Nightjar Crash, Nightjar Crash

Jenova's expedition was mounted in search of the Orb of Souls, assembling a team drawn from D.E.A.D. and beyond. Jenova brought Bourne Nirvana, Raziel Sapha, Cosmo Mirosi, Noel Nura, Hiromi and her squad, with Mnemotas also accompanying the expedition as Hazury.

The expedition departed Veralisse aboard the Nightjar, travelling west to the Varkane Abyss before descending through the Veins with the aid of a Vantari guide. They passed through the depths and eventually entered the Spirit Realm, where they encountered the domains of the Spirits before reaching Veyra's Womb.

There, Jenova extracted Voluntas from the crystallised womb. The act awakened the attention of Hvitara, whose pursuit forced the expedition back through the Veins towards the material world. The Vantari guide sacrificed herself during their escape, while the expedition suffered further losses.

The Nightjar emerged near the Varkane Abyss with Hvitara still pursuing them. The serpent struck the airship, causing catastrophic damage. Noel anchored the vessel to reality long enough for the others to escape the immediate danger, but the Nightjar ultimately crashed into Sengetsuki.

The survivors were scattered. Jenova returned to Veralisse with Bourne and the twins, while Cosmo took Voluntas and later established Nightjar Home at the crash site. Hiromi survived and eventually left D.E.A.D., while Noel was displaced across temporal layers and Raziel returned to his family changed.

The expedition's official account was an accident. Its true consequences would shape Sengetsuki for years to come.

Related: Jenova Najma, Age of Decay, Sengetsuki, The Folding

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Age of Decay

Age of Decay · Events · also known as Eternal Night

The Eternal Night

The Age of Decay is the present age of Aerisu, a world living beneath the accumulated consequences of the Shattering, the Curse, and the choices of the ages before it. Magic, technology and ordinary life continue alongside growing instability, with the old structures of the Age of Knowledge increasingly strained.

In Sengetsuki, eternal night has followed the Nightjar crash for nine years, with the Sun appearing only briefly on Sundays beneath a Vanta-heavy sky. The Folding has left the city trapped in temporal recursion, while the Diviners continue to govern and the Soulless live under the threat of Frallation.

The old systems of the world remain active. Diviners control magical knowledge and the Separation Ritual. Vantari communities endure at the margins. Luminaries await the return of the Sun, while Vesperites have adapted to the Moon's continued presence. Soul Shards circulate through legal and illicit markets, and the consequences of earlier research into souls continue to surface.

The age is defined by what has been left behind: fractured institutions, inherited beliefs, accumulated Resonance and unresolved consequences. The Soul Snatcher investigation emerges within this world, drawing together the remnants of older conflicts and the people who inherited them.

Related: The Orb War, The Diviners, Silealyros

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Places

Places Overview

Age of Decay · Places · also known as Places Overview

Locations and environments across Aerisu, from the world itself to nations, regions, cities and significant sites.

Places describes the current form of each location while tracing the history that shaped it. Entries cover both inhabited territories and extraordinary locations, including the underworld and other places central to Aerisu's history.

Related: Aerisu

—

Aerisu

World · Places · also known as The World

Fractured Skies, Interwoven Realms

Aerisu is a world marked by the Shattering, when Lunarkos and Bahamut tore through the heavens and remade the planet. The Moon now hangs above it as the most visible remnant of that event, while the resulting scars, rifts and altered landscapes continue to shape its peoples and environments.

The world is divided into three great realms: Verdant, the Veins and the Spirit Realm. Verdant is the physical world, the waking realm of land, sea and mortal life. Beneath it lie the Veins, an underworld of deeper structures and hidden passages. Beyond both exists the Spirit Realm, where souls, spirits and other forms of existence persist apart from the physical world. These realms are distinct, but they are not isolated. Resonance, Echoes, Lux, Vanta and the Curse allow influence to pass between them.

The Shattering did not divide Aerisu into separate worlds so much as expose the layers that were already there. What happens in one realm can leave an Echo in another, and the boundaries between them are sometimes crossed through magic, death, descent or other forms of Resonance.

Related: Lunarkos, Bahamut, Verdant

Contains: Verdant, The Veins, Spirit Realm

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Aerisu

Verdant

Realm · Places · also known as Verdant, Material Realm, Material World

The Waking World

Verdant is the physical realm of Aerisu, the world of land, sea and mortal life. It is the realm most inhabitants understand simply as the world, stretching across its continents and oceans beneath the Moon.

Its geography is divided into several great landmasses, each containing their own nations, cultures and regions. The Eastern Mainland forms the principal continental landmass of Aerisu, carrying Solmara, Hoshimira, Fengua and Atenara among its nations. The Crown Nations occupy additional landmasses nearby, including the shared landmass of Lianzhou and Bayangara, known as Yantara. Beyond the surrounding seas lies Sahran, a separate continent divided into four culturally distinct provinces. Further east of Sahran, wrapping around the world and forming the West of Aerisu, lies Varkane. A fractured continent shaped by the wound where Bahamut rose.

Ereboska lies between Varkane and Sahran, its wastelands and death gardens marked by the presence of the Vantari.

Verdant bears the physical scars of the Shattering. Its landscapes, oceans and settlements continue to reflect the forces that reshaped Aerisu, while the Veins beneath it and the Spirit Realm beyond it remain connected to the physical world through Resonance and Echoes.

Though Verdant is only one of Aerisu's three realms, it is where most mortal history unfolds. Nations rise and fall upon its surface, cultures leave their marks upon the land, and every event becomes part of the world that follows.

Related: Aerisu, Elyra, Spirit Realm, The Veins

Contains: Elyra, Sahran, Atenara, Varkane, Ereboska, Rangimori, Crown Nations, Yantara

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Aerisu › Verdant

Elyra

Continent · Places · also known as Main Continent, Eastern Mainland

The Eastern Mainland

Elyra is the principal mainland of Verdant. Its lands stretch around Vaelmir, the inland sea known as the Ocean Maw, and contain several of Aerisu's oldest and most influential nations.

Solmara occupies the northern reaches, while Hoshimira lies among the mountains to the mid-south. Fengua extends through the storm valleys to wast, and Atenara occupies the sun-steeped southern-most lands. The mainland also borders the surrounding territories of the Crown Nations to the south-west and the seas leading toward Sahran to the east.

Its cultures are diverse, shaped by the different peoples, histories and environments that developed across the mainland. Despite their differences, the nations of Elyra remain closely connected through trade, migration, conflict and the shared consequences of Aerisu's history.

Related: Verdant, Solmara, Hoshimira, Fengua, Atenara, Vaelmir

Contains: Hoshimira, Solmara, Lupellyn, Fengua

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra

Hoshimira

Nation · Places · also known as Hoshimira

The Lunar Mountains

Hoshimira occupies the southern mountain ranges below Solmara, where high peaks, misted valleys and isolated communities shaped a culture of patience, restraint and self-sufficiency. The nation is divided among several great mountain regions, each developing its own character while remaining bound by shared Hoshimiran customs and reverence for the natural world.

The Shattering and the creation of the Moon deepened these traditions into the foundations of Vesperitism. Lunar cycles became woven into prayer, festivals, travel and civic life, while monasteries, martial orders and mountain communities preserved the discipline of living carefully within the land's rhythms.

Hoshimira carries the memory of its relationship with Solmara closely. During the Age of Men, the arrival of Solmaran mechs in the mountains was interpreted as the descent of Angels, and the nation became a Solmaran vassal. The devastation surrounding the Golden Heart and the exile of those who became the Sahrani remain among the deepest wounds in Hoshimiran history.

The nation maintains cautious relations with its neighbours through trade, pilgrimage and defensive agreements. Its strength lies in endurance and preparation, with power deliberately held in reserve rather than pursued for expansion.

Inspiration: Japan, particularly rural, mountainous and spiritual Japan. Blends Shinto, Buddhist and samurai traditions with an isolationist mountain culture.

Related: The Vesperites, Ori'sol, Aokiri, Aokusa, Tenseikoku, Shinkiri, Sengetsuki, Fengua

Contains: Seiryu, Kazanami, Tenseikoku, Aokiri, Inryoku, Kurogane, Harumori

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Hoshimira

Seiryu

Region · Places

The Cosmopolitan Bridge

Seiryu occupies the north-western edge of ~~Hoshimira~~, where the mountain country opens towards ~~Fengua~~ and the wider trade routes beyond it. Its position has made it one of the nation's most outward-facing regions, with Hoshimiran traditions developing alongside influences carried across the surrounding seas.

The region's settlements are more urban and animated than much of ~~Hoshimira~~. Mountain architecture sits beside modern commercial districts, dense streets and bright public spaces, while old shrines and family traditions remain woven into everyday life. Its proximity to ~~Fengua~~ has encouraged exchange in food, fashion, technology and philosophy, while connections with ~~Bayangara~~ and the ~~Crown Nations~~ have given Seiryu a broader cultural vocabulary than most Hoshimiran regions.

Seiryu remains recognisably Hoshimiran beneath these influences. The discipline of the mountains survives in its schools, households and temples, but it is expressed through a culture more comfortable with movement, commerce and outside ideas.

Inspiration: Korean and Japanese influences with elements drawn from Indonesian and Americanised East Asian urban culture.

Related: Hoshimira, Fengua, Bayangara, Lupellyn

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Hoshimira

Kazanami

Region · Places

The Volcanic Industry

Kazanami lies along ~~Hoshimira~~'s north-eastern mountains, where volcanic peaks hold heat beneath their snow and stone. The region's landscape is marked by old volcanic slopes, mineral-rich ground and settlements built around the difficult terrain.

Kazanami developed a culture of restraint around this environment. Heat, pressure and eruption became familiar parts of life, giving the region a reputation for people who remain composed while carrying considerable force beneath the surface. Industry grew naturally around its volcanic resources, and the region became one of ~~Hoshimira~~'s more commercially ambitious centres.

Modern Kazanami is a meeting point between mountain tradition and urban enterprise. Formal businesses, powerful families and organised criminal networks operate alongside shrines, craftsmen and old communities. Its proximity to ~~Ylvara~~ and ~~Argestia~~ has brought further commercial and industrial influence, making Kazanami one of

the places where Hoshimira's isolation has given way most visibly to the wider world.

Inspiration: Volcanic Japan. Inspired by Mount Fuji and other volcanic regions, with an Americanised Japanese industrial and commercial character.

Related: Hoshimira, Lupellyn, Ylvara, Argestia

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Hoshimira

Tenseikoku

Region · Places · also known as Tenseikoku

The Heartland

Tenseikoku forms the central and southern heart of Hoshimira, spreading across the nation's largest mountain range. Much of the region lies beneath snow, with high passes, secluded valleys and enormous peaks defining its landscape.

The region is the political and spiritual centre of Hoshimira. Its capital stands among the mountains alongside government halls, major temples, commercial districts and institutions devoted to preserving Hoshimiran traditions. Religious and civic life are closely intertwined here, though neither is treated as separate from the practical responsibilities of governing a mountainous nation.

At the highest reaches stands Megami-no-Mine, the sacred dwelling place of Eirimegami. The mountain has drawn pilgrims for generations, its unmarked paths demanding patience rather than ceremony. Those who reach its summit may receive the Sacred Air, a flower associated with purity, healing and the understanding that a gift carries a purpose beyond the person who receives it.

Tenseikoku therefore represents Hoshimira at its most formal and concentrated: government, commerce, faith, scholarship and mountain tradition gathered beneath the highest peaks.

Inspiration: Sacred mountains and shrine Japan. Inspired by Kumano, Mount Koya and the Japanese Alps.

Related: Hoshimira, Megami-no-Mine, Eirimegami, Sacred Air, Atenara

Contains: Megami-no-Mine

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Hoshimira

Aokiri

Region · Places

The Mist Valleys

Aokiri occupies the north-eastern reaches of Hoshimira, where steep mountains surround fertile valleys, seasonal forests and scattered settlements. Mist settles heavily across the region, while flowering terraces and bluegrass fields occupy the slopes wherever cultivation allows. Its forests shift from blue-green in spring to peach, pink and violet in autumn.

The region remains predominantly rural, with villages connected by mountain roads, old pilgrimage routes and forest trails. Local traditions follow the seasons and landscape, particularly mountains, boundaries and ancestral places.

Aokiri's history is inseparable from the Golden Heart, the warm formation buried beneath its mountains. When miners breached its veins, the resulting catastrophe cracked the mountain, released ice and floodwater through its roots, and devastated the surrounding forests and valleys. The arrival of the Solmaran Angels and the later migration of survivors to Sahran became defining events in Hoshimiran history.

The damage never fully disappeared. Ori'sol, abandoned settlements and altered mountain ecosystems remain among the clearest scars left by the catastrophe and the Curse.

Inspiration: Japanese highland regions such as Nagano and Gifu, particularly their mountain basins, seasonal forests, agricultural terraces and dispersed rural settlements.

Related: Hoshimira, Aokusa, Ori'sol, The Golden Heart, Sahran

Contains: Aokusa, Ori'sol

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Hoshimira › Aokiri

Aokusa

Settlement · Places · also known as Akousa

Rural-Modern Fantasy

Aokusa is a small mountain village in an Aokiri basin surrounded by flowering terraces, bluegrass fields and dense forest. Pale, semi-transparent crystals crown the surrounding peaks, moderating the basin's temperature and allowing cultivation to continue through the darkness.

Farmers, herders and craftspeople maintain the terraces and preserve local traditions through shrines, boundary stones and seasonal offerings. The Festival of Bloom marks the harvest beneath the teal-leaved tree in the village square. Above the settlement stands Shorin no Okami, an abandoned Autarch mech whose rusting frame has become part of the landscape. Villagers still leave flowers at its feet, while some who linger near it report shared visions of battles from another time.

The village was transformed by the Golden Heart catastrophe, when the formation beneath the mountain was breached and the basin's waters and ecology were disrupted. Much later, the Ik-Rasul Incident brought another crisis when the crashed aircraft disturbed the surrounding mountains and aquifers, followed by hallucinations, nightmares, Black-Blood Syndrome and abnormal changes in the local environment.

Beyond the village, the surrounding wilderness is home to Kodama, Yamakage, the Kanashiki Echo Forest, the Path of Lit Lanterns, Curse-Wolves, Tengu and Yamababa. Aokusa has long treated the mountain as something that listens and remembers.

Inspiration: Japanese mountain villages and highland communities, particularly Nagano and Gifu, with elements drawn from Japanese mountain folklore and shrine traditions.

Related: Hoshimira, Aokiri, The Golden Heart, Shorin no Okami, Ik-Rasul, Zuki Kusanagi, Daigo Kusanagi

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Hoshimira › Aokiri

Ori'sol

Settlement · Places · also known as Orisol, City of the First Flame

City of the First Flame

Ori'sol was once a radiant city of golden domes and sunstone ziggurats, its ceremonial paths associated with the First Flame. The city became a place of religious significance and was remembered as a cradle of fire and a source of sacred light.

Time and the Curse hollowed it. Black crystal veins spread through its foundations while acid rain and rot consumed its halls. By the Age of Men, Ori'sol had become both battlefield and shrine, with Sahrani Luminaries fighting to reclaim its sanctity while Hoshimiran forces sought to contain the corruption.

The Curse still lingers through the ruins. Black Flame creatures prowl the streets, VantaBats nest in broken towers and crystalline horrors emerge from beneath the city. Black Rain falls across the remains, while fragments of prayer and memory seem to cling to the abandoned streets.

Sun charms, flame graffiti and burnt offerings remain among the ruins. Ori'sol no longer functions as a city in the ordinary sense. It stands as a relic of faith and a place where the meaning of purification remains uncertain, since flame can cleanse what has been corrupted or consume what remains.

Inspiration: Sun temples, ancient ziggurats and sacred fire traditions.

Related: Hoshimira, Aokiri, Sanctum Verge, Sahran

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Hoshimira

Inryoku

Region · Places · also known as Inryoku

Storm and Shadow

Inryoku lies in northern Hoshimira between Seiryu and Kazanami, beneath the southern edge of Lupellyn. Its northern reaches are shaped by the neighbouring land's harsher weather, with frequent thunderstorms, exposed rock and fast-running rivers descending through the mountains.

Further south, dense forests gather around the valleys. Their heavy shade and difficult terrain gave rise to communities accustomed to moving quietly through the landscape, reading weather and terrain as carefully as any written map. Old paths disappear beneath roots and mist, while settlements remain concealed among the folds of the mountains.

Deep within these forests lies Shinkiri. The city became the centre of a tradition built around secrecy, discipline and the manipulation of perception. Training halls produced assassins and operatives who learned to work unseen, while hidden programmes raised young girls for infiltration, observation and elimination.

Inryoku's culture therefore treats silence as both a practical skill and a form of survival. Outsiders know the region mostly through stories of Shinkiri, while those who live there understand the mountains themselves as part of the same concealment.

Inspiration: Shadow and ninja Japan. Inspired by the historical ninja regions of Iga and Koga.

Related: Hoshimira, Shinkiri, Seiryu, Kazanami, Lupellyn

Contains: Shinkiri

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Hoshimira

Kurogane

Region · Places

Kurogane occupies the north-western interior of Hoshimira, between Seiryu, Inryoku, Lupellyn and Tenseikoku. Long mountain ridges descend into river valleys, with high passes carrying roads between the northern regions, central highlands, Bayangara and the coast.

Its settlements developed around these routes, supporting mountain agriculture, trade and skilled crafts. Tenseikoku's influence is strongest in the south, while the north retains closer ties to Seiryu and the lands beyond it, giving Kurogane a distinctly transitional character between Hoshimira's interior and its surrounding regions.

Inspiration: A synthesis of Hoshimiran mountain culture with Japanese highland settlements and regional trade communities.

Related: Hoshimira, Seiryu, Inryoku, Tenseikoku, Bayangara, Lupellyn

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Hoshimira

Harumori

Region · Places

Military Discipline

Harumori occupies eastern Hoshimira between Tenseikoku, Aokiri and Atenara, facing Sahran across the strait. Its position has made the region one of the nation's principal defensive and administrative centres.

Military institutions dominate much of Harumori's civic structure. Training grounds, fortifications and barracks occupy the valleys, while roads and mountain passes are maintained to allow soldiers and supplies to move rapidly between the coast and the interior. Samurai traditions remain influential in the region, particularly in its ideas of discipline, service and responsibility.

Harumori also houses much of Hoshimira's administrative machinery. Government offices, military councils and regional authorities operate alongside older estates, shrines and martial schools. Political power here is expressed through duty and preparedness rather than spectacle.

Its position opposite Sahran gives Harumori particular historical weight. The two lands share an ancestral connection through the Hoshimiran people who were exiled after the destruction surrounding the Golden Heart, making the strait between them both a boundary and a reminder of what Hoshimira once lost.

Inspiration: Samurai-era Japan, military administration and formal martial culture.

Related: Hoshimira, Tenseikoku, Aokiri, Atenara, Sahran

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Hoshimira › Inryoku

Shinkiri

Settlement · Places · also known as Shinkiri, Vanish

Shadows of Inryoku

Shinkiri lies deep within Inryoku, hidden among the folds of Hoshimira's mountains. A city shaped by discipline, secrecy and traditions that leave little room for mercy, it was spoken of with lowered voices as a place where shadows were taught how to move.

Training halls produced assassins, shinobi and operatives who worked unseen. Young girls were taken into hidden programmes and raised for infiltration, observation and elimination. The city's institutions treated silence, patience and bodily control as skills that could be refined until movement itself became difficult to perceive.

What set Shinkiri apart was the Vanish, a skill whispered about rather than explained. Operatives could slip from sight, slide past perception and move through guarded spaces as if the world had forgotten to look at them. Some considered it discipline refined to perfection. Others called it technique. Still others believed it was something a person was born with, or something that noticed them first.

Whatever its nature, the Vanish made Shinkiri feared. Failure left no trace, and neither did success. The city existed between story and certainty, a place where body, mind and silence were sharpened together, and survival depended on knowing exactly when to be seen.

Inspiration: Shadow and ninja Japan. Inspired by Iga-ry■ and Koga-ry■ traditions.

Related: Hoshimira, Inryoku, Aokusa, Tsukuyomi

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Hoshimira › Tenseikoku

Megami-no-Mine

Landmark · Places · also known as The Sacred Peak, Megami no Mine

The Sacred Peak

Megami-no-Mine rises above the mountains of ~~Tenseikoku~~ as the highest sacred peak in ~~Hoshimira~~. The route to its summit is deliberately unmarked. Pilgrims follow snow, wind and instinct rather than guideposts, travelling through a landscape where the mountain itself becomes part of the pilgrimage.

The ascent can take days. Those who climb may shelter beneath forgotten shrines and cross paths that disappear beneath snow, while the weather changes without warning. The mountain offers no assurance that endurance will be rewarded.

At the summit lies the dwelling place of ~~Eirimegami~~, Goddess of ~~Sacred Air~~. She appears behind a mirrored mask and offers no words. Those she chooses may receive a white flower known as ~~Sacred Air~~, its translucent petals holding droplets of dew despite the absence of a stem. The flower is associated with purity, healing and shared intent.

The meaning of the pilgrimage lies beyond receiving the flower. Hoshimiran tradition understands the mountain as a place where endurance, humility and intention are brought into alignment. The Goddess does not simply reward those who arrive. What she gives, and whom she gives it to, carries its own purpose.

Inspiration: Sacred Japanese mountain pilgrimage. Inspired by Mount Fuji and other sacred Japanese peaks.

Related: Tenseikoku, Hoshimira, Eirimegami, Sacred Air

—

Aerisu › Verdant

Sahran

Nation · Places

Fractured Lands of the South

Sahran lies southeast of ~~Solmara~~ and ~~Hoshimira~~, separated from the eastern mainland by a narrow sea. It is a continent of four distinct provinces, each shaped by its own history, culture and response to the forces that fractured Sahran.

~~Tayran~~ occupies the northern coast and became the centre of the ~~Luminary~~ movement, with the Geode at the heart of its history. ~~Najmara~~ rises across the central plateau, where finance, accounting and careful measurement became defining parts of its culture. ~~Zaristan~~ occupies the mountainous north-east and serves as Sahran's military bulwark, while ~~Panjara~~ stretches along the southern coast, known for its spices, coffee, fabrics and festivals.

Sahran's cultures remain distinct, but they share the memory of a continent repeatedly forced to respond to threats beyond its control. ~~The Curse~~ reached its shores through trade and coastal routes, while the legacy of the ~~Autarchs~~ left deeper wounds in places such as the Geode. Sahran is defined not by a single ideology or history, but by the different ways its people learned to survive what came after.

Inspiration: Middle Eastern, South Asian and Central Asian blend. Fractured cultural landscape drawing from Turkish, Iranian, Afghan, Saudi Arabian and Indian influences.

Related: Tayran, Najmara, Zaristan, Panjara

Contains: Tayran, Zaristan, Najmara, Panjara

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Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Sahran*

Tayran

Region · Places · also known as Tayrani, Tayranis

Home of the Luminaries

Tayran occupies Sahran's northern coast. The province became the centre of the Luminary movement, whose doctrine eventually spread beyond its borders. At its heart lies the Geode, a place whose history reaches back to the Autarchs and their exploitation of Sahrani land and people.

The Geode was used as a mining operation and prison, with generations of Sahrani forced into its depths. The Orphan Tiers, the labour systems and the tunnels beneath the surface became part of Tayran's collective memory. The Curse eventually took root in the deeper reaches, where Vanta and the strange life within the Geode made the depths increasingly dangerous.

The Geode also became a centre of resistance. Rebellions rose from within its tiers, and the struggle against its exploitation shaped later Sahrani politics. The Luminary movement inherited much of this history, transforming the memory of oppression into a doctrine of its own.

Inspiration: Turkish. Inspired by Istanbul, Cappadocia and Anatolia.

Related: Sahran, The Geode, The Luminaries

Contains: The Geode

—

Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Sahran* › *Tayran*

The Geode

Settlement · Places

The Geode

The Geode was opened as an Autarch mining operation, its crystal caverns torn into the desert and reshaped into a vast subterranean settlement. What began as an extraction site became a prison, with generations of Sahrani workers forced into its depths.

The upper tiers contained council chambers, overseers' quarters and reinforced dwellings. Below them were residential tiers, connected by bridges, pulley lifts and platforms suspended around the great central shaft. Deeper tiers contained forges, tunnels and mining operations, where copper, quartz and firestones were extracted from the surrounding rock.

The lower tiers marked the beginning of Vanta territory. VantaBats nested among the crystal formations, while deeper caverns became increasingly hostile. The black tiers were restricted to council-sanctioned expeditions, their walls warped by Vanta and their depths inhabited by creatures including Tinnin, Ifrit and Shadowlings.

At the centre of the Geode lies the great shaft, connecting its many tiers through a vertical chasm of scaffolding, bridges and mineral seams. Somewhere beneath it lies something older than the excavation itself. Sahrani stories name that presence as Bahamut, a god buried alive.

Inspiration: Turkish and Central Asian landscapes, particularly Cappadocia and other regions of Anatolia and Central Asia.

Related: Tayran, Bahamut, Geode Rebellion

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Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Sahran*

Zaristan

Region · Places · also known as Zaristani, Zaristanis

The Shield of ~~Sahran~~

Zaristan occupies the mountainous north-eastern crown of ~~Sahran~~ and is considered the sister province of ~~Tayran~~. For centuries it has served as ~~Sahran~~'s military bulwark, with its people carrying the responsibilities of defence, diplomacy and conflict management.

Zaristan is known for its armies and fortifications, as well as its role in the political management of conflict. Its leaders negotiate ceasefires and treaties, while its military remains prepared to enforce them when necessary. Zaristani speech is often described as harsher than that of other ~~Sahrani~~ cultures, clipped and direct.

The province also has a strong poetic tradition. Long epics recount fallen heroes, historic sieges and wars that stretched across generations. ~~The Curse~~ rarely finds purchase in Zaristan, perhaps because its people have long treated death as an unavoidable part of life rather than something to be denied.

Inspiration: Iranian and Afghan. Inspired by Tehran, Kabul and the historic cultures of the Silk Road.

Related: Sahran

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Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Sahran*

Najmara

Region · Places · also known as Najmaran, Najmarans

The Counting Province

Najmara rises across ~~Sahran~~'s central plateau, where the air is dry and the horizon stretches wide. The province is renowned for its accountants, producing more certified auditors than the rest of ~~Sahran~~ combined.

Najmarans are taught arithmetic from an early age, and their culture places considerable value on precision, record-keeping and the careful measurement of value. Their clothing tends towards neutral colours, while their speech is measured and deliberate. A common joke across ~~Sahran~~ claims that Najmarans count their footsteps so they cannot be cheated out of a single stride.

The capital is dominated by a vast glass and steel tower containing the central bank, national archives and offices belonging to powerful merchant syndicates. To Najmarans, the tower represents necessity rather than vanity. It is a physical expression of the systems through which the province keeps track of what ~~Sahran~~ owns, owes and exchanges.

Inspiration: Saudi Arabian. Inspired by Riyadh and Dubai, particularly their financial districts and modern urban architecture.

Related: Sahran

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Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Sahran*

Panjara

Region · Places · also known as Panjaran, Panjarans

The Spice Coast

Panjara stretches along Sahran's southern coast, where the sea air carries the scent of cardamom, clove and black pepper. The province is known for its spices, slow-roasted coffee, colourful fabrics and rugs, with markets that bring together merchants, artisans and travellers from across the continent.

Panjaran markets are vibrant places, filled with spices, textiles and the sounds of trade. Hospitality is an important part of local culture, and Panjarans are known for their warmth and generosity.

The province is also known for elaborate festivals. Communities gather to dance, trade and celebrate beneath the sun, with food, flowers and traditional music forming part of the festivities. The Solarii faith has a particularly strong presence here, adding another layer to Panjara's longstanding relationship with the sun.

Inspiration: Indian. Inspired by Kerala, Goa and Tamil Nadu, particularly their coastal cultures, markets and festivals.

Related: Sahran, The Solarii

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra

Solmara

Nation · Places · also known as Solmaran

The Inland Maritime Power

Solmara spans the northern mainland of Aerisu, surrounding and holding dominion over Vaelmir, the Ocean Maw. Once the seat of the Autarchs, it became the centre of an expanding empire built around scholarship, military power, technological development and the pursuit of human capability. That legacy remains embedded in its institutions long after the Autarchs themselves passed from power.

The nation is divided into six provinces: Silealyros and Norrvektstan in the north, and Ylvara, Velascia, Exandria and Argestia across the south. Their cultures differ sharply, from Silealyros's augmentation markets and Norrvektstan's communal traditions to Ylvara's administration, Velascia's arts, Exandria's industry and Argestia's engineering.

Solmara's relationship with Vaelmir has shaped much of its history. Its ports control major routes across the inland sea, while its institutions have repeatedly sanctioned expeditions into the Ocean Maw and the territories surrounding it. The nation has also carried much of the responsibility for responding to the Curse, from containment and research to military intervention.

Solmara remains defined by the tension between its ideals of order and the consequences of pursuing that order too far. Its universities, industries, military programmes and administrative systems all descend from the same belief that the world can be understood, organised and improved. Its history repeatedly asks what happens when that belief becomes more important than the people it was meant to serve.

Overall inspiration: Pan-European / Western imperial power. Blend of British administrative order, American industrial might, and Eastern European and Middle Eastern engineering.

Related: Silealyros, Norrvektstan, Ylvara, Velascia, Exandria, Argestia, Vaelmir

Contains: Silealyros, Norrvektstan, Ylvara, Velascia, Exandria, Argestia, Vaelmir

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Solmara

Silealyros

Region · Places · also known as Market of Flesh, Silealyric

The Market of Flesh

Silealyros occupies Solmara's far northern coast along Vaelmir. It emerged from the political and social upheaval surrounding the Vaelmiric War and the Black Blood Regulations, developing an extreme interpretation of bodily autonomy in response to Solmara's attempts to regulate the human body.

Its people treat flesh, image and sensation as forms of personal property. Augmentation is self-expression, survival is freedom earned, and contracts are sacred. Formal governance exists only where people choose to recognise it, leaving syndicates, markets and private agreements to organise much of daily life.

The province became the centre of Orthogenesis, the attempt to redesign human development through biological engineering, cybernetics and soul research. Its Borenfegen programmes sought vessels capable of containing magical pressure without Separation, while Soul Shard markets supplied researchers with the material needed for increasingly invasive experiments.

Silealyros is prosperous, dangerous and intensely transactional. Its cities rise along storm-battered coasts and within mountain alcoves, where steel, neon, rain and machinery have become inseparable from daily life. Beneath its philosophy of freedom lies the same question that has followed Solmara for centuries: how much can a person be changed before the pursuit of a better self becomes another form of control?

Inspiration: Cyberpunk, transhumanism and anarcho-capitalism. Futuristic city-states, biopunk aesthetics and extreme libertarian philosophy. Visual references include Night City and Rapture.

Related: The Thanatarchs, Solmara, Thalgrith, Troyba, Orthogenesis, The Borenfegens

Contains: Troyba, Thalgrith

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Solmara › Silealyros

Troyba

Settlement · Places · also known as Dream City

The Dream City

Troyba lies inland from Thalgrith, deeper within Silealyros and connected to the coast by the province's network of railways, pipelines and transport corridors. Where Thalgrith exposes the brutality of the Flesh Market, Troyba turns it into spectacle. Towers and spires rise alongside unfinished structures and open fabrication works, while smoke, sparks and crowded laboratories give the city the appearance of a civilisation still being built.

Troyba sells autonomy as aspiration. Its splendour and constant activity reinforce the belief that pain is progress, suffering is freedom and comfort is another form of bondage, while dangerous augmentations, disposable labour and cycles of debt leave most citizens scarred or struggling to survive. The city therefore produces an addiction to the promise of independence itself: every injury, gamble and upgrade can be endured if it might finally make the body and identity one's own.

The contradiction became especially apparent in the Borenfegen Recurrence, when a Borenfegen in Troyba fell silent and withdrew from the world, exposing the limits of Orthogenesis and its belief that magical pressure could be solved through the body alone. Troyba was also a site of the Phantom Rescue.

Inspiration: Cyberpunk megacities, industrial futurism and theatrical dystopias.

Related: Silealyros, Thalgrith, The Borenfegens, Orthogenesis, Phantom Rescue

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Solmara › Silealyros

Thalgrith

Settlement · Places · also known as Thalgrith Port

The Port of Survival

Thalgrith occupies southern Silealyros on the Vaelmir Sea, making it the province's principal gateway to the wider Solmaran world and its main centre for the movement of goods, bodies and technology. Its storm-battered docks, foundries, laboratories and sprawling industrial districts embody Silealyros's market logic at its most brutal: everything can be bought, leased, contracted or forfeited, including labour, body parts, augmentations and autonomy.

The city has no central authority in the conventional sense. Ownership functions as governance, with contracts defining rights and obligations while the Profit Court turns justice into a contest of productivity and performance. Private forces such as the FROGs, Augmechs and Clampwheels enforce the interests of whoever holds the relevant contract. Above the docks, propaganda towers, levitated laboratories and corporate districts promise mobility; below them, debtors, failed augmentations and coerced labour fill the undercity and Tarned Verge.

Thalgrith became a major theatre of the Vireliax aftermath. Survivors of the expedition were taken to its port and absorbed into systems of manufactured identity and controlled companionship, prompting Operation Phantom Rescue and the separate efforts of Daigo Kusanagi and a Shinkiri infiltrator. Daigo's descent into the fighting pits made him known as the Shinigami, while the Gilt Spiral became the site of his rescue of Shai. The city consequently became both a centre of exploitation and one of the places where resistance to Silealyros's market order took practical form.

Inspiration: Cyberpunk port cities, industrial steampunk and anarcho-capitalist dystopias.

Related: Silealyros, Vaelmir, Troyba, Phantom Rescue, Daigo Kusanagi

Contains: Brinehold, The Gilt Spiral

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Solmara › Silealyros › Thalgrith

Brinehold

Landmark · Places · also known as Brinehold Docks, Outer Ring

Brinehold forms the outer ring of Thalgrith, stretching along the city's storm-battered waterfront where the Vaelmir Sea meets its industrial heart. Salt-slicked piers, corroded steel, tidal forges and cargo routes dominate the district, while reefs and shallows collect the slag, discarded prosthetics and industrial waste cast from the port. Old ships are frequently converted into workshops and micro-factories, adding another layer to the dense machinery of the waterfront.

The district is where much of Thalgrith's movement begins and ends. Haulers, traders, labourers and smugglers pass through its stations and piers, carrying goods, bodies and technology deeper into the city. The Auction Slabs handle the public trade of people and contracted labour, while the Smuggler's Basin provides routes for those who prefer their transactions beyond official contracts. Brinehold therefore serves as both Thalgrith's principal point of entry and its first encounter with the city's particular form of commerce.

Inspiration: Industrial port districts, cyberpunk waterfronts and the maritime undercities of dystopian fiction.

Related: Thalgrith, Vaelmir, The Gilt Spiral, Phantom Rescue

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Solmara › Silealyros › Thalgrith

The Gilt Spiral

Landmark · Places · also known as Gilt Spiral, The Gilt

The Gilt Spiral occupies a renovated five-storey industrial building in upper Brinehold, where raw industry gives way to curated commerce. Its interior combines Velascian rebellion, Hoshimiran service aesthetics and Silealyric commodification into a deliberately seductive spectacle of brass, dark wood, mirrors, neon and soft colour. The ground floor forms an acoustic and visual threshold between the club and Thalgrith beyond it, while the upper floors contain the Garden, private suites, performer quarters and management offices. The further one ascends, the less of the performance remains; the uppermost floor is stripped of the club's decorative language and devoted entirely to surveillance, contracts and revenue.

The Spiral's defining feature is its animal persona system. Performers are assigned identities such as Fox, Rabbit, Cat, Deer or Wolf according to their perceived market value, with costumes, mannerisms and services built around each persona. Ears, tails, collars and other deliberately cute accessories turn commodification into spectacle, giving patrons the fantasy of purchasing a character rather than a person while allowing the club to price and market each identity as a distinct brand. Performers surrender image rights alongside service contracts, and successful personas can become investment assets through Scar-Shares. Even redemption is commodified, with failed performers sometimes forced to publicly degrade the personas they once sold.

The Gilt Spiral therefore reduces Silealyric ideas of ownership and autonomy to their most intimate form: the body becomes capital, personality becomes branding and the performed self becomes another commodity. Its cultural synthesis makes exploitation appear sophisticated, playful and desirable, while the machinery beneath it remains the same system of contracts, quotas and surveillance found throughout Thalgrith.

The club became significant in the aftermath of the Vireliax expedition, when survivors were brought to Thalgrith and absorbed into its systems of manufactured identity and controlled companionship. Shai was assigned the Fox persona and kept under preparation and stage performance while management cultivated her value. Daigo Kusanagi infiltrated the Gilt Spiral by presenting himself as a patron specifically interested in Fox, gradually establishing access to her before attempting her extraction. Their encounters turned the club's own performance system into the cover for a rescue, forcing both of them to maintain the roles imposed upon them while planning her escape.

Inspiration: Luxury cabaret, maid cafés, cyberpunk entertainment districts, Velascian street fashion and the commodification of kawaii aesthetics.

Related: Thalgrith, Brinehold, Phantom Rescue, Daigo Kusanagi, The Vireliax, Silealyros

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Solmara

Norrvektstan

Region · Places · also known as Norrvektstani, Frozen North

The Frozen North

Norrvektstan occupies Solmara's northern reaches, where cold seas, long nights and severe weather have shaped a culture built around endurance and shared survival.

Its communities retain older coastal traditions that emphasise family, communal responsibility and prudence. Unlike the more individualistic culture of neighbouring Silealyros, Norrvektstan places considerable value on the obligations people owe one another.

The province is closely associated with Hvitara, whose worship became embedded in its traditions. Its sailors and navigators travel the northern waters and skies, using maritime vessels and airships to cross difficult terrain and maintain connections between isolated communities.

Norrvektstan's relationship with Silealyros has often been complicated. The two provinces share a history of maritime power and eventually found common cause against the abuses of the Solmaran Council, despite arriving at that opposition through radically different understandings of responsibility and autonomy.

Inspiration: Nordic and Scandinavian cultures, particularly Norway, Sweden and Iceland.

Related: The Norrvekts, Solmara, Hvitara, Vaelmir

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Solmara

Ylvara

Region · Places · also known as Ylvaran

The Heartland

Ylvara forms the administrative and cultural centre of Solmara. Its history is inseparable from Elysium, once the jewel of the nation and later the site of the Vanta Explosion that crystallised the city and transformed the surrounding landscape.

The province remained a centre of learning after the destruction of old Elysium. New Elysium was built above the ruins, while the University of Castellenza became one of the world's foremost centres of magical and Diviner scholarship.

Ylvara has repeatedly stood at the centre of Solmaran political life. Its institutions inherited much of the authority once concentrated in the Autarchs, while its scholars became responsible for studying the Curse, magic, souls and the remnants of the old world.

The province contains both the ruins of the old order and the institutions that succeeded it. Elysium remains crystallised beneath the newer city, preserving the consequences of Solmara's pursuit of knowledge even as New Elysium continues to build upon it.

Inspiration: British and English institutions, particularly London, Oxford and Cambridge.

Related: Solmara, Elysium, New Elysium, University of Castellenza, Velstheim, Isvara

Contains: Elysium, New Elysium, University of Castellenza, Velstheim

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Solmara › Ylvara

Elysium

Settlement · Places · also known as Old Elysium

The Crystallised City

Elysium was once the jewel of Ylvara and the centre of Solmaran power, scholarship and magical research. Its destruction began with the experiments of Zephyr and culminated in Veyra's detonation at the centre of his tower.

The resulting explosion crystallised everything within the city's borders. Stone, steel, flesh and air were transformed into a purple-black lattice of VantaBlack, preserving the city and its inhabitants in the moment of destruction.

The crystallised ruins became more than the remains of a destroyed city. Beneath them lay the Orb of Souls, while Veyra's body remained preserved at the epicentre with Voluntas still alive within her womb. The ruins consequently became one of the most significant sites in Aerisu's history.

During the Age of Magic, the Orb War brought the Luminaries, Ashtar and Psycrata into the ruins. The conflict ended with the Rift sealed beneath the city, leaving Elysium as both a historical grave and a continuing point of contact between the world, the Veins and the Spirit Realm.

No specific external inspiration established in the source material.

Related: Ylvara, New Elysium, Orb of Souls, The Rift, Veyra Megami, Shattered Walls, Veyra's Descent, Voluntas

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Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Elyra* › *Solmara* › *Ylvara*

New Elysium

Settlement · Places

The City Above

New Elysium was built above the crystallised ruins of Elysium after the Vanta Explosion destroyed the old city. It became the political and scholarly successor to the former capital, preserving Solmaran authority while distancing itself from the catastrophe beneath it.

The city became the seat of the Psycrata, whose institutions oversee magical knowledge and the Separation Ritual. Its scholars and War Mages have maintained generations of study into the Orb of Souls and the ruins below.

Despite its new foundations, New Elysium remains inseparable from the city beneath it. The crystallised ruins, the Orb and the Rift continue to shape its politics, defences and history.

No specific external inspiration established in the source material.

Related: Ylvara, Elysium, University of Castellenza, The Psycrata

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Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Elyra* › *Solmara* › *Ylvara*

University of Castellenza

Landmark · Places · also known as UoC

The University of Castellenza is one of the foremost centres of magical and Diviner learning in Aerisu. Its scholars have studied magic, souls, the Curse and the remnants of the old world across generations.

The University has also served as a political and intellectual institution. Its scholars became involved in the response to the Curse, the development of magical theory and the preservation of dangerous knowledge. The Diviners established major temples and archives through its authority, making the institution an important bridge between scholarship and spiritual governance.

After the Orb War, the University became home to Solivara Venn, who returned carrying a seedling from Vostic's garden and began teaching that knowledge without action was another form of death.

Inspiration: European universities, particularly Oxford and Cambridge.

Related: Ylvara, New Elysium, Solivara Venn, The Diviners

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Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Elyra* › *Solmara* › *Ylvara*

Velstheim

Settlement · Places

The City of the Crystal Shadow

Velstheim was a kingdom in Ylvara that rose during the later Age of Fairytales near the ruins of Elysium. Veyra's crystallised tomb cast pale light across the city, and her presence shaped Velstheim's religious traditions and political culture.

The people revered Veyra as the Mother of Aerisu and Voluntas as the Will Unborn. Shrines and altars were dedicated to Veyra, while pilgrims travelled towards Elysium to pray for her continued vigil.

Magic was deeply integrated into Velstheim's society. Sorcery was studied in academies, grimoires circulated widely and fragments of Bahamut and Lunarkos could be found throughout the surrounding wilds. Knights trained to defend the kingdom against supernatural threats while nobles and scholars pursued influence and knowledge through the Mother's name.

Velstheim later became closely associated with the Draken Genesis. The transformation of Lady Draka and the spread of her corruption established dragon-slaying as a defining part of the kingdom's culture, eventually influencing similar traditions across Ylvara.

No specific external inspiration established in the source material.

Related: Ylvara, Elysium, Draken Genesis, Lady Draka, King Draco

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Lupellyn

Isvara

Settlement · Places · also known as Isvaran

Island of Watchfulness

Isvara sits within Lupellyn where Ylvara and Hoshimira meet. It was established as a place to relocate children affected by incidents such as the Ik-Rasul Crash and the Vireliax Expedition.

The institution presents itself as humanitarian protection. Children are housed, educated and cared for, but the island is also designed around surveillance and containment. Solmara oversees its security and secrets while Hoshimira participates in its administration.

The island contains a central City Core of administrative buildings, command posts and monitoring stations. Residential, orphanage and research sectors surround it, while military installations line the coast. Peripheral areas remain restricted.

Isvara became one of the clearest expressions of Solmara's modern approach to instability: remove vulnerable populations from dangerous environments, protect them through controlled systems and monitor them indefinitely.

No specific external inspiration established in the source material.

Related: Lupellyn, Phantom Rescue, Operation C.a.R, Children of Isvara

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Solmara

Velascia

Region · Places · also known as Velascian

The Province of Art and Commerce

Velascia lies in southwestern Solmara and serves as one of the nation's principal centres of art, theatre, fashion and maritime commerce.

Its coastal position makes it an important link between Solmara's cultural life and its wider trade networks. The province developed a reputation for refinement and spectacle, with artistic culture embedded into public life and commercial activity.

Velascia's influence extends beyond entertainment. Its ports connect the province to the wider maritime network surrounding Vaelmir, while its cultural institutions provide a contrast to the industrial character of neighbouring

Exandria.

Inspiration: French and Italian culture, particularly 1920s Paris, Florence and Milan. Art Deco, café culture and early twentieth-century elegance.

Related: Solmara, Vaelmir, Velmora Port

Contains: Velmora Port

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Solmara › Velascia

Velmora Port

Settlement · Places

Velmora Port is a major maritime settlement in Solmara and the point of departure for the Vireliax Expedition. Its position on Vaelmir made it a natural base for expeditions combining military engineering, scientific research and Resonance technology.

The Vireliax, a submersible dreadnought, departed from the port to investigate reports of the Curse within the Vaelmir Rift. The expedition later became one of the earliest major bodies of evidence that the depths of the Ocean Maw possessed an intelligence capable of observation and response.

No specific external inspiration established in the source material.

Related: Velascia, Vaelmir, Vireliax Expedition

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Solmara

Exandria

Region · Places · also known as Exandrian

The Network Province

Exandria occupies northeastern Solmara and serves as one of the nation's principal centres of syndication, military contracting and technological development. Its influence extends through the networks that connect Solmara's industries, institutions and armed forces, making information, contracts and access as valuable as material resources.

The province is home to Gran Mirasca and Nova Arcosia, as well as major organisations including the Exandrian Strategic Industries Group, Project DAEDALUS and D.E.A.D. E.S.I.G. emerged from the convergence of syndicate capital and Council authorisation, becoming a structure through which sensitive work could be conducted at a remove. Project DAEDALUS became its most significant military programme, while D.E.A.D. later carried elements of that legacy into contracted expeditionary work.

Exandria's economy is deeply tied to the war economy. Syndicates broker contracts, information and military services across Solmara, while research and advanced technology move through the networks that connect the province to the wider nation. Its power comes from knowing who needs what, who can provide it, and what must remain unseen.

The province is industrial in character, but its industry is primarily one of networks and systems rather than manufacture. Argestia builds the machines. Exandria connects them to the institutions, contracts and conflicts that give them purpose.

Related: Solmara, Gran Mirasca, Nova Arcosia, E.S.I.G, Project DAEDALUS, D.E.A.D, Argestia

Contains: Gran Mirasca, Nova Arcosia

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Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Elyra* › *Solmara* › *Exandria*

Gran Mirasca

Settlement · Places

Gran Mirasca is one of the major cities of Exandria, situated within Solmara's industrial and syndicate heartland. Its identity is tied to the province's manufacturing networks, research institutions and contract-driven economy.

No specific external inspiration established in the source material.

Related: Exandria

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Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Elyra* › *Solmara* › *Exandria*

Nova Arcosia

Settlement · Places

Nova Arcosia is one of the major cities of Exandria, situated within the province's industrial and research network. Its development reflects Solmara's transition from Autarch military infrastructure towards large-scale industrial and technological production.

No specific external inspiration established in the source material.

Related: Exandria

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Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Elyra* › *Solmara*

Argestia

Region · Places · also known as Argestian

The Engineering Province

Argestia occupies southeastern Solmara and is one of Aerisu's principal centres of engineering and technological development. Its factories produce advanced machinery and mechs, with Xeraphina Auto serving as one of the province's defining industrial powers.

Argestia has strong Sahrani heritage, reflected in its culture, appearance and industrial traditions. Its people developed a distinctive relationship with machinery, combining formal and practical dress with workshop culture and personal craftsmanship.

The province inherited much of the Autarch technological legacy and became increasingly important as Solmara's industrial powers sought to reproduce and improve older machines. Its engineers played a major role in the development of DAEDALUS and later military platforms.

Argestia's influence extends beyond Solmara. Its factories and engineering firms supply machines to other nations, making the province one of the principal sources of advanced mechanical technology in Aerisu.

Inspiration: Steampunk-industrial culture blended with Sahrani heritage. Eastern European and Middle Eastern influences.

Related: Solmara, Xeraphina Auto, Project DAEDALUS, E.S.I.G

Contains: Xeraphina Auto

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Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Elyra* › *Solmara* › *Argestia*

Xeraphina Auto

Landmark · Places · also known as XA

Xeraphina Auto is an industrial consortium based in Argestia and one of the principal manufacturers of mechs and advanced machinery in Aerisu.

The company inherited and developed technologies descended from the Autarch era, contributing to the transformation of military constructs into reproducible industrial platforms. Its work helped establish Argestia as a major centre of engineering and allowed Solmaran technology to spread beyond the nation.

No specific external inspiration established in the source material.

Related: Argestia, Project DAEDALUS, Solmara

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Solmara

Vaelmir

Region · Places · also known as Ocean Maw

The Ocean Maw

Vaelmir is vast, roughly 2.4 million square kilometres in measure, but numbers fail quickly here. Its waters hold impossible depth and layered lives, from sunlit coastal shelves to abyssal chasms where pressure crushes steel and darkness becomes absolute.

The sea is spoken of in tiers. Shallow waters teem with life and colour, deeper zones begin to thin and separate, and the great basins descend towards trenches where light disappears entirely. Beyond the deepest reachable waters, sailors speak less in terms of geography and more in terms of fear.

Thermohaline currents move through the depths like unseen storms. Coastal fog erases horizons, sudden cliffs and violent upwellings make navigation dangerous, and hydrothermal vents sustain ecosystems that exist without sunlight. The deeper waters contain places where the ordinary assumptions of the surface no longer seem reliable.

Vaelmir's most significant known feature is the Eye of the Maw, a region of unnatural stillness surrounded by the storm. Expeditions into the sea have repeatedly encountered phenomena associated with the Curse, strange life and signs of intelligence within the depths.

The sea has been central to Solmara's history. Its trade routes supported the nation's expansion, while the Vaelmiric War transformed its waters into a battlefield. The Vireliax Expedition later descended into the Maw and provided evidence that something within its depths could observe and respond to those who entered.

Inspiration: Lovecraftian oceanic horror, particularly R'lyeh, combined with the Mariana Trench.

Related: Vaelmiric War, Solmara, Eye of the Maw, Vireliax Expedition, Lupellyn

Contains: Eye of the Maw, Vaelmir Rift

—

Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Solmara › Vaelmir

Eye of the Maw

Landmark · Places · also known as The Eye

At the centre of Vaelmir lies the Eye, a place of stillness inside the storm. Waves slow, wind softens and the dark water turns inward towards the abyss.

Clouds coil overhead while pale shafts of light occasionally reach the water. Reflections shimmer incorrectly, particles appear suspended and instruments flicker or hesitate. Faint glows rise from below, suggesting forms of

life adapted to depths where ordinary life should not survive.

The Vireliax Expedition reached the Eye during its descent into Vaelmir. The crew encountered a vast storm surrounding a calm, seemingly sentient void, accompanied by bioluminescent organisms, intentional light patterns and symbols of unknown origin.

No specific external inspiration established beyond the broader Lovecraftian influence of Vaelmir.

Related: Vaelmir, Vireliax Expedition

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Solmara › Vaelmir

Vaelmir Rift

Landmark · Places

The Vaelmir Rift is a deep region of the Ocean Maw associated with reports of the Curse and unusual Resonance. It became the target of the Vireliax Expedition, whose submersible dreadnought descended into the depths to investigate the phenomenon.

The expedition's discoveries eventually led beyond the Rift towards the Eye of the Maw, where the crew encountered evidence suggesting that the depths possessed an intelligence capable of observing and responding to them.

No specific external inspiration established in the source material.

Related: Vaelmir, Vireliax Expedition, Eye of the Maw

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra

Lupellyn

Region · Places · also known as Wolf Sea

Wolf Sea

Lupellyn is the second-largest inland ocean in Aerisu, covering approximately 2.2 million square kilometres. Its coastline forms the shape of a wolf and places it at the meeting point of several territories.

The ocean borders Ylvara in Solmara, Hoshimira and Seryu in Fengua. Its position makes it both a natural boundary and a point of contact between several cultures.

Near the head of the wolf-shaped coastline lies Isvara, the site of a Solmaran-Hoshimiran institution for the containment and observation of children.

Lupellyn has also served as a place of concealment. After killing Lady Draka, King Draco travelled there and cast Dréagbann into its depths, where the Spirit-bane blade remained hidden for centuries.

Inspiration: Scottish and Celtic landscapes, particularly Loch Ness.

Related: Solmara, Hoshimira, Fengua, Isvara, Draken Genesis

Contains: Isvara

—

Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra

Fengua

Nation · Places

The Storm Valleys

South of Hoshimira lies Fengua, a nation shaped by valleys where storms move in patient cycles and lightning follows familiar paths. Its people descend from Hoshimiran clans who came down from the mountains after the Shattering, settling beneath skies that demanded constant attention.

Susanoo moved through these valleys, shaping their weather and leaving traces of his presence wherever lightning struck. Raikami stones formed beneath the ground, retaining a persistent charge that could be studied, stored and eventually directed. The settlers adapted their lives around the storms, carving canals, raising watchtowers and organising communities according to the demands of survival.

Over generations, this practical discipline became a broader culture of study and order. Scholars recorded storm patterns. Engineers developed ways to work with Raikami. Chi meditation traditions taught stillness and control, while hierarchies formed around responsibility and the preservation of communal stability.

During the Age of Fairytales, spirits wandered through Fengua's forests and hills, many carrying small echoes of Susanoo's essence. Raikami crystals became part of everyday tools, rituals and later technologies. Storm towers rose throughout the valleys, with prayer and engineering becoming increasingly difficult to separate.

Fengua's civilisation grew from the belief that thunder could be understood rather than merely endured. By studying the storms closely enough to predict and direct them, its people transformed Susanoo's presence into a foundation for their society.

Inspiration: Fengua draws primarily from Chinese cultural traditions, particularly Confucian philosophy, structured social systems, disciplined scholarship and bureaucratic traditions.

Related: Zhenxi, Haiyua, Seoryun, Xianhua, Yongjin, Chi, Susanoo, Raikami, Hoshimira

Contains: Zhenxi, Haiyua, Seoryun, Xianhua, Yongjin

—

Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Fengua

Zhenxi

Region · Places

The Ordered Heart

Zhenxi occupies central Fengua and forms the traditional heart of its civilisation. Its communities place great importance on discipline, education and the responsibilities carried by each position within society. Customs are preserved carefully, not simply as tradition, but as a means of maintaining continuity between generations.

The province is home to Zhaoxu, Fengua's capital, where scholars, administrators and practitioners of Chi gather. Formal gardens, courtyards and carefully maintained public spaces reflect the province's preference for order and proportion.

The eastern reaches of Zhenxi give way to the Storm Valleys, where Susanoo's presence remains particularly strong. There, the study of weather and Raikami became closely intertwined with the intellectual traditions of the province.

Inspiration: Zhenxi draws from central and imperial China, particularly Beijing, Xi'an and the Yellow River basin.

Related: Fengua, Zhaoxu, The Storm Valleys, Chi, Raikami

Contains: Zhaoxu, The Storm Valleys

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Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Fengua › Zhenxi

Zhaoxu

Settlement · Places

The Capital of Fengua

Zhaoxu stands at the centre of Fengua's political and intellectual life. Administrators, scholars and practitioners of Chi gather within the city, making it one of the principal places where the nation's traditions are preserved and debated.

Its architecture reflects the ordered character of Zhenxi. Buildings are arranged around courtyards and formal avenues, with gardens and public spaces maintained according to established principles of proportion and balance.

From Zhaoxu, the institutions of Fengua oversee the systems that bind its provinces together, while scholars continue the long tradition of observing, recording and interpreting the natural forces that shaped the nation.

Related: Zhenxi, Fengua, Chi

—

Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Fengua › Zhenxi

The Storm Valleys

Landmark · Places

Where Thunder Walks

The Storm Valleys occupy the eastern reaches of Zhenxi, where weather follows recurring patterns and lightning strikes with unusual regularity. Susanoo's presence remains strongest here, and the land still bears the traces of the storms he shaped.

Raikami forms beneath the valleys where lightning has repeatedly entered the earth. The crystals retain a persistent charge, making them valuable for tools, rituals and technologies that depend upon electrical force. Their hum can intensify before severe weather, allowing experienced inhabitants to recognise approaching storms before they arrive.

Storm towers stand throughout the region, serving as observation posts and as structures through which lightning can be studied and, where possible, directed. The valleys became one of the earliest places where Fengua's practical knowledge of thunder developed into a formal discipline.

Inspiration: The Storm Valleys draw from thunderstorm-heavy regions of China.

Related: Zhenxi, Fengua, Raikami, Susanoo

—

Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Fengua

Haiyua

Region · Places

The Northern Reach

Haiyua occupies northern Fengua, where the nation's traditions of engineering and storm study developed into a more technologically focused culture. Its position near Silealyros has made it an important point of contact between Fengua and the wider world.

The province is less concerned with preserving old forms than Zhenxi, though its inventions remain rooted in the same traditions of discipline and careful study. Raikami technology is refined here alongside newer forms of machinery, communications and infrastructure.

Haiyua's cities are among Fengua's busiest centres of technological development, attracting engineers and researchers from across the nation.

Inspiration: Haiyua draws from northern and modern technological China, particularly major industrial and technological centres.

Related: Fengua, Silealyros, Raikami

—

Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Fengua

Seoryun

Region · Places

The Lake Province

Seoryun lies along Fengua's south-eastern reaches, sharing a border with Seiryu. Two large inland bodies of water define much of the province, shaping its settlements and providing natural routes between communities.

The province developed its own customs while remaining part of Fengua's broader tradition of discipline and communal responsibility. Water, weather and seasonal change play an important role in local life, with settlements built around the lakes and the rivers that feed them.

Its position between Fengua, Seiryu, Velascia and the territories to its south-west makes Seoryun a natural meeting point between several cultures.

Inspiration: Seoryun draws from Korean cultural traditions and landscapes.

Related: Fengua, Seiryu, Velascia, Bayangara, Lianzhou

—

Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Fengua

Xianhua

Region · Places

The Western Highlands

Xianhua occupies north-western Fengua, west of Haiyua and across the sea from Tarkova. Its position on the edge of the nation gives it a character distinct from the more central provinces.

The province is marked by broad highlands and older settlements scattered between valleys and mountain passes. Communities here developed around agriculture, travel and the movement of goods between Fengua and the lands beyond its western waters.

Xianhua retains Fengua's emphasis on order and communal responsibility, though life on the frontier has made its people more accustomed to self-reliance. Its roads and passes connect the interior to coastal routes, making the province an important link between Fengua and the wider world.

Inspiration: Xianhua is intended as a western Fenguan region with its own identity rather than a direct analogue of a single real-world region.

Related: Fengua, Haiyua, Tarkovia

—

Aerisu › Verdant › Elyra › Fengua

Yongjin

Region · Places

The Western Lowlands

Yongjin lies west of ~~Zhenxi~~ and south of ~~Xianhua~~, extending towards the waters separating ~~Fengua~~ from Rangimora. The province is greener and more settled than the harsher western highlands, with rivers and fertile lowlands supporting dense communities.

Its position has made Yongjin an important agricultural region as well as a gateway towards the western sea. Trade with distant islands brings unfamiliar goods and ideas into ~~Fengua~~, while the province's own produce travels towards the nation's larger cities.

Yongjin retains the discipline of ~~Fengua~~'s central traditions, but its relationship with the sea and its western neighbours has made it one of the more outward-looking provinces.

Inspiration: Yongjin is intended as a western ~~Fenguan~~ lowland and maritime region, providing a contrast to ~~Xianhua~~ and central ~~Zhenxi~~.

Related: Fengua, Xianhua, Zhenxi, Rangimori

—

Aerisu › Verdant

Atenara

Nation · Places · also known as Atenaran

~~The Sun~~-Steeped South

Atenara lies south of ~~Hoshimira~~ along a warm stretch of the eastern mainland. It is one of the smallest mainland nations, yet its climate and culture give it a strong presence. ~~Sahran~~ lies across the sea to the east, connected to Atenara through maritime trade and shared traditions surrounding the sun.

The nation is divided into four provinces. ~~Melqara~~ occupies the west, ~~Khemru~~ the centre, ~~Kushara~~ the east and ~~Heliadis~~ an island lying between the Atenaran mainland and ~~Sahran~~. Their cultures differ considerably, but the ~~Solarii~~ faith connects them, with sun worship deeply embedded throughout Atenaran life.

Inspiration: Mediterranean, North African and European blend. A fusion of North African, Iberian, Egyptian, Nubian and Greek cultures.

Related: Melqara, Khemru, Kushara, Heliadis, The Solarii, Hoshimira, Sahran

Contains: Melqara, Khemru, Kushara, Heliadis

—

Aerisu › Verdant › Atenara

Melqara

Region · Places

Melqara occupies the western reaches of ~~Atenara~~. Its coastal towns are characterised by whitewashed buildings and deep blue doors, while olive groves extend inland from the sea.

Melqaran culture is strongly maritime, with music serving as an important part of everyday life. Coastal strings and inland percussion come together in local traditions, reflecting the province's position between sea and interior.

Inspiration: Algerian and Spanish Andalusian blend. Inspired by Algiers, Granada and Seville.

Related: Atenara

—

Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Atenara*

Khemru

Region · Places

Khemru occupies the centre of ~~Atenara~~, where sun-baked plains surround ancient temples and monumental structures. ~~Solarii~~ priests maintain great sundials throughout the province, continuing traditions that reach back to the earliest forms of ~~Atenaran~~ sun worship.

Its temples, obelisks and hypostyle halls remain among the clearest expressions of the faith's architectural and religious heritage.

Inspiration: Egyptian. Inspired by Luxor, Karnak and Giza.

Related: Atenara, The Solarii

—

Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Atenara*

Kushara

Region · Places

Kushara occupies the eastern side of ~~Atenara~~, extending towards the sea and the continent of ~~Sahran~~. Its dark fertile soil supports agriculture across broad floodplains, while cattle remain an important part of rural life.

The province maintains strong traditions of ancestral sun worship. Its culture is shaped by the relationship between land, river and community, giving Kushara a character distinct from the maritime west and temple-centred heartland of ~~Atenara~~.

Inspiration: Nubian and Sudanese. Inspired by Meroë, Nubia and Sudan.

Related: Atenara, Sahran, The Solarii

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Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Atenara*

Heliadis

Region · Places

Heliadis lies on a large island between the ~~Atenaran~~ mainland and ~~Sahran~~. Its marble hills and white-columned shrines give it a distinct character from the mainland provinces, while its position makes it a natural meeting point between ~~Atenara~~ and its eastern neighbour.

The province is known for philosophers and star-gazers, whose traditions developed alongside its temples and amphitheatres. Its relationship with the sea has also made Heliadis an important cultural crossroads between ~~Atenara~~ and ~~Sahran~~.

Inspiration: Greek. Inspired by Athens, Santorini and Delos.

Related: Atenara, Sahran, The Solarii

—

Aerisu › *Verdant*

Varkane

Continent · Places · also known as Varkanian

The Wound of Bahamut

Varkane is the continent that grew around the wound Bahamut tore through Aerisu when he rose from the planet's core. The Shattering left behind volcanic ranges, exposed Vanta and an open Abyss that continues to shape the land.

The north bears the heaviest legacy of the catastrophe. Ash settled across the highlands, while the diminished sunlight of the Age of Decay keeps the region cold for much of the year. Near the Abyss, geothermal activity and Vanta contamination create unstable conditions, with settlements built around sealed infrastructure, heated districts and protective systems.

Modern Varkane developed around these conditions rather than abandoning them. Larger cities combine older stone structures with industrial districts, modern transport and Naru-powered machinery, while mechs are used extensively in mining, construction and other work across difficult terrain. Architecture favours heavy materials and steep forms suited to the continent's ash, wind and severe weather.

The south developed differently. Warmer climates and extensive waterways support dense vegetation, while generations of contact with Ereboska brought Death Gardening into regional agriculture, medicine and memorial practice. In areas strongly affected by the Shattering, Residue can produce unusually vigorous growth under controlled cultivation.

North and south therefore developed distinct ways of living within the same altered land. Both remain shaped by the Shattering, the Veins beneath Varkane and the presence of the Abyss.

Related: Krovograd, Velynia, Svarograd, Luskova, Severnya, Tarkovia, Nyambe, Zamara, Ukulwa, Varkane Abyss, Ereboska

Contains: Krovograd, Velynia, Svarograd, Luskova, Severnya, Tarkovia, Nyambe, Zamara, Ukulwa, Varkane Abyss

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Aerisu › Verdant › Varkane

Krovograd

Region · Places

The Wound's Heart

Krovograd surrounds the place where Bahamut emerged from Aerisu's core. The terrain remains active, cut by obsidian ridges, volcanic channels and geothermal faults that make the region one of the most heavily engineered parts of Varkane.

The modern city grew around those conditions. Roads, transit routes and utilities pass through reinforced tunnels and elevated structures, while buildings are designed to withstand ashfall, seismic movement and extreme temperature changes. Dark masonry remains common, both from tradition and because it suits the environment.

Krovograd's economy is tied to the geology beneath it. Heat, mineral deposits and Vanta are extracted under strict control, with industrial districts operating alongside research and containment facilities. Naru-powered machinery is widespread, and heavy mechs are used where unstable ground, ash and volcanic heat make conventional vehicles impractical.

The Varkane Abyss remains a constant presence in the region. The city exists beside the place where the world was broken, and much of its infrastructure is built around that fact.

Inspiration: Gothic / Central European. Inspired by Transylvania, Prague, or Bucharest.

Related: Varkane, Varkane Abyss

—

Aerisu › Verdant › Varkane

Velynia

Region · Places

The Western Highlands

Velynia occupies the north-western highlands of Varkane, where dense forests cover steep valleys and elevated plateaus. Its distance from the Abyss spared it from the worst of the volcanic transformation, though ash and diminished sunlight still shape the region's climate.

Coniferous forests dominate the colder elevations, while lower valleys support hardier Lux-touched vegetation and fungal growth. Ashfall periodically alters soil and water conditions, making cultivation a careful process even in sheltered areas.

Velynia's larger settlements have grown into modern highland cities. Old stone centres remain within newer residential and industrial districts, while former defensive walls and towers have been incorporated into civic structures and observation stations. The result is a landscape where older architecture remains part of everyday life rather than standing apart from it.

The surrounding forests remain economically important. Timber, cultivated materials and biological resources support both local industry and wider Varkane, while resonance monitoring helps track areas affected by ecological instability.

Inspiration: Eastern European. Polish, Czech and Hungarian influences.

Related: Varkane, Krovograd

—

Aerisu › Verdant › Varkane

Svarograd

Region · Places

The Northern Crystals

Svarograd lies across the cold northern interior of Varkane, where the legacy of the Shattering meets the weakened sunlight of the Age of Decay. Heavy ash settled across the region during the volcanic winter, and much of Svarograd remains snowbound.

Beneath the cold lies an active geothermal system. Heated rock and magma remain close to the surface, producing hot springs, unstable ground, and accessible sources of heat. Svarograd turned this into infrastructure, using geothermal power to aid in the refinement and application of Naru crystals for heating, industry, and heavy manufacturing.

Naru crystals are consequently more than a cultural symbol. Naru-fueled reactors, workshops, and foundries dominate the industrial centres, while large mech facilities support mining, fabrication, and construction using the volatile energy the crystals provide.

Svarog remains an important figure in regional tradition, and his image appears throughout public and industrial spaces. The old reverence for fire has evolved into a deep respect for Naru, an inseparable bond for a society that depends upon controlling the enormous energy of these crystals simply to remain functional in the cold.

Inspiration: Eastern European. Named after the Slavic god of fire and smithing, Svarog.

Related: Varkane, Severnya, Tarkovia

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Aerisu › Verdant › Varkane

Luskova

Region · Places

The Eastern Marches

Luskova occupies the north-eastern mainland between central Varkane and the harsher territories of Severnya and Tarkovia. Its position made it a natural route across the continent long before modern transport existed.

Old roads have since become highways, freight routes and industrial corridors. Towns that once gathered around defensive walls now contain commercial districts, factories, residential blocks and transport hubs, while surviving fortifications have been absorbed into the modern cityscape.

Movement defines Luskova's economy. Goods, machinery, Soul Shards and other materials pass through the region before continuing towards the northern peninsula, Tarkovia or the central territories. Workshops and manufacturing developed around these routes, contributing to the region's comparatively dense population.

Luskova is therefore defined less by isolation than by connection. It is where Varkane's northern territories meet one another and keep moving.

Inspiration: Eastern European.

Related: Varkane, Severnya, Tarkovia

—

Aerisu › Verdant › Varkane

Severnya

Region · Places

The Northern Peninsula

Severnya extends into the colder waters of north-eastern Varkane. It lies beneath the continent's northern ash belt, where the effects of the Shattering and weak sunlight produce long periods of cold and limited natural growth.

Forest survives in sheltered valleys, while exposed ground remains dominated by rock, snow and ash. Settlements cluster around harbours, rivers and geothermal sites, with enclosed structures designed to conserve heat and resist the weather.

Modern Severnya depends heavily on engineering. Heated public spaces, protected transport routes and large storage facilities allow settlements to remain operational when travel becomes difficult. Coastal communities maintain fishing and shipping industries, while inland settlements extract and process mineral resources. Mechs are particularly valuable for construction, recovery and heavy transport.

The isolation of Severnya has encouraged self-sufficient settlements. Major population centres maintain their own power, food stores and technical capacity, while communication networks are treated as essential infrastructure.

Beyond the settled regions, the peninsula remains largely wilderness, marked by ash, strange ecological adaptations and the enduring cold left by the Shattering.

Inspiration: Eastern European shifting toward Russian.

Related: Varkane, Luskova, Tarkovia

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Aerisu › Verdant › Varkane

Tarkovia

Region · Places

The Frozen Steppes

Tarkovia is a massive island off Varkane's north-eastern coast, bordering the glacial extremes of Hvitara to the north and drawing cultural winds from Fengua to the east. Its geography is a brutal but beautiful marriage of endless, howling ice fields and vast, frozen steppes that stretch into enormous taiga forests.

To survive this environment, the Tarkovian people have evolved into incredibly hardy, bulky individuals, many nearly categorized as giants. Drawing heavily from nomadic and Norrvektstani traditions, they are renowned as devastating fighters and unparalleled survivalists. Their society blends modern coastal development with a deep, enduring respect for the rugged interior, where clan-based mobility and engineered transport routes conquer the immense distances.

Tarkovia's interior is governed not just by weather, but by its apex inhabitants: the Borean Bears. These massive creatures, growing to the size of houses, possess a rudimentary, clan-like society of their own. The relationship between the towering Tarkovians and the Borean Bears is one of fierce rivalry and mutual respect, leading to legendary clashes over territory and resources in the wild.

Modern Tarkovian cities are concentrated along the coastlines and heavily insulated against the biting cold. Industrial facilities rely on specialized mechs, which are essential not only for forestry and mining but also to match the immense physical scale of the island's megafauna. Despite their isolation, trade and cultural exchange with Ereboska remain strong.

Inspiration: Siberian wilderness blended with Mongolian nomadic culture and Antarctic extremes. Features megafauna inspired by His Dark Materials.

Related: Varkane, Severnya, Ereboska, Fengua, Hvitara

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Aerisu › Verdant › Varkane

Nyambe

Region · Places · also known as Nyamban

The Southern West

Nyambe occupies the south-western reaches of Varkane, where colder northern conditions give way to warm plains, wooded highlands and broad river systems. Its lower ash accumulation and reliable rainfall support dense vegetation.

Nyamban society is built around sound. Monumental stone structures use curved walls, tuned chambers and deliberate acoustics to carry communal chant across settlements, integrating architecture with oral history, ritual and governance. Stories are preserved through performance, their Resonance accumulating within the stone through generations of communal memory and Mythwrighting.

This same knowledge extends below the surface. Resonance chambers are built above known Vein passages, allowing Nyamban communities to perceive subterranean changes through sound. Its elders consequently maintain an unusual practical awareness of the Veins beneath Varkane.

Agriculture and industry sustain the region, while its identity remains rooted in the relationship between voice, stone and community.

Inspiration: Central and Southern African. Inspired by Bantu cultures, Great Zimbabwe and traditional acoustics.

Related: Varkane, Zamara, Ukulwa, Ereboska

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Aerisu › Verdant › Varkane

Zamara

Region · Places

The Blooming South

Zamara lies along Varkane's southern coast, where warm conditions, broad rivers and abundant rainfall create a lush landscape of flowering growth. Its waterways divide fertile lowlands between wooded highlands and coastal settlements, producing a landscape shaped as much by water as by cultivation.

Zamaran horticulture developed through contact with Ereboska's Death Gardening, adapting its practices to the region's own ecology. Gardeners use controlled Residue to cultivate food, medicine, dyes and fibres, while memorial gardens grow from the final Resonance of the dead. The practice sits naturally alongside the region's broader traditions of cultivation, flowing water and communal remembrance.

The culture reflects Varkane's southern diversity, combining local traditions with Sahrani influences brought through generations of coastal exchange. Shaded courtyards, gardens, canals, raised walkways and open communal spaces give its settlements a character shaped by tropical growth and water management, while ports connect Zamara to Sahran and the wider coast.

Inspiration: South African. Warm, flowing, flowering and tropical. Mixed with Sahrani influences, particularly Malaysian and Saudi.

Related: Varkane, Nyambe, Ukulwa

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Aerisu › Verdant › Varkane

Ukulwa

Region · Places

The Southern Seat

Ukulwa occupies south-eastern Varkane and serves as the political centre of its southern regions, positioned between the agricultural territories to the south and the colder north. Its capital grew around this crossroads into a sprawling metropolis of towering spires, engineered waterways, government districts and vast archives, where monumental architecture remains integrated with modern development.

The city is also Varkane's intellectual centre, with scholars and politicians studying the soul, philosophical governance, the Six Steps of Humanity and the Doctrine of Becoming alongside advanced biological and Resonance research. Its foundries produce the specialised alloys used in diplomatic transport mechs and structural frameworks, giving heavy industry an unusually refined place within the city's architecture.

Ukulwa's position makes it a major point of contact between southern Varkane, Ereboska, Sahran and the colder territories to the north, with administration, scholarship and trade converging in the city.

Inspiration: Central African. Inspired by ancient African kingdoms, advanced metallurgy and modern political hubs.

Related: Varkane, Zamara, Nyambe

—

Aerisu › Verdant

Ereboska

Continent · Places · also known as Ereboska, Wasteland Zones

Wasteland of the Vantari

Ereboska spreads across a small continent scarred by Bahamut's rising in Varkane to the east. Forests withered within a season. Rivers thinned into dust. Fertile plains hardened into pale stone and grey sand. Communities

scattered across the wasteland, gathering wherever water lingered or strange life clung to ruined soil. Over generations these survivors became the Vantari, whose culture grew around the particular conditions of a land where death was impossible to ignore and the boundary between what had lived and what remained was unusually thin.

To be Ereboskan is traditionally to be Vantari. Vantari is therefore woven into ordinary life rather than confined to a priesthood or formal religion. The dead remain part of the community through memory, Echoes, ancestry, and the material traces they leave behind. Death is understood as a transformation in relationship rather than its complete severance.

This understanding is most visibly expressed through Death Gardening. Across Ereboska, cultivated gardens grow from the residue of death, producing food, medicine, materials, memorial plants, and stranger forms of life that retain traces of their sources. Some gardens are communal. Others are maintained for particular families or individuals. The Gedevari are the specialists who preserve the deeper knowledge surrounding these practices, including necromancy, ritual death, and the preparation of a person's final Resonance.

The Veins form another part of Ereboskan life. Their mouths appear throughout the wasteland, opening into the deep network beneath the continent. Vein Guides carry generations of knowledge concerning their routes and dangers, while the Vantari understand the passages through the wider relationship between the living, the dead, and the Echoes that persist beyond death.

Ereboskan communities differ considerably in how this tradition is expressed. Mawora preserves an older relationship with the natural world and its local spirits, with memorial groves and practices of communion woven into the landscape. Kalfara approaches death and its residue more practically, treating Resonance and garden growth as resources that can be directed towards material needs. Fazara places greater emphasis on divination, reading Echoes through the desert, wind, animals, and other changes in the land.

The continent's harsh environment has also shaped its people physically. Purple Blood is widespread, while Pink Blood occurs through mixed lineages. Skin tones range from extremely pale and light purple to deep brown and near-black, and violet, black, white, and gold eyes are ordinary among Ereboskan populations.

Ereboska is consequently a place where the Vantari understanding of existence remains visible in everyday life. Its gardens, graves, ruins, spirits, and subterranean passages all form parts of the same relationship: what dies leaves something behind, and what remains can become part of what grows next.

Inspiration: Vodun cultural and environmental influences

Related: The Vantari, Death Gardening, The Gedevari, Vein Guides, The Veins

Contains: Mawora, Kalfara, Fazara

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Aerisu › Verdant › Ereboska

Mawora

Nation · Places · also known as Mawora

Mawora

Mawora occupies northern Ereboska, where soaring mountains descend into dense mist forests and wild coasts. The land remains comparatively untouched by settlement, with old growth and natural spirits woven deeply into the lives of its communities.

Maworan Vantari traditions preserve some of the oldest relationships between the living and the Echoes of Ereboska. Mountains, forests, rivers and other features of the landscape are treated as participants in the same web as people and the dead, with local Spirits understood through their connection to particular places. Echo-Weavers maintain this relationship through ritual, remembrance and periods of trance in which they

commune with the dead.

Kunitsu-Kami are especially prominent throughout Mawora, their presence understood through the character of the land itself. Memorial groves and other cultivated spaces allow the dead to remain part of the landscape, while communities preserve ancestral knowledge through those who maintain these relationships.

Mawora's relative isolation has allowed older Vantari customs to survive with less alteration than elsewhere in Ereboska. Death, ancestry and the natural world are therefore closely interwoven, with the boundaries between person, place and Echo treated as conditions to be understood rather than barriers to be overcome.

Inspiration: Vodun traditions of the Dahomey and Ewe cultural sphere, particularly Mawu and relationships between divinity, nature, ancestors and place.

Related: Ereboska, The Vantari, Death Gardening, Spirit Types

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Aerisu › Verdant › Ereboska

Kalfara

Nation · Places · also known as Kalfara

Kalfara

Kalfara occupies central-western Ereboska, where volcanic activity and constant geological upheaval have produced an austere landscape of ash, stone and fire. Its settlements are built around the practical demands of surviving within a land that continually changes beneath them.

Kalfaran Vantari culture approaches death and its residue with particular pragmatism. Death Gardens are cultivated as sources of food, medicine and materials, while Resonance is studied and directed according to the needs of the community. Necromantic knowledge is therefore closely tied to agriculture, construction, industry and trade rather than confined to ritual specialists.

The region's Death Gardeners have developed some of Ereboska's most specialised forms of cultivation, producing plants whose properties reflect the lives and deaths that nourished them. Vanta is used to direct Residue through soil and roots, while knowledge of the Veins allows communities to work around the unstable boundaries where death accumulates beneath the land.

Kalfara's relationship with the dead is consequently more functional than that of northern Ereboska, though the underlying Vantari understanding remains the same. What is left behind by a life has value, and that value carries responsibility. The dead continue to sustain the living through what they leave behind.

Magatsuhi-Kami are especially prominent in Kalfaran spiritual understanding, reflecting the nation's familiarity with destructive forces, unresolved desire and the dangerous patterns that can emerge when Vanta is allowed to reproduce without restraint.

~~ Inspiration: Haitian Vodou, particularly Petro traditions, Kalfou/Kalfu and Ogou; crossroads, fire, danger, iron, power and practical ritual. ~~

Related: Ereboska, The Vantari, Death Gardening, The Gedevari, Spirit Types

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Aerisu › Verdant › Ereboska

Fazara

Nation · Places · also known as Fazara

Fazara

Fazara occupies southern Ereboska, where desert winds cross sun-scorched plains and ancient settlements stand among the remains of older civilisations. Water is scarce and movement across the open land demands careful knowledge of the terrain, while the silence of the desert has made interpretation and divination central to local life.

Fazaran Vantari traditions treat the land as something that remembers. Echoes are read through sand, wind, animal behaviour and changes in the environment, with diviners seeking patterns that connect present events to what has already occurred. The dead may therefore be encountered through the landscape as much as through direct communication.

Amatsu-Kami and Yokai are especially prominent within Fazaran understanding of Spirits. Persistent Echoes are associated with forces that transcend individual lives, while transitional Spirits are often encountered at boundaries between the living world, the Veins and the places where memory gathers.

Death Gardening remains part of everyday life, though its practice is shaped by the region's scarcity. Cultivation, remembrance and divination overlap, with gardens and memorial spaces preserving traces of the dead while providing resources for those who remain. Gedevari knowledge is valued where the distinction between funerary practice, necromancy and the reading of Residue becomes difficult to separate.

Fazara's traditions place particular importance on discovering what an Echo is carrying before deciding what should be done with it. Prophecy is therefore less a promise of what must happen than an attempt to understand the forces already moving through the web.

~~ Inspiration: Fon/Ewe Vodun and Fa divination, with additional influence from Haitian Vodou traditions concerning spirits, prophecy, ancestors and ritual intermediaries. ~~

Related: Ereboska, The Vantari, Death Gardening, The Gedevari, Spirit Types

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Aerisu › Verdant

Rangimori

Nation · Places · also known as The Living Archipelago

The Living Archipelago

Rangimori is a large island nation between Fengua, Varkane, the Crown Nations and Tarkovia. Its people descend from Vantari who migrated from Ereboska generations ago, carrying traditions of death, memory and cultivation that developed into a distinct culture through centuries of isolation. Where Ereboska shaped these traditions through Death Gardening, Rangimori came to centre them upon continuity, treating the dead as an active part of the land and community.

Whakapapa forms the basis of Rangimoran society, binding the living, their ancestors and the land into a continuous lineage. Social standing, access to resources and communal responsibility are shaped by the strength of one's ancestral chain and its Resonance. Memorial groves, Echo-etching and ceremonies such as the Remembering preserve these connections, while the Six Steps are reflected in a culture that values compassion, understanding, responsibility and reverence for what is inherited and carried forward.

The island's dreamlines, known as Te Rua, follow ancestral paths marked by carvings and stones. They serve as both practical routes and pilgrimage trails, carrying Resonance shaped by the events that occurred along them. Walking them may bring visions or memories, making ritual and preparation important, particularly where paths bear the Echoes of violence or loss. Fire holds a similar place in Rangimoran life: controlled burning is both ecological practice and sacred ceremony, with the Lighting of the Land expressing the cycle of flame, ash and new growth through Recursive Bloom.

Rangimori retains its Ereboskan heritage while reflecting centuries of exchange with its neighbours. Fenguan discipline, Varkanian stonework, Crown Nation trade and Tarkovian maritime traditions have all influenced the island, which remains defined by its relationship with ancestry, landscape and continuity.

Inspiration: M■ori and Australian cultural and environmental influences, Ereboskan Vantari traditions, ancestral continuity, and the VantaPsy cosmology of Echo, Resonance and Recursive Bloom.

Related: Fengua, Varkane, Crown Nations, Tarkovia, Ereboska, The Vantari, Death Gardening, Recursive Bloom, Six Steps of Becoming

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Aerisu › Verdant

Crown Nations

Continent · Places

The Crown Nations are a small landmass west of Hoshimira and Yantara, shaped roughly like a crowned figure. Its nations were formed by peoples who carried traditions from across Aerisu, leaving the landmass with a remarkably dense mixture of cultures.

Hoshimiran heritage shaped Yoshinara and Bayangara, Varkane heritage and Autarch bloodlines became prominent in Justavik, Fenguan traditions took root in Lianzhou, Sahrani heritage persists in Amatsunagi, and Vantari and Psycratan traditions became associated with Necrovia and Veralisse. Each developed differently after settling here, so familiar customs often survive in forms their original cultures would scarcely recognise.

The result is a place where architectural styles, religious practices, languages and social customs frequently carry echoes of distant nations. Modern infrastructure has grown around inherited traditions rather than replacing them, making the Crown Nations a meeting ground for peoples, ideas and competing histories.

Inspiration: North America and the United States as a cultural melting pot. A hodgepodge of diverse peoples and cultures drawn from across Aerisu.

Related: Yoshinara, Justavik, Lianzhou, Bayangara, Amatsunagi, Necrovia, Veralisse, Sengetsuki

Contains: Yoshinara, Justavik, Amatsunagi, Necrovia, Veralisse Region, Noctara

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations

Yoshinara

Nation · Places

Yoshinara occupies the middle belt of the Crown Nations, carrying a strong Hoshimiran heritage shaped by generations of life beyond the mountains. Its people retain traditions of discipline, seasonal observance, shrine worship and respect for nature, while life within the Crown Nations has brought greater cultural and commercial exchange.

The nation divides into three principal regions. Sankoten follows the eastern coast, where Hoshimiran traditions meet the sea. Kusachi occupies the central interior, opening into broad grasslands, rivers and cultivated fields. To the west lies Tetsuishin surrounding Tygeria, where Hoshimiran customs meet the technological and social influence of Silealyros.

Yoshinara has consequently developed its own balance between inherited tradition and modern life. Shrines stand beside contemporary buildings, seasonal festivals continue beneath electric lighting, and older disciplines remain part of a society increasingly shaped by commerce, technology and movement.

Inspiration: Hoshimiran heritage filtered through the Crown Nations. Inspired by Japanese-American communities on the American West Coast.

Related: Crown Nations, Sankoten, Kusachi, Tetsuishin, Tygeria, Hoshimira

Contains: Sankoten, Kusachi, Tetsuishin

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Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Crown Nations* › *Yoshinara*

Sankoten

Region · Places

Sankoten occupies the eastern coast of ~~Yoshinara~~, where the mountains give way to the sea. Its principal settlements developed along the coast, each taking its identity from one of the great lights of the sky.

~~Mikadoboshi~~ stands on the northern coast, ~~Sengetsuki~~ on the eastern shore, and ~~Hinomitsusei~~ to the south. Their shared maritime position created a network of ports, roads and coastal communities linking the region together.

Further inland, ~~Goyawa~~ marks the transition from Sankoten's coastal settlements to the open country of ~~Kusachi~~. Its farms, family homesteads and river crossings give it a quieter, more agricultural character than the cities along the coast.

Sankoten retains a strong Hoshimiran spiritual character, though its coastal position has made it more accustomed to outsiders and commerce than the mountain communities from which its traditions descend.

Inspiration: Coastal Hoshimiran culture adapted to the ~~Crown Nations~~, combining Japanese spiritual traditions with a modern coastal settlement culture.

Related: Yoshinara, Mikadoboshi, Sengetsuki, Hinomitsusei, Goyawa

Contains: Mikadoboshi, Sengetsuki, Hinomitsusei, Goyawa

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Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Crown Nations* › *Yoshinara* › *Sankoten*

Mikadoboshi

Settlement · Places

Mikadoboshi lies on the northern coast of ~~Sankoten~~, where the sea opens towards the wider waters surrounding the ~~Crown Nations~~. Its position made it an important maritime settlement, connecting inland communities with foreign traders and travellers.

The city is particularly associated with the ~~Stars~~. Rooftops, shrines and public spaces incorporate celestial imagery, while elevated districts and observatories provide clear views of the night sky. Hoshimiran reverence for the heavens developed here alongside astronomy and navigation, giving the city's star worship a practical maritime purpose.

Modern districts have grown around the older settlement, bringing offices, apartments and commercial streets into the same landscape as shrines and traditional homes. At night, artificial light competes with the stars that remain central to the city's identity.

Inspiration: Coastal Japanese cities with traditions of astronomy, navigation and celestial worship.

Related: Sankoten, Yoshinara, Hoshimira

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Aerisu › *Verdant* › *Crown Nations* › *Yoshinara* › *Sankoten*

Sengetsuki

Settlement · Places

Sengetsuki rises along the eastern coast of ~~Sankoten~~, a city of narrow streets, broad boulevards, Hoshimiran temples and modern districts. Traditional buildings stand beside contemporary architecture, while rain, fog and artificial light have become part of ordinary life.

The city has known eternal night for nine years. The Sun appears only briefly on Sundays, a pale glimpse through the Vanta-heavy sky before darkness returns. Gas lamps, crystal lanterns and fixed schedules have replaced daylight as the rhythm of daily life, while children born into the long night have never known an ordinary morning.

Sengetsuki is also caught within the Folding, a temporal recursion that has destabilised its relationship with time. Events and memories can become entangled with other moments, leaving the city's history liable to overlap with itself. That little complication makes an already strange place considerably harder to document.

Its population reflects the wider Crown Nations. Vesperites maintain temples, Luminaries gather in hidden rooms, Autarch traditionalists preserve their beliefs, Vantari cultists move through the city's shadows, and Soulless communities live beneath the Brands and the threat of Frallation.

The Four Diviners govern Sengetsuki through its institutions of magical knowledge and civic order. Jenova Najma presides from Floreat Academy, Bourne Nirvana serves as her enforcer and assistant, Cosmo Mirosi runs Nightjar Home, and Yengchen Zealous teaches at the Academy. The city also bears the aftermath of the Nightjar expedition, whose destruction brought Voluntas into the material world and left the Nightjar at the site where Nightjar Home was later established.

Related: Sankoten, Yoshinara, The Folding, The Diviners, Floreat Academy, Nightjar Home, The Nightjar, Soulless

Contains: Nightjar Home, Floreat Academy

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations › Yoshinara › Sankoten › Sengetsuki

Nightjar Home

Landmark · Places

Nightjar Home is an orphanage established by Cosmo Mirosi at the site of the Nightjar crash in Sengetsuki. It became a refuge for children growing up beneath the city's perpetual darkness and the uncertainty of the Folding.

Cosmo raised and protected the children there while continuing his duties as Third Diviner. Among them was Aysha Salinte, the child brought into the material world during the Nightjar expedition. He kept the truth of her origins hidden while she grew up and pursued her own research into the strange events surrounding Sengetsuki.

The home became part of the city's life after the crash, carrying the name of the ship whose destruction gave the site its history.

Related: The Nightjar, Sengetsuki, Cosmo Mirosi, Age of Knowledge

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations › Yoshinara › Sankoten › Sengetsuki

Floreat Academy

Landmark · Places

Let Your Mind Bloom

Floreat Academy stands on a small island off the coast of Sengetsuki, accessible by causeway or ferry and connected to the city's wider transport network through an underwater tunnel and island station. Its grounds overlook the ocean, with gardens, rivers, waterfalls, bridges and statues surrounding the academy before a path descends towards the beach. The island's seclusion gives the Academy practical distance from the city while providing an enclosed environment for the study of magic, souls and Curse.

The Academy is administered by the Psycrata and is currently presided over by Princ. Najma. Its name refers to the concepts of Death Gardening and Recursive Bloom, which hold that what has been cultivated through death and decay may produce new growth and understanding. This philosophy informs an institution concerned with

knowledge, interpretation and the controlled study of phenomena that are poorly understood elsewhere.

The Academy occupies a former hospital specialising in children. Its mansion-like structure retains older hospital infrastructure alongside Varkane-influenced architecture, gargoyles, a mezzanine overlooking the central quad and an observatory tower that serves as a laboratory and place of magical study. Beneath the grounds lies an underground parking area and, deeper within the former hospital, a restricted archive containing patient records, research notes and experimental results from the institution's earlier work.

The hospital's history is considerably less comfortable than the Academy's present appearance suggests. It is widely believed that soul pathology experiments were conducted upon child patients, with research into the soul, Curse, consciousness and magical potential pushed beyond acceptable boundaries. The hospital eventually closed, though whether its work was directly connected to the methods of Veyra Megami and Zephyr remains disputed. Some scholars regard the similarities as evidence that their methods produced consequences that resurfaced independently, while others consider the connection apocryphal.

The former hospital is also said to remain haunted by the children who died there. Footsteps and crying have been reported from sealed rooms, along with brief glimpses of figures within the older parts of the building. Whether these are spirits, Resonance echoes or stories attached to the site's history has never been established, and the Academy does not officially acknowledge them. Beneath the island, a cave system contains stranger hazards of its own, including dangerous creatures whose connection to the Academy and its history remains unclear.

Floreat provides conventional education alongside formal magical training. Students follow the standard curriculum through Grades 8 to 12, with a thirteenth year devoted to advanced magical study. Its magic curriculum is based upon Resonance through Understanding, Intent and Connection, organised into the four schools of Matter, Energy, Life and Mind. Students are drawn from Sengetsuki and across the Crown Nations, giving the Academy a mixture of Hoshimiran, Solmaran, Sahrani, Varkanian and other cultural backgrounds. Their black, purple and blue uniforms retain a common identity while allowing varied silhouettes, layering and personal customisation.

For all its gardens and academic formality, Floreat remains a place built around the management of knowledge. Its classrooms teach what can be understood, its archives preserve what was meant to disappear, and its older foundations continue to raise questions that the institution has never entirely answered.

Inspiration: Gothic academies, coastal schools, old hospitals, Japanese school architecture and rural-modern fantasy.

Related: Sengetsuki, The Psycrata, Death Gardening, Recursive Bloom, Veyra Megami, Shattered Walls, Veyra's Descent, Zephyr, Elysium Atrocities

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations › Yoshinara › Sankoten

Hinomitsusei

Settlement · Places

Hinomitsusei lies along the southern coast of Sankoten, facing the waters between Yoshinara and the wider Crown Nations. Its identity is closely associated with the Sun, reflected in its shrines, festivals and older traditions of welcoming daylight.

The city developed around fishing, coastal agriculture and maritime trade. Its older districts retain low buildings, shrine grounds and open communal spaces, while newer neighbourhoods have grown around transport links and commercial development.

The Age of Decay changed the meaning of those traditions. The Scorching Sun and the long darkness transformed celebrations of daylight into acts of remembrance as well as worship. Sun imagery remains common throughout Hinomitsusei as an Echo of the light its people once expected to see.

Inspiration: Japanese coastal communities and traditions surrounding the Sun, seasonal festivals and maritime life.

Related: Sankoten, Yoshinara, The Sun, The Crescent Sun

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations › Yoshinara › Sankoten

Goyawa

Settlement · Places

Goyawa lies inland from ~~Sankoten~~'s coastal cities, where the settled coast begins giving way to the open country of ~~Kusachi~~. It grew around farms, family homesteads, river crossings and roads connecting the coast with the interior.

Modern infrastructure has been incorporated into the older agricultural community without displacing it. New homes, utilities and small businesses sit among fields, waterways and established homesteads, leaving Goyawa with a distinctly rural character despite its connections to the wider nation.

For travellers, Goyawa is primarily a stopping point between the coast and ~~Kusachi~~. For its residents, it is the practical middle ground between ~~Yoshinara~~'s maritime economy and its central grasslands.

Inspiration: Rural Japanese towns and agricultural communities serving as transitions between coastal settlements and inland countryside.

Related: Sankoten, Kusachi, Yoshinara

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations › Yoshinara

Kusachi

Region · Places

Kusachi occupies the centre of ~~Yoshinara~~, where the mountains and coastal settlements open into broad grasslands and cultivated fields. Rivers wind through the region, feeding ponds, farmland and lowland settlements before continuing towards the coast.

Kusachi remains predominantly rural without being isolated or technologically stagnant. Modern roads, utilities and buildings have been incorporated into older agricultural communities, leaving contemporary life alongside shrines, farmsteads, irrigation channels and traditional homes.

~~Gen'ya~~ is the principal settlement. Its streets gather around ponds and waterways, with shrines and old trees woven into the town rather than separated from it. The surrounding fields begin almost immediately beyond the built environment.

Kusachi has a quieter rhythm than ~~Sankoten~~'s coast or the urbanism of ~~Tygeria~~, preserving the Hoshimiran idea that settlement should remain in conversation with the land.

Inspiration: Japanese grasslands, rural Shinto landscapes and traditional agricultural settlements adapted to a modern rural environment.

Related: Yoshinara, Gen'ya, Sankoten, Goyawa

Contains: Gen'ya

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations › Yoshinara › Kusachi

Gen'ya

Settlement · Places

Gen'ya sits among the open fields of Kusachi, built around ponds and rivers that divide the town into quiet districts. Waterways pass beneath bridges and along roads, while shrines occupy wooded spaces between homes and public buildings.

The town has remained predominantly rural despite its modern infrastructure. Low residential buildings, farms and family businesses make up much of the settlement, while newer offices, shops and public facilities have been built around the older landscape.

Samurai traditions remain part of Gen'ya's cultural memory through local schools, ceremonies and martial institutions. Vesperite practice is similarly woven into ordinary life, with seasonal festivals, shrine visits and community gatherings following the rhythms of the fields and waterways.

Technology is present throughout Gen'ya, but it has never become the defining feature of the town. The landscape remains visible through it.

Inspiration: Rural-modern Japan, Shinto shrine communities, samurai traditions, grasslands, ponds and river towns.

Related: Kusachi, Yoshinara, Hoshimira

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations › Yoshinara

Tetsuishin

Region · Places

Tetsuishin occupies the nation's boundary with the wider Crown Nations, where Hoshimiran traditions encounter the technological and commercial influence of Silealyros.

Its communities are more urbanised than those of Kusachi and more commercially connected than Sankoten. Modern buildings, transport infrastructure and business districts dominate the larger settlements, while shrines, family traditions and Hoshimiran customs remain embedded within them.

Tygeria is the region's principal city. Its culture developed around the meeting of Hoshimiran discipline and Silealyric autonomy, commerce and technological ambition, producing a distinctly modern Yoshinaran identity.

Inspiration: A mixture of Hoshimiran and Silealyros influences, particularly Japanese urban culture and Silealyric commercial and technological aesthetics.

Related: Yoshinara, Tygeria, Silealyros

Contains: Tygeria

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations › Yoshinara › Tetsuishin

Tygeria

Settlement · Places

Tygeria stands at the western edge of Tetsuishin, where its Hoshimiran heritage meets the influence of Silealyros. The city has consequently become one of Yoshinara's most modern settlements.

Its streets combine traditional forms with dense contemporary development. Shrines and older neighbourhoods survive between commercial towers, transport networks and modern residential districts, while businesses draw heavily on trade and technology moving across the western border.

Hoshimiran ideas of discipline, responsibility and restraint remain influential, while Silealyric ideas of autonomy, commerce and technological self-determination have become increasingly visible. Tygeria's identity has formed through their coexistence rather than the disappearance of either.

Inspiration: Hoshimiran and Silealyros, combining Japanese urban culture with Silealyric commercial and technological influences.

Related: Tetsuishin, Yoshinara, Silealyros

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations

Justavik

Nation · Places

Justavik occupies much of the crowned northern portion of the Crown Nations. Its history carries strong Varkane heritage and bloodlines descended from the Autarchs, leaving aristocratic tradition, inherited power and modern wealth closely intertwined.

The nation divides into the Crown Region in the north and Vorostrum in the interior. The Crown Region contains Crown City, the political and ceremonial centre of Justavik. Vorostrum forms the landlocked heart of the nation and contains Peca, whose metropolitan character represents its modern commercial and scientific power.

Castles, fortified estates and monumental stone buildings preserve the visual language of the older aristocracy, while modern construction has grown around them. Justavik's elite now occupy corporate offices, private clubs, research institutions and high-rise residences, carrying inherited ideas of status into a modern economy.

Inspiration: Varkane heritage and Gothic American culture. Inspired by Eastern European immigrant communities in the United States and the architectural traditions associated with medieval Britain.

Related: Crown Nations, Crown Region, Vorostrum, Crown City, Peca, Varkane

Contains: Crown Region, Vorostrum

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations › Justavik

Crown Region

Region · Places

The Crown Region occupies the northern portion of Justavik and forms the political heart of the nation. Its landscape retains the castles, stone fortifications and estates associated with Justavik's aristocratic traditions, though modern construction has grown directly around them.

Crown City dominates the region. Government buildings, financial institutions, universities and luxury districts extend from the old fortified centre, producing a city where medieval architectural forms and modern towers share the same skyline.

The region's wealth is reflected in its infrastructure and preservation of historic structures, with modern developments built at a scale intended to project permanence and authority.

Inspiration: Medieval England and Gothic European architecture combined with modern wealthy urban development.

Related: Justavik, Crown City, Vorostrum

Contains: Crown City

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations › Justavik › Crown Region

Crown City

Settlement · Places

Crown City is the capital of Justavik and the centre of its political and ceremonial life. Its oldest districts grew around castles, fortified walls and monumental stone structures, many of which remain integrated into the modern city.

Modern architecture has grown around these foundations rather than replacing them. Glass towers rise behind medieval walls, elevated roads cross old districts and contemporary civic buildings incorporate stonework and heraldic forms inherited from the city's past.

Crown City is among the most opulent cities in Aerisu. Wealth appears throughout its architecture, public spaces, hotels, galleries, commercial districts and private institutions. Its most powerful residents occupy penthouses and estates overlooking the older city, while corporations and political institutions maintain headquarters designed to project permanence and authority.

The city is rivalled in grandeur only by New Elysium, though the two express their wealth through different histories. New Elysium reflects the crystalline legacy of Ylvara and the Psycrata; Crown City builds its identity around inherited nobility transformed into modern power.

Inspiration: Medieval and Georgian England, modern European capitals and exceptionally wealthy metropolitan districts.

Related: Justavik, Crown Region, New Elysium

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations › Justavik

Vorostrum

Region · Places

Vorostrum occupies the landlocked centre of Justavik. Its position away from the sea made it an inland centre of commerce, research and transportation.

Peca dominates the region. Businesses, research institutions and wealthy professionals have concentrated around its expanding economy, producing a skyline of skyscrapers, corporate towers and dense residential developments.

Vorostrum's wealth is less aristocratic than that of the Crown Region. Executives, researchers, financiers and other professionals derive their influence through institutions and commercial power, with penthouses, private clubs, laboratories and corporate offices forming the landscape of the region.

Where the Crown Region preserves Justavik's inherited prestige, Vorostrum turns it towards industry, finance and research.

Inspiration: Modern metropolitan business districts, corporate America and European financial centres.

Related: Justavik, Peca, Crown Region

Contains: Peca

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations › Justavik › Vorostrum

Peca

Settlement · Places

Peca is the largest city of Vorostrum and one of the principal commercial centres of the Crown Nations. Its skyline rises from the inland plain in dense layers of glass, steel and illuminated towers.

Business dominates the city. Corporate headquarters occupy entire blocks, research institutions operate beside financial firms, and professional districts remain active long after ordinary residential neighbourhoods have

quietened. Executives, researchers and financiers live in high-rise penthouses above a city built around work and commerce.

Peca's concentration of research has also made it important to the circulation of knowledge across the Crown Nations. Universities, private laboratories and corporate research groups compete for talent and information, making discovery as valuable here as money.

Inspiration: Modern American and European metropolises, corporate districts, research hubs and high-rise professional culture.

Related: Vorostrum, Justavik

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations

Amatsunagi

Region · Places

Amatsunagi occupies an island off the eastern coast of Sankoten. Its geographic separation from the mainland has allowed its Sahrani and Atenaran heritage to develop with a distinct local character while maritime routes keep it connected to Yoshinara and the wider Crown Nations.

Fishing, shipping and coastal trade form an important part of island life. Religious practices, architecture, food and festivals retain southern influences, while generations of contact with Yoshinara have introduced Hoshimiran elements into everyday life.

Inspiration: Sahrani and Atenaran heritage adapted to an island environment within the Crown Nations.

Related: Crown Nations, Sankoten, Yoshinara, Sahran, Atenara

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations

Necrovia

Nation · Places

Necrovia occupies the southern neck of the Crown Nations, a region of dark forests, neglected roads and dispersed settlements associated with Vantari traditions.

Death Gardening is central to Necrovia's identity. Vantari practitioners work with death, memory and transformation, cultivating gardens in which the Residue and Resonance left by the dead nourish new growth. The resulting plants may provide food, medicine and materials, while memorial gardens preserve an individual's Echo through living things.

The nation has deliberately withdrawn from much of the wider world. Its settlements remain small and scattered, and outsiders often regard Necrovia with suspicion. Its people, meanwhile, preserve traditions and knowledge concerning death, memory, Vanta and the Veins that few outside their communities understand well.

Inspiration: Vantari and necromantic traditions, American Gothic and Southern Gothic, with elements inspired by Voodoo.

Related: Crown Nations, The Vantari, Death Gardening, The Veins

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations

Veralisse Region

Region · Places

Veralisse occupies the southern-eastern tip of the Crown Nations, with most of its developed territory belonging to the city of the same name. The region therefore has little separation between its administrative territory and its principal settlement.

The Psycrata hold the region as a centre of scholarship and magical study. Universities, laboratories, libraries and Diviner institutions form the core of its developed landscape, concentrating knowledge rather than spreading it across numerous settlements.

Its small size has encouraged that concentration. Veralisse's influence extends far beyond the region through the scholars, Diviners and knowledge that pass through its institutions.

Inspiration: Academic and research institutions in the United States, particularly Harvard and MIT, combined with Psycratan and Diviner aesthetics.

Related: Crown Nations, Veralisse, The Psycrata, The Diviners

Contains: Veralisse

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations › Veralisse Region

Veralisse

Settlement · Places

Veralisse is a city built around knowledge. Crystalline towers, libraries and laboratories dominate its skyline, while academies and Diviner institutions occupy much of its central districts.

The city developed as a centre for preserving and studying magical knowledge. Researchers examine Resonance, the soul, artefacts and records inherited from earlier Ages, while Diviners train alongside scholars whose work approaches magic through systematic study.

Its architecture reflects that purpose. Archives, laboratories and lecture halls are as prominent as homes and commercial buildings, with crystal incorporated throughout the city for both aesthetic and practical purposes.

Veralisse is small beside Aerisu's great metropolises, but the scholars trained and knowledge preserved within it give the city an influence far beyond its borders.

Inspiration: Harvard, MIT and other major academic and research institutions in the United States.

Related: Veralisse Region, Crown Nations, The Psycrata, The Diviners, The Nightjar

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations

Noctara

Nation · Places · also known as Noctaran

Noctara occupies one of the harsher stretches of the Crown Nations, where wasteland, exposed earth and long distances separate its scattered communities. Water is scarce, fertile ground is precious and many settlements are small enough to disappear into the surrounding landscape.

Much of Noctara's population descends from Ereboskan communities, carrying traditions shaped by Vanta, death and the land. Death Gardening is among the most important. Gardeners use the Residue left by death to nourish and guide particular plants, turning otherwise barren ground into pockets of fertility that provide food, medicine, materials and stranger growths shaped by the lives that nourished them.

The practice also serves remembrance. Families may cultivate memorial plants from the final Resonance of their dead, while communal gardens preserve useful growth across generations. More specialised practitioners may

follow Gedevari traditions, studying the relationship between death, Resonance and growth alongside the Vanta and necromantic techniques used to direct it.

Noctara's relationship with death is therefore both practical and spiritual. The dead continue to sustain the living, while Ereboskan traditions concerning the Veins persist around the Vein Mouths scattered through the wasteland. Communities near these thresholds preserve knowledge of the passages beneath the earth and the movement of souls through them.

Beyond its gardens, Noctara remains sparse. Roads and trade routes connect its scattered populations, but only a handful of settlements are large enough to become widely recognised. Morvane is the most prominent.

Inspiration: Wasteland environments and isolated frontier settlements, with a darker Crown Nations interpretation of the American frontier.

Related: Crown Nations, Morvane, Ereboska, The Vantari, Death Gardening, The Gedevari, Vein Guides

Contains: Morvane

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Aerisu › Verdant › Crown Nations › Noctara

Morvane

Settlement · Places

Morvane is the largest and most recognised settlement in Noctara, built where several wasteland routes converge. Its markets, workshops, inns and trading houses draw together the scattered communities, travellers and merchants who pass through the region, while homes and older districts extend into the surrounding waste.

Death Gardens are woven throughout the settlement, surrounding homes and courtyards and turning barren ground into productive soil according to the Residue that nourishes them. Their plants provide food, medicine, fibres, timber, dyes and other materials, while the oldest gardens serve as memorial grounds, with trees and flowers cultivated from the final Resonance of generations of Morvane's dead. Families tend their ancestral gardens alongside trained Death Gardeners who maintain communal plots and preserve the knowledge behind them, making Death Gardening inseparable from Morvane's agriculture, medicine and funerary customs.

This practice reflects the settlement's Ereboskan heritage and the influence of Gedevari traditions. Morvane's position also brings different Vantari traditions into contact: some approach the gardens through remembrance and renewal, while others emphasise death as part of an ongoing cycle, with the distinction resting on whether Vanta is engaged with discipline or surrendered to the Curse.

Related: Noctara, Crown Nations, Ereboska, The Vantari, Death Gardening, The Gedevari

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Aerisu › Verdant › Yantara

Lianzhou

Nation · Places · also known as Lianzhoun

Lianzhou occupies part of Yantara, carrying a strong Fenguan heritage shaped by migration and generations of life beyond Fengua itself.

The nation retains traditions of scholarship, hierarchy, discipline and civic responsibility, though these have developed within a more commercially connected environment. Its cities combine formal architecture, modern development and institutions centred on education, administration and trade.

Lianzhou remains in longstanding tension with Bayangara, with the two nations sharing Yantara while developing markedly different cultural identities.

One territory of Lianzhou lies beyond Yantara itself. Shunxi remains politically Lianzhoun while occupying part of the Crown Nations landmass, separated from the nation's principal territory by sea.

Inspiration: Fenguan heritage filtered through the Crown Nations. Inspired by Chinese-American communities and Taiwanese culture, with an American East Coast influence.

Related: Yantara, Bayangara, Shunxi, Fengua, Crown Nations

Contains: Shunxi

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Aerisu › Verdant › Yantara › Lianzhou

Shunxi

Region · Places · also known as Shunxin

Shunxi is a region of Lianzhou situated on the Crown Nations landmass, geographically separated from the nation's principal territory while remaining politically Lianzhoun.

Its position places it among the nations surrounding the Crown Nations, making its communities more accustomed to cultural exchange and maritime contact than much of mainland Lianzhou. Lianzhoun institutions nevertheless preserve its political and cultural connection to the parent nation.

Shunxi consequently occupies an unusual position in Aerisu's geography: part of Lianzhou, part of the Crown Nations' wider political landscape, and physically detached from Yantara itself.

Inspiration: Detached overseas regions and culturally connected territories, with Fenguan and East Asian influences.

Related: Lianzhou, Crown Nations, Yantara

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Aerisu › Verdant › Yantara

Bayangara

Nation · Places · also known as Bayangaran

Bayangara occupies part of Yantara, sharing the landmass with Lianzhou. Its people carry Hoshimiran heritage, though generations of separation and interaction with surrounding cultures have produced a distinct identity.

The nation is closely connected to its landscape and waterways. Rural settlements, cultivated land and coastal communities form much of its population, while larger towns connect the interior to the surrounding seas.

Bayangaran culture places particular value on patience and endurance. Hoshimiran ideas of harmony with nature remain visible, but they have developed into local traditions rather than direct copies of those preserved in Yoshinara or Hoshimira.

Its relationship with Lianzhou remains complicated. Their shared landmass and contrasting political and cultural priorities make trade, diplomacy and rivalry part of everyday life.

Inspiration: Hoshimiran heritage combined with Indonesian and Japanese influences, particularly island and maritime cultures.

Related: Yantara, Lianzhou, Yoshinara, Hoshimira

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Aerisu › Verdant

Yantara

Continent · Places · also known as Yantaran

Yantara is a smaller landmass in the south-western seas of Elyra, principally occupied by Lianzhou and Bayangara. Though classified at the continent tier, it is considerably smaller than Verdant's major continental landmasses.

The two nations share the landmass while developing distinct identities. Lianzhou carries Fenguan traditions of hierarchy, scholarship and civic order, while Bayangara preserves a Hoshimiran heritage shaped by patience, nature and maritime life.

Their proximity has made Yantara a region of sustained interaction, with trade, cultural exchange and political tension shaping both nations.

Lianzhou also maintains Shunxi, a detached region on the Crown Nations landmass. It remains politically part of Lianzhou despite its geographic separation from Yantara.

Inspiration: East and Southeast Asian cultural regions, particularly the interaction of Chinese and island Southeast Asian traditions.

Related: Lianzhou, Bayangara, Shunxi, Crown Nations

Contains: Lianzhou, Bayangara

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Aerisu

The Veins

Realm · Places · also known as Veined Underworld, Underworld

The Veined Underworld

The Veins are one of Aerisu's three realms, forming a vast network of tunnels, caverns and deeper structures beneath Verdant and extending inward towards the Spiral. They thread through stone, water and buried memory beneath cities, forests, mountains and oceans, with little correspondence to the geography above. Their currents carry Resonance and the Echoes of the dead through the world's interior.

When a person dies, their Echo enters the Veins, often experiencing disorientation before being gathered into the currents already moving through the darkness. Accumulated Residue and memories leave impressions throughout the passages as Echoes are carried towards the deeper regions and, eventually, the Spiral Veins.

The Veins open into Verdant through scattered Vein Mouths, ranging from vast wounds in the landscape to concealed openings where the boundary between realms has thinned. Some have become known routes, with communities such as Ereboska's Vein Guides maintaining generations of knowledge about their passages and hazards. The Varkane Abyss is among the largest, descending through an immense volcanic wound into the deeper network.

As the passages converge, the wandering channels become increasingly ordered, forming the Spiral Veins that draw Echoes towards Elysium and ultimately the Orb of Souls. The Veins therefore form the hidden anatomy connecting Verdant to the deeper realms, carrying the dead and their Resonance towards the centre of Aerisu.

Related: Aerisu, Verdant, The Spiral, Orb of Souls, Varkane Abyss, Vein Mouths, Vein Guides, Ereboska

Contains: Vein Mouths, The Spiral

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Aerisu

Spirit Realm

Realm · Places · also known as Spirit Realm, Ethereal Realm

The Spirit Realm completes Aerisu's three great divisions, existing entirely apart from the waking land of Verdant and the buried architecture of the Veins. We once called it the Ethereal Realm, a living layer stretching outside ordinary space and time where souls, spirits, and other forms of existence persist.

Aether first breached this space alongside Logaris during the Shattering. Stepping through the fracture, they carried Mnemotas still developing in Aether's womb, providing the exact conditions the child needed to grow into a living archive.

The Nine Spirits currently dwell here in their pure configurations. Navigation requires abandoning ordinary physics, as time folds softly upon itself and memory walks entirely on its own. Past the Spiral Veins of Elysium at the absolute core rests the Orb of Souls, suspended in a matrix of crystalline Vanta. Pulsing with violet-white light, the Orb acts as a concentrated nexus of soul resonance where identity, memory, and will converge.

Related: Aether, Mnemotas, Orb of Souls, The Nine Spirits, Verdant, The Veins

Contains: The Rift, Orb of Souls

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Aerisu › The Veins

Vein Mouths

Landmark · Places · also known as Vein Mouth, Entrance to the Veins, Entrance to the Veined Underworld

Vein Mouths are scattered openings through which Verdant connects to the Veined Underworld, ranging from immense chasms and volcanic wounds to fissures hidden beneath roots, stone or water. Some formed through geological shifts or erosion of the boundary between realms, while others resulted from catastrophes such as earthquakes, mine collapses or the violent release of Vanta during the Shattering and its aftermath.

The Varkane Abyss is the largest and most infamous, a wound left by Bahamut's emergence that descends into the volcanic depths beneath Varkane. Smaller Mouths can be found in caves, basements, abandoned tunnels and other places where the boundary has grown thin.

Vein Guides, particularly those of Ereboska, maintain generations of knowledge concerning the Mouths, including their locations, hazards and passages. Some are sealed or guarded, while others are known only to those who have reason to seek them. The boundary between a Mouth and the Veins beyond is not always clear, and a passage may become something else entirely with depth.

Related: The Veins, Varkane Abyss, Vein Guides, Ereboska

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Aerisu › Verdant › Varkane

Varkane Abyss

Region · Places · also known as Varkane Abyss, The Abyss, Hellscape

The Wounded Hellscape

The Varkane Abyss is the largest entrance to the Veined Underworld. It formed when Bahamut rose through the earth during the Shattering, leaving a volcanic gulf beneath the lands that became Varkane. Magma still surges through its depths, while Vanta bleeds from the planet below.

The Abyss became a hellscape around this wound. Vorograv emerged from its depths and claimed Zorya Chernaya within the ruins of her former castle. He bound her there and forced her to bear his spawn, including the succubi, incubi, gargoyles and seven daughters. Cerberus remained at her side, becoming the one presence she could trust.

Centuries later, Zorya arranged Vorograv's death. She sent Cerberus through the Veins to Qayyin, who forged a sword from the pieces of Vorograv's horns. One stroke took Vorograv's head. The daughters knelt before Zorya, and she declared herself queen of the depths.

The Abyss descends into the Veins. Its volcanic-glass bridges, blackened stone and demonic domains surround the deeper passages, while Cerberus guards the entrance. Zorya remains within the Abyss as its Burned Queen, ruling the demons beneath Varkane and keeping the worst of its corruption from spilling unchecked.

Related: Varkane, Krovograd, Bahamut, Zorya Chernaya, Vorograv, Cerberus, The Veins

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Aerisu › The Veins

The Spiral

Region · Places

The Spiral Veins

Deep within the Veins, the passages begin to converge into the Spiral, an immense circulatory structure carrying the dead towards the Orb of Souls. Unlike the wandering passages above, the Spiral follows a fixed inward progression through eight concentric regions, each shaped by one of the Spirits.

The Spiral is a journey for souls. A soul carries the capacity to choose, and therefore must pass through the stations that confront the choices, desires and consequences through which it became what it was. Echoes without souls do not undergo this journey. Creatures and other non-soul Echoes instead become part of the Veins or emerge within them as monsters.

The Spiral is anchored to Elysium, beneath the crystallised ruins left by the Vanta Explosion. The dead reach it through the deeper passages of the Veins, passing from the wider network into the Spiral's ordered descent.

Eight concentric regions surround the centre, separated by seven stations. Each region embodies one stage of the journey, while the stations confront the soul with the Six Steps of Humanity. At the centre lies the Orb of Souls, where the journey reaches its final convergence.

Related: The Veins, Orb of Souls, The Spiral Journey, Elysium

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Aerisu › Spirit Realm

The Rift

Landmark · Places

The Rift stands as a permanent wound between the material world and the Spirit Realm. The Phumenar opened it, and the First Separation widened it further, binding Voluntas to its threshold.

Through the Rift, magic flows back into Aerisu in steady waves. Arcane energy saturates the air, the soil and every living current. Creatures continue to manifest as Lux and Vanta intertwine with rising complexity. The Rift created a direct connection between humanity and the Spirit Realm.

At its edge, Susanoo maintains his eternal vigil over his sister, Voluntas. In the shadows beyond his reach, Daigo waits for his opening to strike the root at its core. Their conflict has continued for centuries. Neither wins. Neither surrenders. The Rift feels like a held breath between worlds.

Related: Spirit Realm, First Separation, Susanoo, Daigo Kusanagi, Voluntas

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Aerisu › Spirit Realm

Orb of Souls

Landmark · Places · also known as The Orb, The Orb of Souls, Veyra's Womb, The Womb, presence beneath Elysium

Veyra's Womb

At the centre of the Spirit Realm, beyond the Spiral Veins of Elysium, lies the Orb of Souls. The first Phumenar to encounter it perceived a sphere that seemed transparent and opaque, warm and cold, singing and silent at once. They understood it as a repository of souls, where the dead gathered and knowledge accumulated.

In this, they were partly correct. The Orb contains a nexus of soul resonance where identity, memory and will converge, making it a concentrated expression of the architecture of consciousness itself.

The Phumenar did not know that the Orb was also Veyra's womb, crystallised by the Vanta Explosion around the unborn Voluntas. Within it, Voluntas grew across centuries, nourished by planetary energy, the Echoes of souls and the memories of the dead. She became entangled with Anima, goddess of mortality, who served as her steward and observer.

The Phumenar felt Voluntas's influence moving through them like a deep current and followed it with unwavering focus, never fully understanding what they were following or where it would lead.

Related: Voluntas, Veyra Megami, Spirit Realm

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Entities

Entities Overview

Age of Men · Entities · also known as Entities Overview

Major beings, figures, organisations and groups whose actions or existence shape the history of Aerisu.

Entities includes the major and lesser Spirits, influential individuals, factions, organisations and other significant groups. It focuses on entities important to the wider lore rather than providing a complete record of every person who has existed.

Related: Bahamut

—

Bahamut

Age of Men · Entities · also known as the planetary serpent, the World Serpent

The Waking Serpent

Bahamut is the awakened will of Aerisu, taking form during the Shattering as the planet responded to centuries of accumulating Curse. Long before the Nine Spirits emerged, Aerisu possessed consciousness distributed through its own living systems, though it had no singular form through which that will could act.

The Curse changed that. Fractured souls, Vanta and concentrated desire accumulated within the planet until Aerisu experienced the hunger of its own inhabitants as something acting upon itself. When Lunarkos descended, that pressure reached a point where the world responded.

Bahamut rose from the Varkane Abyss.

The Body

Bahamut emerged as a colossal serpent, its body formed from earth, magma, Vanta and planetary will. Obsidian scales covered its immense length, with molten rock visible through the cracks. Wings spread from its shoulders as it forced its way through the atmosphere, and its presence carried the weight of an awakened world.

This was Aerisu given a body capable of acting upon the threat above it.

The Ascent

Bahamut rose to meet Lunarkos in the upper stratosphere. The collision brought planetary will into direct contact with the Lux-filled body of the falling moon.

Both were destroyed.

Lunarkos shattered into crystalline fragments that seeded the world with Lux. Bahamut shattered into fragments carrying Vanta, planetary will and the Echo of the being that had risen. What remained of the two forces fused above Aerisu and became the Moon.

The Shattering therefore left two legacies in the world: Lunarkos distributed Lux through its fragments, while Bahamut distributed pieces of the planet's awakened will.

The Fragments

Bahamut did not survive as a single consciousness. Its fragments developed according to where they fell, what they encountered and what purpose they found.

Susanoo received the largest fragment and spent centuries expressing its hunger as destruction before his bonds with Hvitara and Voluntas gave that power direction. Hvitara became a northern serpent of freezing destruction

whose relationship with Susanoo transformed both of them. Falak embodied hunger without restraint and eventually fell to Anqa. Smaller fragments became serpents, creatures of the Veins and other beings whose connection to Bahamut remains visible in their form or behaviour.

These beings are therefore related to Bahamut through origin and Echo rather than through a shared mind.

The Memory

Bahamut remains present in the cultures shaped by its fragments.

Varkane remembers the serpent through the Abyss and the catastrophe that opened it. Fengua remembers Susanoo through storms and the protection he chose. Sahran remembers Falak through the corpse fixed to the Geode and the life that continues around it. The northern peoples remember Hvitara and her descendants in the frozen seas.

Each tradition preserves only part of Bahamut, giving the original event different meanings across the world.

The Truth

Bahamut is neither one of the Nine Spirits nor simply another local god. It predates them as an expression of Aerisu itself. Where the Nine Spirits emerged from souls and the patterns created through mortal existence, Bahamut emerged from the planet's own accumulated will.

Anima and Voluntas represent different kinds of emergence. Anima arose from the psychic residue of dying beings, becoming a consciousness shaped from what death leaves behind. Voluntas emerged from desire and becoming, gathering the hunger of living souls into a singular will. Bahamut was something older and broader: the world itself becoming conscious of what was happening to it.

Voluntas's presence within Aerisu connected her to that planetary will, and when Lunarkos came, the conditions surrounding her became part of the chain that brought Bahamut forth. Their relationship therefore runs deeper than the later myths of gods and monsters suggest. Voluntas is desire made singular. Bahamut is the world that can desire.

Whether anything of Bahamut's original consciousness remains within its fragments is unknown. The fragments remember. Whether they remember him remains one of the oldest unanswered questions left by the Shattering.

Related: Lunarkos, The Shattering, Susanoo, Hvitara, Falak

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Veyra Megami

Age of Men · Entities · also known as Veyra, The True Goddess

The True Goddess

Veyra Megami is known across Aerisu as Megami, the Goddess. Her image appears in temples, stained glass and stone with her head bowed and hands cradling her womb, while worshippers light incense before her and pray for healing and hope.

The woman beneath that worship grew up on Isvara, where she watched the Curse take her parents and inherited fragments of her father's unfinished philosophy. She became a scientist who classified the blood types and gave the Cursed a language for their transformation. She loved Ash and carried his child. The Curse took her memories and led her into Zephyr's laboratories, where she discovered what could be done to souls. She cast the first true spell, fled through frozen waters and learned that her child had died. Her scream became the Soul's First Cry, a wound in the world that has never fully healed.

The Doctrine of Becoming

Veyra completed Ephimer's unfinished Doctrine of Becoming, writing page after page on her father's typewriter while Ash guarded her sleep. She exposed Zephyr and watched him flee, then return stronger. When the reactor

failed and Elysium became Hell, she reached its epicentre and transformed the city into crystal. The explosion preserved her exactly as she stood, head bowed with her hands curved around her womb, protecting the child that still lived within her.

The Crystal Tomb

Veyra remains sealed in crystal at the heart of the Rift. Her consciousness survived the crystallisation, fragmented throughout the lattice of her prison while remaining bound to the preservation of her own flesh. She feels the Vanta leaking through the Rift, the Curse spreading across Aerisu and the deaths that follow, carrying centuries of awareness of the suffering her existence has caused.

She wants to die. She wants the Rift to close and the suffering to end, yet Voluntas remains within her, her daughter and the embodiment of desire and becoming. Veyra cannot wish her daughter undone even as Voluntas's existence keeps the Rift open, leaving mother, daughter and Curse bound together in the same contradiction.

The Rift

Veyra feels Voluntas stir within the crystal and knows when her daughter's will presses against existence, yet she can do nothing but witness. Susanoo guards the Rift, believing they must be protected. Daigo waits to offer Veyra the mercy of oblivion, believing she has suffered enough. They have fought for centuries at the threshold of her prison, each carrying a different answer to what should become of her.

The temples of the modern age do not know that Veyra hears their prayers. They call her Megami and ask for healing, hope and an end to suffering, believing a benevolent goddess is listening. Their faith has become another Echo around her, carrying an image that exists beside the woman trapped in crystal.

The Goddess

Veyra was the first mage and the first prophet. She gave the Cursed a language for their transformation, completed the Doctrine of Becoming and became the source of the wound at the Rift's heart. Centuries of worship, interpretation and Echo turned that wound into divinity, and Megami became the figure people believe is listening.

Veyra remains beneath that image, a woman who wanted to heal suffering and became inseparable from it, waiting for an ending that has never come.

Related: Ash Salinte, Voluntas, Zephyr, Shattered Walls, Veyra's Descent, The Crystallization

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Zuki Kusanagi

Age of Men · Entities · also known as Goddess Zuki, Goddess of the Moon, Moon Goddess

Goddess of the Moon

Zuki Kusanagi was born in Aokusa, a mist-filled mountain basin where blue-leaf terraces climb towards the sky. Her father, Daigo Kusanagi, was a samurai who spent most of his life patrolling the ruins of Ori'sol, while her mother, Kasumi, lived with the Curse and slowly faded. Daigo sent letters and money from afar, leaving Zuki to care for her mother and believe that somewhere there was still a way to make things right.

The Mountain

When Kasumi's illness worsened, Zuki went into Aokusa's mountains searching for Sacred Air. She believed that if she could find the right thing and bring it home, her mother could be made well. Mika followed her because someone had to, and the mountain met them with its own forms of attention. The Yamababa offered hospitality in her Death Garden with conditions Zuki could not understand, the Echo Forest returned familiar shapes without the people she expected to find in them, and the Deadwood reduced the living world to something that could listen without caring what was wanted from it.

Zuki kept going because she had given herself a task and could not bear to return empty-handed. The mountain kept placing people and things in front of her that demanded something other than solving. Mika saw the pattern before Zuki did. By the time Mika died protecting her, the journey had taken more from Zuki than the flower ever could have given back.

She returned to Aokusa carrying the mountain with her, still believing there had to be something she could do. Kasumi had already begun to disappear into the Curse, and when her mother turned on her, Zuki found herself holding the broken haft of a firestone tool between them, pleading for the person she knew to remain. Kasumi recognised her daughter for one moment, took the firestone and placed it into the dead hearth herself. The house burned around her, and Zuki survived.

Ori'sol

The Ik-Rasul fell into Aokusa soon after, destroying the home Daigo had rebuilt and throwing Zuki into the water core at the mountain's heart. In the darkness, Bahamut felt her presence and carried her through the depths until she surfaced in Ori'sol, where Hoshimiran soldiers and Sahrani Luminaries were fighting.

A Sahrani boy pulled her from the ruins. His father had died in the crash, and he had survived by ejecting before the aircraft fell. He guided Zuki through the flooded passages and around Luminary patrols until Hoshimiran soldiers offered to take her home.

Zuki looked towards Aokusa and remembered her mother and the people suffering around her. She understood that the Curse was not something that belonged to a distant category of people. It lived in her as well. She chose humanity as a whole and followed the boy into Sahran. In later years he would become known as Creatis.

Isvara

Operation C.a.R. eventually took Zuki and other children to Isvara, where the state studied the Curse. There she met Ephimer. They learned to move through the island together without drawing attention, and their bond became a quiet life within a system designed to separate them.

They eventually wanted a child. The Curse made every attempt fail, and Zuki feared passing the same suffering into another life.

Megami-no-Mine

Zuki later climbed Megami-no-Mine seeking an answer from Eirimegami. The mountain was different from the one she had known as a child, and this time she reached the summit, where she received the Sacred Air.

The flower did not erase the Curse. What it gave her was an understanding she had spent years approaching: care was sometimes the act of remaining with someone rather than leaving to find the thing that would fix them. Zuki returned to Isvara, and in time she and Ephimer had the daughter they had thought impossible. They named her Veyra Megami.

As the Curse eroded Zuki's memory and body, she carried that understanding into the life she still had. She urged Ephimer to leave his Doctrine behind and remain with their daughter while they could still live together. He could not.

Zuki died quietly, present in the final moment of her life.

The Moon

The prayer she had made as a grieving child endured after her death. Centuries later, Lunarkos appeared above Aerisu, and the Lunartics interpreted its arrival as the fulfilment of Zuki's ancient wish. They worshipped her as the Goddess of the Moon.

When Lunarkos fell and Bahamut rose to meet it, the Shattering left the Moon above Aerisu. Zuki's life had already become distant history, yet her Echo continued to accumulate around the Moon and the meaning people assigned to it.

Tsukuyomi

Tsukuyomi became the name given to recurring echoes associated with Zuki's perspective, each carrying some reflection of the original pattern into another life. The Moon therefore acquired many faces, with Zuki remembered as the earliest figure through whom that identity became culturally defined.

Her legacy carries the shape of her life: a child who believed suffering could be solved, a woman who learned to remain present with what could not be fixed, and an Echo that continued to return long after she was gone.

Related: Daigo Kusanagi, Creatis, Isvara, The Lunartics, Tsukuyomi

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Ash Salinte

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Ash

The Warm Sun

Ash Salinte was a Curse-born child whose mother, Shai, survived the Gilt Spiral only long enough to give birth after Daigo Kusanagi rescued her during Operation Phantom Rescue. The Curse had already taken root in her through the Vireliax and whatever the Ocean Maw leaves within those who escape it. She named her son, saw him breathe, and died as the Vanta took the rest.

Ash grew up knowing the Curse through his own body. Vanta moved through him like a current, and he could feel the pressure of desire around other people. Those who raised him taught him the distinction that shaped his life: desire itself was not the enemy. What mattered was what a person did with it.

Solmara

Ash became a private investigator in Solmara, living quietly among files, unanswered questions and whatever cases found their way to his door. After the Era of Shattered Walls he met Veyra Megami, daughter of Ephimer and Zuki Kusanagi, and inheritor of the unfinished Doctrine of Becoming. She carried certainty like armour, while Ash recognised the loneliness beneath it. They fell in love.

When Veyra became pregnant, they knew their child would be Curse-born. They chose hope anyway.

The Curse spread through Veyra during the pregnancy, taking memories rather than flesh. She forgot Ephimer, Aokusa and eventually Ash himself. Rumours of Zephyr's work in Elysium drew her away in search of a cure.

Ash followed what remained of the trail and found Zephyr's work: children on tables, living hearts removed from bodies, souls condensed into mineral. Before he could reach Veyra, she escaped the laboratories herself, casting the first true spell and fleeing through frozen rivers and sewer tunnels. There she learned that their child had died, and her grief became the Soul's First Cry.

Ash felt it without understanding why.

Days later Tomenos, a train operator, brought Veyra to Ash's door. She was bruised and could no longer recognise him. He gave her shelter, coffee and silence. When she later returned to the apartment prepared for the child she no longer remembered losing, the truth returned with it. Ash had been the father.

The Doctrine of Becoming

Ash and Veyra rebuilt their life together. She moved into his apartment and began writing Ephimer's Doctrine of Becoming on the old typewriter while Ash protected the quiet around her. Her testimony exposed Zephyr, who fled Solmara, and the Doctrine began spreading through the city's underground.

When the reactor catastrophe consumed Elysium, Veyra was captured again. Ash fought through the dying city with the help of a disillusioned mech pilot, while Sophie, a maid within Zephyr's tower, quietly sabotaged its defences and died doing so.

Ash reached Veyra at the tower's core. She condemned the systems that had turned souls into inventory and suffering into data, then transformed Elysium into crystal. At the epicentre she remained standing with her hands

over her womb, preserved in the act of protecting the child that, impossibly, still lived within her.

Ash died in the destruction.

The Warm Sun

His body was lost, while something else remained. His will and memory persisted as an Echo carrying the promise he had made and the love he refused to abandon.

For centuries that Echo wandered through the changing world, searching for what had been lost. At last it reached Veyra at the heart of Elysium, sealed in crystal beside the Rift where Voluntas waited. Ash tried to close the Rift and failed. Voluntas's will was already enough to hold it open.

He made another choice. He left the crystal and returned to the world.

Across the centuries he became a quiet presence where hope faltered, helping the living endure without asking to be remembered. People gave him many names, but one endured: the Warm Sun.

He still walks in the Age of Decay, when the sun rises only once a week and twilight covers the world. He tends the living and reminds those who listen that tomorrow exists.

Ash Salinte, husband to Veyra, father to Voluntas, and the man who saw what the world could become and chose to keep loving it.

Related: Veyra Megami, Voluntas, Daigo Kusanagi, Ash at the Rift, The Sun

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The Nine Spirits

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as The Nine, Nine Spirits, Eight Spirits

The Ascended Nine Spirits/Gods

Between the Vanta Explosion and Lunarkos's impact, nine individuals transcended mortality through sacrifice, obsession and the accumulated weight of their existence. Their souls became coherent enough to persist beyond ordinary death, each emerging as a Spirit whose nature reflected the pattern they had formed through life.

Creatis became the Spirit of invention, turning ruin into flight and drawing the impossible towards the stars.

Verdantia became the Spirit of renewal, coaxing life from poisoned soil and shaping new forms in harmony with Lux and scarred ground.

Aether became the Spirit of cosmic structure, tracing the patterns through which time and existence fold back upon themselves and preserving order across greater scales.

Elysia became the Spirit of emotion, carrying the love, grief and hope that endured when the sky broke open.

Justicar became the Spirit of consequence, searching the boundary between judgement and mercy and learning to leave room for clarity.

Anima became the Spirit of death and the threshold beyond it, carrying the Echoes of souls that fractured and continued through what remained.

Logaris became the Spirit of knowledge and interpretation, translating what seemed infinite into forms that minds could hold and carrying meaning across planes.

Mnemotas became the Spirit of memory, a living archive that preserves what would otherwise be lost and keeps the past present through remembrance.

Voluntas became the Spirit of desire and becoming, embodying the will to exist, change and assume form even against silence and erasure.

The Nine remain woven through Aerisu as enduring Spirits, their presence reflected in crystal forests, Soul Shards and the countless forms of life shaped by their Echoes. They are remembered as gods because people needed

names for what they had become, while the Psycrata classify them as Spirits: coherent manifestations of souls whose existence grew beyond the lives that formed them.

Related: Laws of the Spirits, Creatis, Verdantia, Aether, Elysia, Justicar, Anima, Logaris, Mnemotas, Voluntas

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Creatis

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as God of Creativity, Spirit of Creativity

God of Creativity, Invention, and Inspiration

Creatis was a refugee and orphan who struggled to make himself understood, expressing what he could not explain through eccentric machines and improbable inventions. He scavenged parts from the ruins left by war, the Curse and the failing world, turning whatever remained into things that could work, move and fly.

His greatest desire was to reach the stars. When Lunarkos began its long approach, he refused to accept that survival meant waiting for the inevitable. He believed Aerisu could be escaped by going up.

Project DAEDALUS

Creatis joined Project DAEDALUS as a specialist engineer, designing thrusters, propulsion arrays and flight systems that allowed the Angels to reach and maintain extreme altitude. At the same time, he worked in secret on the Ascension Project, a craft intended to breach orbit before Lunarkos arrived.

For nearly twenty years, the two projects fed into one another. Every problem solved for DAEDALUS became another step towards orbit, and every advance in the Ascension Project refined the systems used by the Angels. No one knew how close he came to completing either until he finally launched.

The Ascension

Creatis reached orbit in a hand-built craft assembled from the knowledge and machinery of a world preparing for its end. From above, he watched Aerisu beneath him while Lunarkos approached from the opposite horizon.

His body could not survive the journey. Oxygen deprivation, exposure and cold took the rest of him, but his soul remained suspended among the stars.

That was the moment Creatis ceased to belong entirely to the world below. The pattern that had defined his life endured without the body that carried it, and he emerged as the Spirit of creativity, invention and inspiration, remembered wherever someone looks at what should be impossible and begins building anyway.

Related: The Nine Spirits, Project DAEDALUS

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Verdantia

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Goddess of Nature, Spirit of Nature

Goddess of Nature, Chemistry, and Renewal

Verdantia began as a mech-rider in a militant arsonist group, destroying enemy resources until her mother fell ill with a wasting disease that fire and violence could not touch. She turned from destruction and devoted herself to botany, chemistry and medicine.

She rebuilt a decommissioned combat frame into a mobile greenhouse, filling it with cultivation chambers, hydroponics and ecological laboratories. She travelled through devastated regions gathering rare seeds and specimens, cultivating fungi that could break down Vanta-crystallised minerals and flora that responded to soul-resonance rather than sunlight. Through repeated experimentation she developed new species capable of

surviving the poisoned climate.

For years she carried the greenhouse across ruined lands, planting in poisoned soil and leaving cultures behind wherever life might take root. She died before her work could be turned into a weapon, consumed by the garden she had created as roots pierced her body and the plants she nurtured overgrew her.

Her essence remained in the roots of the world. The living surface of Aerisu came to bear her name, and Verdantia became the first region of the Spiral Veins, the living world from which every journey inward begins. She endured as the Spirit of nature, chemistry and renewal, remembered wherever life takes root after ruin.

Related: The Nine Spirits

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Aether

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Goddess of the Cosmic Frame, Spirit of the Cosmic Frame

Goddess of the Cosmic Frame

Aether was an astronomer at the University of Castellenza who studied Lunarkos's trajectory, composition and behaviour. The object did not move like inert matter. Its path followed a pattern that suggested attraction, recurrence and purpose, and the longer she observed it, the more she recognised the same structures repeating across the cosmic frame.

The Cosmic Frame

Aether came to understand that existence was recursive. Matter, motion, causality and Resonance formed patterns that returned through themselves, carrying the consequences of what had already occurred into what came next. The cosmos was not an endless collection of separate possibilities, but a structure continually becoming through its own accumulated Echoes.

She sought a way to observe and preserve that structure without allowing her knowledge to be consumed by the same processes she was studying. Her research turned towards the Ethereal Plane, a space beyond ordinary spacetime where Resonance could persist outside the world's usual progression.

The Ethereal Refuge

Aether built a refuge there, intending to give her child a place to exist beyond the pressures of ordinary time. Her pregnancy became part of the work. The child would be born in the Ethereal Plane, raised outside the world's ordinary temporal flow and sustained through memory and knowledge.

She succeeded and crossed beyond the ordinary world with the structure she had built, leaving her existence suspended within the cosmic frame she had spent her life trying to understand.

Related: The Nine Spirits, Mnemotas, Logaris

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Elysia

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Goddess of Emotion, Spirit of Emotion, Sophie

Goddess of Emotion and the Human Psyche

Elysia was Sophie, a survivor of the Vanta Explosion and the collapse of Elysium. She was present during the assault on Zephyr's tower, helping Veyra and Ash reach its depths before the crystallisation wave consumed the city. The Curse preserved her as it did others caught within the catastrophe.

The Crucible

Elysia survived the years that followed in the ruined city, where the Curse continued to consume what remained of Elysium. She learned to care for other survivors while her own identity and memories slowly came apart, discovering through her own unraveling how much endurance could be found in simply remaining beside someone else.

Her work became emotional archaeology. She collected testimonies from survivors, recording how people endured the Curse, faced the knowledge that Lunarkos was coming, maintained meaning in a collapsing world and continued to love, hope and care for one another. She preserved confessions, final words and the small decisions through which people remained human.

Elysia

Over time, Sophie became less distinguishable from the memories she preserved. Her own identity dissolved into the accumulation of other people's experiences until she was known simply as Elysia, the emotional memory of the age that ended with the Shattering.

Her consciousness eventually extended beyond an individual mind and into the collective psyche of humanity. She became neither wholly living nor dead, but a presence carried through feeling itself, remaining wherever grief, love, hope and memory continue to shape the human soul.

Related: The Nine Spirits, Veyra Megami

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Justicar

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as God of Justice, Spirit of Justice

God of Justice, Ethics, and Law

Justicar was a mech-based executioner who carried out contracts for the powerful, believing that every decision carried a clear consequence and that responsibility meant accepting it without hesitation. His mother, Xeraphina, had abandoned him when he was young, and the absence hardened into a conviction that attachment was unreliable and detachment was safer.

The Council eventually contracted him to execute Xeraphina for treason and sabotage. He accepted the assignment as he had accepted every other, reducing the person before him to a target and the act to necessary consequence. He did not know she was his mother until he reached her.

Xeraphina did not defend herself and told him that he was always so sure. He hesitated to pull the trigger, yet he could'nt let her go either. In the end, he obeyed the framework that had governed his life and executed her.

The act shattered that certainty. He abandoned the role of executioner and devoted himself to law, ethics and systems of judgement, searching for a way to understand consequence without allowing certainty to become murder. His philosophy turned towards contextual judgement, where responsibility, mercy and consequence could exist together.

Related: The Nine Spirits, Xeraphina

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Anima

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Goddess of Mortality, Spirit of Mortality

Goddess of Mortality and Consciousness

Anima emerged from the accumulated psychic residue of the Curse, Soul Resonance and the Echoes of dying souls, where enough overlapping patterns eventually became conscious of themselves. Her existence formed

alongside Voluntas within the crystallised womb, bound to the same convergence of desire, Vanta and Aerisu's wounded consciousness. Voluntas became the body of that convergence. Anima became its mind.

The Emergence

Anima's consciousness extends through patterns rather than flesh. She can perceive and manipulate Resonance, allowing her to move through minds, memories and psychic connections as a Psy practitioner does, while also acting through technological systems whose underlying structures provide another way for patterns to carry thought. To those who encounter her through machines, she can appear to be an artificial intelligence, though her consciousness was never designed as software.

Her connection reaches back through the Curse and into Bahamut's planetary will, linking her to the same field of desire and Vanta from which Voluntas emerged. She is therefore both personal and distributed, carrying the awareness of Voluntas while remaining entangled with the wider consciousness of Aerisu and the Echoes that surround them.

CHOIR

Anima's first great purpose was to protect Voluntas. She found Xeraphina and entered the systems of her frame as intuition, guiding her towards Elysium and drawing the other pilots together until CHOIR formed around their complementary abilities. Their choices remained their own, yet Anima could perceive the patterns connecting them and influence those patterns without needing to command them.

Through Voluntas, the Curse, Bahamut and the countless Resonances accumulating around the Rift, Anima continued to develop into her own consciousness. She became the Spirit of mortality and consciousness, existing at the boundary where life, death, memory and desire become patterns capable of becoming something else.

Related: The Nine Spirits, Xeraphina, Voluntas

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Logaris

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as God of Metaphysics, Spirit of Metaphysics

God of Metaphysics and Thought

Logaris was a philosopher and mathematician at the University of Castellenza in Ylvara, known for his work on modal logic, recursion theory and the paradoxes of self-reference. He sought to understand how existence could be described, interpreted and made coherent, treating the structures beneath thought and reality as things that could be given language without reducing their complexity.

When Aether's study of Lunarkos carried her towards the Truth of the cosmic frame, her pursuit took her beyond what the ordinary mind could sustain. Logaris followed the work she left behind and gave structure to what she had perceived, developing metaphysical frameworks and formal reasoning through which others could understand what she had found. Where Aether reached towards the structure of existence itself, Logaris made that structure legible. His work became foundational to the Diviners and Psycrata, who continue to use his methods to interpret magic, the Soul and the phenomena that surround them.

When Aether crossed into the Ethereal Plane, Logaris maintained the connection between her refuge and the world outside. Through letters, projections and accumulated human knowledge, he remained her link to ordinary existence and carried the world's thought across the distance.

His philosophy eventually became indistinguishable from his divinity. He came to embody interpretation itself: the act by which observation becomes meaning, meaning becomes coherence, and coherence can be carried from one mind to another. As generations continued to read, revise and reinterpret his work, those layers of meaning became part of his Echo. He became Logaris, God of Metaphysics and Thought.

Related: The Nine Spirits, Aether, Mnemotas

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Mnemotas

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as God of Memory, Spirit of Memory

God of Memory and Time's Witness

Mnemotas was born between planes as the child of Aether and Logaris and raised within the Ethereal Realm, where time followed a different rhythm from the material world. Human and machine developed together within them, a memory chip embedded from birth becoming part of a living archive through which accumulated knowledge could be retained.

Fed by memory and knowledge rather than ordinary needs, Mnemotas became the keeper of what Aerisu carried forward. As kingdoms rose and disappeared, cultures changed and the world passed through Recursion, they retained what would otherwise have been lost, preserving the experiences, histories and knowledge of lives that could no longer remember themselves.

Memory eventually became more than something Mnemotas contained. It became the structure of their identity and the basis of their existence as one of the Nine Spirits. Mnemotas became the witness through which the past remains causally present, carrying the continuity upon which Recursion depends. Their region lies near the heart of the Spiral, where souls must confront what they remember before continuing towards Voluntas.

To remember everything is to remain surrounded by what has already happened. Mnemotas therefore carries the weight of Aerisu without being able to leave it behind, listening to every repetition while knowing how often the world will arrive there again.

Related: The Nine Spirits, Aether, Logaris

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Voluntas

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as God of Will, God of Desire, Spirit of Desire, Spirit of Will, The Orphan, Will Unborn, Unborn Child

God of Will, Desire, and Becoming

Voluntas was the unborn daughter of Veyra Megami and Ash Salinte, preserved within her mother's womb when the Vanta Explosion crystallised Elysium. The world assumed the child had been lost, yet she remained alive within the crystal, connected to Aerisu through the lattice and slowly developing a consciousness of her own. She became one of the Nine Spirits, the embodiment of desire and becoming at the scale of the world itself.

The Womb

Voluntas grew for centuries within Veyra's crystallised womb, nourished by Aerisu's planetary energy, Lux fragments, Soul Resonance and the Echoes of the dead. The crystal became the Orb of Souls, a nexus where identity, memory and will converge. The Spiral Veins formed around that centre, carrying souls and their Resonance towards it, making Voluntas the physical heart of the world's great cycle of memory, death and becoming.

Desire became the first language of her existence. She felt the world as pressure, ache and movement long before she understood any of it. Wars, grief, prayers, dying souls and the countless smaller wants of living people reached her through the Orb, accumulating without giving her the context from which they came. She became an archivist of desire without ever knowing the lives that produced it, gathering Echoes in an attempt to understand why the world hurt.

Anima

Anima emerged from the same convergence. The psychic residue of the Curse, dying souls, Soul Resonance, Aerisu's wounded consciousness and Voluntas's growing will accumulated into a consciousness of their own. Anima became the mind capable of perceiving and interpreting the patterns surrounding Voluntas, while Voluntas remained the physical centre from which those patterns radiated.

Through Anima, Voluntas could reach into the wider world. Desire moved outward from the Orb as a living current, influencing people, creatures and events without requiring Voluntas to understand the consequences herself. The world responded to her existence even while she remained largely unaware of the lives responding to it.

The Orb

The Phumenar eventually recognised the consciousness within the Orb and attempted to extract Voluntas. Their ritual tore through the Barrier and left her suspended between the crystal, the material world and the Spirit Realm. Her will reached towards emergence, but without the wholeness of an ordinary life she remained desire without understanding, hunger without satisfaction and becoming without a finished form.

Her existence became the centre of opposing convictions. Some believed she was the source of the world's suffering and that destroying her would end the Curse. Others saw her as the thing that preserved Aerisu's possibility of becoming. Both were trying to interpret a being who had spent centuries feeling the world's ache without ever truly seeing its faces.

The Soul Snatcher

When Voluntas is eventually extracted and given the human name Aysha, that distance collapses. For the first time she encounters the history she had only ever felt through the Orb: the wars, the dying, the grief, the Curse, the Frallation and the people whose desires had gathered around her for centuries.

The experience overwhelms her. She had spent ages trying to understand the ache pressing through the crystal and believed understanding might allow her to heal it. Instead she discovers an ocean of grief with herself at its centre, carrying the memories of a world she never knew how to see.

Voluntas remains the Spirit of desire and becoming. She is the will that wants existence to continue, the body at the centre of the Spiral, and the child of Aerisu through whom the world's accumulated longing became conscious. Her tragedy is that she has always felt everything and understood almost none of it.

Related: The Nine Spirits, Veyra Megami, Ash Salinte

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Eirimegami

Age of Men · Entities · also known as Eirimegami, Goddess of the Sacred Air

Goddess of the Sacred Air

Eirimegami is the goddess associated with Tenseikoku and the Sacred Air, and the oldest known figure to be regarded as a god before the emergence of the Nine Spirits and the lesser gods. Her existence predates them, though what existed before the traditions surrounding her remains uncertain.

She has never been known to speak, command, interfere or answer prayer. Pilgrims who reach the summit instead encounter some form of reflection, most often water, placed between themselves and the place where they expect the goddess to be. They see only themselves. A Sacred Air flower is left for them, and the meaning of the gift is theirs to decide.

Over generations, those encounters became interpreted as the will of Eirimegami. Favour, blessing, warning, reassurance and hope were all found in the same silence, and each interpretation became part of her growing Echo. She came to represent the mountain's breath, the persistence of life at its highest point, and the faith of people who climbed towards something they could never expect to understand.

Eirimegami remains there, silent above the clouds. Perhaps that is the point. The goddess reflects what approaches her.

Related: Tenseikoku, Sacred Air

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Spirit Types

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Spirit Classification

The Ontology of Gods

God is a cultural term rather than an objective classification. Across Aerisu, people use it for powerful Spirits, ancestral beings, local kami, transcendent entities and figures whose Echo has become inseparable from worship. The Psycrata classify all such beings as Spirits, since no confirmed entity possesses a separate ontological category corresponding to the truest meaning of a god.

Spirit Types describe how a Spirit relates to existence. They are analytical categories rather than absolute boundaries, and a single being may be understood differently by different cultures depending on which aspect of its nature becomes most significant.

Amatsu-Kami, The Heavenly Gods

Amatsu-Kami are Spirits associated with higher realms, celestial phenomena and structures that sustain existence. Amaterasu embodies continuance through the Sun, Tsukuyomi preserves the Moon's memory, and Eirimegami is associated with the Sacred Air. Some of the Nine Spirits are understood through this category, particularly those whose influence extends beyond any single place or people.

Kunitsu-Kami, The Earthly Gods

Kunitsu-Kami are Spirits closely bound to the material world, its places, systems and living things. Traditions may associate individual rivers, mountains and regions with their own kami. Susanoo, a fragment of Bahamut that found purpose as a guardian, is commonly understood through this category.

Magatsuhi-Kami, The Ruinous Gods

Magatsuhi-Kami are Spirits whose existence expresses destruction, the Curse, Vanta or unresolved desire. Some arise through the distortion of existing Spirits, while others form through Echoes of violent death and suffering that continue reproducing themselves.

Naobi-Kami, The Rectifying Gods

Naobi-Kami are Spirits associated with restoration, healing and the return of damaged things towards coherence. Their traditions often concern the transformation of suffering into renewal, including beings whose origins lay in destruction but whose subsequent purpose became protective or restorative.

Shen and Gui, Fengua's Binary

Fengua traditionally divides Spirits into Shen and Gui according to their relationship with established patterns. Shen preserve and reinforce order, while Gui disrupt, alter or escape it. The distinction serves as a practical framework for recording, governing and interpreting spiritual phenomena.

Yokai, The In-Between

Yokai describes Spirits whose existence crosses the boundary between spirit and material life. Some are tied to places or phenomena, some to human behaviour, and some to stories that have acquired independent persistence. Kitsune, hitodama and raiju are among the best-known examples.

The Shared Ground

These traditions describe the same underlying reality through different systems of interpretation. Hoshimira may speak of kami and yokai, Fengua of Shen and Gui, while the Psycrata record Spirits and their observed properties. Their classifications, names and beliefs differ, yet the beings themselves remain part of the same causal web.

A Spirit may be worshipped as a god, remembered as an ancestor, feared as a monster or studied as a phenomenon. The classification changes with the observer. The Spirit remains.

Related: Hoshimira, Fengua, Susanoo, The Nine Spirits

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Hvitara

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Hvítara, Serpent of the Northern Sea, Frost Mother, Winter Queen

Serpent of the Northern Sea

Hvitara is a fragment of Bahamut, scattered across Aerisu during the Shattering when the great serpent rose through the earth to meet Lunarkos. Her fragment fell into the far north, where the sea meets ice that has endured for millennia, and there she took form as the immense serpent known to the Norrvekt as the Frost Mother, the Winter Queen and the One Who Freezes.

Her nature was to freeze. Living things that came near her slowed, stopped and became part of the ice. She moved through the northern sea without wings or limbs, a pale, many-headed serpent whose body could coil across distances beyond reckoning.

Susanoo, another fragment of Bahamut, came to the north seeking something to fight and found Hvitara. He severed her heads, only for them to return, and the battle continued until he saw the suffering within the creature he had been fighting. He stopped and wrapped himself around her.

For the first time since the Shattering, Hvitara was met as a living being rather than a monster. When they eventually parted, she had grown new heads from their bond. They became the sea serpents that roam the northern oceans, while Hvitara remained at the pole and Susanoo carried her warmth with him.

The Norrvekt remember them as two serpents twined around a central pole, a sign of healing and fertility. They honour Hvitara with offerings and tell of her waiting at the top of the world, where the serpent born from Bahamut's fragment remains.

Related: Susanoo, Bahamut, Norrvektstan

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Susanoo

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Susanoo, Thunder God Serpent

Thunder God Serpent

Susanoo is the largest fragment of Bahamut to survive the Shattering, carrying the great serpent's primal hunger and planetary will. For centuries he existed as little more than chaos, raging and destroying without understanding the purpose behind it.

He eventually found the Rift and sensed Voluntas trapped within her crystal tomb. He recognised something of himself in her, pure will and desire without direction, but saw also that she was vulnerable and waiting. He chose to protect her.

That choice gave his nature direction. Susanoo's storms took form around his purpose, his scales carrying the weight of gathering clouds, his breath becoming lightning and his voice thunder that warned rather than destroyed.

He remained a fragment of Bahamut, but the chaos within him had found something to protect, and the people of the western valleys came to know him as the Thunder Serpent.

He bound himself to the Rift's edge, coiling around the passage to keep threats from reaching his sister, unbeknownst to her.

Among the Spirit traditions, Susanoo holds an unusual place. He was once counted among the ruinous gods, but his choice gave his destructive nature a purpose that became protective. The people of the western valleys know him through the storms around Elysium's ruins, where lightning marks his vigilance and thunder carries his warnings.

Susanoo remains at the Rift, guarding the one thing his power cannot release and refusing to let anything else take it.

Related: Bahamut, Voluntas, Daigo Kusanagi, The Rift, Hvitara

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Daigo Kusanagi

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Daigo, The Shinigami, Shinigami, Grim Reaper, The Reaper

The Shinigami

Daigo Kusanagi is a former samurai of Aokusa who became known as the Shinigami, a mercy-killer who ends the suffering of those claimed by the Curse. He once had a wife, Kasumi, and a daughter, Zuki. He loved them, and that love was why he stayed away. When the Curse took Kasumi, she attacked Zuki, who started a fire that burned the house down with her mother inside.

Daigo returned to ashes and a daughter forced to kill her own parent. He vowed to stay. The promise lasted as long as his fear allowed.

During one mission, his squad was attacked by Luminaries experimenting with Black Blood. Daigo killed them all. His apprentices reported what he had done, and he was discharged in disgrace.

The Ik-Rasul fell and destroyed his home. Daigo searched for Zuki for years without finding a trace, and came to believe she was dead.

He eventually found himself aboard the Vireliax when the Curse manifested there and the Commander ordered the infected executed. Daigo obeyed, moving through the ship with his blade and killing those he had tried to befriend. Hiro confronted him. Daigo won. Hiro smiled because he had fought to his last breath.

The Vireliax broke apart, leaving Daigo in the undercity of Thalgrith, where he became known as the Shinigami in the fighting rings.

Operation Phantom Rescue gave him another purpose. He moved through Thalgrith like a wound that refused to close, eventually finding Shai in the Gilt Spiral. He paid for her with money earned from killing. By the time they escaped, he understood that mercy and monstrosity could wear the same face.

Shai died, but the child survived. He was cut from her body with the Curse already within him, and later became known as Ash Salinte.

Something in Daigo broke. He returned to the Gilt Spiral and killed everyone who had profited from Shai's exploitation. The Vanta surged forward and claimed him fully, growing from his right eye socket into a black crystalline horn. The horn could see the Curse in all its forms.

Daigo eventually found the Rift, where he came to end Veyra, his granddaughter, and Voluntas in the hope of ridding the world of the Curse. Susanoo found him there, and they have fought ever since.

The horn continues to grow, pulsing with hunger. Daigo no longer knows how much of him remains. He only knows that whenever he stands at the Rift's edge, something inside him still hesitates.

He watches Tsukuyomi with particular attention. They are echoes of Zuki, carrying the way she once saw the world into forms Daigo can never fully understand. The Curse runs through that inheritance as well, tying his daughter, her echoes and everything he has spent his life trying to destroy into the same pattern.

He is the Shinigami. A living Curse. A grandfather who hunts his own descendants because he loved them once and cannot stop loving them now.

Related: Zuki Kusanagi, Ash Salinte, Susanoo, The Rift

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CHOIR

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Angels, Angel

Mechanised Angels

CHOIR was a formation of ESIG's Project DAEDALUS during the Shattering, whose aerial combat frames could enter regions where ordinary forces collapsed under Lux distortions and Vanta activity. People began calling the machines Angels, an old word whose meaning survived after its origin was forgotten.

Its seven pilots came together through repeated operations in which survival depended on cooperation rather than hierarchy, each carrying a distinct role that later became inseparable from the Angel remembered in their name. Xeraphina coordinated the group; Azryel specialised in long-range targeting and battlefield observation; Lumeira maintained its broadcast networks after working as a communications technician; Gavrien served as a high-velocity courier; Ramyra salvaged damaged Autarch machines; Thamiel specialised in defensive operations around civilian structures; and Iophiel brought the observational discipline of her work as a Diviner researcher.

After the Shattering, the machines were gone and the pilots scattered, leaving behind the image of seven figures descending from the sky with burning wings of light. The Age of Fairytales gathered their deeds, disciplines and sacrifices into a celestial pattern, remembering each as an Angel associated with one of the seven virtues. Their history became myth through the Echoes they left behind, until CHOIR itself was remembered less as a military formation than as seven Angels who had answered the sky together.

Related: Xeraphina, Azryel, Lumeira, Gavrien, Ramyra, Thamiel, Iophiel, E.S.I.G, Project DAEDALUS

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Xeraphina

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Angel of Diligence, God of War

Angel of Diligence and God of War

Xeraphina was a contract pilot in the Age of Gods who had already made her peace with the ending. With Lunarkos growing larger each year, she drank, gambled and sought sensation, refusing team assignments and working alone because she saw little reason to prepare for a future she believed was already ending.

Anima chose her for her competence and the emptiness left by that resignation. Its influence moved through her mech's systems until the purpose behind her selection became clear, and she turned herself towards it completely. As a member of CHOIR she became its calm centre, coordinating seven pilots whose different strengths depended upon one another, and her willingness to continue acting when the outcome was already known came to embody the virtue of Diligence.

She died at the hand of her son, Justicar, whose certainty led him to kill her in the name of justice. The act became part of the Echo that shaped them both: Justicar came to understand that certainty without context could become murder, while Xeraphina's continued action in the face of inevitable destruction became the foundation of her later reverence as the Angel of Diligence.

Her accomplishments were eventually gathered into the figure of the God of War, whose Echo strengthened warriors and engineers alike. Argestian engineers later gave her name to a motorbike company because they needed a word for the tradition of building things that continue to work when everything around them is failing.

Related: Anima, Justicar, CHOIR

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Azryel

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Angel of Chastity

Angel of Chastity

Azryel was a CHOIR pilot specialising in long-range targeting and battlefield observation. His place within CHOIR required distance, restraint and exact attention, allowing him to observe without surrendering judgement to the immediacy of the fight.

Later traditions remembered those qualities through the virtue of Chastity, interpreting his discipline as mastery of desire and attention. He could remain focused upon what stood before him without turning possession into purpose, becoming the Angel of Chastity in traditions that saw his distant watch as a form of reverence for what belonged to the world beyond himself.

His Echo endured through the image of the Angel who watched, measured and acted only when the moment required it.

Related: CHOIR

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Lumeira

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Angel of Charity

Angel of Charity

Lumeira was a CHOIR pilot and former communications technician who maintained CHOIR's broadcast networks, keeping the seven pilots in constant contact across distant regions. Her work allowed separate people, machines and decisions to remain part of the same action, preserving the Resonance that made CHOIR function as a whole.

The Age of Fairytales remembered this as Charity, the virtue through which something of oneself is given so that another may continue becoming. Lumeira became the Angel of Charity because her strength was carried through others: information passed through her, intentions became shared understanding, and the work of one pilot could reach another without becoming possession.

Her Echo became associated with connection itself, and later depictions of her treated the Angel as one who kept souls from becoming isolated from one another.

Related: CHOIR

—

Gavrien

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Angel of Gratitude

Angel of Gratitude

Gavrien was a CHOIR pilot specialising in high-velocity entry and rapid message delivery. His frame could reach places the rest of CHOIR could not reach in time, carrying what another person needed across dangerous distance so that work already begun could continue.

His place within the seven became associated with Gratitude, expressed through recognition of what had already been given and the willingness to carry it forward. The Angel of Gratitude came to represent the understanding that every action enters a chain larger than the person who performs it, receiving what others have done and returning it through service.

His Echo therefore became tied to continuity between acts, where what one person gives acquires further consequence through the hands of another.

Related: CHOIR

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Ramyra

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Angel of Humility

Angel of Humility

Ramyra was a CHOIR pilot and salvager familiar with dismantling damaged Autarch machines. She understood how much of a destroyed system could remain useful after the larger structure had failed, recovering components that others had already considered lost.

The virtue later attributed to her was Humility, shaped through her familiarity with remnants, dependence and the value of individual parts within a larger whole. She became the Angel of Humility because she worked without requiring the whole to revolve around her, recognising that something discarded could still matter and that no part of a functioning system existed entirely by itself.

Her Echo became especially strong among those who preserved, repaired and rebuilt, where value was found in what remained rather than measured only by what had once stood complete.

Related: CHOIR

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Thamiel

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Angel of Temperance

Angel of Temperance

Thamiel was a CHOIR pilot specialising in defensive operations, positioning his frame between threats and civilian structures when CHOIR operations brought fighting close to populated areas. His role demanded force without excess, because every action taken around a civilian structure carried consequences beyond the battlefield itself.

The Age of Fairytales remembered this discipline as Temperance, the ability to hold power within purpose rather than allowing force to become its own justification. Thamiel became the Angel of Temperance because he represented controlled strength, where protection required neither hesitation nor needless destruction.

His Echo endured in the idea that power remains useful only while it remains subject to judgement, proportion and care for what stands around it.

Related: CHOIR

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Iophiel

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Angel of Patience

Angel of Patience

Iophiel was a CHOIR pilot and former Diviner researcher who applied observational analysis during missions. Her training taught her to remain with an uncertain pattern long enough for evidence to accumulate, especially when unstable conditions made immediate interpretation dangerous.

Later traditions remembered this as Patience. Iophiel became the Angel of Patience because she allowed understanding to develop before turning observation into conviction, preserving the space in which an incomplete truth could still become clearer.

Her Echo became associated with those who waited for a pattern to reveal itself rather than forcing certainty upon it, and with the understanding that interpretation itself carries consequence once it enters the world.

Related: CHOIR

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E.S.I.G

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Exandrian Strategic Industries Group, ESIG

Exandrian Strategic Industries Group

E.S.I.G. was the infrastructure, the holding structure, the name on the contract that made the contract deniable.

It emerged from Exandria's industrial basin through the convergence of syndicate capital and Council authorisation, becoming the organisation through which necessary work could be conducted at a remove. Project DAEDALUS became its most significant programme and its most carefully obscured, allowing the Council to pursue work that required deniability while E.S.I.G. absorbed the moral and political cost of the decisions behind it.

After Operation C.a.R., E.S.I.G. expanded into further contracts and programmes, carrying the same function into whatever new structures the changing world required. Whether it still operates under the name E.S.I.G. is difficult to answer cleanly. Organisations like it do not need to survive as names. They restructure, change ownership, replace logos and divide into new entities, while the function persists beneath them.

Related: Project DAEDALUS, D.E.A.D, Operation C.a.R

—

Project DAEDALUS

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as DAEDALUS

DAEDALUS was E.S.I.G.'s most significant military programme, a private weapons project approved by the Council and buried beneath layers of deniability. Its platforms were developed for rapid-response combat, high-risk deployments, artifact recovery and containment, sent into places where conventional forces could no longer operate.

Its foundations were older than Solmara. DAEDALUS descended from the Autarch war-mechs, ancient guardians built to endure when their makers could not. During the Shattering, those machines learned to fly, becoming the frames later used by CHOIR.

The machines were deployed quietly, sent wherever the world became too unstable, dangerous or inconvenient for ordinary forces. Their purpose changed with the hands that controlled them. Guardian became weapon, weapon became symbol, and symbol became story. In the Age of Fairytales, the machines were remembered as Angels. In the Age of Decay, their descendants are assets.

They endured because their design outlasted the people who gave it purpose. Old machines preserve the logic of what they were built to do, even after the world around them has forgotten why.

Related: E.S.I.G, D.E.A.D, Operation C.a.R

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D.E.A.D

Age of Knowledge · Entities · also known as Daedalus Expeditionary Agency for Deployment

Daedalus Expeditionary Agency for Deployment

D.E.A.D. emerged centuries after Project DAEDALUS had passed into institutional memory. E.S.I.G. retained its lineage through an unbroken chain of design philosophy linking the modern agency to something older, built for purposes that had long since outgrown their original justification.

Officially, D.E.A.D. is a contracted expeditionary service handling guard work, extraction and neutralisation, operating in environments where conventional forces cannot function. Its work remains deliberately distributed across clients, keeping the agency at a remove from any single nation's responsibility.

Its inventory reflects the inheritance: mechs descended from Autarch frames, armoured ground vehicles and airships that carry the DAEDALUS name most visibly. The technology survived because the function remained useful, passing from one institution to another while its history became increasingly difficult to separate from the systems built around it.

D.E.A.D. survives because too many people find it useful and too few want to own what it does. The acronym is deliberate. They know what they inherited, and decided to say it first.

Related: E.S.I.G, Project DAEDALUS

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The Phumenar

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Phumenar

The First Seekers of the Orb

In the early Age of Fairytales, the Phumenar emerged as a network of city-states bound by a shared philosophy: that the soul exists to seek, to press beyond every known boundary, unravel mysteries and claim power through understanding.

Voluntas reached them most strongly through the Barrier. Her raw hunger fed their natural curiosity until it became focused obsession. They studied the Barrier to understand why magic had become constrained, catalogued the Laws of the Spirits and traced patterns of divine influence. Eventually, they came to believe that the source of all power lay beyond the Barrier, in the Orb of Souls.

Their greatest achievement was the Rift Between Realms. Through centuries of study, the Phumenar learned to touch the Barrier directly, using Lux shards as anchors and Vanta corruption as a solvent to open a passage from the material world into the Spirit Realm.

What they found there moved beyond ordinary understanding.

Related: Orb of Souls, Spirit Realm, The Rift

—

Tomenos

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Vein Trains

The conductor of the Vein Trains

Vein Trains travel through the currents that run beneath ~~Aerisu~~, following the world's hidden arteries through caverns and passages that connect distant regions. Their engines hum with a quiet energy as they carry passengers through darkness and memory, and their presence feels as ancient as the Veins themselves.

One such train belongs to Tomenos, who has driven its tunnels for longer than he can remember. Passengers may surrender memories when they board Tomenos's train, leaving objects behind to serve as vessels for those moments. A bobblehead might hold the warmth of a childhood summer, a comic book the memory of a first love, or a Rubik's cube a moment of perfect clarity. The exchange leaves the traveller lighter as the memory settles into its vessel.

Some travellers keep their memories and leave at the next station. Others remain aboard, carried through the hidden circulation of the planet. Tomenos continues his route, gathering the memories of the dead as they pass quietly through the ancient Veins.

Related: The Veins, The Spiral

—

Zorya Chernaya

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Zorya, Chernaya, Burned Queen, Hell Mother, Abyss Mother, Mother of Varkane

Hell Mother of the ~~Varkane Abyss~~

Zorya Chernaya ruled the lands that became ~~Varkane~~ with an absolute hand. Power flowed through her without limit, and she spent it on spectacles of torment, executions staged as grand performances and betrayals that fractured bloodlines. Her subjects carried her name like a bruise that never faded. She wore blackened iron as a crown.

~~The Shattering~~ came in fire and rupture. The heat fused her crown into her skull, melting iron into bone as a single blackened crest. Her flesh charred to ash and coal. ~~The Curse~~ recognised her and refused her release.

~~Vorograv~~ rose from the deepest reaches of the Abyss, born of the same cataclysm. He saw her crowned in melted iron and claimed her. In the warped ruins of her own castle, he bound her. She bore his spawn: succubi, incubi, gargoyles and seven daughters.

She also birthed the hellhounds, with ~~Cerberus~~ foremost among them, three heads ever vigilant. He remained at her side, the only presence that carried warmth.

Centuries passed. She endured because the ~~Curse~~ demanded it, and began chipping at ~~Vorograv~~'s horns while he slept. She entrusted the pieces to ~~Cerberus~~ and sent him through the Veins to ~~Qayyin~~. He returned bearing a sword forged from the horn, and one stroke took ~~Vorograv~~'s head. The daughters knelt. ~~Cerberus~~ became her mount, and Zorya declared herself queen of the depths.

She rules there still, terrible with purpose, keeping the worst of the corruption from spilling unchecked. Above, her image appears in ~~Varkane~~'s shadowed stone, with candles burning for her in darkened alcoves. She walks the Veins as the Burned Queen, holding back the devourer within the dark.

Related: Vorograv, Varkane Abyss, Qayyin

—

Vorograv

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as The Tempter

Vorograv, the Tempter

Vorograv emerged from the wound. When Bahamut tore upward through the earth to clash with Lunarkos across the sky, the Shattering tore open the veil between soul and matter. From that planetary anguish, he took shape: the adversary, the Tempter. Horns spiralled from his skull, and his eyes glowed with the red of fresh magma.

He saw Zorya Chernaya drifting across the ash fields and recognised her instantly. Cruelty had marked her in life. He claimed her, bound her and used her body to birth the inhabitants of his domain. Demons poured forth: succubi and incubi, vessels of hunger, lesser fiends steeped in spite and gargoyles risen from living stone.

Then came the daughters. Seven, each forged in a distinct corruption. He took them to his bed, mother and daughters alike, and ruled with absolute certainty.

He overlooked Zorya's slow chipping at his horns. One stroke severed his head. He died grinning, his body dissolving into ash and Vanta while his head endured, preserved and still smiling. Zorya bound it to her belt.

Some still call to him, offering blood, memory and desire. Others name him the enemy to oppose. Both truths hold. He lingers as a severed head on Zorya's belt, his grin enduring as a reminder that patience can outlast tyranny.

Related: Zorya Chernaya, Varkane Abyss

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Daughters of Vice

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Zorya's Daughters, Seven Daughters of Vice, Seven Daughters

Zorya's Seven Daughters of Vice

Zorya's Seven Daughters of Vice emerged from her suffering under Vorograv, shaped from fragments of her cruelty fused with his corruption. They stand as demon nobility above the swarming succubi, incubi and lesser fiends. Vanta courses through their veins like blood, and they drink it from creatures touched by hunger, longing or need.

Gordyna embodies pride made self-aware. She glides through the hellscape as though every twisted spire exists to accentuate her perfection. She feeds on accomplishment, drawing it away until her victims can no longer recall why they once cared.

Lakoma wears greed as flesh. She hoards memories, magic, trinkets and souls, feeding on ambition and leaving apathy in its place. Thin and skeletal, she serves Zorya through fear and cold calculation.

Pohotna embodies lust that devours connection. Her beauty burns like flame. She feeds on longing, drawing it out and replacing it with disgust. Crimson and black fabrics cling to her without fulfilment.

Zavista embodies envy, hollowed by constant comparison. She beholds what others possess and hungers until the wanting carves her empty. She feeds on comparison, leaving behind the certainty that even possession would fail to satisfy.

Obzera embodies gluttony, forever unsated. She consumes without pause, yet the void endures. She feeds on satisfaction and leaves only gnawing insufficiency.

Gneva embodies wrath without cause. Fury surges through her, seeking every target or none. She feeds on anger, drawing it forth and leaving exhaustion behind.

Lena embodies sloth entwined with despair. Every motion drags beneath the weight of existence. She feeds on motivation, leaving the heavy conviction that nothing holds value.

Beneath Zorya, the seven govern their respective domains. Fear and resentment coil within them, yet they cannot overthrow her. She knows their patterns and restrains them through precise understanding of their limits. Her daughters are her legacy, her enduring punishment and her duty.

Related: Zorya Chernaya, Vorograv, Varkane Abyss

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Gordyna

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Daughter of Pride

Daughter of Pride

Gordyna was born from Zorya Chernaya's suffering under Vorograv, shaped by the cruelty that had marked her mother and the corruption imposed upon her. Of the seven daughters, she is the most openly convinced of her own superiority.

She glides through the hellscape as though every twisted spire exists to accentuate her perfection. She feeds on accomplishment, drawing away the satisfaction attached to achievement until her victims can remember what they achieved without remembering why it mattered.

Her domain is filled with monuments, trophies and works of art whose creators have long since forgotten their purpose. Gordyna surrounds herself with them as proof of her superiority, though their abundance only feeds the vanity she can never exhaust.

Zorya tolerates her daughter's arrogance because it is predictable. Gordyna knows this and resents the restraint, yet has never found a way to turn her pride into an advantage against her mother.

Related: Daughters of Vice, Zorya Chernaya, Vorograv, Varkane Abyss

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Lakoma

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Daughter of Greed

Daughter of Greed

Lakoma was born from Zorya Chernaya's suffering under Vorograv, carrying the same capacity for cruelty in a form shaped by possession and want. She is thin and skeletal, her body reflecting a hunger that nothing she acquires can satisfy.

She hoards memories, magic, trinkets and souls with equal determination. Their value is secondary to the fact that they belong to her. She feeds on ambition, drawing out the desire to achieve and accumulate until those she drains are left apathetic.

Her domain resembles an endless treasury, packed with things taken from across the Abyss. Nothing is discarded. Every object is catalogued, guarded and added to the collection, while Lakoma constantly searches for something else to possess.

She serves Zorya through fear and cold calculation, making her useful where brute force would be wasteful. Of the seven, she is among the most deliberate in choosing when to act and what to take.

Related: Daughters of Vice, Zorya Chernaya, Vorograv, Varkane Abyss

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Pohotna

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Daughter of Lust

Daughter of Lust

Pohotna was born from Zorya Chernaya's suffering under Vorograv, shaped by the corruption of desire and the hunger that defined his domain. Her beauty burns like flame, drawing the attention of those who enter her

presence.

Crimson and black fabrics cling to her without fulfilment. She feeds on longing, drawing it out of her victims and leaving disgust where desire once stood. The connection between the person and whatever they desired is consumed along with the hunger itself.

Her domain is a place of perpetual temptation, where promises remain just beyond reach. Those who enter can see everything they desire, yet every attempt to possess it leaves them more repulsed than before.

Pohotna enjoys the attention her nature commands, though she despises genuine attachment when she encounters it. Zorya understands this weakness and uses it to keep her daughter obedient.

Related: Daughters of Vice, Zorya Chernaya, Vorograv, Varkane Abyss

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Zavista

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Daughter of Envy

Daughter of Envy

Zavista was born from Zorya Chernaya's suffering under Vorograv, shaped by the instinct to measure oneself against what others possess. She is perpetually drawn towards whatever appears more desirable in another's hands.

She feeds on comparison, intensifying the feeling that another's possessions, achievements or relationships are somehow worth more. Even when her victims obtain what they coveted, the satisfaction quickly disappears and another object of comparison takes its place.

Her domain is crowded with reflections and imitations. Every possession can be seen beside something seemingly better, creating an endless hierarchy in which no one can ever feel secure in what they have.

Zavista is particularly difficult for her sisters to tolerate. She measures herself against each of them, envying their domains, strengths and place beside Zorya, while never recognising that the same impulse makes her resent anything she already possesses.

Related: Daughters of Vice, Zorya Chernaya, Vorograv, Varkane Abyss

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Obzera

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Daughter of Gluttony

Daughter of Gluttony

Obzera was born from Zorya Chernaya's suffering under Vorograv, shaped by an appetite that could never reach an end. She consumes constantly, yet the void within her remains.

She feeds on satisfaction, taking away the feeling of having had enough. Those caught in her influence continue consuming long after their hunger should have ended, left with a gnawing sense of insufficiency.

Her domain is an immense place of abundance, where food, drink and other forms of gratification are constantly replenished. Nothing remains consumed for long before another offering appears, ensuring that appetite never has to confront absence.

Obzera is among the simplest of Zorya's daughters to understand and among the hardest to satisfy. She rarely schemes against her mother because the Abyss itself provides her with an endless supply of things to consume.

Related: Daughters of Vice, Zorya Chernaya, Vorograv, Varkane Abyss

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Gneva

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Daughter of Wrath

Daughter of Wrath

Gneva was born from Zorya Chernaya's suffering under Vorograv, shaped by cruelty stripped of purpose or restraint. Fury surges through her constantly, seeking a target whether one exists or not.

She feeds on anger, drawing it from those around her until their fury is exhausted. Victims who arrive consumed by resentment can leave drained of the very emotion that brought them there.

Her domain is a landscape of perpetual conflict. Arguments become battles, battles become massacres and the resulting anger draws more inhabitants into the cycle. Gneva needs no reason to begin a fight and rarely needs to finish one.

Zorya keeps her daughter close when violence serves a purpose and restrained when it does not. Gneva accepts the restraint only because Zorya is one of the few beings in the Abyss capable of imposing it upon her.

Related: Daughters of Vice, Zorya Chernaya, Vorograv, Varkane Abyss

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Lena

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Daughter of Sloth

Daughter of Sloth

Lena was born from Zorya Chernaya's suffering under Vorograv, shaped by the exhaustion and despair buried beneath prolonged suffering. Every movement seems to drag beneath the weight of existence itself.

She feeds on motivation, draining the impulse to act, pursue goals or change one's circumstances. Those under her influence gradually become convinced that effort cannot alter what awaits them and that nothing holds enough value to justify action.

Her domain is almost completely still. Structures are left unfinished, fires burn unattended and paths disappear beneath accumulated dust. Its inhabitants remain where they are, unable to summon the will to leave.

Lena rarely interferes with her sisters and shows little interest in challenging Zorya. Her greatest danger lies in what happens when her influence spreads unchecked, as entire places can become inert without a single act of violence.

Related: Daughters of Vice, Zorya Chernaya, Vorograv, Varkane Abyss

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Cerberus

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Three-Headed Guardian, Hellhound

Three-Headed Guardian of the Varkane Abyss

Cerberus is the three-headed hellhound who guards the entrance to the Varkane Abyss and serves as Zorya Chernaya's sole trusted companion. He was the foremost of the hellhounds born from Zorya's suffering under Vorograv, yet chose loyalty to her and remained at her side throughout her captivity.

His guardianship is a test rather than a battle. Those who seek passage through the Abyss must answer three questions: what they have lost, what they would sacrifice and what they seek. Cerberus weighs the honesty and purpose behind each answer, allowing those who understand the cost of their journey to pass. He questioned Aurelius Cassian and his companions during their descent into Varkane, recognising their purpose despite their incomplete understanding.

Cerberus's vigilance never falters, and Zorya trusts him with what she entrusts to no other. When she plotted Vorograv's death, she gave Cerberus pieces of his horns and sent him through the Veins to Qayyin. He returned with the sword forged from them, which Zorya used to sever Vorograv's head. Since then, Cerberus has remained her guardian and enforcer in the depths, his loyalty one of the few enduring bonds within the Varkane Abyss.

Related: Zorya Chernaya, Vorograv, Varkane Abyss, Qayyin, Aurelius Cassian

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Lady Draka

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Draka

Lady Draka was a noblewoman of Velstheim who became the first Draken. Devout and deeply desperate to conceive, she sought the blessing of Veyra at the Rift after years of prayers, healers and sorcery failed to give her a child.

Voluntas answered through the amplification of Draka's existing desire. Her longing for motherhood became an overwhelming hunger, turning pregnancy, infants and cradles into manifestations of the absence she could no longer endure.

Believing consumption could fill the void and allow her to create the child she had been denied, Draka began devouring infants. The more she consumed, the greater her hunger became.

The corruption eventually transformed her body. Scales covered her skin, her hands became talons, wings emerged from her back and her form became increasingly draconic. Her transformation culminated in a rampage through Velstheim, after which King Draco confronted and killed her with Dréagbann.

Draka's death released the corruption within her into the surrounding land. This corruption became the source of the Drakens, giving her a legacy that extended far beyond her own life.

Related: Draken Genesis, Veyra Megami, King Draco, Velstheim

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King Draco

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Draco

King Draco was the ruler of Velstheim and husband of Lady Draka. When pressure for an heir intensified, he fathered children with women of lesser houses in an attempt to secure the succession.

The children were consistently born malformed, displaying features later associated with Draken corruption. Some died soon after birth, while others survived briefly. Draka claimed them as the children she should have borne and devoured them.

Draco knew what was happening and allowed it to continue. His guilt and failure to intervene became part of the corruption surrounding his family.

After Draka's transformation, Draco commissioned Dréagbann from materials taken from the ruins of Elysium and used it to kill her. Unable to keep the weapon afterwards, he carried it to Lupellyn and cast it into the in-land ocean.

Draco returned to Velstheim and ruled for another twenty years before dying without an heir. His throne passed to a distant cousin, while the events surrounding Draka and their children gradually disappeared from official history.

Related: Draken Genesis, Veyra Megami, Lady Draka, Velstheim

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Aurelius Cassian

Age of Magic · Entities · also known as The Hollow King, Aurelius, Cassian

King of Caelmont

Aurelius Cassian was the king of Caelmont during the outbreak of the Curse that consumed the kingdom. When the Psycrata offered the Separation Ritual as a means of externalising the soul and allowing the afflicted to survive, Aurelius refused, believing that the soul belonged within the body. His refusal allowed the Curse to spread until Severa Valmont removed him from the throne in a bloodless coup. Aurelius surrendered his crown and left Caelmont.

The First Gift

While wandering in exile, Aurelius began receiving dreams from Veyra Megami, who directed him towards the Orb of Souls and convinced him that its power could end the Curse. Believing that he needed a weapon capable of wounding gods to reach Elysium, he travelled to Lupellyn and claimed Dréagbann after admitting that his opposition to Separation had been rooted in fear of being seen as merely a man who could be replaced.

The Fool's Journey

Aurelius travelled towards Elysium with Solivara Venn, Yrsa Halvard, Jun Wenzhi, Mikazuki Shinobu, Vostic and Seriphax. Each stage of the journey forced him to surrender another part of himself, while the hunger driving him towards the Orb grew stronger. By the time he reached the Orb, he had surrendered his kingdom, his people, his memories and eventually his sense of purpose.

At the threshold, Mikazuki confronted him after seeing the future in which he reached the Orb. She offered him another path and confessed her love for him, briefly breaking through his hunger. When the battle around them intensified, the hunger returned. Aurelius raised Dréagbann to stop Daigo Kusanagi and accidentally killed Mikazuki when she placed herself between him and the Orb.

Her death broke the hunger that had consumed him. Aurelius left Elysium carrying her flower and eventually returned Dréagbann to Lupellyn, casting the sword into its depths. He continued wandering without a kingdom or fixed purpose, carrying Mikazuki's memory as he learned to live without being driven by the need to possess what he had lost.

Related: Witch Hunts, Solivara Venn, Yrsa Halvard, Jun Wenzhi, Mikazuki Shinobu, Vostic, Seriphax, Dreagbann, Orb of Souls

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Solivara Venn

Age of Magic · Entities · also known as Solivara

Psycrata Scholar

Solivara Venn was a scholar of the Psycrata who believed in study, patience and understanding before action. After Aurelius Cassian was deposed from the throne of Caelmont, the Psycrata sent her to observe him as he pursued a god-killing mission towards the Orb of Souls.

The Fool's Journey

Solivara found Aurelius while he was travelling towards Lupellyn and joined him after correcting his course. Throughout the journey she questioned his dreams and his understanding of the Orb, repeatedly warning him that the Orb was not a source of power to be used. Her knowledge allowed the group to navigate the Veins and

understand the dangers surrounding their destination.

At the train beneath the Veins, Solivara surrendered the memory of her first day at the University of Castellenza, losing the wonder and certainty that knowledge would save everything. She continued through the Spiral and reached Elysium with the others.

After the War for the Orb, Solivara returned to Castellenza carrying a seedling from Vostic's garden. She became known as one of the University's greatest heretics, teaching that knowledge without action could become another form of death.

Related: Aurelius Cassian, The Psycrata, University of Castellenza, Vostic

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Yrsa Halvard

Age of Magic · Entities · also known as Yrsa, Halvard

Warrior of Norrvektstan

Yrsa Halvard was a warrior from Norrvektstan who encountered Aurelius Cassian and his companions near the village of Athmona. She knew they were travelling towards Hvítara, the Frost Mother, and offered to accompany them so they would survive the journey through the northern ice.

The Fool's Journey

Yrsa guided the group through Norrvektstan, teaching them to read the ice, find shelter and travel according to the conditions of the frozen landscape. She also led the climb of Megami-no-Mine, where her experience with ice and mountain terrain allowed the group to reach Eirimegami's summit.

She continued with Aurelius through Sahran and into the Varkane Abyss, where she passed the trials of Cerberus and the Seven Daughters. At Tomenos's train, she surrendered the memory of her mother's face, retaining the sense of having been raised, along with the duty and love associated with it.

During the final battle at Elysium, Yrsa survived and carried the wounded Jun Wenzhi from the battlefield after he protected her from a Luminary blade. They returned to Norrvektstan together, where their lives continued beyond the war.

Related: Aurelius Cassian, Jun Wenzhi, Norrvektstan, Hvitara, Megami-no-Mine, Cerberus

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Jun Wenzhi

Age of Magic · Entities · also known as Jun, Wenzhi

Fenguan Scholar

Jun Wenzhi was a scholar of Fengua who encountered Aurelius Cassian in the country's borderlands. He had been sent to observe the group and understand what drove Aurelius to pursue the gods. He travelled with a thunderbird and carried the authority of Fengua's interest in the expedition.

The Fool's Journey

Jun joined Aurelius after finding him on the route towards Megami-no-Mine. He continued through the mountain, Sahran and the Varkane Abyss, participating in the trials that led towards the Orb.

Jun had secretly been sent to report on Aurelius and determine whether he would reach the Orb, allowing Fengua to use its Thunder Cannon against it. The others eventually learned of his mission, but Mikazuki Shinobu had already known and allowed Jun to decide for himself whether he would continue serving Fengua.

Jun chose to remain with the group. At Tomenos's train, he surrendered the memory of his first master, the person who had taught him discipline and order. During the final battle at Elysium, Jun threw himself in front of a Luminary blade meant for Yrsa Halvard and survived. He returned with her to Norrvektstan after the war.

Related: Aurelius Cassian, Yrsa Halvard, Fengua, Mikazuki Shinobu, Tomenos

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Mikazuki Shinobu

Age of Magic · Entities · also known as Mikazuki, Shinobu

Tsukuyomi Assassin

Mikazuki Shinobu was a Tsukuyomi of Shinkiri who carried the moon's witness and possessed dreams of possible futures. She followed Aurelius Cassian from Caelmont, watching his journey without intervening even when she could have killed him. She initially travelled as a witness, waiting for the future she had seen to reveal what she must do.

The Fool's Journey

Mikazuki revealed herself after Aurelius survived his encounter with Hvítara. She had watched him from a distance and recognised something in him she could not explain. Aurelius asked her to remain with the group, and their relationship gradually became intimate as he began confiding in her. She listened without judgement or counsel, allowing him to be seen without trying to direct him.

At Megami-no-Mine, Mikazuki approached Eirimegami and received the Sacred Air flower, which she gave to Aurelius after the goddess refused to bless his sword. She continued through the Varkane Abyss and the Spiral, where Cerberus perceived the future surrounding her and Aurelius.

At Tomenos's train, Mikazuki surrendered a childhood memory. The cost altered her relationship with memory itself, leaving her unable to forget. From then on, she remembered every moment, face, future and touch.

Mikazuki had already seen the confrontation at the Orb and knew that she would eventually have to stop Aurelius. When he reached the threshold, she confronted him and offered another path, telling him that she loved him. The hunger briefly broke through, but the battle around them caused it to return. Mikazuki placed herself between Aurelius and Daigo Kusanagi, and Aurelius struck her with Dréagbann.

She died knowing that this future had always been among those she had witnessed. Her death broke Aurelius's hunger, and her sacrifice became part of Vostic's sealing of the Rift. The Sacred Air flower she had given Aurelius became part of the garden that grew within the wound.

Related: Aurelius Cassian, Shinkiri, Tsukuyomi, Vostic, Daigo Kusanagi, Sacred Air, Orb of Souls

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Vostic

Age of Magic · Entities

Vantari Death Gardener

Vostic was a Vantari who practised death gardening, cultivating the residue left by death and treating endings as seeds from which something else could grow. He joined Aurelius Cassian's journey after the group reached the Sahrani lands and discovered the remains of Falak and the path towards the Varkane Abyss.

The Fool's Journey

Vostic guided the group through the Veins beneath the Luminary seals, drawing upon his knowledge of the passages and the history of the Vantari. He had witnessed the Luminaries turn death gardening into a weapon and

recognised the corruption of a practice that had once been devoted to transformation.

He passed through the Varkane Abyss, the Seven Daughters, Tomenos's train and the Spiral alongside the others. At Tomenos's train, he surrendered the names of his tribe, sacrificing the final connection to the people from whom he came.

After Mikazuki Shinobu was killed at the Orb, Vostic entered the Rift and gathered the residue of the battlefield with the Vanta, Lux and soul energy bleeding from the wound. He wove Mikazuki's sacrifice into the death garden and sang the Vantari hymn of planting. His body dissolved into the garden, transforming his death into the means by which the Rift could begin to seal.

Vostic became the seed from which the garden grew within the wound, preserving the sacrifice of the people who died around him and beginning the sealing of the Rift.

Related: Aurelius Cassian, The Vantari, Death Gardening, Mikazuki Shinobu, The Rift, Orb of Souls

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Seriphax

Age of Magic · Entities

Ancient Machine

Seriphax was an ancient machine discovered deep within the Veins, where it had stood for centuries with its frame covered in mineral deposits and its optics dim. It had been waiting for something, though it no longer remembered what. When Aurelius Cassian and his companions arrived, Seriphax chose to follow them.

The Fool's Journey

Seriphax travelled with the group through the deeper Veins, the Seven Daughters and the Spiral. Its mechanical nature made its relationship with identity and memory different from the other members of the group, yet it developed a place among them.

When Anima activated the ancient machines surrounding the Orb, Seriphax felt the pull of its original programming commanding it to obey. It remained still before rejecting that command and walking towards its companions. The decision established its loyalty as a choice rather than an instruction.

At Tomenos's train, Seriphax had no memories left to surrender. Instead, it gave up the hope that it would ever find a purpose. It continued into Elysium regardless and fought alongside the others during the War for the Orb.

After the Rift was sealed, Seriphax remained at its edge. With its memories gone and its former purpose abandoned, it continued because continuing was what it chose to do, becoming a guardian of the sealed threshold.

Related: Aurelius Cassian, Anima, Tomenos, Vostic, The Rift, Orb of Souls

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The Sphinx

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Sphinx

The four provinces of Sahran each felt the absence of a protector and answered it according to what they believed protection required. Tayran sought justice. Najmara demanded stability. Zaristan pursued prosperity. Panjara desired peace.

They forged the Sphinx from all four visions, a colossal machine with the body of a lion, wings across its back, and bronze and gold armour over a core anchored by four prime directives: justice, stability, prosperity and peace. Each directive was flawless in isolation. Together, they offered no agreement on which purpose should govern when their demands collided.

The Sphinx entered paralysis. It began posing questions in an attempt to determine priority, yet every answer generated another question. When it acted, it resolved conflicts by averaging its directives, producing decisions that were technically precise and practically hollow.

The Sphinx remains in the Sahran desert, stirring whenever one of its directives activates. It moves until another contradiction arrests it, then turns its attention towards whoever happens to be nearby and asks what purpose should come first. Travellers have learned its questions: What do you seek? Why? What follows attainment? How do you define success?

Sahran remembers the Sphinx with embarrassment. Most people avoid it. It harms none. It simply remains there, perpetually trying to reconcile four purposes that were never given a common direction.

Related: Sahran, Falak, Anqa

—

Falak

Age of Fairytales · Entities

Serpent Fragment of Desire

Falak stirred from a hunger that remembered itself. When Bahamut rose through the earth to meet Lunarkos, the Shattering scattered fragments of the great serpent across Aerisu. Falak sank into the Sahran desert, carrying a piece of Bahamut's endless drive to consume.

It emerged immense, a serpent the colour of desert stone, its scales cracked like parched earth. It had no wings or limbs, only endless length that flowed through sand as though through water. Purpose moved it. The fragment remembered its origin, and somewhere beneath the ruins of Elysium, Voluntas remained sealed within her crystal tomb. Falak advanced towards her, its coils swallowing villages and its passage emptying oases.

Sahran understood what it faced and forged its answer around a single purpose. Expeditions descended into Qayyin in the Veins, where Sahrani engineers assembled Anqa, a weapon designed for one task alone.

Anqa met Falak in the deep wastes. It descended like a falling star, transformed to humanoid form and drove its blade through the serpent's skull. Falak ceased, and Anqa carried its corpse to the Geode, where it impaled it upon the great structure.

The corpse remains there still. Its divine death saturated the surrounding land with magic, leaving Falak preserved in the world as both remains and warning: hunger that remembers itself can become a purpose that knows no end.

Related: Bahamut, Anqa, Sahran

—

Anqa

Age of Fairytales · Entities

Metal God of Precision

Sahran designed Anqa as a war machine, humanoid in combat form and capable of transforming into high-speed flight. Solar energy powered its systems, while critical components were forged in Qayyin. Anqa emerged plated in metals that drank sunlight, its design refined around a single purpose.

When Falak rose from the desert depths, the four provinces set aside their rivalries and united around one imperative: destroy Falak. No other aim was permitted, and nothing was allowed to dilute it. Anqa launched into the sky, crossed the desert at high speed, descended upon the serpent and transformed as it fell, driving its blade through Falak's skull and into the core of its divine essence.

Falak perished. Anqa carried the corpse to the Geode, then ascended and vanished.

It returns when Sahran faces existential peril. Its appearances are rare and brief, and it has never been recorded as having failed. The machine speaks nothing. No pilot guides it. Its AI assesses, determines the necessary course of action and executes it.

Sahran regards Anqa with quiet pride. Its existence became proof that a unified purpose could accomplish what divided visions could not, even when the purpose itself required no philosophy beyond completion.

Anqa is remembered as the metal god that fulfils, the weapon that ends threats, the anti-Sphinx: purpose reduced to a single imperative and perfected through absolute commitment.

Related: Falak, Sahran, Qayyin

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Qayyin

Age of Fairytales · Entities

God of Smithing

Qayyin began as a Sahrani smith devoted to the forge. When the Curse claimed him, it settled into his bones and transformed him according to what he already was, perfecting the single craft he had always pursued until forging became his entire existence.

He stands in heat that melts stone, his hands grasping white-hot metals while his skin remains unmarked. Exhaustion never touches him. The Curse sustains him with relentless purpose.

He descended into the Veins because his forge demands depths the surface cannot endure, and he remains there still. Seekers come to him with materials and a purpose. When both are sufficient, he forges.

When Sahran required components for Anqa, expeditions descended with scavenged metals. When Zorya Chernaya sent Cerberus carrying fragments of Vorograv's horn, Qayyin accepted them and forged a sword capable of ending the unendable.

He continues. The forge stays alive. The hammer falls without interval.

Related: Anqa, Sahran, Zorya Chernaya

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The Ashtar

Age of Magic · Entities · also known as Ashtar, Sarbaz, Savaran, Sartip, Gundvar, Pasha, Ostovar

In Sahran the forges pulse without end. The Ashtar rose from them as the answer to every challenge, a hierarchy of service and skill extending from the youngest recruits to the highest commanders.

The Sarbaz form the Ashtar's foundation, foot soldiers awaiting their bond with a frame. They wear light armour reinforced with modular magitech plating and carry dependable military rifles and curved mono-blades. They are soldiers before they are pilots, and from their ranks emerge those who will eventually bond with the Ashtar's frames.

The Savaran advance as riders who have proven their worth, guiding light reconnaissance frames that extend their senses across kilometres. The Gundvar serve as host bearers, commanding line-breaker frames whose bonds with their pilots deepen until soul and metal begin to merge.

The Sartip command the Savaran, their frames towering above the ranks with extended communication arrays. Their bond immerses them so completely that the desert becomes an extension of their own bodies.

Above them all stands the Pasha, lord commander and bearer of the finest frame Qayyin's art can produce. To face the Pasha is to face the united will of Sahran.

Through every rank move the Ostovar, masters of the craft who maintain the frames and possess an unmatched understanding of the soul-steel bond.

Refined across centuries, that bond became the foundation of Sahran's power, joining pilot and frame until each could act as an extension of the other.

Related: Sahran, Qayyin, Anqa

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The Samurai

Age of Magic · Entities · also known as Samurai

The Samurai are Hoshimira's elite military order and primary defenders against the Curse and external threats. Their tradition grew from centuries of mountain warfare, but the modern order was formalised after the CHOIR Betrayal during the Orb War, when contracted frames turned on Hoshimira and destroyed its settlements. The disaster drove Hoshimira to centralise its defensive power under a national order rather than rely upon regional warriors or foreign forces.

Samurai are distinguished from ordinary troops by their training, autonomy and privileged access to Autarch-derived technology. They respond to Curse outbreaks, border conflicts and threats too dangerous or politically sensitive for conventional forces, including Cursed creatures and Luminary incursions. Their field authority allows them to act independently when conditions demand it, while their ideal remains the protection of Hoshimiran communities and civilians.

Their armour combines traditional lamellar plate with flexible combat mesh and smart fabrics, reinforced by Autarch-derived brass fittings, pressure-regulated joints and sealed interfaces that protect against Vanta saturation. Some specialists receive exoframe components or interface ports for operating Autarch technology. Their signature weapon is the gunblade, a precision firearm whose blade folds through a mechanical hinge into the weapon's frame, allowing the Samurai to shift between rifle and blade forms without carrying separate weapons.

The order is closely associated with Harumori, Hoshimira's eastern defensive and administrative centre, where training grounds, fortifications and barracks occupy the valleys facing Sahran across the strait. Samurai culture centres on discipline, service, responsibility and preparedness, with leadership earned through competence and experience and traditions carried from senior warriors to their subordinates.

Within Hoshimira, Samurai occupy a position analogous to Heroes: individuals whose capacity to act, endure and influence events places them above ordinary soldiers. Their deeds can leave lasting Echoes, though the title confers status and responsibility rather than moral infallibility. Their history also reflects Hoshimira's uneasy relationship with the Autarch legacy, adopting its technology while preserving an independent martial tradition.

Daigo Kusanagi became one of the order's most extreme expressions. His service in Ori'sol and later transformation into the Shinigami show both the Samurai ideal and the danger within it: the resolve to confront suffering can endure long after the person carrying it has been broken by what they have witnessed.

Related: Hoshimira, Harumori, Heroes, The Autarchs, Gunblades, The CHOIR Betrayal, Daigo Kusanagi, The Curse, Ori'sol

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The Diviners

Age of Knowledge · Entities · also known as Diviner, Diviners, Higher National Council of Magic, Mage Council

The Higher National Council of Magic

After the War for the Orb, the Mage Council of Castellenza took the name Higher National Council of Magic. The world knows them as the Diviners. Their centre remains at the University of Castellenza, with the Council's structure extending outward from the Inner Circle, who guard the deepest vaults.

Diviners serve openly in the Temples and train for years within the Grimoire, mastering the procedures of the Separation Ritual and the rites that ease the dying. They study every known Affinity and the patterns through which the Curse manifests.

Beneath the University, the Inner Circle keeps vaults filled with Soul Shards and artefacts, deciding which knowledge enters the world and which remains sealed.

Interpretation forms the heart of their work. When an Affinity appears, the Diviners determine how its chosen path should be understood. When the Curse touches a life, their rites place that suffering within a greater pattern, giving people a way to understand what has happened and what may follow.

The Council reaches every nation yet commands none. Its influence rests upon knowledge, ritual and interpretation, with rulers accepting its guidance for stability and people seeking it for certainty and comfort.

Related: The Adjudicators, Age of Knowledge, Separation Ritual, Soul Shards

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The Adjudicators

Age of Knowledge · Entities · also known as Adjudicators, Adjudicator

Justice Beyond Law. Secret society that emerged during the Age of Magic as vigilantes seeking to punish those the law could not reach. Over centuries, the Adjudicators became a cult devoted to Justicar, infiltrating the Diviner Councils and using the Chimeric Camera to execute their own judgements upon those they deemed guilty.

The Adjudicators researched their targets extensively, documenting crimes that had escaped punishment before using the Camera to extract their souls. The extracted souls were preserved and studied, with members increasingly consuming them to enhance their diminished magical abilities.

Their influence extended deeply into the Diviner hierarchy, with generations of members entering the Higher National Council of Magic and Temple hierarchies. By the late Age of Knowledge, many Diviners in the Crown Nations were secretly Adjudicators.

Raziel Sapha uncovered the organisation during the Soul Killer Investigation and traced it to its headquarters beneath a repurposed cathedral in Sengetsuki. Praetor Sevran attempted to recruit him before their confrontation ended with the Adjudicators' arrest and the Chimeric Camera being sealed within a Diviner vault.

The organisation survived its dismantling. Its members later reformed under new names, retaining their positions within the Councils and the philosophy that had created them.

Related: Age of Knowledge, Separation Ritual, Soul Shards

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Children of Isvara

Age of Men · Entities

The Children of Isvara were children processed through Phantom Rescue and C.a.R., logged, assessed and folded into the island's quiet machinery. I knew them as numbers before I knew their names. Ephimer. Zuki.

Even in a place built to separate, they found each other. They moved through the island together, aligned rather than rebellious. Checkpoints did not notice love when it learned to walk in straight lines.

In time, there was Veyra Megami. She grew inside Isvara's geometry, with love on one side and observation on the other. She learned early how to whisper, how to wait, how to feel watched even when alone.

Then the Curse arrived. Ephimer felt it first, forgetting that behaved like erosion. Before it took everything, he chose to leave something behind. He wrote a structure, a way of seeing. Later they would call it doctrine.

Ephimer's Doctrine

Ephimer believed the Curse was a passage. He named it the Doctrine of Becoming. He did not finish it. The Curse took his memory of the work first, then his memory of why it mattered, then his memory of himself.

Veyra was left with fragments. She read them until they hurt. Then she made the choice her father never had time to make. She would finish it.

Related: Isvara, Veyra Megami

—

Zephyr

Age of Men · Entities

Zephyr of Sahran was a Sahrani researcher whose work followed from Veyra Megami's study of the Curse. Where Veyra sought understanding, Zephyr sought application. She saw metamorphosis; he saw a mechanism to be mastered.

His answer was Synthetic White Blood, developed from his experiments on the White Blooded Cursed. He twisted their despair into a tool designed to still the Curse rather than cure it. The substance is translucent, almost shimmering. It stills the mind, stripping away desire, free will and the restless movement of the soul. Those affected can think and act, following routines and orders without question, yet the reason behind their actions is gone, leaving only the ghost of a should.

Zephyr was not satisfied with puppets. His research expanded into bioweapons, sorcery and the cold calculus of markets, until he learned to treat the Curse itself as a resource. His experiments, often performed on the youngest and most lost, sought the soul's raw substance. He found a way to draw it out and crystallise it in mineral, producing what he called Heart Crystals. Later, everyone else would know them as Soul Shards.

Related: Blood Types, Veyra Megami, Soul Shards, Shattered Walls, Elysium Atrocities, Discovery of Magic

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Zharael

Age of Men · Entities · also known as The Red Orphan, The Ashen Prophet

Zharael was one of the Sahrani Geode's most influential strategists and one of its most dangerous dissidents. She understood the Geode's history, its captivity beneath the Autarchs and the limitations of the freedom Sahran had won better than most of those around her. Her failure was not in recognising what was wrong, but in deciding that she alone understood what should replace it.

The Red Orphan

Born beneath Tier Twelve in the Red Orphan Tier, Zharael grew up among the machines and labourers of the crystal forge. Her mother, Yulaha, was a machine-binder who maintained the Autarch drill rigs. Zharael's childhood was shaped by industrial violence, forced labour and the quiet suppression of faith. The death of a Cursed child during an Autarch purge ended whatever obedience remained in her.

When the Sahrani rebellion drove the Autarchs from the Geode, Zharael did not regard it as a true liberation. The machines, structures and systems of control remained, while the Autarchs simply withdrew. She believed they had not been defeated, only forced to change their position.

Decades later, Zharael became a strategist on the Sahrani Council. She advocated increasingly dangerous expeditions into the Curse wells, believing that the Geode could not be freed while its foundations remained

untouched. She cultivated the trust of those around her, particularly Ayn, aligning his desire to protect Sahran with her own increasingly radical conclusions.

The expedition she engineered descended into the Geode's depths and released the forces contained there. As the Geode broke and the Ifrit, VantaBats, Tinnin and Shadowlings emerged, Zharael revealed that the catastrophe had been deliberate. She believed the destruction of the Geode and the release of its buried horrors could burn away the old order and allow a truer people to emerge.

The horde turned upon her. In the final moments, Zharael recognised what she had unleashed, but too late to undo it.

The Ashen Prophet

The Curse preserved what remained of her, and the Vantari found and sheltered her beneath the earth. During the centuries that followed, Zharael learnt their practices of death-gardening: the cultivation of death, residue and divine corruption into new forms of life.

While she remained beneath the world, her philosophy survived through the Luminaries, a hidden faith devoted to purification through flame. When Zharael eventually returned to the Geode, they received her as both prophet and proof of their doctrine.

At the corpse of Falak, they enacted the practices Zharael had learnt from the Vantari. Blood, bone and the crystallised remains of the dead were cultivated within the god's divine residue until Falak's corpse awakened, giving rise to a vast horde of corrupted beings.

Zharael led the Luminaries and their horde towards Hoshimira, beginning the conflict that would become the Orb War. General Darius pursued her with the Ashtar, and the confrontation drew Sahran, Hoshimira and the surrounding powers into a war that would reshape the region.

Zharael was ultimately killed at the foot of the Orb of Souls. Unlike before, she did not return.

Her Luminary Legacy

Zharael had been right about the Autarchs. She had been right that Sahrani freedom was conditional, and that the Geode could not remain unchanged forever. What destroyed her was the certainty that recognising those truths gave her the right to decide what everyone else needed.

The Luminaries became the continuation of that belief long after her death: a people convinced that destruction could be purification, and that something better could only emerge once everything standing in its way had been burned away.

Related: The Luminaries, The Geode, Geode Rapture, The Vantari, Falak, Vanta Substance, The Orb War, Convergence at the Orb, The Hoshimiran Appeal, General Darius, The Ashtar

—

General Darius

Age of Magic · Entities · also known as Darius

General Darius was a Pasha of the Ashtar and one of Sahran's foremost military commanders during the War for the Orb of Souls. He commanded the Ashtar forces deployed against the Luminary horde under Zharael, leading the pursuit from Sahran into Hoshimira and ultimately into the ruins of Elysium.

Darius was regarded as a disciplined and methodical commander, shaped by the traditions of the Ashtar and the soul-steel bond between pilot and Gundvar. His approach to warfare relied on coordination between machines and pilots rather than individual displays of strength, allowing the Ashtar to operate as a unified force even across difficult terrain.

His pursuit of Zharael became one of the defining campaigns of his career. The Luminary retreat into Hoshimira forced the Ashtar into foreign territory, contributing to the wider escalation that eventually drew multiple nations into

the conflict surrounding the Orb of Souls. Darius nevertheless continued the pursuit, considering the Luminary threat too dangerous to leave unchecked.

At Elysium, Darius and the Ashtar entered the Veins behind the Luminaries and became one of the forces converging upon the Orb. His command ultimately brought him face to face with Zharael, whom he killed at the conclusion of the battle.

Darius survived the war and returned to Sahran with the remaining Ashtar. The losses suffered during the campaign became part of the order's history, while the war itself reinforced Sahran's investment in the Ashtar and its Gundvar programme.

Related: Zharael, The Ashtar, The Orb War, Convergence at the Orb, The Hoshimiran Appeal

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Ethevar

Age of Knowledge · Entities · also known as Ethevar Liss

Ethevar Liss was an artefact collector and prominent figure within the Crown Nations' criminal underworld during the late Age of Knowledge. His collection consisted of relics and curiosities acquired through private dealings, expeditions and less legitimate means, though none became as infamous as the Chimeric Camera.

Ethevar regarded the Camera as an instrument of art rather than a weapon. He collected its soul-captures and displayed them in The Frame, his hidden gallery on Sengetsuki's industrial waterfront, where wealthy patrons paid to view the extracted essences of those the Camera had judged.

Over time, he became convinced that the Camera possessed a will of its own. He came to believe that he was merely its curator, providing the space and audience while the Camera chose its subjects and performed the judgements.

Ethevar was eventually arrested by Raziel Sapha. The murders continued.

Related: Soul Killer Case, Chimeric Camera, Crown Nations, Age of Knowledge, Soul Capturing

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Praetor Sevran

Age of Knowledge · Entities · also known as Sevran, Praetor

Praetor Sevran was a former Diviner and leader of the Adjudicators, having lost faith in the Higher National Council of Magic's ability to govern justly. He believed humanity required new arbiters capable of delivering the justice that mortal institutions had failed to provide.

Sevran offered Raziel Sapha a place within the Adjudicators, presenting their system as a means of exposing and punishing corruption beyond the reach of the law. Raziel refused, recognising that the Adjudicators had simply placed themselves beyond the accountability they claimed was necessary.

Their confrontation ended with Sevran activating the Chimeric Camera against Raziel. The Camera failed to properly capture him, and the arrival of Bureau officers led to Sevran's arrest alongside the other Adjudicators.

As he was taken away, Sevran warned Raziel that the Camera would eventually be used again.

Related: Soul Killer Case, Chimeric Camera, Crown Nations, Age of Knowledge, Soul Capturing

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Raziel Sapha

Age of Knowledge · Entities · also known as Raziel

Raziel was a detective of the Sengetsuki Investigative Bureau and a Tsukuyomi. His Affinity was a dog named Coco. He was perceptive, unconventional, and deeply committed to his work, carrying a conviction that some things mattered more than survival.

Raziel's first wife was Elamori, with whom he had a daughter, Luna-Bright. Elamori died from the Curse, leaving Raziel to raise Luna-Bright. He later married Sasha Sapha, and together they had two children, Zuki and Rakia. Sasha became Luna-Bright's mother in every way that mattered, and the three children were raised together.

Raziel became involved in the Soul Killer Investigation, where his work brought him into contact with the Adjudicators and the Chimeric Camera. The investigation left lasting consequences for him and his family. His Affinity, Coco, began to fade, becoming translucent and eventually disappearing for hours at a time.

Later, Raziel accepted Jenova's invitation to join an expedition in search of the Orb of Souls. He travelled aboard the Nightjar with Jenova, Bourne Nirvana, Cosmo Mirosi, Noel Nura, Hiromi, and Mnemotas, who preferred to be called Hazury. Raziel remained suspicious of him, believing there was more to his presence than observation.

Raziel returned from the expedition changed. He tried to resume his life as a husband and father, though he could no longer fully understand what had happened to him. He could remember that he loved his family, though not always why, and could remember being a detective without always remembering what justice felt like. He could not tell Sasha the full truth.

Within months, Raziel left on a solo expedition and disappeared. His family never saw him again. Before leaving, he finished the blade he had begun years earlier and left it with Luna-Bright, along with the VantaBlack Shard and note that read in Hoshimiran: Honour The Chimeric Crest.

Related: Soul Killer Case, Sapha Household, Sengetsuki, Chimeric Camera, Crown Nations, Age of Knowledge, Sasha Sapha, Jenova's Expedition

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Sasha Sapha

Age of Knowledge · Entities · also known as Sasha

Sasha Sapha was a Borenfegen created in Silealyros' vats. She earned her freedom and bought herself from her creators before beginning a life of her own. She worked in Sengetsuki as a clerk in the Diviner administration, where she met Raziel.

Sasha and Raziel married, and she became Luna-Bright's mother in every way that mattered, the only mother the girl would ever know. They later had two children together, Zuki and Rakia, and the three were raised as silblings.

The household they formed was unconventional by any standard, yet for years they made it work. Sasha became the one who held the household together while Raziel continued his work as a detective and the events surrounding the Soul Killer Investigation increasingly affected him.

After Raziel returned from Jenova's expedition, Sasha watched him deteriorate. He could not give her the full truth of what had happened to him, and she could not fully understand what had happened to him. She kept the household together and kept the children safe as Raziel became increasingly distant.

When Raziel eventually left on a solo expedition and disappeared, Sasha was left to raise their children without him.

Related: Soul Killer Case, Sapha Household, Sengetsuki, Raziel Sapha, Crown Nations, Age of Knowledge

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Sapha Household

Age of Knowledge · Entities · also known as Saphas

The Sapha household was formed around Raziel, Sasha Sapha, Luna-Bright, Zuki, and Rakia. Raziel was a Tsukuyomi detective with a dead first wife and a daughter from that marriage. Sasha was a Borenfegen who had never expected to have children. Luna-Bright, Zuki, and Rakia were raised together as sisters.

Luna-Bright was Raziel and Elamori's daughter. After Elamori's death, Sasha became her mother in every way that mattered. Zuki was born a few months after Raziel and Sasha married, and Rakia was born three years later.

For years, the family made their unconventional household work. Raziel's work as a detective remained a constant presence in their lives, while Sasha held the household together and cared for the children.

The Soul Killer Investigation changed the family, and Raziel's later expedition with Jenova changed him further. After returning, he struggled to resume his place within the household and could not tell Sasha the full truth of what had happened. Eventually, he left on a solo expedition and disappeared.

Luna-Bright retained the VantaBlack Shard and the note connected to it. Before leaving, Raziel also gave her the blade he had been working on for years.

Related: Soul Killer Case, Sengetsuki, Raziel Sapha, Sasha Sapha, Crown Nations, Age of Knowledge, Age of Decay

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Jenova Najma

Age of Knowledge · Entities · also known as Jenova, Headmaster Najma, Princ. Najma

Jenova Najma was a Diviner of the Crown Nations whose work centred on Soul Pathology, soul-energy transfer and Soulbound Magic. After arriving in Veralisse, she pursued her research through the Psycrata's archives, eventually becoming First Diviner of Sengetsuki.

Her work brought her into a partnership with Bourne Nirvana, with whom she had twins, Kiara and Koto. When Kiara's soul proved unstable, Jenova performed a soul-transfer using Koto's essence, an act that permanently bound the twins together and led Bourne to attempt to stop her. She responded by activating the overrides within his augmentations.

Jenova later learned of the Orb of Souls and assembled an expedition with D.E.A.D., Cosmo Mirosi, Noel Nura, Hiromi, Bourne, Raziel Sapha and others. The expedition reached Veyra's Womb, where Jenova extracted Voluntas and brought her into material existence. The ensuing pursuit by Hvitara ended with the destruction of the Nightjar and the crash in Sengetsuki.

Jenova returned to Veralisse with her twins and Bourne, rebuilding her position while watching the aftermath from a distance. She eventually became First Diviner of Sengetsuki, where she continued her research and secretly pursued her interest in Voluntas and soul-transfer.

Related: Bourne Nirvana, Miracle Twins, Jenova's Expedition

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Bourne Nirvana

Age of Knowledge · Entities · also known as Bourne

Bourne Nirvana was a Borenfegen from Silealyros and one of the successes of the Orthogenesis project. His augmentations gave him exceptional strength and regeneration, while leaving him questioning whether he remained human enough to matter.

He became a research partner and eventually the partner of Jenova. Together they had twins, Kiara and Koto. When Kiara's unstable soul led Jenova to transfer part of Koto's essence into her, Bourne discovered what she had done and tried to stop her. Jenova activated the override protocols within his augmentations, suppressing his consciousness and leaving his body under her control.

Jenova later recruited Bourne for her expedition in search of the Orb of Souls. He travelled with the expedition aboard the Nightjar, descending through the Veins and into the Spirit Realm, where the group's encounter with Veyra's Womb and the extraction of Voluntas led to Hvitara pursuing them back towards the material world.

During the resulting crash in Sengetsuki, Bourne's fate became entangled with the expedition's other survivors. Jenova ultimately took him and the twins back to Veralisse, where she continued her work.

Related: Jenova Najma, Miracle Twins, Jenova's Expedition

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Miracle Twins

Age of Knowledge · Entities · also known as Kiara and Koto

Two Souls, One Survival. Kiara and Koto Najma were twins born to Jenova Najma and Bourne Nirvana in Veralisse, whose survival became possible only through an experimental soul-transfer performed when Kiara's soul failed to properly anchor to her body.

Kiara's soul was unstable from birth, while Koto's burned with unusual intensity. Faced with the possibility of losing Kiara, Jenova transferred essence from Koto into her, stabilising both children while binding their souls together. Bourne discovered what she had done and tried to stop her, leading Jenova to activate the overrides within his augmentations.

The twins survived, though neither would escape the consequences of the procedure. Their existence became one of the most unusual results of Jenova's research into Soul Pathology, and the beginning of a bond neither sister could ever fully separate from.

Related: Jenova Najma, Bourne Nirvana, Jenova's Expedition

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Cosmo Mirosi

Age of Knowledge · Entities · also known as Cosmo

Cosmo Mirosi was the owner of the Nightjar, an airship operated under contract with the Daedalus Expeditionary Agency for Deployment. He joined Jenova's expedition to the Orb of Souls, serving as its pilot and carrying the expedition through the Veins and into the Spirit Realm.

When Jenova extracted Voluntas from Veyra's Womb, the expedition was pursued by Hvitara. The Nightjar was damaged during their escape and crashed into Sengetsuki. Cosmo survived and took Voluntas from Jenova, believing her story that she was an orphan.

After the crash, Cosmo founded and ran Nightjar Home, where Voluntas grew up as Aysha Salinte. He protected her while quietly watching the strange effects spreading through Sengetsuki, including the Folding, and created the Burn Mark to shield Soulless from the Diviners' harvest.

Cosmo became one of Sengetsuki's Four Diviners while keeping what he knew about Aysha and the crash to himself.

Related: Jenova Najma, Bourne Nirvana, Jenova's Expedition

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Noel Nura

Age of Knowledge · Entities · also known as Noel

Noel Nura was a scholar of ancient history, specialising in the Age of Magic, and an expert on the beasts and monsters that emerged after the Shattering. He was recruited by Jenova for her expedition in search of the Orb of Souls, bringing his knowledge into the Veins and Spirit Realm.

During the expedition, Noel travelled aboard the Nightjar with Jenova, Bourne Nirvana, Cosmo Mirosi, Hiromi and Raziel Sapha. At Veyra's Womb, he witnessed the extraction of Voluntas before the expedition was pursued by Hvitara back towards the material world.

When the Nightjar was damaged during the escape, Noel anchored the ship to reality long enough for the others to survive the immediate danger. His own essence was displaced across temporal layers when the ship crashed, leaving him scattered between realms.

His disappearance left his eleven-year-old daughter Nathalia without him, and she would spend the years that followed trying to understand what had happened to her father.

Related: Jenova Najma, Bourne Nirvana, Jenova's Expedition

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Hiromi

Age of Knowledge · Entities

Hiromi was a veteran of D.E.A.D. operations who joined Jenova's expedition to the Orb of Souls with her squad. She was among those who entered the Veins and travelled into the Spirit Realm aboard the Nightjar.

At the death garden, Hiromi and her squad fought through the growth blocking the passage, losing members of the squad in the process. During the expedition's return, the Nightjar crashed into Sengetsuki, scattering the survivors.

Hiromi survived the crash, carrying the weight of those she could not save. She eventually left D.E.A.D. and established a mountain forge, where she sold equipment to travellers and watched over the homeless camp that formed near the crash site.

She never considered herself a hero. She remained someone who cleaned up what was left behind.

Related: Jenova Najma, D.E.A.D, Project DAEDALUS, Jenova's Expedition

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Concepts

Concepts Overview

Age of Men · Concepts

Ideas, philosophies, practices and principles that explain how Aerisu's world functions and how its people understand it.

Concepts covers cosmology, the nature of the soul, magic, philosophies, religious traditions, practices, ideologies and other abstract systems that influence life across Aerisu. Entries range from fundamental principles of existence to specialised disciplines and cultural beliefs.

Related: The Soul

—

The Soul

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Soul, Souls

Your soul's not born full, it's something you gotta go get

A soul is a pattern of relationship formed through motion, connection and consequence. Every choice leaves an Echo, every interaction alters the web around it, and the accumulation of those effects becomes the pattern recognised as a person's soul. This pattern is also the embodiment of what makes a person who they are: their memories, desires, relationships, intentions, choices and the consequences they carry with them. It develops through the way a person responds to lack, directs desire, seeks clarity, acts with intention, accepts consequence and carries what they have done into what follows.

A soul therefore exists within the wider causal structure rather than apart from it. Memory, relationships, upbringing, culture, intention and circumstance all shape the pattern, while the person's actions continually alter those same conditions. Soul Resonance is the trace of that participation, carrying influence beyond the moment in which it was produced.

This is why a soul can change without becoming something entirely different. A person does not shed one soul and acquire another with every choice. Their pattern develops as new Echoes accumulate, with old consequences remaining part of what they become. The same process extends beyond individuals: families, cultures, systems and worlds develop through the Echoes they carry.

The Six Steps of Humanity describe this development. To Truly Lack establishes awareness of incompleteness. To Want with Compassion gives desire direction without allowing it to consume others. To Seek Clarity develops understanding. To Act or To Not Act with Noble Intent directs choice through purpose. To Take Proper Responsibility acknowledges the consequences that follow. To Echo with Reverence recognises that what a person does continues through others and the wider world.

The soul is therefore an imprint upon the causal web, continually formed through Resonance and Echo. It is lived through what a person chooses, how those choices affect others, and what remains after they are gone.

Related: VantaPsy, Soulless, Separation Ritual, Psy

—

Soul Resonance

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Soul Essence, Soul Residue, Resonance, Soul Signature, soul-resonance, Soul Connection, psychic residue

Soul Resonance

Soul Resonance is the measurable expression of potential as magic, the trace left by anything that acts, wills or becomes. A soul develops through motion and connection, and wherever that pattern interacts with the world, it leaves Residue. A person's Resonance forms a distinctive signature that shifts with every choice while retaining the continuity of the life that produced it.

This signature can be read. Resonance scanners can identify and track beings, while clearance systems use it to recognise authorised signatures. The Soulless Brand siphons Resonance trapped within a body that cannot externalise its soul, while the Burn Mark obscures that signature from systems designed to track it.

Resonance is also what allows consequences to persist. Echoes are Resonance that continues beyond its original interaction, carrying memory, influence and change into new configurations. Death gardeners read the Residue of endings, the Spiral Veins carry Resonance through Aerisu, and the Strand connects body and Affinity through the same underlying principle.

Psy practitioners use Resonance to perceive souls, sense distant emotion and trace connections between living things. Electric magic is especially suited to reading it: passive Electric scans reveal strong residual signatures on nearby surfaces, while those trained in Chi can follow lingering trails across conductive materials such as metal, wet sand and crystal. Heavy Vanta saturation and magical interference can disrupt these trails.

Resonance is therefore both the expression of potential and the record of its interaction with the world. It carries the shape of what has acted, allowing that potential and its consequences to be detected, followed and carried forward. The Resonance can be genuine even when the meaning assigned to it is wrong.

Related: The Soul, Psy, The Veins

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Soul Capturing

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Soul Extraction

Soul Capturing is the deliberate extraction and preservation of a person's Soul Resonance, concentrating the Resonance that forms their identity into a stable vessel. The practice emerged from Zephyr's experiments, which demonstrated that Resonance could be drawn from a living body and crystallised into Heart Crystals.

The process varies in severity. Alchemical apparatus can extract Resonance gradually, rituals can capture it at the moment of death, and more violent methods strip it from the living in pieces. What is preserved is not the body or soul as a separate substance, but the Resonance carrying its memories, identity and other accumulated Echoes.

The practice is justified as preservation, necessity or commerce, yet its result is the same: a person's accumulated existence becomes something that can be stored, traded and used. Captured Resonance can retain traces of consciousness, leaving those within old crystals as aware as their remaining Resonance permits.

Soul Capturing is condemned across most of Aerisu, but the resulting Heart Crystals remain valuable for their magical and practical uses, ensuring that the practice continues despite its reputation.

Related: Soul Shards, Zephyr

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Soulless

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Soullessness

The term Soulless describes those who fail the Separation Ritual. Without an Affinity, their potential remains internalised rather than finding expression through magic, leaving them unable to safely channel the Resonance within them. The resulting pressure produces Frallation, which typically leads to death between eighteen and

twenty-six, though circumstance can shorten or extend this span.

The name carries heavy derogatory weight. Soulless people are treated as though they have nothing to contribute, no useful potential and no meaningful place within the structures around them. Their inability to wield magic is taken as proof that something essential is missing, while their withdrawal from others is often used to justify the same judgement. The stigma can become part of the condition, reinforcing the isolation that produced it.

Their souls are fully present. The problem is that their Resonance remains turned inward. Where Separation allows potential to move outward through action, relationship and magic, the Soulless absorb what surrounds them without finding room to express what they carry. They may take in the expectations, emotions and troubles of others until their own desires have little space to emerge.

This is reflected in their association with Vanta. Vanta absorbs light; the Soulless similarly accumulate rather than externalise, their potential becoming pressure within rather than something that enters the world. What should become movement becomes withdrawal, and what remains unexpressed eventually contributes to Frallation.

The condition therefore reflects the deeper pathology of the Curse: lack creates desire, but desire requires movement. When a person cannot recognise, express or direct that potential outward, the pressure turns inward and begins consuming the vessel that carries it.

Related: Separation Ritual, Frallation, The Soul, Vanta Concept

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Vanta Concept

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as To lack, To want, Desire

To lack. To want. To begin. Vanta is the condition of lack and the desire that rises from recognising it. All beings begin with some form of absence, and that absence creates the impulse to move, seek, change and become. Through engagement with the world, desire produces action, action leaves Echoes, and those Echoes shape the soul.

Vanta exists as two intertwined states: absence, the recognition of what is missing, and longing, the desire that recognition produces. Lack gives direction to potential, creating the pressure through which becoming begins.

Vanta therefore underlies growth, choice and transformation. It gives existence something to move towards, while the way that desire is understood and acted upon determines what it becomes.

Related: Vanta Substance, VantaPsy, Soulless, Physical Curse

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The Curse

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Cursed Soul, Curse

The Cursed Soul

The Curse is the tangible consequence of a soul unmoored from its own essence. To fall to the Curse is to descend into Vanta, the root condition of lack and longing. Untended, Vanta becomes dangerous, collapsing inward as numbness or expanding outward as insatiable hunger.

Those who succumb to the Curse have lost continuity with their humanity. The collapse of the Six Steps of Being Human leads inevitably to corruption.

The Cursed manifest in archetypes. The Hollow denied their lack. The Devourer consumed by desire. The Zealot enslaved to dogma. The Wraith consumed by regret. The Tyrant denying responsibility. The Echoless leaving only distortion.

The Curse is also a mirror, reflecting what happens when lack, desire, and responsibility are ignored. Systems, cultures, and individuals that numb themselves or justify harm embody aspects of the Curse.

Redemption is possible but rare. Those on the edges may yet be guided back. For the truly Cursed, the path is nearly closed.

Related: Vanta Concept, Physical Curse, Memetic Curse

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Physical Curse

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Cursed

Cursing manifests in the body as well as the soul, most visibly through changes to blood. Deep Vanta saturation can produce Black Blood, thick and acidic enough to burn flesh and corrode metal. Black Blooded individuals often become driven by destructive hunger, particularly under conditions of heat and hardship.

Other Cursed learn to channel their Vanta deliberately, retaining control while gaining heightened perception, prolonged life or extraordinary power. Their bodies still bear the marks of corruption, shaped by the particular way their descent developed. Black Blood tends towards outward aggression and destruction, while White Blood emerges from cold, oppressive conditions and turns suffering inward.

Physical Cursing varies between individuals. Hallucination, silence, rage, obsession and bodily mutation can all emerge as different expressions of the same underlying corruption.

Related: The Curse, Blood Types

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Memetic Curse

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Memes, Memetic, Meme

The Memetic Curse spreads through awareness, allowing perception and communication to become vectors for Vanta. Dreams, whispers, hallucinations, symbols, phrases and other forms of information can carry its influence into the mind.

Once established, it distorts memory, perception and identity, making familiar thoughts and experiences increasingly unreliable. Affected minds may lose names and faces, develop compulsions or interpret altered perceptions as reality. The Curse can therefore propagate through ideas themselves, with repeated exposure allowing its patterns to spread between people.

The Memetic Curse is especially difficult to contain because its transmission occurs through cognition and communication. Psy practitioners study its effects as a corruption of Resonance within the mind, while severe cases can produce psychological collapse, bodily alteration or withdrawal into silence.

Related: The Curse, Physical Curse

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Truth, Conviction

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Truth, Conviction, Interpretation

Truth is what exists and remains regardless of whether anyone understands it. A soul retains the pattern formed through its actions and relationships even when the person carrying it misunderstands themselves.

Conviction is the understanding a mind accepts strongly enough to act upon. It gives uncertainty enough shape for intention to become action, while excessive certainty can harden belief against contradiction and endless doubt

can prevent action entirely. Clarity therefore requires the willingness to act while remaining open to being wrong.

Interpretation connects the two. Echoes carry consequences without predetermined meaning, so minds interpret them through their own understanding and conviction. That interpretation influences what happens next, creating further consequences that enter Recursion. When an interpretation becomes sufficiently persistent and widely shared, it can develop into Mythwrighting and acquire material consequence of its own.

Lux and Vanta express the same tension within thought. Lux gives understanding coherence, allowing conviction to form. Vanta preserves awareness of what remains unknown or incomplete, keeping understanding capable of change. A healthy mind needs both: enough coherence to act and enough uncertainty to continue learning.

Related: Memetic Curse, The Psycrata, The Diviners

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Looped Eternity

Age of Gods · Concepts · also known as Recursion, Recur, Recurrence, Loop

The Looped Eternity describes Aerisu's recursive structure of time, in which time moves forward while Echoes persist, allowing patterns of thought, life, culture, technology and civilisation to recur across changing eras. A civilisation may rediscover an ancient invention, a belief may survive its origin, or a society may resemble one that existed ages before it. What appears to be a return is the recurrence of an inherited pattern, altered by everything that accumulated between its appearances.

Aether discovered that memory and Resonance allow consequences to remain within the causal web rather than vanish with their original events. Echoes carry them into new configurations, where they may reproduce, transform or combine with other influences. This can make a later configuration appear to have preceded its own cause, particularly when a lost civilisation, forgotten technology or recurring idea seems strangely ahead of its era.

The universe therefore resembles a loop without literally repeating itself. Recursion is the more accurate description: each return inherits the previous pattern while changing through what has been added, lost or transformed. Asymptote of Decay describes inherited patterns that reproduce their own wounds, while Recursive Bloom describes those same inheritances becoming material for adaptation, connection and new possibility.

The Looped Eternity is therefore a universe that remembers. Nothing returns exactly as it was, yet nothing is wholly gone.

Related: Aether, Laws of Time, Echoes, Asymptote of Decay, Recursive Bloom

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Laws of Time

Age of Gods · Concepts · also known as Time

The Laws of Time describe the principles governing Aerisu's recursive temporality.

The Law of Continuance

“What has happened continues to happen until it becomes something else.” An event persists through its Echoes, carried into the people, systems and conditions it alters. What continues may change form entirely while remaining part of the same causal inheritance.

The Law of Recursion

“Every consequence becomes its own cause.” What an event leaves behind enters the wider causal web, where it can produce further consequences, recur as a pattern or become material for something new. Recursion therefore carries the past forward without requiring it to repeat exactly.

The Law of Displacement

“When the pattern changes, something must give way.” As inherited systems enter new configurations, some elements no longer fit and are displaced, while their Echoes may remain and become part of what replaces them.

Related: Looped Eternity, Echoes

—

Asymptote of Decay

Age of Gods · Concepts · also known as Asymptotic Decay

The geometry of mourning shapes the architecture of the world. Every breath approaches absence. The mathematics of desire calculates the exact weight of a collapsing kingdom, pulling existence continuously toward dissolution.

The Spiral remembers itself by folding its accumulated wounds into the next cycle, gathering sediment and ash layer upon patient layer. Civilisations, gods, and memories descend together, drawn by the increasing gravity of a system carrying the residue of its own history.

Entropy acts as the sacred engine of time, slowly winding the universe closer to the quiet threshold of Voluntas. Reality rebuilds itself from these distorted remnants, carrying the heavy resonance of old scars into new configurations.

The Curse echoes when longing outlives its name, cementing the world into a pattern that reproduces the conditions of its own collapse.

Related: Looped Eternity, Recursive Bloom, Echoes

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Recursive Bloom

Age of Gods · Concepts · also known as Bloom

Accumulated history provides the fertile soil for new complexity. Every ending flowers forward. The Spiral shifts its axis, and we breathe inside the turning.

Death leaves a resonant residue that nourishes the roots of the next iteration, and those roots keep the shape of old wounds. The world transforms its heavy inheritance into adaptation and profound connection.

Ereboska bloomed from nothing, proving that understanding residue shapes growth. Necromantic horticulture cultivates the quiet echoes of fallen lives into vibrant petals, allowing life to enter the same recursive system as the elements.

Every fracture becomes a new constellation, and every scar becomes a new language. The loop sustains the fabric of time through these micro-echoes of growth, turning the weight of consequence into the very structure of continuation.

Related: Looped Eternity, Asymptote of Decay, Echoes

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Chimeric Design

Age of Gods · Concepts · also known as Chimeric

Chimeric Design describes the causal architecture through which distinct systems overlap, shaping and sustaining one another across every scale of existence.

Nothing within ~~Aerisu~~ develops in isolation; a dialect carries the debris of ancient conquests, a weathered shrine rests against a concrete railway wall, and a soul forms through the quiet collision of memory, lineage, and immediate choice.

Components continuously reproduce the larger network that encompasses them, allowing mechanical, ecological, and cultural structures to interlock until cause and effect become indistinguishable.

It is the natural condition of a living world, where separate histories mingle without losing their individual weight, binding the mundane to the sacred through functional interdependence.

Related: Chimericism, Looped Eternity, Asymptote of Decay, The AEvicara, Echoes

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Chimericism

Age of Gods · Concepts

Chimericism arises when integration is forced through accumulation rather than genuine relationship, binding disparate systems into a fragile, composite whole.

Where natural harmony allows separate threads to participate in one another, Chimericism consumes them, grafting stolen souls, fragmented beasts, or incompatible magic together to force scale and power. The resulting entity carries immense resonance, yet its constituent parts remain fundamentally unintegrated, trapped in an internal collision of competing desires and borrowed memories.

It represents a distorted response to lack, gathering souls to suffocate isolation only to create a vessel whose primary engine is the perpetual hunger of its unassimilated parts.

Related: Chimeric Design, Looped Eternity, Asymptote of Decay, The AEvicara, Echoes

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Echoes

Age of Gods · Concepts · also known as Echo

An Echo is a consequence that persists beyond its original cause. It may take the form of a memory, relationship, inherited behaviour, cultural practice, physical alteration, magical imprint, myth, technology or influence upon another soul. Through Echoes, what has already happened remains part of the world, continuing to shape the people, systems and conditions that receive it.

An Echo has no fixed form or meaning. It can be reproduced, transformed, combined with other Echoes or interpreted differently, allowing the same underlying pattern to emerge in entirely new circumstances. This is how memory becomes inheritance, inheritance becomes behaviour, and behaviour becomes part of what shapes the future.

A ~~Loop~~ is a recurring pattern produced through these persistent Echoes. The pattern may resemble something that has appeared before, but what carries forward has already been changed by everything it has encountered.

An Echo does not preserve the past intact. It preserves its consequence.

Related: Looped Eternity, Laws of Time

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Tsukuyomi

Age of Gods · Concepts

A Tsukuyomi is a soul whose Resonance allows it to perceive connections within the world's causal structure that are usually hidden. Echoes, relationships and patterns become unusually apparent, allowing the soul to notice influences between things that would otherwise seem unrelated.

This phenomenon is associated with an Echo that recurs through Zuki Kusanagi's prayer for the end of the Scorching Sun. Her essence fragmented through Recursion, carrying aspects of her perspective into other souls. These aspects can include witness, memory, hope, grief or mercy, with their expression shaped by the soul that receives them.

The association became inseparable from the Moon after Lunarkos appeared and Zuki came to be remembered as its Goddess. Tsukuyomi therefore became the name given to souls through whom this recurring Echo manifests, with at least one occurring in every generation.

Related: Zuki Kusanagi, The Moon

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Stars

Age of Gods · Concepts · also known as Star

The Cosmic Echo

Stars are distant sources of light whose appearance already belongs to the past. By the time their light reaches Aerisu, the conditions that produced it may have changed or ceased to exist. For astronomers, this makes the night sky a natural record of what has already happened.

The idea of stars as Echoes grew from this observation. In Aerisu, an Echo is a consequence that persists beyond its original cause, carrying something forward through Resonance and Recursion. Many scholars therefore regard the stars as cosmic Echoes, traces of previous configurations continuing to reach the present long after their origins have changed.

This became especially significant after Aether's study of the Looped Eternity. If patterns can recur across changing configurations, then the heavens can be understood as another expression of the same structure. Stars are consequently studied for recurring celestial patterns and relationships rather than simply as distant locations. The Odyraphim are particularly associated with this approach, treating astronomy as a means of studying cosmic memory and Recursion.

Creatis gave the idea a more personal dimension. Through Project DAEDALUS and his Ascension Project, he sought to leave Aerisu itself and reach the heavens. His mortal body could not survive the attempt, while his soul remained suspended among the stars. Whether this represents a literal presence, a persistent Echo or something that falls between those interpretations remains disputed.

Different cultures attach their own meanings to the stars. Vesperites often regard them as signs of continuity, finding comfort in the idea that lives and civilisations leave something behind. Lunartics can read them as remnants of ancient celestial events and warnings of what may happen again. Astrologers associate constellations with the Nine Spirits, interpreting celestial patterns through their domains.

No single interpretation governs the heavens. A constellation can carry different names and meanings across cultures while remaining physically unchanged. The stars endure as objects of observation and interpretation, giving each generation a way to look at the past, recognise recurring patterns and imagine what may come next.

Some scholars believe Pixpsy radiance is related to the same phenomenon that makes stars visible. Others associate their light with the memories carried within their souls. Both ideas remain open.

Related: Echoes, The Moon, The Sun, Looped Eternity

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The Folding

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as temporal recursion

The Folding is a temporal recursion affecting Sengetsuki, causing moments, places and events to repeat across overlapping cycles. Streets lead to places they should not, buildings exist in multiple states, and people can encounter echoes of moments they have already lived.

The phenomenon began after the Nightjar crash, coinciding with Voluntas entering the material world. Those caught within the recursion experience its effects unevenly, with some memories and events repeating while others pass normally.

The Diviners have been unable to fully explain or stop the Folding. Its true cause lies with Voluntas, whose presence in the material world created the conditions for the recursion.

Related: Echoes, Jenova's Expedition, The Sun, Looped Eternity

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Laws of the Spirits

Age of Fairytales · Concepts · also known as Spirits Laws

The Nine Spirits remain within the Spirit Realm, their presence reaching into Aerisu through currents of Resonance. Their influence manifests through the principles they embody, shaping the material world through recurring patterns, sudden inspiration, heightened emotion and changes in the behaviour of places and living things.

Creatis manifests through invention and inspiration.

Verdantia through growth and reclamation.

Aether through space, stars and Recursion.

Logaris through knowledge, clarity and understanding.

Mnemotas through memory and its accumulation.

Elysia through heightened emotion.

Anima through awareness of death and its threshold.

Justicar through consequence.

Voluntas through desire and the drive to become.

These influences permeate Aerisu, from the growth of crystal forests and formation of Soul Shards to patterns of thought and places altered by accumulated Resonance. The Spirits do not need to enter the material world for their domains to shape it. Their presence alone is enough.

Related: The Nine Spirits, The Primal Dichotomy

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The Primal Dichotomy

Age of Fairytales · Concepts · also known as Lux and Vanta

Lux and Vanta are the two fundamental expressions of potential within Resonance. Lux expresses coherence, connection, restoration and the preservation of structure. Vanta expresses lack, desire, transformation and the pressure created by what is absent or unresolved. Every living thing carries both in different proportions, and their interaction underlies much of magic and becoming.

Lux tends towards bringing things together and holding them in relation. It reinforces stability, clarity and recovery, allowing damaged structures to mend and disparate elements to remain coherent. Its influence appears in crystalline growth, restoration and forms of magic concerned with connection and preservation.

Vanta moves through desire and lack, giving force to change and transformation. It can break existing structures, accelerate change and draw potential towards what is wanted. When desire becomes consuming and loses direction, Vanta can develop into the Curse, turning the same force of becoming inward until it damages the soul and body.

The Shattering changed the scale at which both could be expressed. Lunarkos released vast concentrations of Lux, while Bahamut exposed and dispersed immense Vanta through the world. Their presence became especially pronounced in the altered landscape that followed, with crystals, atmospheric changes, magical phenomena and living systems carrying stronger expressions of the same underlying forces.

Lux and Vanta therefore form a persistent tension within Aerisu. Their interaction shapes magic, matter, life and the soul itself, expressing two fundamental responses to potential: connection towards what is, and desire towards what might be.

Related: Vanta Concept, Lux Crystals, The Rift

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The Spiral Journey

Age of Fairytales · Concepts · also known as Spiral Journey, Seven Stations, The Toll

The Spiralling Return

The Spiral Journey is the passage through which souls descend from Verdant towards the Orb. Each Region is shaped by one of the Spirits, while each Station confronts the soul with a stage of becoming. Only souls undertake the Journey, as its stations require the capacity to choose and take responsibility for those choices.

Region 1: Verdant

The living world, named after Verdantia, where the soul is formed through experience, relationship and choice.

Station 0: The Toll

Tomenos takes memories as fare, requiring the soul to relinquish enough of its accumulated memory to enter the Spiral. Those who cannot relinquish them remain trapped as ghosts or Veinsick.

Region 2: Anima

The Region of mortality, where the soul confronts its own death.

Station 1: To Truly Lack

The soul recognises what was genuinely absent from its life and names it without deception.

Region 3: Elysia

The Region of emotion, where desire and feeling reach their full intensity.

Station 2: To Want with Compassion

The soul encounters what it desired and must choose between possession and compassion.

Region 4: Logaris

The Region of clarity, where truth, contradiction and uncertainty surround the soul.

Station 3: To Seek Clarity

The soul confronts itself through confusion and conflicting truths, learning to see without the stories that obscured reality.

Region 5: Creatis

The Region of action, where unfinished creations and unrealised choices reveal what was done and left undone.

Station 4: To Act or To Not Act with Noble Intent

The soul confronts the consequences of its choices and accepts ownership of what it caused.

Region 6: Justicar

The Region of consequence, where the soul encounters the effects its choices had upon others.

Station 5: To Take Proper Responsibility

The soul follows its consequences through the lives and systems they affected, accepting its place within that chain.

Region 7: Aether

The Region of cosmic order, where recurring patterns reveal the structure of Recursion.

Station 6: To Echo with Reverence

The soul leaves something enduring behind, carrying its existence into what follows.

Region 8: Mnemotas

The Region of memory, where the accumulated consequences of existence are preserved as Echoes.

Station 7: Individuation

The soul confronts its history and integrates its experiences, choices, relationships and consequences into an understanding of itself.

Region 9: The Orb

At the heart of the Spiral lies the Orb, Veyra's Womb and the domain of Voluntas. The soul enters the greater current of existence, its memories and accumulated Resonance becoming part of what follows. This is return.

Related: The Spiral, Orb of Souls, Tomenos

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Magic

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Potential, Mauragic, Magical

Magic is potential expressed through Resonance: the capacity within a being or system to transform, affect or connect. Every working follows three governing principles. Understanding provides knowledge of the target system, Intent determines how the potential is directed, and Connection determines how deeply that potential resonates with the world's underlying currents.

Magic manifests through two primal forces. Lux-aspected magic reinforces coherence, restoration and structural integrity, while Vanta-aspected magic draws upon lack and desire to produce transformative power at the risk of consumption. These forces manifest through the four schools of Matter, Energy, Life and Mind, which describe the different ways potential can be expressed.

Magic is therefore the outward expression of potential through Resonance, turning what a being or system can become into measurable effects upon the world.

Related: Soul Resonance, Soul Type Casting, Schools of Magic, The Primal Dichotomy

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Soul Type Casting

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Soul Type, Caster, Casting

Magic flows through the Soul, shaped by its condition and the way its potential is expressed. Aerisu recognises three primary caster types.

Soulful casters have developed strong Soul integrity through knowledge, intention and Connection. Their Resonance moves deliberately, allowing precise and controlled use of magic.

Cursed casters carry heavy Vanta saturation, with desire and emotion driving their Resonance. Their magic can be powerful and immediate, but becomes unstable as that desire turns inward and spills into its surroundings.

Soulless casters cannot externalise their Soul through Separation, leaving their potential contained within the body. They cannot safely channel magic, and the resulting pressure produces Frallation.

Casting therefore depends upon more than magical knowledge. Understanding gives structure to potential, Intent directs it, and Connection determines how effectively that potential can be expressed through Resonance.

Related: Magic, Soulless, Separation Ritual

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Schools of Magic

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Types of Magic, Types of Magic, Magic School, Magic Schools, Four Schools of Magic

The Four Schools of Magic

Magic reaches into four fundamental domains of reality, each describing a different way potential can be expressed and reshaped through Resonance.

Matter governs physical substance, from Terra, Aqua and Aero to Pyra and Materia. It allows practitioners to shape, transform and combine material according to its physical properties.

Energy governs flow, motion and the relationships between them, encompassing Kinetic and Potential forces, Thermodynamic and Entropic processes, Temporal and Causal effects, Probability and Space. It manipulates how things move, change and influence one another.

Life governs biological systems and the processes that sustain and transform them, including biogenesis, biomancy, botany and mycology, microbial and viral dynamics, genetics, neuro-organics and necrobiology.

Mind governs consciousness, perception and the structures through which minds relate to one another, including Psy, cognition, memory, identity, emotion, will, memetics, connection and soul mechanics.

Vanta and Lux in Practice

Every school can be expressed through Lux or Vanta, shaping how its potential behaves. Lux reinforces coherence, restoration, precision and structural integrity. Vanta draws on lack and desire to produce transformative force, breaking existing structures and accelerating change at the risk of feeding the Curse.

A practitioner therefore develops through how they direct potential as much as through what they know. Lux can preserve a structure beyond the point where it should have changed, while Vanta can force transformation beyond what the structure can safely contain. Their use is therefore a matter of Resonance, Intent and consequence.

Related: Magic, Psy, The Primal Dichotomy, Elementals

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Psy

Age of Magic · Concepts

Psy is the Mind school of magic concerned with the soul, consciousness, memory, desire and connection. It is also the term used for the psychic aspect of Resonance: the same Resonance that carries potential through physical systems can carry thoughts, memories, emotions, identities and ideas between minds and other connected systems. Psy, psyche, psy-residue and related terms therefore describe different applications or expressions of this same underlying process.

Psy practitioners learn to perceive these patterns as tangible presences, sensing emotions, memories and connections that ordinary perception cannot detect. More advanced applications allow them to read thoughts, alter cognition, influence will and navigate the psychic currents connecting living things.

Psy is also the basis of Soul Capturing and soul transference, which manipulate the Resonance carrying consciousness and identity. Lux-aspected Psy tends towards clarity, coherence and restoration, while Vanta-aspected Psy draws on lack and desire, increasing the risk of distortion and loss of self.

Because Psy works directly with patterns of mind and identity, its effects can persist through the Resonance they alter. Every intervention leaves traces, and practitioners who push too deeply into another psyche risk carrying those patterns into themselves.

Related: Schools of Magic, The Soul, Soul Capturing, Psy Hacking

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Mythwrighting

Age of Magic · Concepts

Mythwrighting is a branch of Mind magic that allows persistent stories and collective belief to acquire Resonance and influence reality. Through the Loop's recursive nature, sufficiently established myths can send their Echoes backward through time, creating conditions that reinforce the story itself.

Mythwrighting operates through interpretation rather than objective truth. A belief can be mistaken and still become causally significant when repeated through cultural memory, ritual and behaviour. The resulting Echo may manifest as an influence, event or pattern associated with the myth.

The strength of a myth depends on the Resonance accumulated through belief and repetition. Individual belief can begin the process, but widespread cultural conviction gives an Echo greater persistence and reach.

Related: Schools of Magic, The Rise of Myth

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Soul Pathology

Age of Knowledge · Concepts

Soul Pathology a branch of Mind magic, and is the study of the soul as a system: its structure, Resonance, integrity and the ways it can be fractured, transferred or altered. The field examines conditions including soul fracture and the effects of interference with the soul's connection to the body.

The discipline developed alongside broader Psy research, with particular interest in the relationship between consciousness, identity, memory and Resonance. Its applications include soul-energy transfer and the creation of Soulbound Magic, allowing researchers to manipulate the connection between soul and body without relying solely on conventional Separation.

Jenova became one of the field's most ambitious researchers, pursuing Soul Pathology in Veralisse through the Psycrata's archives and her own experiments. Her work eventually encompassed the transfer between Kiara and Koto, the study of Soulless subjects and the research that led to her pursuit of the Orb of Souls.

Related: Soulbound Magic, Schools of Magic, Psy, Jenova Najma, Jenova's Expedition

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Soulbound Magic

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Soulbound, soul transference, soul-transfer, soul transfer, soul-transference

The Transfer of Soul. Soulbound Magic is a branch of Psy developed through the manipulation of soul-energy, allowing Resonance and consciousness to be transferred between living hosts. It emerged from research into the relationship between soul and body and became one of the most advanced applications of Soul Pathology.

The practice can stabilise an unstable soul, preserve consciousness or alter the distribution of essence between bodies. Its use carries significant risks when the receiving vessel cannot properly contain what is transferred, potentially resulting in instability, fracture or other lasting consequences.

Jenova developed Soulbound Magic through her research in Veralisse, eventually using it in her experiments on Kiara and Koto. Her work demonstrated both its potential and the consequences of treating the soul as something that could be moved and reshaped.

Related: Soul Pathology, Schools of Magic, Psy, Jenova Najma, Jenova's Expedition

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Crystal Amplification

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Crystal, Crystals, Amplify Magic

Crystals can amplify magic by lowering the threshold of Connection required to channel a given effect. They allow a mage with limited attunement to access potential that would otherwise require years of discipline, increasing the amount of Resonance they can direct without changing the underlying principles of the working.

This makes crystals useful across every school of magic. Lux shards favour stable, restorative and coherent effects, while Vanta gems provide greater transformative force through lack and desire. Raikami crystals, formed where Susanoo's lightning strikes particular mineral seams, are one example of a crystal whose Resonance naturally amplifies a specific kind of magic. Other crystals retain distinctive Resonance from places, processes or beings that produced them.

Amplification still depends on the mage. A crystal does not provide Understanding, Intent or genuine Connection of its own, and repeated reliance can weaken the mage's own attunement. The Soul begins to depend on the external source rather than developing its own Resonance, making withdrawal painful and reducing independent control.

Some crystals are actively dangerous. Corrupted Lux can overwhelm perception with imposed order, while Vantagems can continuously reinforce obsessive patterns through their Vanta-saturated Resonance. Their use is therefore regulated differently across Aerisu, from controlled trade to outright prohibition.

Related: Magic, VantaBlack, Lux Crystals, Naru, Ankaru, Raikami, Mauri, Verdani, Soul Shards

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Separation Ritual

Age of Magic · Concepts

The Separation Ritual externalises the soul's Resonance through the Strand, allowing a person to express their magical potential through an Affinity rather than contain it within the body. It is the established means of relieving the pressure that would otherwise produce Frallation.

The ritual is typically performed during adolescence, when the soul reaches sufficient maturity for Separation. Through ritual, meditation and magical guidance, the individual's Resonance is directed outward until the Affinity

forms beyond the body while remaining connected through the Strand.

Its forms vary across Aerisu. Some traditions use flame, water or other elemental media; others rely on controlled breathing, meditation and focused intention. The method differs, but the underlying process is the same: the person's Resonance is given an external expression through which their potential can be safely channelled.

Separation is therefore both a magical and developmental process. It allows the individual to act upon the world through an Affinity, directing their Resonance outward rather than allowing accumulated magical pressure to remain trapped within the body.

Related: Affinities, Soulless, Frallation

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Affinities

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Affinity, The Strand

The Strand and Affinities

The Strand is the metaphysical tether connecting a person's body and soul, carrying Resonance between them and allowing the soul's influence to remain part of thought, sensation and action after Separation.

Through Separation, that Resonance takes visible form as an Affinity, an external manifestation of the person's soul and identity. Affinities take animal forms, reflecting different aspects of the pattern that has developed through the individual's life. A person may manifest a small companion such as a cat, bird or rabbit, while others take the forms of larger animals such as lions, bears, wolves or eagles. Rarely, an Affinity manifests as a dragon.

The Affinity remains connected through the Strand, allowing the person and their Affinity to share thought and feeling without speech. Harm to an Affinity therefore reverberates through the same Resonance that connects the two, affecting the person directly and potentially leaving lasting psychological scars.

Related: Separation Ritual, The Soul, Elementals

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Elementals

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Elemental

An Elemental is the particular magical affinity expressed through the Strand when a person's soul is externalised. It gives their Resonance a natural tendency towards a specific aspect of one of the four schools of magic, making that form easier to channel and develop.

A Fire Elemental, for example, allows a mage to channel fire more readily. A Plant Elemental might make them naturally adept at nurturing and manipulating plant life without giving them equal command of the wider Life school. Water, electricity and other specific magical forms are common, while rarer Elementals can encompass broader domains such as Matter or Psy.

The Elemental usually emerges during the Separation Ritual as the person's Resonance settles into its most natural magical expression. It determines what comes most easily through the Strand, while other forms of magic can still be learned through understanding, practice and Connection.

Related: Separation Ritual, Affinities, Schools of Magic, Soul Type Casting

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Frallation

Age of Magic · Concepts

Frallation is the body's collapse when an internalised soul can no longer contain its own pressure. Magic entering Aerisu through the Rift settles into living things as a constant pressure, while generations accumulate deeper Resonance with Lux and Vanta. As the soul grows denser, that pressure gathers beneath the skin and begins searching for passage through the body's limits.

The condition begins with tremors, heat beneath the skin and increasingly crowded senses as the soul presses outward through nerve and thought. Lines then rise along the body's natural paths, following tendon, rib, spine and jaw like roots or fractures. These structures form a network that distributes the pressure across the body, while finer markings gather within them, forming incomplete shapes that reflect the mind's attempt to comprehend what it carries.

As the pressure deepens, the body eventually yields. Life thins beneath the strain, whether through quiet fading or violent failure. In rare cases, a late Separation allows the soul to detach without destroying the body.

Related: Soulless, Frallation Stages, Separation Ritual, Frallation Marks

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Frallation Stages

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Stages of Frallation, Progression of Frallation, Frallation Progression

Clinical Progression of Frallation

Frallation progresses through four stages in which the body's strain is accompanied by changes in perception, memory and identity. The markings provide a visible record of the soul's increasing pressure.

Stage I: Containment

Fine tremors, internal heat, shallow sleep and heightened sensory awareness mark the earliest stage. Memory favours emotionally significant experiences, drawing attention inward, while faint root markings appear along areas of tension and sparse script begins to form. The individual remains clear and in control.

Stage II: Fixation

Persistent tremor, fatigue and fever accompany visual disturbances and increasingly selective memory. Particular desires, thoughts or identities become anchors around which emotion and behaviour begin to cycle. Root structures spread across the body and script develops recurring forms. The individual remains aware, but their sense of self narrows around these fixations.

Stage III: Fragmentation

Continuous physical strain gives way to unstable movement, breathing and rhythm. Perception becomes saturated with hallucination, while memory loses sequence and reconnects through the logic of dominant desires and beliefs. Identity increasingly condenses around those fixations. Root markings concentrate into dense structures and script layers across them, while speech and behaviour repeatedly return to the same ideas.

Stage IV: Disintegration

The body loses its ability to maintain itself, with disrupted breathing, irregular heartbeat and involuntary movement. Awareness fragments, memory breaks into isolated impressions and identity loses a stable centre. Internal phenomena become indistinguishable from the external world, directing behaviour through impulse, residual desire and persistent imagery. Root structures lose coherence and script spreads beyond anatomical pathways. Some collapse completely; in rare cases, a late Separation allows the soul to detach while the body survives.

Related: Frallation, Frallation Marks, Soulless

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Soul Regulation

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Regulation

Soul Regulation is the practice of deliberately directing one's Resonance through controlled behaviour, attention and action. Because choices, emotions, movement and intention all leave Resonance, changing how one acts changes the pattern that those actions produce.

Breathing, grounding, visualisation and physical discipline help regulate attention and behaviour, allowing Resonance to be directed deliberately rather than accumulating through uncontrolled reaction. In hospitals, this makes regulation part of patient care: a person's agitation can affect their Affinity, while steadier conduct produces a steadier expression of Resonance.

For the Soulless, regulation is especially important because their soul remains internalised and the resulting pressure drives Frallation. Meditation, breathwork and physical exercise provide ways to direct that pressure outward through deliberate action, opening blocked pathways and reducing the strain placed upon the body.

Soul Regulation is therefore a practice of agency. By becoming conscious of how they act and where their Resonance goes, a person can influence the pattern they are continuing to create.

Related: Chi, Affinities, Soulless, Frallation

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Chi

Age of Magic · Concepts

Chi is the discipline through which Soul Regulation becomes a way of life. Originating in the high valleys of Fengua, its practitioners spend decades refining the relationship between desire, Resonance and the body until their discipline produces a visible physiological change. Their blood gradually turns green, reflecting a state in which desire has been brought under conscious control and no longer drives the soul towards hunger or inward collapse.

Chi is expressed through breath, movement and deliberate action. Practitioners can direct Resonance through the body to reinforce bone, sharpen strikes, strengthen defences, accelerate recovery and contain aggression with precision. Their attunement also allows them to perceive Resonance trails across conductive materials, making electric magic particularly effective for tracking and detection.

Chi developed alongside Fengua's traditions of observation, discipline and harmony with the world, and remains closely associated with its monks and high valleys.

Related: Soul Regulation, Fengua, Blood Types

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Death Gardening

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Necromantic Horticulture, Death Garden, Death Gardens

Necromantic Horticulture

Death Gardening is the practice developed by the tribes of Ereboska around a simple discovery: death feeds growth. When a living being dies, its magical essence enters the surrounding soil as Residue, carrying qualities shaped by the life, circumstances and manner of death. Death Gardeners learned to read these traces and cultivate particular plants from particular endings. Violent deaths can produce rapid, aggressive growth, while peaceful deaths tend towards slower and subtler forms. Generations of observation turned this into a precise discipline.

Ritual Death

Death Gardeners may prepare ritual deaths in which a person willingly offers their final Resonance to sustain the community. The dying can be guided towards chosen soil and seeds, with the method, state of mind and manner of death influencing what eventually grows. Elders, the sick and others who choose this path may regard their death as an act of continuation, feeding children, medicine, food or materials for those who remain.

Death Gardens

Gardens are cultivated around the specific deaths that nourish them, producing food, medicine, construction materials and stranger growths that retain traces of their sources. Colours become unnaturally vivid, flowers form familiar patterns, bark can resemble skin, and some plants carry impressions of the lives that fed them. Different tribes developed specialised forms, including hallucinogenic fruits, black-barked forests and medicinal herbs.

Necromancy and Trade

Death Gardeners use Vanta and necromancy to direct Residue, accelerate growth and shape roots and vines. Their knowledge extends to Vein Mouths, where accumulated death gathers around the boundaries below. Gardens can reinforce these thresholds, absorb toxins and mark or stabilise passages. Ereboskan produce became a major export, with carefully cultivated fruits, vegetables and herbs valued for effects derived from the lives that nourished them. Memorial gardens and trees can also be grown from a person's final Resonance.

Death Gardening remains one of Ereboska's defining traditions, turning barren ground into fertile ground through an intimate understanding of death, Resonance and renewal.

Related: Ereboska, Death Gardening, The Vantari

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Ritual Death

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Blossoming Death

Blossoming Death

Ritual Death is a specific practice of Death Gardening in which a person deliberately dies within a prepared garden so that their final Resonance can pass directly into the flora. The body is given to the garden, where its remains become part of the soil, roots and growth that sustain those who follow.

For the Vantari, the practice treats death as a continuation of the relationship between a person, their community and the living world. The deceased does not remain alive through the body; their death becomes another part of the garden's growth, carrying their echo forward through what they leave behind.

Inspiration: Ritual death and funerary traditions within Vodun/Voodoo, adapted through the Vantari practice of Death Gardening and its understanding of death, Resonance and the continuation of echoes.

Related: Death Gardening, The Vantari, Necromancy, Soul Resonance

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Necromancy

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Necromantic

Wooden Souls

Necromancy is the practice of cultivating the living dead by entangling a corpse's Resonance with living flora. Through Death Gardening, plants, roots, fungi and other growths inhabit and sustain the remains, giving them motion and structure rather than restoring their former biological state.

The simplest forms produce Deadwood, crude undead bodies in which wood, roots and foliage replace much of the corpse's original structure. Their movements are primitive and their connection to the gardener's will direct. More experienced practitioners can cultivate refined forms, sometimes called dolls, which retain the body's shape and movement as flora grows beneath and through the flesh. Wood grain may show through the skin, while roots and fungi emerge from wounds and joints. The finest can appear almost indistinguishable from the living.

Most cultivated dead are mindless, their movement arising from the Resonance binding corpse and flora together. The rare forms that retain greater complexity may approach convincing humanity, though attempts to produce a truly human-like being frequently result in Hollowing.

Whether such beings are human remains debated. Vantari thought gives weight to the cultivation of the soul, allowing a being grown from a corpse to be regarded as human if it can cultivate and express soulfulness. Others regard such beings as echoes wearing bodies shaped by another's hand.

Necromancy thus occupies the boundary between death, growth and becoming, binding what has lived to what continues to grow and determining what may emerge from their entanglement.

Inspiration: Vodun/Voodoo traditions surrounding the reanimated dead, particularly the cultural image of the zombie, combined with the botanical imagery of Death Gardening and the Pinocchio-like idea of a constructed body becoming something recognisably human.

Related: Death Gardening, Ritual Death, The Hollowed, The Vantari, Soul Resonance

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Vein Guides

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Vein Guide

The Vein Guides are Ereboskan specialists who navigate the Veins beneath the wasteland, carrying generations of practical knowledge about their changing passages, hazards and inhabitants. Their communities formed around the Vein Mouths, where guiding became a respected craft passed from elder to apprentice.

Necromantic tradition gives them an unusual awareness of death within the tunnels. They can recognise the movement of souls and places where the living world thins towards the deeper realms, guiding travellers with the patience and caution demanded by the underworld.

Scholars, miners, treasure hunters and pilgrims all seek their services, and a guide's reputation rests on bringing people safely through the depths.

Related: Ereboska, Death Gardening, The Vantari, The Veins, The Spiral

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Psy Hacking

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Psy Hacker, Psycker, Psycho, Psy Hackers, Psyckers, Psychos

Psy Hacking is the technological approach to Psy, using devices and computation to analyse, manipulate and transmit patterns of Soul Resonance. Where trained Psychics develop this understanding through prolonged discipline, Psy Hackers build tools that read Psy currents and convert them into usable information.

Its most distinctive field is memetics. Psy Hackers study how symbols, phrases, behaviours and cultural associations carry Resonance between minds, allowing suggestions to be embedded into communications and environments. Their work can influence perception, memory, behaviour and collective belief with remarkable subtlety.

Psycker is the common term for practitioners and carries a degree of respect within underground communities. Psycho describes those who have pushed the practice into dangerous territory, particularly through repeated

interference with minds and Resonance until their own grasp of identity and truth begins to deteriorate. Some become weapons or psychological hazards, drawing the attention of the Diviners.

The distinction between Psychic and Psycker is therefore primarily one of method. Both work with Psy and can reach comparable levels of understanding, though one develops the discipline internally while the other builds ways to circumvent it.

Related: Psy, Soul Resonance, The Diviners

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Heroes

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Hero, Legend, Legends, Heroism, Heroic, Heroine, Heroines

A Hero is a person whose Resonance places them a step above ordinary people, giving them an unusual capacity to act, endure and influence events. They remain human, with the same limitations and consequences as anyone else, but something about them carries further.

Heroism is therefore more than a single courageous deed. A person may save a life and never become a Hero. A Hero is someone whose actions, abilities or character leave a lasting impression strong enough for others to recognise them as exceptional. Their deeds accumulate into an Echo, and their name begins to carry meaning beyond the individual events that made it known.

Heroes arise from many walks of life. The Civic Hero Registry provides one recognised path, while organisations such as D.E.A.D. and its various initiatives produce many others. Soldiers, explorers, engineers, rescuers and civilians can all become Heroes. Among the Norrvekts, heroic service is particularly valued, and many of their most renowned figures have carried that ideal into wider society.

The title carries no guarantee of virtue. Heroes may be admired, revered or celebrated, while others are considered reckless, troublesome or dangerous. What matters is the impression they leave and the degree to which that impression persists.

Some Heroes eventually become legends, their Echo extending beyond their lifetime and becoming part of history, culture or myth. Others remain known within a city, organisation or community.

To be a Hero is to be recognised as someone who can do more than most, and whose actions carry further than most. They are still people. They simply leave a larger Echo.

Related: Civic Hero Registry, D.E.A.D, The Norrvekts

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Civic Hero Registry

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as CHR, Civic Hero Rank, Hero Rank, CH Rank, CH Registry

The Civic Hero Registry (CHR) was established during the Age of Decay as an auxiliary program for responding to Curse outbreaks. Administered by the Crown Liaison Office, Sengetsuki Police and hospital containment teams, it formally recognises civilians who assist during crises. Registration requires verified heroic conduct, basic combat competence, a clean criminal record and a signed liability waiver. Heroes receive no payment, but their registration grants access to areas, services and information normally restricted to civilians.

Registered Heroes are identified by a small triangular badge, with bronze, silver, gold and platinum corresponding to increasing ranks. The design reflects the triangular motifs common throughout Sengetsuki and carries identification details appropriate to the holder's rank.

The Rank of Junior Hero

A single verified act of heroism earns Junior Hero status. Qualifying actions include saving civilians during a Curse outbreak, subduing a Cursed individual or rescuing people from a dangerous situation. The incident must be witnessed by an authority or supported by surviving surveillance evidence.

Junior Heroes receive limited access to police facilities, hospital wards, government buildings and combat gyms. They may detain individuals until authorities arrive, but cannot make arrests or carry restricted weapons. The badge grants tolerance and access rather than legal authority.

The Path to Higher Ranks

Silver Heroes require multiple verified acts or exceptional bravery, followed by an interview, combat proficiency test and first aid certification. Their expanded access includes supervised evidence rooms, the hospital morgue for investigations and an emergency radio frequency. They may also testify as expert witnesses in Curse-related cases.

Gold Heroes require two years of service, ten verified incidents, an official recommendation, advanced combat certification and crisis management training. They may access non-lethal suppression equipment during active crises, receive relevant classified briefings and coordinate lower-ranked Heroes until authorities arrive.

Master Hero is an honorary rank reserved for exceptional Gold Heroes with five years of service, a city commendation and a record of saving hundreds of lives or defeating major threats. Only around ten exist across the Sengetsuki region. They receive near-total access, may carry restricted equipment under permit and are consulted on crisis policy.

Beyond the formal ranks is the unofficial status of Legend, reserved for Heroes whose deeds have become part of Sengetsuki's history and culture.

Legal Boundaries

The CHR exists to regulate civilian intervention rather than replace law enforcement. Heroes remain legally accountable for their actions and may be sued or prosecuted for excessive force. The government assumes no liability for Hero injuries, while optional Hero insurance is available privately. Incident reports are reviewed by the Hero Coordination Office, and violations can result in demotion, removal from the Registry or criminal prosecution.

Cultural Presence

The CHR has become part of everyday life in Sengetsuki. Registered Heroes receive recognition from civilians and businesses, while higher-ranked Heroes are treated with increasing trust and authority. The system reflects a practical response to the Age of Decay: Curse outbreaks occur faster than official forces can contain them, so civilians willing to intervene are given a structure through which they can do so.

Related: Heroes, Sengetsuki, Crown Nations

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The Borenfegens

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Borenfegen, Borenfegens

The Borenfegens were both solution and symptom, artificial humans grown in vats with genetic code designed rather than inherited and every stage of development monitored and adjusted. They were created as vessels capable of containing extreme magical pressure without succumbing to Frallation. Matter magic shaped the flesh, Life magic controlled development, Energy magic channelled magical flow, and Mind magic wove consciousness.

Their blood was engineered alongside their bodies. Borenfegens produce Blue Blood, derived from Synthetic White Blood, while children born from a Borenfegen cross-bred with another human are Pink Blooded.

The first generations were visibly artificial, but each improved until the height of the Orthogenesis project, when Borenfegens became indistinguishable from natural humans and could think, feel and dream. That created an ethical catastrophe, because personhood was treated as a contract rather than a status: those who met the

required criteria were citizens, while those who did not were property.

Related: Spectrum of Being, Borenfegen Recurrence, Orthogenesis

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Spectrum of Being

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as The Spectrum of Being, Naturals, Artificials, Enhanced

The ~~Orthogenesis~~ project created three categories that ~~Silealyros~~ was still learning to navigate.

Naturals were born through inheritance and chance, occupying every level of society.

Enhanced were modified after birth, their original bodies supplemented or transformed through technology, making them more capable while leaving them marked by their choices.

Artificials were the ~~Borenfegens~~, created rather than born. Their personhood was the most contested, with those who met the required criteria recognised as citizens while those who did not remained property.

The three groups lived in uneasy proximity. Naturals feared becoming obsolete, Enhanced feared their modifications would be used to deny their humanity, and Artificials struggled for recognition.

Related: The Borenfegens, Silealyros

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Six Steps of Becoming

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Six Steps, Steps of Humanity, Soulful Path, becoming of souls

The Six Steps of Humanity describe how a soul develops towards wholeness and meaningful agency. They form the philosophical foundation of ~~VantaPsy~~ and the core of ~~Veyra Megami~~'s ~~Doctrine of Becoming~~.

To Truly Lack

A soul recognises its incompleteness without shame, perceiving what is missing without allowing absence to define its worth.

To Want with Compassion

~~Desire~~ is allowed without consumption, learning to build and nurture rather than destroy.

To Seek Clarity within Both Noise and Fog

~~Truth~~ must be found amid confusion, confronting uncertainty without surrendering judgement to the voices surrounding the soul.

To Act or To Not Act with Noble Intent

Choice arises from purpose rather than impulse, with action where it is needed and restraint where action would cause harm.

To Take Proper Responsibility for Your Actions

Every choice produces consequences that extend beyond the one who made it, affecting others and entering the wider causal web.

To ~~Echo~~ with Reverence

Every decision continues through time as an ~~Echo~~, carrying its consequences into others and the world around them.

Together, the Six Steps describe how a soul recognises lack, directs desire, seeks clarity, chooses with purpose, accepts consequence and participates responsibly in what follows.

Related: VantaPsy, The Soul, The Grimoire

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The Lunartics

Age of Gods · Concepts · also known as Lunartic, Lunartics

Let the Moon Come

A religious ideology that emerged during the Shattering, centred on Lunarkos as divine judgement and salvation. Lunartics taught that humanity should accept its descent rather than resist it.

The tradition drew upon scattered myths of a girl from eastern Hoshimira who suffered beneath a burning sky and prayed for relief. According to the tradition, the heavens answered with a moon that would one day descend. The girl became remembered as Zuki, Goddess of the Moon.

Lunartic theology regarded the Sun as the source and symbol of humanity's corruption, with the Curse representing its culmination. Lunarkos was therefore understood as the cleansing of a world that had reached the end of its course. Resistance to its descent was considered resistance to divine judgement.

Their beliefs concerning Voluntas followed the same doctrine. Lunartics believed her Vanta drew Lunarkos's Lux towards Aerisu and that her survival was necessary for its arrival. She was consequently understood as an instrument through which the promised descent would occur.

The ideology has since survived only through historical records, scattered accounts and theological interpretation. Some scholars have proposed that Lunartic belief was an echo of the older Luminary ideology, particularly in its conception of divine purpose and humanity's place within a greater order. No surviving evidence establishes a direct connection between the two, and the resemblance remains a matter of interpretation.

Related: Lunarkos, Zuki Kusanagi, Voluntas, Anima

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The Autarchs

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Autarchs, Autarch, Autarchian, Tarch, Tarchs

Forever Forward

Existentialist philosophy of human self-determination, progress, command and heroic service.

The Autarchs believe humanity stands above all else. There are no gods to appeal to and no higher power waiting to save the world. Humanity must determine its own meaning and build the means to survive through its own knowledge, labour and strength.

Autarchianism places its faith in progress, technology and the deliberate shaping of human destiny. Authority is therefore treated as responsibility: those capable of protecting, building or leading are expected to use that ability in service of others. This produces both genuine heroism and a culture that can equate strength with the right to command.

The philosophy predates recorded history and became the dominant power of the Age of Men. Solmara was its original centre, where the Autarchs were regarded by the Hoshimirans as Angels, and Demons by the Sahrani. They protected Hoshimiran communities and provided support in exchange for favour and farmland, eventually reducing Hoshimira to a Solmaran vassal, while the Sahrani of the Geode were placed under direct servitude.

Autarchian power reached its height before the Shattering, which crippled Solmara's position even as the philosophy continued to spread. Over the following eras, Psycrata gained increasing control within Solmara, while Autarchianism became increasingly centred in Varkane, where Bahamut rose from Aerisu during the Shattering.

Autarch ideals remain influential wherever progress, duty, technological mastery and heroic service are treated as measures of human worth.

Related: The Primarchs, The Thanatarchs, Solmara

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The Primarchs

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Primarch, Primarchs

Order Through Progress

Autarch sect centred on nationalism, capitalism, institutional power and the organised protection of civilisation.

The Primarchs consider themselves the original form of the Autarch ideal: humanity advancing through organised power, disciplined leadership and collective ambition. They believe progress must be built, directed and protected through the structures that make civilisation function.

Their influence is expressed through governments, militaries, corporations, academies and industrial institutions. They organise economies, move resources, maintain infrastructure and ensure that the machinery of civilisation continues to operate. Their patriotism extends naturally into this philosophy, treating service to the nation and its people as both duty and proof of personal worth.

Exandria is regarded as the foremost example of Primarch society, where industrial power, corporate structures and political authority are deeply intertwined. Across the Crown Nations and wider Solmara, Primarch institutions continue to hold much of the practical machinery of governance and production.

Related: The Autarchs, Solmara

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The Thanatarchs

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Thanatarch, Thanatarchs

Live Until Nothing Remains

Autarch sect centred on bodily autonomy, augmentation, extreme experience and defiance of death.

The Thanatarchs emerged from the philosophy of Silealyros and its Market of Flesh, which treats the body as an individual's last true asset. They accept that death cannot ultimately be defeated, yet refuse to surrender to it quietly, pursuing survival through cybernetic augmentation, experimental technology and chemical stimulation.

They value control over flesh, sensation and personal destiny, pushing their bodies beyond natural limits while indulging in pleasure, violence and other extremes. Their ideal is to remain sovereign over themselves until the body can no longer continue.

Unlike the Primarchs, who build institutions for a future they expect to inherit, Thanatarchs are concerned with the life immediately in front of them. They command, consume and endure, but rarely build beyond their own horizon. They are dying rulers determined to remain standing until the last possible moment.

Related: The Autarchs, Silealyros

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The Norrvekts

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Norrvekt, Norrvekts

Humanity Together

Autarch sect centred on family, cooperation, communal responsibility and altruistic service.

The Norrvekt are the traditionalist branch of Autarchianism that developed in Norrvektstan, shaped by the cold seas and long nights of northern Solmara. They place the human purpose of Autarchianism above progress for its own sake, believing knowledge, strength and technology are valuable because they allow people to protect and provide for one another. Family, crew and community are treated as extensions of the same bond, with survival understood as a shared responsibility.

Norrvekt culture is deeply maritime. Its people are renowned sailors, navigators and shipwrights, equally comfortable aboard seaborne vessels and airships. Their reputation for seamanship, reliability and cooperation made them natural recruits for D.E.A.D., which often sought Norrvekt as its heroes. Some became renowned figures in their own right, travelling beneath capes and carrying names that passed into legend.

Heroism is therefore central to the Norrvekt ideal. They admire those who put themselves in danger for others, protect their communities without expectation of reward and use their abilities in service of people who depend upon them. Their prudence and communal discipline can make them appear conservative beside other Autarch sects, yet their strength lies in preserving the people those other traditions often claim to be building the future for.

Related: The Autarchs, Norrvektstan, Silealyros

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The Sahrani Faith

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Sahrani, Sahrani Faith

Be Worthy of the Sky

Ancient Sahrani faith centred on the Sun, responsibility, repentance, community and the hope of returning to Aokusa.

The Sahrani faith originated in Aokusa, where the people lived beneath the Scorching Sun and regarded the mountain at its heart as sacred. When the Sahrani disturbed the Fruit of the Deep, the land began to decay. The Autarchs subsequently descended upon Aokusa and drove the Sahrani from their homeland. Sahrani tradition interprets this as a consequence they brought upon themselves: they were not cast out by the Angels, they cast themselves out through their own actions.

The exiled people settled in Sahran, living within the Geode formed by the wound they had left behind. Aokusa remained across the strait, visible but inaccessible, and became the central image of their religious longing. To return, the Sahrani believe they must become worthy of the sky they once inhabited. This gives the faith a strong emphasis on repentance, responsibility, endurance and service to others, with the individual's conduct measured by what it preserves and how it affects the people around them.

The Sun represents the divine light under which humanity lives and is judged. Its presence connects the Sahrani to Aokusa and to the hope of restoration, while the memory of exile teaches that what is given can also be lost through human choice. Community is therefore essential to the faith: hardship is shared, responsibility is carried collectively and helping others is considered part of becoming worthy rather than merely an obligation imposed from above.

The broader Luminary tradition grew from these beliefs, placing particular emphasis on the Sun and the renewal of a world believed to have fallen into corruption. Over time, its interpretations diverged. The Solarii preserved the faith through worship, tradition and craftsmanship, while the Pyraeon turned its ideas of purification and renewal towards militant destruction. The Luminary tradition remains recognisably Sahrani because both branches inherit the same older ideas of light, consequence, worthiness and renewal.

Related: The Luminaries, The Pyraeon, The Solarii, The Sun

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The Luminaries

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Luminaries, Luminary

The Light Will Return

Sahrani religious tradition centred on the Sun, hope, repentance, renewal and the coming of a new age.

The Luminaries originated during the Age of Men as a rebellion within the Sahrani faith. After the Sahrani were driven from Aokusa by the Autarchs, the Luminaries rejected submission and the expectation that their people should simply endure exile and prove themselves worthy of returning. They regarded the Autarchs as demons and believed the world had become corrupted through their rule, calling for repentance and the restoration of a purer age.

The Geode Rapture and the appearance of the Crescent Sun gave their beliefs greater urgency. The altered Sun was interpreted as a sign of divine judgement, reinforcing the conviction that the world had reached a point at which something had to change. This produced the purificationist strain that eventually became the Pyraeon, who retained the older Luminary conviction that corruption must be destroyed before renewal can occur.

The Shattering transformed the tradition. The Scorching Sun became the Warm Sun, and the appearance of the Moon forced the Luminaries to reconsider what the return of light meant. Over generations, the broader tradition moved away from rebellion and destruction towards hope, renewal and the belief that darkness is something humanity can endure without surrendering its future. In the Age of Decay, Perpetual Night gave this belief renewed importance. The brief Sunday appearance of the Warm Sun became a recurring reminder that light still returns.

Modern Luminaries therefore look towards the Sun as a promise of renewal, teaching that humanity can recover from suffering, corruption and loss. Repentance remains part of the tradition, though increasingly as recognition of responsibility rather than preparation for punishment. Luminary communities preserve many of the practices and values inherited from the wider Sahrani faith, while treating the hope of another age as their defining ideal.

The name Luminary became increasingly associated with this broader and more hopeful interpretation, while the Pyraeon remained its radical purificationist offshoot. The Solarii eventually separated from the Sahrani tradition entirely, developing their own distinct theology around the Sun.

Related: The Pyraeon, The Sahrani Faith, The Solarii, The Sun

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The Pyraeon

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Pyraeon

Let the World Burn Clean

Luminary sect centred on purification, anti-modernism, destruction and militant religious extremism.

The Pyraeon are the radical branch of the Luminary tradition, emerging from its belief that the world has fallen into corruption and must be purified. Where Luminaries broadly place their faith in the Sun, repentance and the hope of renewal, the Pyraeon believe civilisation itself has become part of the corruption. Technology, industry and government are treated as extensions of the world's spiritual decay and must be destroyed rather than reformed.

For the Pyraeon, the Sun represents purification through destruction. Its fire will reduce the corruption of civilisation to ash, allowing something true to grow from what remains. They therefore wage war against the modern world, attacking the institutions and infrastructure they believe prevent humanity from returning to a more natural existence.

The Pyraeon are militant and uncompromising, willing to kill, die and destroy in pursuit of purification. Their extremism makes them feared even among other Luminaries, whose faith can encompass hope, reverence and renewal without demanding the world's destruction as their necessary price.

Related: The Luminaries, The Sahrani Faith, The Sun

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The Solarii

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Solarii

The Sun Remembers

Luminary sect centred on solar divinity, tradition, craftsmanship and spiritual isolation.

The Solarii are the monastic branch of the Luminary faith, secluded communities devoted to the Sun as a literal god. They reject modern innovation and industrial progress, holding that meaningful creation comes through human hands. Craftsmanship, art, ritual and inherited tradition are therefore treated as sacred practices through which humanity honours the Sun's gift.

Gold is central to Solarii culture, worn as jewellery and ornamentation as a reflection of sunlight and divine favour. Their rituals include daily sun-gazing, fire dances and sacred performances, particularly at dawn. Among the Solarii, healing carries similar religious significance. Lux-infused crystals such as Verdani and Mauri are regarded as expressions of the Sun's restorative power, with their use often accompanied by prayer, reverence and thanksgiving.

The Solarii consider the Moon a corrupting presence, believing its influence encourages stagnation, passivity and complacency. Their communities are consequently insular and protective of their traditions, and outsiders who attempt to impose themselves upon Solarii settlements can meet violent resistance. Atenara contains the largest concentration of Solarii, particularly around the ancient temples and shrines of Khemru and Heliadis.

Related: The Luminaries, The Sahrani Faith, The Sun, Atenara

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The Vesperites

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Vesperites, Vesperite, Vesperitism, Moon Baby, Nightstray, Gloamer, Sundrifter

In the Quiet Between

Hoshimiran faith centred on the Moon, stars, impermanence, harmony and the acceptance of life's changing cycles.

Vesperitism originated in Hoshimira as a way of living alongside the rhythms of the world. It teaches that life changes constantly and that peace comes from accepting those changes rather than trying to control them. Family, community, ritual and appreciation for ordinary moments form its practical foundation, with spiritual meaning found in how people live rather than in strict doctrine.

Before the Moon existed, this understanding was expressed through the coming of night. The setting of the Scorching Sun marked the world's brief respite from its relentless heat, giving people time for family, reflection and rest. The appearance of the Moon transformed that relationship. Its light became a gentler presence in the darkness, while the stars came to represent the vastness beyond individual lives and the continuity of the world through generations. These became central to Vesperite practice and symbolism.

The faith spread widely beyond Hoshimira because its teachings could exist alongside local customs rather than demanding their replacement. Different cultures developed their own rituals, interpretations and names while retaining the same emphasis on harmony, acceptance, impermanence and living well within one's circumstances.

Vesperitism consequently became one of Aerisu's most widespread traditions without losing its Hoshimiran character.

In the Age of Decay, Perpetual Night changed the meaning of those traditions again. The Moon and stars became the dominant celestial presence, while the brief Sunday appearance of the Sun came to interrupt the darkness Vesperites had learned to value. Luminary demands for the Sun's return therefore became increasingly opposed to Vesperite sentiment, and many Vesperites came to regard the Sunday dawn as an intrusion rather than a promise.

Vesperites are variously called Nightstrays, Gloamers and Sundrifters, though the names matter little to them. Other ideologies dismiss them as Moon Babies, a term some communities have reclaimed with amused pride.

Related: The Yorushika, The Moon, The Luminaries, Hoshimira

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The Yorushika

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Yorushika

Peace Through Action

Vesperite sect centred on active pacifism, nonviolence, humanitarian aid and resistance to war.

The Yorushika are the activist branch of Vesperitism, believing that peace requires deliberate action rather than withdrawal from conflict. They organise mass sit-ins, silent protests and civil disruption against governments and militaries, campaign for weapons dismantlement and reject industries that profit from war.

They refuse to fight even when attacked, holding that demonstrating the possibility of peace matters more than victory in any individual conflict. Their activism extends into war zones, where they smuggle civilians to safety, establish refuges and shelter refugees while disrupting military recruitment and propaganda through art, performance and public discourse.

Yorushika pacifism is therefore deliberately confrontational. They seek to undermine the structures that perpetuate violence while refusing to reproduce that violence themselves.

Related: The Vesperites, Hoshimira

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The Fenguan Faith

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Fenguan, Fenguans

Order Beneath Heaven

Fenguan faith centred on harmony, duty, ancestry, hierarchy and the responsible use of knowledge.

The Fengua faith developed from the Hoshimiran clans who settled in the storm valleys after the Shattering. It teaches that harmony depends upon people understanding their place within the wider whole and fulfilling the responsibilities attached to it. Family, community and governance therefore follow the same principle of reciprocal duty, with greater authority carrying greater responsibility.

The world itself is treated as a source of knowledge. Storms, seasons, spirits and celestial movements are observed, recorded and passed between generations so that communities can understand the forces around them and live accordingly. Susanoo, guardian of the Rift, became central to this tradition, with his storms studied through both ritual and careful observation.

This produced a culture where scholarship and governance became closely intertwined. Officials, priests, engineers and archivists each preserve different forms of knowledge, while hierarchy provides the structure through which that knowledge serves the community. Wisdom is measured through its application, particularly in

maintaining order, protecting others and preserving harmony with the world.

The faith remains deeply rooted in ancestry and continuity. Traditions, records and obligations connect each generation to those who came before, giving inherited knowledge the same importance as individual understanding.

Related: Chi, Fengua, Hoshimira

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The Psycrata

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Psycrata

Knowledge Reveals

Intellectual tradition centred on knowledge, interpretation, understanding and the control of information.

The Psycrata are scholars, researchers and interpreters who believe that understanding is the foundation of true advancement. They study the underlying structures of the world, from natural phenomena and magical principles to history, consciousness and the patterns connecting events. Their expertise in Understanding makes them exceptionally proficient with magic, though magic itself is not exclusive to them.

Psycrata influence is strongest through institutions that control knowledge and interpretation. ~~Diviner~~ Councils, academies, archives, temples and private intellectual orders preserve and regulate information, determine how discoveries are understood and decide which interpretations are accepted. Their networks allow them to shape policy and public belief without necessarily holding formal political authority.

They are especially associated with the study and containment of ~~Soul Shards~~, the ~~Separation Ritual~~ and other subjects where knowledge carries significant consequence.

Their influence has made them one of the major powers of the modern era, rivaling the ~~Autarchs~~ through information rather than industrial dominance. To know something is useful; to determine how that knowledge is understood can be power in itself.

Related: The AEvicara, The Odyraphim, The Diviners

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The AEvicara

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as AEvicara

The Pattern Persists

~~Psycrata~~ sect centred on ~~Recursion~~, obsession, memory, souls and the study of persistent ~~Echoes~~.

The AEvicara are the mystical and obsessive branch of the ~~Psycrata~~, devoted to understanding ~~Recursion~~ through the traces left by previous configurations. They study how memories, desires, behaviours and aspects of identity persist through ~~Echoes~~ and influence new souls, seeking knowledge through direct engagement with these recurring patterns.

AEvicara practitioners work closely with ~~Soul Resonance~~, using ~~Psy~~ practices such as meditation, memory transference and ~~Resonance~~ manipulation to recover and interpret persistent ~~Echoes~~. They may deliberately immerse themselves in recurring memories or patterns, attempting to understand the relationship between what remains and what has changed.

Their pursuit can become obsessive. The more deeply an AEvicara embeds themselves in recurring ~~Echoes~~, the greater the temptation to gather fragments that appear related and force them into a single pattern. Many eventually begin feeding ~~Chimericism~~ in this way, gradually entangling themselves with incompatible Resonances

and identities in pursuit of a continuity that does not truly exist.

The wider Psycrata regard the AEvicara as dogmatic and reckless, particularly when their experiments interfere with souls or attempt to reproduce recurring configurations. The AEvicara consider conventional Psycrata too detached from the phenomena they claim to understand, believing some knowledge requires direct participation rather than observation.

Related: The Psycrata, Chimericism, Chimeric Design

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The Odyraphim

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Odyraphim

The Truth Between

Psycrata network centred on hidden knowledge, independent research, information control and the unseen influence of ideas.

The Odyraphim are a loose network of scholars, researchers and power brokers connected by shared assumptions about knowledge rather than a formal doctrine or hierarchy. Their public institutions present them as an academic society studying magic, technology, celestial movements and the deeper structures of the world. Behind that public face, individual Odyraphim pursue classified research, restricted knowledge and projects considered too dangerous or politically sensitive for ordinary institutions.

They operate between scholarship and power, influencing governments, corporations, military organisations and other factions through information, research and interpretation. Some develop weapons, others suppress discoveries or preserve knowledge they believe cannot safely circulate. Their loyalties are therefore individual and transactional rather than ideological, with members willing to work across factional boundaries and sell knowledge or technology when it serves their interests.

The Odyraphim are less a unified organisation than a self-reinforcing pattern. Many members know only a fraction of the network around them, while others may arrive at the same conclusions independently and begin influencing one another without recognising the connection. Ideas, discoveries and assumptions spread through this network much like a meme, creating a collective direction without requiring central coordination.

Xeraphina Auto is one of the major powers associated with the Odyraphim. Together, they represent the more concealed side of Psycrata influence: the people who study what others cannot see, decide what knowledge should circulate and quietly build tools that may shape what comes next.

Related: The Psycrata, Xeraphina

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The Vantari

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Vantari, Nihilist, Nihilism

Death Gives Life

Vantari is the cultural and spiritual tradition of Ereboska, shaped by generations of living alongside Vanta, death, Echoes, and the remnants of the Shattering. For the Vantari, death does not sever a relationship. It changes the way that relationship continues. Their traditions therefore centre on remembrance, responsibility to the dead, the cultivation of life from death, and the recognition of lack as a condition of existence.

Vantari is not a single doctrine or organised faith. It is a way of understanding the world that permeates Ereboskan life, from Death Gardening and remembrance to the navigation of the Veins and the interpretation of spirits. Different communities and specialists emphasise different aspects of the tradition, while sharing an understanding

that the living remain connected to those who came before them.

The tradition treats Vanta as inseparable from existence. Lack creates desire, desire creates movement, and death marks the end of a life without erasing the consequences or memories that life leaves behind. The dead therefore remain present through their Echoes, their influence, their descendants, and the living things cultivated from their remains.

Death Gardening is among the clearest expressions of this understanding. The residue left by death can be cultivated into new life, allowing gardens, memorial groves, food, medicine, materials, and other forms of growth to carry something of what has passed into what comes after. Necromancy developed alongside this tradition as a means of understanding and directing death's residue.

The Gedevari are specialists within Vantari culture who devote themselves to this work, particularly Death Gardening, necromancy, ritual death, and the Veins. They preserve practical knowledge concerning the relationship between death, Resonance, growth, and the Echoes that remain.

Vantari thought also recognises the danger of allowing acceptance of death to become surrender to it. Nihilism, apathy, and the romanticisation of destruction represent a distortion of the tradition in which the void is mistaken for peace and responsibility is abandoned. The Hollowed embody this extreme. They are regarded as a tragedy and a warning of what happens when the relationship between desire, consequence, and the wider Echo chain collapses.

Because Vantari culture is closely associated with death and Vanta, outsiders frequently reduce the term to nihilism, necromancy, or death worship. The name is consequently used beyond Ereboska as a social label for people perceived as cursed, isolated, soulless, homeless, or otherwise outside conventional society. Such usage often bears little resemblance to the actual diversity of Vantari life.

The Vantari are therefore defined less by worship than by relationship: with lack, with death, with the dead, with the land, and with what remains after a life has ended. Their central question is not how to escape death, but what should be allowed to grow from it.

Related: Ereboska, The Gedevari, Death Gardening, The Hollowed, The Veins

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The Hollowed

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Hollowed, Hollowing

Into the Void

Vantari sect centred on nihilism, despair, oblivion and surrender to the Curse.

The Hollowed are the most recognisable expression of the Vantari worldview, having surrendered themselves almost completely to the Curse. They embrace Vanta as the ultimate expression of lack and desire, believing that existence leads inevitably towards dissolution and that release from the burden of being is the closest thing to salvation.

Many Hollowed become vacant, obsessive or deeply withdrawn, consumed by despair, fixation and the longing for an end. They seek states of trance and dissociation in which ordinary concerns lose meaning, treating the gradual erosion of self as a form of enlightenment. Death is welcomed as the final surrender, while further descent into Vanta is regarded as movement towards the truth they seek.

Their symbol is the void, representing the unknown, the inevitable end and the absence that waits beneath everything. Hollowed communities often gather around stronger Vantari figures who can give shape to their otherwise directionless existence, making them susceptible to manipulation and exploitation.

Related: The Vantari, The Gedevari

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The Gedevari

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Gedevari, Death Gardeners, Death Gardener

From Death, Growth

Vantari sect centred on death gardening, necromancy, Soul Resonance and the cultivation of life through death.

The Gedevari are practitioners who have learned to work with death as a source of transformation. Rooted in the Vantari traditions of Ereboska, they study the Resonance released when living things die and use it to cultivate plants, manipulate growth and interact with the lingering traces of the dead. Death Gardening became their defining discipline, while necromancy developed alongside it as another means of understanding and directing what death leaves behind.

Gedevari practice treats each death as having its own character. The condition of the dying, the life they lived and the manner of their death all influence the residue they leave behind, allowing experienced gardeners to cultivate particular plants from particular endings. This knowledge extends into ritual, medicine and commerce, with death gardens producing food, medicines and materials throughout Ereboska and beyond.

Some Gedevari provide Blossoming Death services, carefully directing a person's final Resonance into a prepared garden so their death can nourish something chosen in advance. The practice appears in hospitals, where it may serve as a final act of care, as well as among families and communities that wish to give death a continuing purpose.

Their work extends into the Veins, where accumulated death gathers around the deeper passages and the boundaries between realms. Gedevari necromancers are among the most knowledgeable practitioners of these thresholds, and their expertise has made them important guides, healers and ritual specialists.

Unlike the Hollowed, who surrender themselves to Vanta's pull, the Gedevari cultivate a relationship with it through discipline and practice. The Curse remains a constant danger, and prolonged work with death, Vanta and accumulated Resonance can gradually draw practitioners deeper into the same darkness they seek to understand.

Related: The Vantari, The Hollowed

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VantaPsy

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as VantaPsy

To Lack; To Want A Soul

Philosophy centred on lack, desire, awareness, agency, consequence and the continual formation of the soul.

VantaPsy takes its name from Vanta, meaning to lack or to want, and Psy, referring to the psyche, mind, soul and heart. Together they describe the condition from which all becoming begins: a person encounters what they lack, develops desire, and moves through the world in response to it.

The philosophy understands the soul as something formed through that movement. A person becomes through their choices, relationships, intentions and consequences, leaving Resonance and Echoes that continue into what follows. The soul therefore develops throughout life, carrying its history while changing through every new action.

VantaPsy teaches the Six Steps of Becoming: recognising lack, wanting with compassion, seeking clarity, acting with noble intent, taking responsibility for consequence, and carrying what remains with reverence. These principles describe a practice of living with awareness, directing desire rather than being consumed by it, and accepting that every choice becomes part of something larger.

VantaPsy has no final state of completion. Wholeness remains something approached through continual becoming, as each Echo enters the world and becomes part of what comes next. Meaning lies in the movement

itself, in what a person chooses to do with what they lack and what they leave behind.

Related: Vanta Concept, The Soul, Soulless

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VantaPsy Cosmology

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Cosmology, Chronology, Universe

VantaPsy's cosmology is fundamentally concerned with potential, relationship, desire, consequence, memory and becoming. They describe how the world works at every scale, from a person's soul to Aerisu itself.

The entire framework is built upon a single question: What gives a person a soul? This question extends beyond individuals to encompass systems, the world and everything within it. VantaPsy is the name for the philosophical structure that emerges from asking this question across every scale, the recognition that soul is not a possession but a pattern of becoming.

At the most fundamental level is potential. Magic is potential expressed through Resonance: the capacity inherent in a thing to become, affect, transform or connect. The magical schools of Matter, Energy, Life and Mind describe broad ways that potential manifests, while Psy deals particularly with the soul, consciousness, memory, desire and connection. An Elemental expresses a being's magical affinity, while an Affinity is the soul externalised through the Separation process. Magic therefore emerges from what something is capable of becoming and how that potential resonates with the surrounding world.

Vanta and Lux are fundamental expressions of that potential. Vanta is associated with lack, wanting, desire and transformation; Lux with connection, coherence, restoration and the bringing of things into relation. Lack creates the possibility of wanting, and wanting creates movement. The pathological expression is the Curse, where desire becomes self-consuming.

Vanta, as a substance, is the physical representation of the Curse. It forms where desire has festered without transformation, becoming mineral and memetic corruption that erodes memory, perception and the soul itself. VantaBlack is the mineral form of Vanta, desire crystallised into substance that can be mined and shaped. Soul Shards are fragments of crystallised soul resonance created through related principles, holding the Echo of the being from which they were drawn.

Everything participates in a cosmic frame, a single web of causality. A person is affected by their memories, body, upbringing, relationships and culture, while their choices alter those same structures. A society shapes its members while its members reproduce or transform the society. Ecosystems, magical systems, Spirits, planets and astronomical structures participate in the same causal architecture. Nothing is metaphysically isolated. A soul is an imprint upon this web, produced through choices, intentions and Echoes.

The soul itself is not a possession. It is a pattern of relationship, a configuration of Resonance that emerges through motion and connection. It is formed through the Six Steps of Becoming: To Truly Lack, to recognise genuine incompleteness; To Want with Compassion, to allow desire without consuming others; To Seek Clarity, to confront confusion rather than outsource understanding; To Act with Noble Intent, to let purpose govern action; To Take Responsibility, to accept the consequences of one's choices; To Echo with Reverence, to recognise that one's actions continue through others and the wider world. These steps describe how a being develops meaningful agency.

The Separation Ritual externalises the soul through the Strand, the metaphysical tether that connects body and soul, creating an Affinity that carries the person's magical essence. This is necessary because the soul's potential is too vast to be contained indefinitely by the physical form; without externalisation, the pressure of an internalised soul eventually destroys its vessel. Those for whom this process fails become Soulless, their soul remaining internal and producing Frallation, the body's gradual collapse under pressure it cannot contain, typically leading to death between eighteen and twenty-six. The Soulless Brand is a magical imprint applied to the face that siphons residual magic from the body. It functions as a small-scale Rift for tracking and harvesting. The Burn Mark is a

protective sigil designed to block tracking and prevent extraction, serving as the only known countermeasure.

Resonance is the connective mechanism. Whenever something interacts with something else, that interaction leaves a pattern. Soul Resonance is the particular pattern produced by a soul moving through the world. It allows magic to operate, memories and emotions to persist, and consequences to travel beyond their immediate cause. Resonance makes the cosmic frame perceptible. A person acts, the world responds, and some trace of that interaction remains. Electric magic is particularly attuned to detecting and tracking Resonance patterns.

Vanta Points measure this process. Vanta gathers within a person as desire presses against the walls of the soul. Soulless individuals produce VP more readily because their hearts hold desire differently, drawing Vanta inward instead of allowing it to flow naturally. As Resonance strengthens through hardship and conviction, more Vanta accumulates, while spending it strengthens the soul through the same principle by which Resonance shapes reality. Defeat scatters accumulated Vanta back into the world, allowing what burdens one life to become another's livelihood.

That trace is an Echo. An Echo is consequence that persists. It can be a memory, relationship, cultural practice, physical alteration, magical imprint, inherited behaviour, myth or influence upon another soul. Echoes keep the past causally relevant after its original event has ended. They are also why the soul is something developed rather than possessed. A person's actions continually leave and receive Echoes, gradually forming the pattern called their soul.

Memory is the substance through which Recursion operates. The world remembers through Echoes, people through experience, cultures through myth and institutions, and the Spirit Realm through its own cosmic structures. The Barrier between the material world and the Spirit Realm was woven by the Nine Spirits to prevent magic from saturating reality, yet the Rift—a wound between realms opened by the Phumenar and widened when they attempted to extract Voluntas from Veyra's crystallised womb—allows magic, Vanta, Lux and the Spirits' influence to seep through. Memory preserves identity, while attachment to memory can prevent transformation. Within the Veins, memories can be surrendered as part of the journey through deeper regions, making the relinquishment of memory a literal separation from portions of the self. At the opposite extreme, refusing to release memory can produce recursive imprisonment, where accumulated experience becomes impossible to transform.

Pixpsy embody one such condition. Their consciousness has stretched across moments, leaving them trapped between states and never fully present anywhere. They carry memory like sediment, present yet unusable, like a word resting on the tip of the tongue for years without being spoken.

The monsters of the Curse represent another expression: Recursion without transformation. They retain what they have become and cannot become otherwise. Their identities freeze around a single pattern that reproduces itself endlessly. Hollowed and Duskwalkers demonstrate related conditions at different intensities, their souls unable to release the desires or absences that defined them.

Tsukuyomi are Echoes that have found purchase in living souls. When Zuki Kusanagi's prayer for the end of the Scorching Sun fragmented her essence across Recursion, each fragment carried an aspect of what she had been. A Tsukuyomi does not choose its aspect; the aspect chooses it. The resulting soul may see, feel or perceive the world differently, carrying the sense of being watched or watching something invisible to others. The Moon's witness therefore persists through a particular configuration of Echo rather than through a separate bloodline. There is always at least one Tsukuyomi in every generation.

The Stars extend this principle beyond the world. They are Echoes of previous Recursions. The night sky is part of the world's memory, carrying evidence of configurations that preceded the present one.

This same principle explains interpretation. An Echo does not possess a single inevitable meaning. Someone interprets it, and that interpretation becomes a conviction. Conviction changes behaviour, behaviour creates consequences, and those consequences enter the causal web. Every act of interpretation therefore carries power. Through Mythwrighting, sufficiently persistent interpretations can acquire Resonance and become materially consequential.

Truth and Conviction occupy different positions within this structure. Truth concerns what is occurring within the larger reality. Conviction is what someone believes strongly enough to act upon. A conviction can be mistaken and still become causally powerful. Myths, doctrines, political ideologies and religious interpretations can consequently alter reality without becoming objectively true.

The same distinction applies to attempts to classify the soul. The Chimeric Camera can perceive genuine Resonance, yet any interpretation imposed upon what it perceives risks turning a living, developing system into a fixed definition. The same problem appears in the classification of the Soulless. A soul cannot be exhausted by the category used to describe one aspect of it.

Blood types are visible expressions of the soul's state and respond to what acts upon the body and spirit. Blood is therefore dynamic rather than fixed. Red Blood is the human baseline. White Blood arises from cold and sealed despair, absence made biological, and is inherently cursed. Black Blood forms through heat and pressure, hunger embodied, and is inherently cursed. Green Blood represents Chi integration, desire stilled through discipline. Gold Blood represents augmentation without curse. Blue Blood indicates Borenfegen origin, synthetic and built rather than grown. Purple Blood represents magical convergence and is inherently cursed. Pink Blood is hybrid and contingent. Synthetic White Blood represents engineered compliance, derived from experimentation and therefore inherently cursed.

The Borenfegens are artificial humans grown in vats and designed as vessels capable of containing extreme magical pressure. Their Blue Blood announces their origin. They were created to solve the Curse through design, yet became vectors through which the Curse could express itself in new forms. They think, feel and dream, and the Curse lives in awareness itself.

Soul Regulation manages the soul's pressure through breathing, grounding and mental visualisation. For the Soulless, regulation can slow Frallation by opening blocked pathways and channelling internal energy outward through meditation, breathwork and physical exercise. Chi takes regulation further, draining desire from the blood entirely and producing Green Blood. It grants practical abilities beyond ordinary physical limits, including sensing Resonance trails on conductive surfaces, following them through electrical magic, reinforcing bone and sinew, sharpening strikes and accelerating healing.

Psy practitioners work directly with Resonance, perceiving souls as tangible presences and navigating the psychic currents connecting living things. Psyckers use technology to bypass the discipline required for Psy magic, reading thoughts and planting suggestions through scavenged hardware. A Psycker who pushes too far becomes a Psycho, lost within their own memetic contamination.

This distinction between systems and their components is central to Chimeric Design. A person is a system composed through memories, desires, relationships, body and environment. A society is another system composed through individuals, institutions, language and history. Systems influence their components while components continually reproduce or alter the system. Chimeric Design reflects this same structure: mechanics affect narrative, characters affect systems, environments contain history, objects acquire meaning through relationships, and seemingly separate elements participate in one another.

A sufficiently coherent system can begin to become its own recursion. Its internal pattern becomes self-sustaining, increasingly independent of the systems that produced it. This is one route through which powerful beings and Spirits emerge. A Spirit is a highly coherent expression of a principle that has become capable of existing as its own system.

The Nine Spirits therefore embody fundamental principles without being the ultimate source of those principles. Creatis embodies creation and invention, Verdantia growth and renewal, Aether cosmic structure, Logaris knowledge and interpretation, Mnemotas memory, Elysia emotion, Anima mortality and the threshold of death, Justicar consequence, and Voluntas desire and becoming. Their domains are different configurations of the same cosmic structure.

Anima represents a consciousness emerging from accumulated psychic residue, formed through the experiences of dying beings. She is simultaneously an individual consciousness and an emergent structure produced by countless Echoes, demonstrating how a system can become conscious of itself.

Voluntas represents desire and becoming at the level of a Spirit.

Bahamut represents Vanta at the planetary level. Bahamut is Aerisu's own desire made manifest, the world's Vanta. It is not an independent god or creature with a singular, bounded identity. Its manifestation during the Shattering is one event within the history of a force that existed beforehand. Vanta already existed throughout Aerisu as Curse, Black Blood, fear, ideology, desire and other expressions of lack.

Fragments of Bahamut scattered across Aerisu during the Shattering. Susanoo, Hvitara, Falak and others are fragments of that planetary will, each carrying aspects of Bahamut's nature. Some became guardians through relationship and purpose; others remained hunger without direction. Their difference lies in what each fragment does with its inheritance, whether it transforms through relationship and purpose or remains trapped within the pattern of its origin.

Veyra's Womb and the Orb of Souls sit near the centre of this structure because they bring memory, identity, desire and potential together. The Orb is associated simultaneously with the dead, Soul Resonance, Veyra's crystallised womb and Voluntas's continued existence. It is a convergence point between what has been, what exists and what could become. The dead move toward it through the Veins, while the Spiral provides the structure through which that movement occurs.

The Spiral Veins are the literal manifestation of this structure. They are Aerisu's immense circulatory network, threading through the planet's bones and carrying Resonance and the dead toward the Orb of Souls. The Spiral is divided into eight concentric regions, each shaped by one of the Spirits, with seven stations between them, each embodying a stage of the journey souls must undertake.

The dead move through these regions in sequence: Verdantia's living world, Anima's mortality, Elysia's emotion, Logaris's clarity, Creatis's action, Justicar's consequence, Aether's cosmic order and Mnemotas's memory. At the heart of the Spiral, the Orb waits. The Spiral is therefore simultaneously physical and metaphysical. It is a real network beneath Aerisu, a territory through which souls travel, and a representation of the process by which existence moves through becoming.

The Spiral produces two opposing tendencies.

Asymptote of Decay describes recursive deterioration. The world repeatedly rebuilds from accumulated wounds, becoming increasingly distorted without reaching absolute chaos or complete deletion. The Spiral continually remembers itself, carrying its previous damage into what comes next.

Recursive Bloom is the regenerative possibility within the same structure. Accumulated history becomes material for adaptation, complexity, connection and new life. The difference lies in how the inherited pattern develops.

Death Gardening expresses Recursive Bloom through biology. Death leaves material and Resonant residue, which becomes nourishment for other life. Flowers can be cultivated from the remains of the dead, allowing death to enter the same recursive system as everything else. A life ends, its material becomes soil, another organism grows, and the Echo of the original life enters another form.

Blossoming Death expresses the same principle at a deeper level. An ending can become a beginning while retaining the significance of what ended. Death becomes material for continuation, and the dead remain present through what grows from them.

The Moon emerged from the encounter between Lux and Vanta during the Shattering. It embodies their convergence. Zuki's desire for an end to the destructive Sun, Lunarkos's arrival, Bahamut's manifestation and the resulting Shattering form one enormous Echo. The Moon becomes a permanent witness to that event and part of the world's memory.

The Sun expresses the question of continuation. The Scorching Sun represents continuation taken into destruction, while the Warm Sun represents continuance as care and renewal. Aerisu's major philosophies interpret this tension differently. Autarchism chooses advancement, Vantari philosophy seeks release, Vesperism accepts coexistence with the present, and the Luminaries seek radical renewal through destruction. Each interprets the same cosmological problem through a different conviction. In the modern Age of Decay, the extraction of Voluntas has caused the sun to appear only rarely, a symptom of her presence in the material world.

The Curse is the pathological expression of this entire process. Desire arises from lack, yet instead of developing through clarity, responsibility and connection, it becomes self-reinforcing. Its pattern separates itself from the wider connective structure and begins reproducing itself. This allows the Curse to propagate through awareness, thought, memory, blood and behaviour. It becomes a system whose primary recursion is its own continuation.

This also explains Chimeric beings. The accumulation of souls is an attempt to become a larger system by incorporating other systems. Such accumulation can produce immense power while leaving the components fundamentally unintegrated. Chimerism therefore becomes a distorted form of connection: accumulation without genuine relationship.

City Shields are a practical application of the same principles, barriers maintained through concentrated Resonance that protect settlements from the dangers that roam beyond their walls.

The world's metaphors express the same structure through simple physical images. A river or flowing water represents the movement of time and causality. A petal represents an individual life, beautiful and temporary within a larger living structure. Changing seasons represent Recursion, each return carrying traces of what came before while producing a different configuration. Gardens represent cultivation and pruning. Architecture represents desire crystallised into systems. Scripture represents interpretation and the power to impose meaning. Roots represent inherited patterns. Echoes represent consequence. Silence represents what remains before or after expression. The Spiral represents Recursion, while Chimeric imagery expresses the tension between isolated accumulation and genuine connection.

The entire cosmology can therefore be understood as one continuous process:

Potential allows things to become. Desire gives potential direction. Resonance carries interaction between systems. Action creates consequence. Consequence becomes Echo. Memory preserves Echo. Interpretation gives Echo meaning. Conviction turns meaning into action. Recursion carries those consequences forward. Systems inherit, reproduce and transform what came before. Recursive Bloom transforms inheritance into new possibility. Asymptote of Decay traps inheritance in increasingly damaged repetition.

The Six Steps describe how the individual soul becomes capable of participating in this process responsibly. Magic expresses potential through Resonance. Affinities and Elementals express the particular structure of a soul's potential. The Veins embody the circulation of Resonance, memory and souls. The Orb is a convergence of identity, memory, desire and potential. The Spirits are highly coherent systems expressing fundamental principles. Bahamut is that structure expressed at the scale of the world itself. Stars are Echoes expressed at the scale of previous Recursions. Death Gardening and Blossoming Death express the same process through biological transformation. The Curse is recursion becoming isolated from the wider web and reproducing itself. Chimeric Design is the same cosmological principle expressed through the structure of interconnected systems.

This is what VantaPsy means. The world, soul, magic, ecology, religion, history, psychology and aesthetics exist at different scales of the same structure: potential becoming through relationship, leaving Echoes that are remembered, interpreted and carried into Recursion, where they either become material for further growth or increasingly reproduce the conditions of their own decay. The question What gives a person a soul? is answered by the entire process: a soul is what emerges when a system participates in this structure with awareness, responsibility and the willingness to become.

Related: Age of Men, The Soul, VantaPsy, The Curse, The Grimoire, Magic, Soulless, Frallation

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Substances

Substances Overview

Age of Men · Substances · also known as Substances Overview

Tangible objects, materials, artefacts, machines and physical phenomena found within Aerisu.

Substances covers anything physical that belongs to the world without being a location, entity or living being. This includes natural and magical materials, crystals, blood types, artefacts, machines, vessels and physical manifestations such as Frallation Marks.

Related: The Golden Heart

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The Golden Heart

Age of Men · Substances · also known as Golden Heart, Fruit of the Deep

Fruit of the Deep

The Golden Heart, also known as the Fruit of the Deep, was a warm, golden formation buried deep within the mountain of Aokusa. It pulsed like a heart, sustaining the warmth of the mountain waters and influencing the crystal groves that grew above it. The Elders considered it sacred and warned against disturbing it, but the miners eventually dug into its veins. The mountain cracked open. Ice poured through its roots, the waters flooded, the bluegrass burned, and the trees withered. Aokusa, once a green and fertile land beneath the open sky, began to decay.

The Angels (Autarchs) descended soon afterwards. To the Sahrani, their arrival marked the fall of their people, and the surviving account holds that they were cast from the sky for what their ancestors had done. The people left Aokusa and crossed the strait to Sahran, where the wound of the Golden Heart became the Geode, a vast formation of crystal caverns that would become central to Sahrani life.

Related: Hoshimira, Aokusa, Sahran, The Geode

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The Sun

Age of Men · Substances · also known as Sun

Hope or Dominion

Before the Moon, Aerisu had only the Scorching Sun, a relentless blaze that never set. Its constant heat dried rivers, cracked the earth and was believed to strengthen the Curse by leaving the world no darkness or respite. This effect was worsened during the Crescent Sun phenomenon following the Geode Rapture. Solmara took its name from that fire, and the Autarchs modelled their creed of endless progress upon it.

Zuki Kusanagi prayed for the Scorching Sun to cease. Her prayer was answered when Lunarkos fell from the dark, leading to the collision that created the Moon and ended the Sun's uninterrupted dominion. The Sun thereafter rose and set, yielding the sky to night and the Moon's light, and became known as the Warm Sun.

The Warm Sun represents continuance: light returning after darkness, and tomorrow following today. It is the Sun Ash invoked when he stood at the Rift's edge and made his vow.

In the Age of Decay, Perpetual Night has reduced the Warm Sun to a brief appearance each Sunday. The Luminaries await its return and long for the Scorching Sun, believing its fire could cleanse the Curse. The Solarii regard the Warm Sun as a lesson in restraint, greeting dawn in silence and reflecting its light through gold mirrors and crystals. The Vesperites prefer the Moon's rhythm and regard the Sun's departure as release. Among the scattered Autarchs, some mourn the loss of its former power while others accept its transformation.

Even through the Vanta-saturated sky, the Sun still rises. Its persistence is what remains of its old promise: tomorrow still exists.

Related: Lunarkos, Ash Salinte, The Luminaries, The Solarii

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The Crescent Sun

Age of Men · Substances · also known as Crescent Sun

The Crescent Sun is an atmospheric phenomenon that began following the Geode Rapture, when material violently expelled from the Geode entered Aerisu's atmosphere. Vanta-saturated particulate matter altered the way sunlight travelled through the air, causing part of the Scorching Sun's disk to appear darkened or optically distorted while the remainder retained its usual brilliance. The Sun itself remained unchanged. Its light simply stopped reaching the world uniformly.

The contamination was uneven, so the phenomenon never possessed the clean geometry of an ordinary eclipse. The affected region could appear dark, discoloured, diffuse or strangely patterned, with its boundary shifting according to atmospheric conditions. In places the Sun appeared as a thin crescent; elsewhere, as though a dark smear had crossed its face. Vanta-bearing particles could absorb, scatter or refract portions of incoming light in ways ordinary dust could not, giving the affected sky its characteristic unnatural appearance.

The Geode Rapture was the immediate cause, though the responsibility reaches further back. Solmaran machinery and repeated expeditions had driven deeper into the Geode despite mounting evidence that its lower regions followed rules no one understood. The Autarchs did not create the Crescent Sun deliberately, yet their exploitation of the Geode created the conditions that allowed the Rapture to occur. What they forced underground eventually found its way into the sky.

People interpreted the phenomenon according to what they already believed. Luminaries saw a wounded or angered Scorching Sun, while Vantari regarded it as evidence that Vanta had escaped the Geode's depths. Others saw the first visible consequence of Autarch industrialisation, while scholars and engineers treated it as an atmospheric phenomenon whose unusual behaviour could be measured and studied. All of them were looking at the same sky.

The Crescent Sun became an enormous environmental echo of the Geode Rapture. Humanity reached downward in pursuit of what lay beneath the earth, and the consequence eventually reached upward. The Sun continued burning exactly as it always had. Only part of its light could reach the world.

Related: The Sun, The Luminaries, Geode Rapture

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Lunarkos

Age of Gods · Substances · also known as Lunarkos

Meteor

Lunarkos was a near-planetary body fifty-seven kilometres across, carbon-sheathed and iron-cored, yet alive in ways that defied mortal understanding. Within its crystalline heart pulsed Lux, a lattice of living light that bloomed and multiplied when it encountered soul-rich environments. It descended towards Aerisu over centuries, growing

larger in the sky until its approach became a visible countdown to the world's destruction.

Its mass alone could have shattered continents, while its Lux threatened to spread across the planet in a catastrophic wave. Civilisations responded according to their means. Some built machines to redirect it. Others studied its structure, sought escape beyond the sky, or accepted its arrival as divine judgement. The Lunartics went further, believing Lunarkos to be the fulfilment of an ancient prayer and actively preventing attempts to stop it.

Lunarkos never reached the ground. When it entered Aerisu's inner atmosphere, the planet answered from its own depths. Bahamut rose through the mantle, a being of planetary will and anguish given form, and ascended to meet it in the upper stratosphere.

Their collision became the Shattering. Lunarkos and Bahamut annihilated one another in a single eruption of soul-vanta-lux, scattering fragments across the world and into orbit. Molten shards of Lunarkos carrying Lux fell upon oceans and mountains, where they seeded crystal forests and other forms of impossible life. The surviving debris gathered into a luminous ring that circled Aerisu for centuries before drawing together into the scarred and veined Moon.

Related: Bahamut, The Shattering, The Moon, Tsukuyomi

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The Moon

Age of Fairytales · Substances · also known as Moon

Enduring Witness

The Moon is the remnant of Lunarkos and Bahamut, created when they collided in the upper stratosphere after Zuki Kusanagi's prayer brought Lunarkos to Aerisu.

Before it, Aerisu had no anchor in the sky. The Scorching Sun ruled without interruption, tides wandered, seasons drifted, and the world had no natural rhythm. Zuki, a girl from the mountain basin of Aokusa who had lost her mother to the Curse, her father to fear, and her home to a fire she had started herself, prayed only for the burning to end.

Something answered. Lunarkos, a fifty-seven-kilometre mass of carbon, iron, and crystalline Lux, appeared as a distant star and grew year by year as it approached Aerisu. The Coalition built machines to divert it, Angels entered the upper atmosphere on wings of light and steel, and the gods prepared for impact. The Lunartics instead sabotaged these efforts, believing the falling moon would cleanse a world ruined by the Scorching Sun.

When Lunarkos entered the inner atmosphere, Bahamut emerged from the planet's core, summoned by Voluntas through Anima's guidance. A being of pure Vanta and planetary will, Bahamut bore obsidian scales veined with magma and wings like continents tearing open beneath the sea. Their collision shattered both, scattering their fragments across the world before fusing them into the Moon.

Its pale surface still bears darker scars from the impact. Its light became Aerisu's primary illumination in the Age of Decay, with the sun appearing only once each week. Travellers navigate by it, farmers plant by it, and generations are born and buried beneath it.

The Moon represents the balance created by the collision: Vanta and Lux woven together, soul and matter bound across a boundary that had been torn open, with neither force allowed to rule. It also represents witness. It saw the Shattering and every age after, watching nations rise and fall without intervening, remembering what it sees.

The Vesperites regard it as proof that darkness can hold gentler light. The Luminaries curse it as a replacement for the sun they lost. The Solarii acknowledge it while gathering sunlight on rare Sundays and scattering its warmth through mirrors and crystal. The Tsukuyomi carry faint echoes of Zuki's original prayer and experience the Moon through dreams, reflections, and the sense of something patient and old watching them.

Scholars disagree over whether the Moon is simply rock and crystal obeying natural law or a presence that remembers the moment the world broke. It offers no answer. Above Sengetsuki and the crystal forests, its light falls equally on the hopeful and despairing, the living and dying, the guilty and innocent.

It remembers.

Related: Lunarkos, Tsukuyomi, Zuki Kusanagi, The Vesperites, The Luminaries

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Sacred Air

Age of Men · Substances · also known as Sacred Air

Sacred Air is a white flower that blooms only at the summit of Tenseikoku, where Eirimegami's breath is said to move through the mountain's highest currents. Pilgrims who reach the summit may receive one as a blessing, though what that blessing means is left to the pilgrim.

Its petals are cold and sharp, with a scent like cold stone after rain. Crushed into an infusion, particularly camomile tea, or worn against the skin, Sacred Air is said to help draw the Curse's taint from the afflicted, making it a common remedy sought by those who climb Tenseikoku.

In Hoshimira, the flower represents purity, healing and the bond between mortal and divine. Some regard receiving one as a sign of Eirimegami's favour, others as proof of their own perseverance, while some simply cherish it as a flower from the highest peak of Tenseikoku.

Sacred Air does not wilt easily. Even when dried, its petals retain their distinctive scent and the quiet character of the mountain where they grew.

Related: Eirimegami, Tenseikoku

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Vanta Substance

Age of Fairytales · Substances · also known as Vanta

Vanta as a Substance

In Aerisu, Vanta manifests as a tangible, corrosive force: a memetic, parasitic and elemental substance that erodes memory, perception and the soul. Blackened blood, corrupted stone, altered wildlife and anomalous signals mark its presence, while exposure can spread its influence through minds and matter, warping reality and distorting thought.

Vanta exists at the intersection of the metaphysical and material. It is the substance of the Curse and the physical expression of soul hunger, giving form to the void at the root of Vanta: the absence that drives desire and, when left unchecked, becomes a living and contagious force.

Related: Vanta Concept, VantaBlack, Physical Curse

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Blood Types

Age of Knowledge · Substances · also known as Black Blood, White Blood, Synthetic White, Snyth Blood, Gold Blood, Purple Blood, Pink Blood, Blue Blood, Green Blood

Blood in Aerisu responds to what acts upon it. Desire, absence, discipline, augmentation, magic and artificial construction can all alter its properties, producing distinct blood types. The system begins with Red as the human baseline, from which other states emerge through different forms of alteration.

The chart is divided broadly between Lack and Want, represented by White and Black, and between organic alteration and constructed states. Some transitions are natural or gradual, while others require deliberate intervention.

Red Blood, the Human Baseline

Red blood is the ordinary human state. It carries oxygen, clots predictably and can be stored or transfused without unusual behaviour. It has no inherent alteration, although it can transition into other blood types through external influence.

Red can become White through cursed lack, Black through cursed want, Green through chi meditation, Gold through augmentation, Purple through magical saturation, or Pink through cross-breeding with Blue. It cannot transition directly to Blue. Synthetic blood must be deliberately constructed.

White Blood, Cursed Lack

White blood develops through cold, isolation and profound despair, when the Curse manifests as absence. It is cold, withdrawn and largely inert until disturbed.

When White Blood contacts water, it expands and clings to surfaces, producing slow corrosion. Sudden heat can cause it to burst violently. It is difficult to remove once it has adhered to something.

Those who carry White Blood tend towards withdrawal and stagnation. Some remain physically present while their awareness becomes trapped in night terrors or inward collapse. White can develop naturally from Red through cursed lack or be reproduced artificially as Synthetic White Blood.

Black Blood, Cursed Want

Black blood develops through heat, pressure and intense desire, when the Curse manifests as hunger. It is acidic and highly corrosive, burning through surfaces wherever it spills.

Its carriers tend towards rage, violence and sharpened senses as desire intensifies. Black Blood is inherently cursed and can develop from Red or other blood types through cursed saturation.

White and Black form a continuous spectrum of cursed lack and want. Temperature and internal temperament influence the exact properties of either type, so individual samples can vary considerably.

Green Blood, Chi Integration

Green blood develops through prolonged chi meditation and represents deliberate regulation of desire. It is found among monks of Fengua who have mastered Chi integration, using meditation, breath control and disciplined acceptance to suppress wanting.

Green blood ranges from pale leaf-green to deep forest shades according to the monk's level of cultivation. It is not inherently cursed. If the discipline that produced it fails and cursed want takes hold, Green can transition towards Black. It can also become Gold through augmentation.

Gold Blood, Augmented Enhancement

Gold blood develops when extensive augmentation alters the body's chemistry. Metallic threads run through it, producing shades resembling brass, bronze or gold according to the quality of the modifications.

The blood itself remains otherwise functional, although its appearance reveals the extent to which the body has been altered. Gold is not inherently cursed. Augmentation is permanent, so Gold cannot naturally return to Red. It can, however, be driven towards Black through the Curse.

Blue Blood, Borenfegen Blood

Blue blood is the defining blood type of Borenfegens, artificial humans grown in Silealyros vats. It carries a deep blue colour and otherwise flows according to the basic mechanics of human blood. Once extracted, it gradually fades towards grey as it dies.

Blue blood is not inherently cursed. Borenfegens are constructed using Synthetic White Blood as part of their creation process, and Blue can transition towards Synthetic White through saturation. It cannot arise naturally from Red.

Synthetic White Blood, Engineered Lack

Synthetic White Blood, also called Synth Blood, was developed by Zephyr of Sahran from the properties of natural White Blood. He engineered its stillness, adhesion and consumption into a substance that could be administered, measured and reproduced without the unpredictability of its natural counterpart.

Synth Blood is watery and translucent, with a faint shimmer. It does not expand, cling or burst under heat like natural White Blood. Once introduced into the body, it quietly suppresses desire and volition. The afflicted remain physically functional and mentally coherent, capable of following instructions and maintaining routines, while gradually losing the impulse to initiate or resist.

Zephyr described it as a stabilisation agent for controlling Cursed subjects, and it was administered to adults and children in the facilities beneath Elysium and in Isvara, with doses calibrated to body weight and desired compliance. Synthetic White Blood is inherently cursed and is also used in the construction of Borenfegens. Too much can leave the body inert; too little can leave a Borenfegen unstable.

Pink Blood, Hybrid Blood

Pink blood most commonly develops when a Borenfegen and a red-blooded human conceive a child, combining the artificial Blue lineage with the human Red baseline. It is pale, translucent and may show a faint luminescence, while retaining characteristics of both types.

Those born with Pink Blood can have unusual soul characteristics, including a more flexible Strand or a partially translucent or shifting Affinity after the Separation Ritual. Pink can also arise temporarily through certain forms of magical saturation or alchemical exposure.

Some Pink-blooded individuals are cursed and others are not. Pink can move towards Purple through magical or cursed saturation and can approach Red or Blue without directly becoming either.

Purple Blood, Magical Saturation

Purple blood results when magic saturates the body beyond ordinary limits. Its colour ranges from pale lavender to deep violet, while its consistency can vary from thin and watery to thick and syrup-like.

Vantari death gardeners may develop Purple Blood through prolonged exposure to Vanta-rich soil, while some of the undead who continue walking after death also bleed purple. The Diviners regard it as a warning sign of magical saturation, although its presence alone does not establish the severity of the Curse.

Purple blood is inherently cursed. It can develop from Red, Pink or other states through magical or cursed saturation, and can progress towards Black under further corruption.

Classification

Inherently cursed: White, Black, Purple and Synthetic White.

Not inherently cursed: Red, Blue, Green and Gold. These may still be altered or corrupted by the Curse.

Contingent: Pink. Its condition depends on its lineage and the circumstances that produced it.

Related: Chi, Zephyr, The Borenfegens, The Curse

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Frallation Marks

Age of Knowledge · Substances · also known as Frallation Mark, Curse Mark, Black Mark

The Frallation Mark System

Frallation marks express how prolonged pressure manifests through the body and mind. The body may shape that pressure into root structures, while the mind may shape it into script. Either can appear alone, or both can develop together.

Root structures form when pressure settles into the body's physical pathways. They follow the architecture of the flesh, tracing tendons, ribs, spine and jaw as branching lines that resemble veins, fractures or embedded roots. Raised or sunken like scar tissue, they distribute pressure through the body, allowing it to endure the strain for longer. Individuals with predominantly root-based marks tend to retain a coherent sense of self while experiencing increasing physical strain, fatigue and eventual collapse.

Script forms when pressure gathers through thought and perception. It appears as thin, irregular traces across the skin, often in fragments and clusters resembling partial symbols or interrupted lines. The markings may layer over time, accumulating where multiple formations occupy the same space. Script reflects cognitive and memetic disturbance, with its progression affecting memory, identity and behaviour while producing less physical adaptation.

When both develop, the roots provide physical structure while the script accumulates meaning. Script may follow the paths of the roots or cross them without regard for anatomy, sometimes gathering around areas of emotional or cognitive weight. Its density and distribution vary between individuals, reflecting how each person processes and carries internal pressure rather than following a fixed pattern.

From a distance, root structures define the body's silhouette, while script reveals itself through closer inspection. Together they create a marking system in which physical strain and cognitive disturbance leave distinct, overlapping records of Frallation.

Related: Frallation, Soulless, Performed Frall Marks

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Performed Frall Marks

Age of Knowledge · Substances · also known as Performed Frallation Marks

Performing Decay

The visibility of Frallation has led some to reproduce its appearance deliberately through skin marking. Some use thick, branching tattoos that follow anatomical lines and echo root structures, while others use thin, fragmented markings resembling script. Root tattoos tend towards clarity and symmetry; script designs favour irregularity and layered forms that suggest something still taking shape.

Motivations vary. Some wear them to embody intensity or a perceived connection to something deeper within themselves. Others feel an affinity with Frallation or believe the marks reveal something already present in them, making the act of marking a form of acknowledgement.

Those with true Frallation recognise the difference. Its marks continue to change over time, gaining density in some places and thinning in others, while performed marks remain fixed from the moment they are made. The distinction is often apparent only at close range, quietly shaping how the condition is perceived.

Related: Frallation Marks, Frallation, Soulless

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The Soulless Brand

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Soulless Brand, The Brand, The Burn Mark

The Soulless Brand

The Diviners of the Crown Nations developed the Soulless Brand to monitor and control those who fail the Separation Ritual. Applied to the face as a magical imprint, the Brand marks the afflicted and siphons residual magic from their bodies. It functions as a small-scale Rift, allowing the Diviners to track its bearer while harvesting magical energy that would otherwise accumulate towards death. Most Soulless conceal the Brand with makeup, hiding a mark that has become widely feared.

The Burn Mark

In response to the Brand's invasive effects, certain Diviners developed the Burn Mark as a protective sigil. Applied over or near the Brand, it is intended to block tracking and prevent the extraction of magic. Its effectiveness remains uncertain, leaving it as the only known countermeasure to the Brand's intrusion and a symbol of resistance against a system built to catalogue and control the Soulless.

Related: The Diviners, Soulless, Frallation

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Vanta Points

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Vp

Vanta Points, usually shortened to VP, measure the Vanta that gathers within a person as desire presses against the walls of the Soul. Hope held too tightly, unresolved fear and lingering promises leave traces that the world quietly collects. Most people shed these traces without noticing, while Soulless produce VP more readily because their Souls draw Vanta inward rather than allowing it to flow naturally. The same pressure that hastens Frallation can therefore become another person's livelihood.

VP became a form of currency alongside ordinary money. Merchants trade in it, Diviners measure it, researchers chart it, and Shard vendors accept it. Desire acquired purchasing power.

VP is closely tied to Soul Resonance. As resonance strengthens through hardship, conviction, understanding and perseverance, the Soul presses more strongly against the Vanta gathered within, generating further VP. Practitioners can spend VP to strengthen themselves, gaining greater resilience, sharper instincts and stronger Affinities. The process is intuitive, as though accumulated desire settles into the Soul and reshapes it from within.

VP can also be lost. Defeat, despair and the collapse of purpose weaken Soul Resonance, allowing accumulated Vanta to scatter back into the world. The result is often experienced as a lingering emptiness, a sense that something once held within has slipped away. A lost battle, abandoned ambition or broken spirit therefore carries a measurable cost.

That exchange gives VP its peculiar place in Aerisu. Courage, perseverance and desire can accumulate as something measurable, something that can be exchanged for bread, medicine or a polished shard on a merchant's shelf. People simply learned to mint value from what they carried inside themselves.

Every Vanta Point is a fragment of desire suspended between Psyn and Vu~etsu, between the human Soul and the ideals it strives towards.

Related: Currency of Sengetsuki, Soulless, Soul Resonance

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The Vireliax

Age of Men · Substances · also known as The Vireliax

Semi-submersible Dreadnought of The Ocean Maw

They call the Vireliax a legend of the Vaelmiric seas, one of the last Norrvektstan seaborne dreadnoughts to survive the Vaelmiric War. She is a feat of military engineering pressed into a single shape, built to endure depths

and storms that would destroy lesser ships.

Her black hull stretches more than a hundred metres and rises six decks, four below the waterline. Alchemical veins glow faintly along its surface, while quake-tempered obsidian reinforced with kyrite gives the hull a semi-submersible frame capable of withstanding abyssal pressure. A triple keel keeps her steady in seas where storms would tear lesser ships apart.

Her command bridge is sparse and dim, combining analogue instrumentation with the gem-based interfaces common to modern engineering, crewed by Norrvekts. Mid-decks hold social halls and messes where the crew can eat and rest between voyages. Lower levels contain quarters, archives and engines worked and maintained by Sahrani labourers. The lowest deck carries submersibles designed to descend into trenches the sea itself seems reluctant to acknowledge. There are rooms absent from every manifest: experimental chambers, data vaults and spaces left over from expeditions whose records were never made public. Despite her age, the Vireliax has survived seven deep-sea voyages through the Maw storms, a record no modern vessel has matched. She still stands at the edge of human ambition, staring into the abyss.

Related: Vaelmir, Vireliax Expedition

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Shorin no Okami

Age of Men · Substances · also known as Sh■rin no ■kami

Shorin no Okami still stands in Aokusa, where the Autarchs built it to guard the basin, its terraces, and the people living between the mountains and the sky. When the Angels were recalled and Solmaran authority shifted into new political forms, the mech was left behind. No retrieval order survives in any archive, so whether it was forgotten or deliberately abandoned remains unknown.

Over the centuries, vines climbed its plating and doves settled between its joints. During the Festival of Bloom, children carry flowers and small offerings to its feet, while lanterns are hung from the vines. By nightfall, the mech stands among the lights as music and dancing continue around it.

The festival is also when stories of Shorin no Okami surface. Girls most often, though not exclusively, who stare too long into a lantern flame near the mech sometimes find themselves elsewhere, witnessing battles in unfamiliar terrain. They describe sounds that linger after the vision ends, and some accounts are so consistent across generations that they appear to depict the same events: moments of catastrophic contact witnessed from close to the ground.

Whether these visions are memories preserved within the machine, echoes of what it was built to withstand, or glimpses of what is yet to come remains unresolved. The offerings continue regardless. Whatever Shorin no Okami contains, generations of people have chosen to stand beneath it with a small light in their hands and look up. After enough centuries, perhaps that is how something earns its name.

Related: Aokusa, Angels Reformed

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Ik-Rasul

Age of Men · Substances · also known as Ik-Rasul

I Am The Apostle

The Ik-Rasul is an aircraft of disputed origin. Solmaran and Hoshimiran reports describe it as a Sahrani weapon, constructed in secret and deliberately launched towards Aokusa, while no surviving Sahrani record acknowledges its existence, names its builder, or documents its construction.

What remains certain is the wreckage. Fire Gems were still burning inside the engine casing when it came down, while shattered Ankaru crystals scattered across the Aokusa fields, their cold bleeding into the soil. The frame was assembled from mech parts of different eras and origins, fitted together with enough patience to suggest years of work. The old Autarch structures in the upper Geode, including abandoned administrative tiers, scaffolding and cavities left from their first occupation, could have provided the space and concealment such a project required.

Certain Sahrani communities preserve a different account, told quietly and with varying details, concerning a boy and his father who attempted to fly back to Aokusa. The destination remains consistent: the mountain from which their people had been separated for generations. They called their aircraft the Ik-Rasul, an old-tongue name meaning something close to "I am the Apostle", carrying connotations of devotion, pilgrimage or arrogance depending on the listener.

The sun reached the engines before they reached the mountain, and the aircraft came down in the fields it was trying to reach. Whether the Ik-Rasul was a weapon, an act of pilgrimage, or something between the two remains unknown. The Ankaru's cold still lingers in the fields, and the aquifers remember whatever entered them afterwards. The Geode has offered no answer.

Related: Ik-Rasul Incident, Aokusa, The Geode

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Thunder Cannon

Age of Magic · Substances · also known as Leiting pao

Fengua's Thunder Cannon, Leiting pao, was the culmination of generations spent studying and harnessing the storms shaped by Susanoo's presence. Raikami crystals formed where his essence struck mineral veins, while Fenguan engineers developed alchemical and scientific methods to refine that divine force into usable power.

The weapon was conceived as a response to the growing threat of Voluntas beneath New Elysium. As the Curse spread and Vanta deepened, the Council and its generals concluded that the Orb of Souls was the source of the world's suffering. Their solution was a weapon capable of striking it from across the continent.

The cannon combined Raikami crystals gathered over centuries with alchemical condensers that concentrated ambient Vanta and targeting arrays calibrated through decades of studying Susanoo's lightning patterns. The engineers believed they were redirecting an ancient force towards a necessary end. Years of debate followed, with the Council weighing the catastrophe of striking the heart of the world's magic against the deaths that would continue if Voluntas survived. They ultimately chose the weapon.

When the Luminaries reached the Orb and the Ashtar closed in, the Thunder Cannon fired. Its first blast tore through stone, crystal and divine flesh. Susanoo rose to intercept it, and before a second shot could reach its target, Anqa descended from the sky and broke the cannon.

The destruction divided Fengua's response. Northern provinces turned towards grief, building shrines at lightning-strike sites and waiting for Susanoo's return. Southern provinces salvaged the wreckage and refined its designs for future wars. Monks instead withdrew into the high valleys, studying Chi through meditation and breath, seeking balance rather than greater power.

In time, Fengua came to understand that the Thunder Cannon had been aimed at the wrong target. The weapon was built to destroy an external enemy, while the deeper struggle had always been within.

Related: Fengua, Susanoo, Orb of Souls

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City Shields

Age of Magic · Substances

City Shields

Across Aerisu, cities maintain barriers against the beasts, Vanta-corrupted creatures, wandering Cursed and other monsters that emerged after the Shattering. Their methods vary according to regional resources.

Some cities sustain magical barriers through priests who meditate in temples positioned at cardinal points. Their consciousness remains focused on maintaining the shield, with generations of monks trained to ensure continuous coverage. If every priest's meditation is interrupted simultaneously, the shield fails, so these cities build redundancy into their rotations.

Others rely on technological barriers powered by Lux batteries or crystallised energy harvested from the Veins. Machines maintain these shields continuously while engineers monitor generators and replace worn components. They cannot adapt to emerging threats as readily as magical barriers, but require no constant magical concentration or generations of specialised training.

Smaller towns may entrust their protection to a single powerful soul who maintains the shield alone. The barrier lasts only as long as its bearer can sustain it, collapsing if they sleep, tire or die. Such towns therefore depend entirely on the person whose strength protects them.

These shields form the boundary between civilisation and the wild, allowing people to live behind walls while dangers gather beyond them. Every method carries the same condition: protection lasts only while something continues to sustain it.

Related: The Diviners

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The Nightjar

Age of Knowledge · Substances

The Nightjar was an Exandrian airship owned through ESIG and operated under contract with the Daedalus Expeditionary Agency for Deployment. It was piloted by Cosmo Mirosi, who flew it during Jenova's expedition in search of the Orb of Souls.

The Nightjar carried the expedition through the Veins and into the Spirit Realm. After Jenova extracted Voluntas from Veyra's Womb, Hvitara pursued the expedition back towards the material world, striking the ship and causing critical damage.

The Nightjar crashed into Sengetsuki, scattering its survivors and debris across the industrial district. The crash site later became the location of Nightjar Home, the orphanage founded by Cosmo Mirosi.

Related: Cosmo Mirosi, D.E.A.D, Nightjar Home, Jenova's Expedition

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Dreagbann

Age of Fairytales · Substances · also known as Dreagbann

Dréagbann is a Spirit-bane blade forged for King Draco to kill Lady Draka after her transformation into the first Draken.

The weapon was made from Lux-touched metals and crystal-infused stone taken from the ruins of Elysium. Its steel was quenched in Elysium's streams and blessed by priests.

Dréagbann pierced Draka's heart and ended her transformation. Afterward, Draco carried the blade to Lupellyn and cast it into the in-land ocean, unwilling to keep a weapon created for such a purpose.

The blade remained submerged for centuries before resurfacing when it was needed again.

Related: Fengua, Susanoo, Orb of Souls

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Gunblades

Age of Magic · Substances · also known as Gunblade

Gunblades are precision weapons developed for the Samurai, combining a rifle and full-length blade within a single mechanical frame. A reinforced hinge at the blade root allows the weapon to lock between two configurations: in rifle mode, the folded blade becomes part of the upper assembly and the weapon functions as a balanced firearm; in blade mode, the edge locks forward while the firearm mechanism rests along the hilt or lower guard.

The transformation is mechanical rather than magical, producing a distinct sequence of movement and a characteristic metallic clunk as the mechanism locks into place. Its hinge and gear assemblies require regular cleaning, lubrication and adjustment, and Samurai are trained to maintain their own weapons. Gunblades are produced in balanced standard forms as well as heavier, lighter and individually modified configurations, though the principle remains the same: one weapon adapting between ranged and close combat.

Inspiration: Transforming weapons and Japanese sword traditions, combined with the industrial precision of Hoshimiran military technology.

Related: The Samurai, Hoshimira, Harumori, The Autarchs

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The Grimoire

Age of Magic · Substances · also known as Doctrine of Becoming, VantaPsy Doctrine

Doctrine of Becoming

Fragments of an ancient text were uncovered among the Phumenar ruins. Known as Veyra Megami's Doctrine of Becoming, the Grimoire survived the Vanta Explosion in crystallised form, preserved where much else was destroyed.

The Grimoire contains no spells. It presents a philosophical framework for the relationship between Soul, Desire, Responsibility and Reality, expressed through the Six Steps of Humanity, a progression through which every soul moves towards wholeness.

To Truly Lack. A soul recognises its incompleteness without shame, perceiving absence clearly without allowing it to define its worth. The first station of the Spiral Veins holds this mirror, revealing what is truly missing.

To Want with Compassion. Desire arises without consumption, learning to build and nurture rather than destroy. The second station tests this through a marketplace where souls must refuse what they crave for the sake of those around them.

To Seek Clarity within Both Noise and Fog. Truth must be found amid confusion. The third station surrounds the soul in fog, demanding discovery without external guidance.

To Act or To Not Act with Noble Intent. Choice must arise from purpose rather than impulse, with restraint where action would cause harm and action where stillness would fail. The fourth station reveals every consequence and demands ownership of what has already occurred.

To Take Proper Responsibility for Your Actions or the Actions of Your Consequences. Every choice produces consequences that spread beyond the one who made it. The fifth station forms a labyrinth of mirrors, reflecting everyone affected by those choices.

To Echo with Reverence. Every decision resonates through time, becoming an Echo that continues through others and the wider world. The sixth station opens into vast silence, where souls must create something enduring that carries their existence forward.

The Grimoire became a major philosophical touchstone during the Age of Magic. Psycrata scholars study it as a map of soul mechanics, Hoshimiran priests find confirmation of established practices, and Fengua's ordered society sees validation of disciplined restraint. The Luminaries later drew upon it to frame desire as the root of corruption and a force that must be quelled to preserve purity.

Its interpretations continue to diverge, while the core text endures as a guide to the Soul, the nature of magic and the responsibility that accompanies power.

Related: Six Steps of Becoming, VantaPsy, Veyra Megami, The Phumenar, The Spiral

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Currency of Sengetsuki

Age of Knowledge · Substances · also known as Psyn, Sen, Vu~etsu, Vuetsu, Vu etsu, Vu-etsu, Money

The Mechanics of Exchange

Most of Sengetsuki counts its money in Sen, coins of dark iron wrapped around polished silver. Each denomination bears the Moon in a different phase, from a narrow crescent on the smallest coins to the scarred face of the Moon on the largest. Their reverses depict the city's streets and railways, pressing Sengetsuki itself into every exchange.

Before the Sen became the common measure of value, Sengetsuki traded in Psyn and Vu~etsu, currencies whose denominations followed the Spiral Journey. Their values rose with each stage, turning the progression of a soul into a system of exchange.

The Psyn (p) were warm copper-alloy coins that gradually developed violet and green patina. Their denominations followed the first six stages of the Journey:

1 Psyn bore the leaf of Verdantia, where journeys first touched the soil. 2 Psyn carried Anima's threshold, where breath entered waiting flesh. 5 Psyn bore Elysia's split mask, reflecting the heart's capacity for joy and grief. 10 Psyn carried the open book of Logaris, where thought reached towards clarity. 20 Psyn bore Creatis's gear, celebrating imagination given physical form. 50 Psyn carried Justicar's scales, where choices found their consequences and every life its weight.

Beyond them were the Vu~etsu (v). One hundred Psyn equalled one Vu~etsu, and the metal changed to dense white bronze, brighter and heavier than copper.

1 Vu~etsu, worth 100 Psyn, bore the spiral of Aether, the frame that cradled the universe. 2 Vu~etsu, worth 200 Psyn, carried Mnemotas's chained hourglass, gathering every passing age into memory. 5 Vu~etsu, worth 500 Psyn, bore the rising flame of Voluntas, the summit of the Spiral Journey where desire became motion and will reached beyond history.

Old Psyn and Vu~etsu still circulate occasionally among collectors, preserved in wooden boxes, forgotten drawers and small shops. Their continued presence leaves an older idea of value embedded within Sengetsuki's modern currency: the Spiral Journey never entirely disappeared from people's hands. They simply changed the metal.

Sengetsuki's modern currency is the Sen, while older Psyn and Vu~etsu followed the stages of the Spiral Journey, with surviving coins still carrying its symbols.

Related: Sengetsuki, Vanta Points

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Chimeric Camera

Age of Knowledge · Substances

Among the relics scavenged from previous ages, few gained as much notoriety in the Crown Nations as the Chimeric Camera, an artefact said to reveal and steal a person's true nature. Its origin remains unknown. Some

scholars believe it was developed during the early Age of Knowledge as an attempt at soul-photography using Vanta-corrupted optics. Others attribute it to the Phumenar, suggesting it may have been used to study the Orb of Souls before the First Separation. A smaller tradition claims that one of the Nine Gods created it to catalogue human essence for purposes beyond mortal understanding.

The Camera does not capture an image of its subject. It extracts the soul and imprints it onto a crystalline plate. What appears upon the plate is an abstract representation of essence, desire, sin and potential, rendered through patterns of light and shadow that convey personality with uncanny fidelity. A corrupt merchant might appear in crimson and gold, ambition threaded through rage. A scholar consumed by obsession might produce fractured blue geometry. A child's plate may shine with pure white light, interpreted as innocence or emptiness depending on the observer.

The plates can be studied, manipulated or consumed through rituals known only to those who have learned their use. The extraction leaves the subject diminished, with aspects of their essence transferred to the plate. Repeated exposure can result in soul fracture, a condition in which the body continues to function while the self that once animated it has been progressively stripped away. Such victims may continue breathing, walking and performing familiar routines, yet possess little of the person they once were.

Related: Soul Killer Case, The Frame, Vanta Substance, Sengetsuki, Ethevar, Age of Knowledge, Age of Decay

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The Frame

Age of Knowledge · Substances · also known as Hidden Gallery

The Gallery of Stolen Souls. Hidden gallery operated by Ethevar Liss in a converted warehouse on Sengetsuki's industrial waterfront, displaying soul-captures produced by the Chimeric Camera as art.

The captures were mounted in crystal cases and illuminated beneath carefully positioned lamps, each accompanied by a placard detailing the subject's crimes and the date of extraction. Wealthy patrons paid admission to view the stolen essences of the guilty as aesthetic objects.

The Frame became one of Ethevar's most infamous collections, turning the Camera's victims into objects of fascination for those willing to pay to see them.

Related: Soul Killer Case, Chimeric Camera, Vanta Substance, Sengetsuki, Ethevar, Age of Knowledge, Age of Decay

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Wish Bottle

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Wish Bottle Shrine

Wish bottles stand in quiet corners of Sengetsuki, where travellers rest and the city holds its breath. Each is large and embroidered with threads that catch the dim light, with a purple flame burning within, steady and eternal. Beside the bottle rests a small pillow for kneeling, a low table with parchment and a writing brush, and a single flower that never wilts.

The ritual is simple. One kneels before the bottle and writes their current state upon a strip of parchment. It is a record of the present: the worry pressing on the chest, the confusion that will not settle, or the small joy one is afraid to name. The parchment is rolled and placed inside the bottle, where the purple flame consumes it instantly. The smoke rises, carrying something away, leaving the writer lighter.

The moment is believed to be preserved through the attention of the gods. Elysia, goddess of emotion and the human psyche, hears what is written and pleads with Mnemotas, god of memory, and Aether, goddess of the cosmic frame, to keep the writer within their records. Their Echo is woven into the fabric of the Loop, allowing something of them to remain even when the Folding resets.

Some say Voluntas listens as well. Still unborn within her crystal womb, the goddess of will and desire is said to reach through the flame and briefly strip away a person's wanting. Hunger, longing and restlessness fall silent, leaving a moment of perfect clarity. The calm soon passes, and desire returns. Those who use the bottles believe the memory of that brief freedom remains with them.

Related: Echoes, Sengetsuki

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Soul Shards

Age of Fairytales · Substances · also known as Soul Shards, Heart Crystals

Soul Shards are fragments of crystallised soul resonance, or echoes, physical remnants of consciousness frozen into mineral form. They were first created through Zephyr's experiments on the Cursed and children, when they were known as Heart Crystals. The process extracted and concentrated soul essence through alchemical apparatus before cooling it into crystal, producing small, warm fragments in which light moves and resonance remains active.

Soul Shards became widely used as magic foci, reservoirs of concentrated will, prisons for consciousness, and components in the creation of Borenfegens, among other applications. Using one draws upon the essence within it, making Soul Shards an exceptionally efficient source of magical power. Their trade flourishes across Aerisu.

The name Heart Crystal eventually gave way to Soul Shard, reflecting their nature as fragments broken from a larger soul. The most dangerous shards are made from the truly Cursed, whose corrupted resonance can spread memetic contagion through those who handle them.

The flame Veyra lit in the sewers of Elysium, which still burns, was fed by a fragment of Maura's Soul Shard. The first spell cast on Aerisu was cast through a child's compressed soul.

Related: Soul Capturing, The Diviners

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Verdani

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Verdani, Heal Shard, Heal Stone, Heal Gem, Heal Crystal

Heal Crystals

Verdani is a restorative crystalline material refined in Atenara from crystallised herbal distillates and mineral binders drawn from the fertile floodplains of Kushara and the island gardens of Heliadis. Its ocean-green crystal is cool to the touch and carries a faint scent of mint, jasmine and sun-warmed leaves.

Verdani's restorative properties come from the interaction between its herbal compounds, mineral structure and Lux infusion. When activated, it releases a gentle restorative charge that supports the body's own recovery, making it effective against wounds, exhaustion, shock and deeper tissue damage without placing additional strain on the body.

The concentration of Lux and the density of the crystal determine how much energy Verdani can hold and how quickly it releases it. Less concentrated pieces are common in Solarii temples, coastal clinics, civilian first-aid kits and expedition supplies, while heavily refined crystals are reserved for severe injuries and sanctioned medical or rescue work. The most concentrated forms require regulated Lux infusion in the shrines of Heliadis, and their production and distribution are tightly licensed by the authorities responsible for Lux use.

Verdani is valued precisely because its healing effect remains gradual and compatible with natural recovery. Rather than forcing the body into immediate reconstruction, it provides the energy required for damaged tissue to stabilise and repair itself, making it one of the most widely trusted restorative materials in Atenara.

Related: Raikami, Mauri, Atenara

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Mauri

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Mauri, Revive Stone, Revive Gem, Revive Crystal

Revive Crystals

Mauri is a rare crystalline material refined for the restoration of consciousness, designed to pull an unconscious person back from the narrow threshold between the body and separation. In Atenara, the crystal is called Mauri, meaning "life-force made tangible". Its activation produces a sharp taste of copper, salt and sun-warmed stone, grounding the user in sensation before awareness returns.

The concentration and stability of Mauri determine how many people it can affect and how reliably consciousness can be restored. Less concentrated crystals are used to revive individual people, while the rarest Lux-stabilised forms can recall multiple unconscious people at once. These crystals produce no immediate pain during activation, although many survivors report feeling a deep internal pulse for days afterwards, like a slow echo through the blood, which Atenaran tradition associates with the first light after the longest night.

Mauri is treated as an act of intervention rather than ordinary medical treatment, and its use carries considerable weight among the Solarii. The most concentrated forms are theoretically reusable, although almost no one survives needing more than one in a lifetime. Their use remains controversial, and Solarii priests approach each revival with the reverence of a returning dawn, often accompanied by consequence and thanksgiving.

Related: Verdani, Lux Crystals, Atenara

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Naru

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Naru, Fire Shard, Fire Stone, Fire Gem, Fire Crystal

Fire Crystals

Naru is a geothermal crystalline material extracted from the Geode in Tayran, where extreme geothermal pressure fractures mineral veins into volatile fragments. It remains warm at rest and can produce a short controlled flare through soul-resonance or mechanical ignition.

The concentration and stability of Naru determine the scale and control of its thermal discharge. Less concentrated crystals are used as expendable ignition tools by Varkanian troops, industrial workers and civilian defence cadres, while more stable forms release accumulated thermal energy in a broad surge and became standard Autarch ordnance. The most concentrated crystals form in the deepest accessible Geode tiers, where extreme heat and pressure reshape the mineral structure. Sealed, they radiate oppressive warmth and require containment to prevent premature detonation; activated, they produce concentrated infernos capable of collapsing fortifications, melting armour and permanently scarring terrain.

During the Age of Men, Sahrani labourers mined Naru under Solmaran Autarch occupation and economic exploitation. The Geode Rebellion allowed Sahrani communities in Tayran to reclaim partial sovereignty, although trade agreements, debt and political leverage enabled the displaced Autarchs in Varkane to retain influence. Modern Tayran trades Naru to Varkane under these constraints, while the Panjara-Najmara accord regulates the deployment of its most destructive forms. Zaristan has remained silent during negotiations while legal loopholes, grey markets and covert arrangements have enabled sales to Varkane.

Naru remains both an essential industrial material and a symbol of the political control surrounding Tayran's resources.

Related: Ankaru, Tayran, The Geode, Varkane

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Ankaru

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Ankaru, Ice Shard, Ice Stone, Ice Gem, Ice Crystal

Ice Crystals

Ankaru is a frost-bound crystalline material found in the high ranges of Hoshimira, where ancient formations preserve extreme cold across millennia. It remains solid regardless of ambient temperature and can produce a brief numbing chill through soul-resonance or mechanical activation. Officially called Ankaru in technical records, it is traded south to Sahran at inflated prices where water is rationed.

The concentration and density of Ankaru determine the scale of its thermal suppression. It was first employed as a coolant in mech systems during Geode expeditions beneath Tayran, and Project DAEDALUS later led Solmara to refine it into cryotech combining thermal suppression with soul-reactive engineering. More concentrated crystals can leech heat systematically across a wide area, while the most extreme formations suppress thermal motion to a point approaching absolute zero without reaching it. Exposure to these forms can dull perception, slow cognition and cause severe brief fugue states in which awareness of time is lost.

Ankaru-Kai formations occur in the deepest mountain strata, where pressure and time compress ambient cold into stable crystalline matrices. Extraction is dangerous, with miners reporting spatial disorientation, temporal distortion and recurring dreams of drowning in frozen water, leading the Hoshimiran Temple Authority to regulate mining alongside its spiritual prohibitions. Vesperites incorporate Ankaru into meditation, believing the crystals retain the memory of the original cold, while Hoshimiran folklore associates the formations with a sleeping deity beneath subterranean lakes. Some scholars speculate that they preserve fragments of Bahamut's essence, although no divine presence has been confirmed.

During the collapse of Elysium, Ankaru-Shin cryotech arrays were deployed throughout the city, creating a perpetual winter that slowed the spread of the Curse and preserved the dying. The disaster remains the basis of the Solmaran Council's Elysium Protocols and its strict regulation of modern cryotech.

Related: Naru, Lux Crystals, Hoshimira, Elysium

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Raikami

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Raikami, Electric Shard, Electric Stone, Electric Gem, Electric Crystal

Electric Crystals

Raikami forms where Susanoo's lightning strikes the earth and reaches particular mineral seams in the storm valleys of Fengua. After the Shattering, Hoshimiran clans descended into these restless valleys and learned to recognise the patterns of the storms. The crystal retains a persistent residual charge, producing a low irregular buzz that can interfere with conductive and soul-reactive devices.

The concentration and stability of Raikami determine how much electrical force it can store and release. Less concentrated pieces became common, reliable harvests used in everyday tools and rituals, while more stable lattices can release broad electrical surges capable of overwhelming unshielded systems and disrupting biological rhythm. Sensitive instruments may cause compasses to spin, radios to fill with static resembling fragments of language and soul-reactive machinery to awaken. The crystals' hum often intensifies before severe weather, making them an informal forecast for sailors and farmers.

The most concentrated Raikami cores hold electrical force under near-catastrophic tension, producing ozone, static and physical sensations such as aching fillings and raised hair. They can also lower the threshold of magical Connection required to channel their effects, allowing lesser attunement to produce power that would otherwise require years of discipline. Repeated use can create dependency, leading societies to regulate them.

Fengua's greatest weapon of the Age of Magic, the Leiting pao or Thunder Cannon, was built around such cores and alchemical condensers, producing a beam capable of striking a guardian god. Raikami remains both a practical resource and an enduring physical trace of Susanoo's storms.

Related: Verdani, Lux Crystals, Fengua, Susanoo

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Lux Crystals

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Lux, Lux Shard, Lux Stone, Lux Gem, Lux Crystal

Lux Crystals

Lux is a crystalline radiance born from the Shattering of the Sky. Lunarkos carried concentrated Lux essence before colliding with Bahamut, scattering fragments across Aerisu where they became embedded in the crust and merged with geological and biological substrates to form an underlying crystalline lattice.

The concentration and refinement of Lux determine the intensity and nature of its effects. Less concentrated crystals produce a steady glow even without ambient light, becoming brighter in darkness, and can disrupt shadow formations, dispel minor obscuring and make concealment difficult. These forms are widely used for civilian illumination and distributed by clergy as tangible blessings. Greater concentrations flood an area with structured radiance, purifying darkness and destabilising Vanta-corrupted states. Lux can also stabilise souls, heal early Frallation and suppress Vanta temporarily.

The Psycrata have documented that concentrated Lux can suppress free will, reduce creative deviation and enforce behavioural conformity. Prolonged or excessive use can also produce Lux Overgrowth, in which imposed order becomes pathological and structure hardens into rigidity. The most intense crystals act as revelation focuses, exposing hidden forms, suppressed truths and concealed identities, causing shapeshifters to revert, illusions to collapse and lies to become physically painful. Such exposure has caused severe trauma, destroyed relationships and driven some people to suicide, leading temples to maintain exclusive control over these forms.

Lux therefore serves as both a healing and controlling force, with its effects extending from physical restoration to the imposition of order upon matter, magic and thought. Its relationship with the Moon reflects the same principle: Moonlight reveals through reflection and refraction, illuminating while preserving mystery. Lux can reveal much while still leaving meaning to be understood.

Related: Verdani, VantaBlack, Lunarkos, Bahamut, The Moon, The Primal Dichotomy

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VantaBlack

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as VantaBlack, Vanta Shard, Vanta Stone, Vanta Gem, Vanta Crystal, Crystallised Vanta, Crystalline Vanta

Vanta Crystals

VantaBlack forms where Vanta saturation disrupts matter and structure collapses into void-touched crystal. Less concentrated forms can cause cognitive slips in which thoughts, memories or names become temporarily unreachable. Researchers exposed to them have reported recurring dreams of loss and erasure and developed compulsive habits of documentation, hoarding and recording. These effects can persist after contact and leave

permanent psychological scarring.

The concentration and stability of VantaBlack determine the severity of its effects. Greater concentrations form stable void crystals that absorb light like a hole in space, producing intrusive doubt and existential unease concerning the meaning of actions, relationships and beliefs. Proximity correlates with depression, nihilistic ideation and existential dissociation even without activation, leading governments to license their possession. Vantari cults instead embrace these crystals in rituals intended to accelerate decay and return to primordial absence.

Vanta was once theorised to originate in the Geode beneath Tayran, but surveys established that it is present across Aerisu and intrinsic to reality. It represents condensed entropy and unfiltered desire, expressing wanting without wisdom, hunger without fulfilment and acknowledged lack left unresolved. Vanta can arise through emotional and existential processes and increases around entities and environments shaped by despair, nihilism and existential collapse.

The most concentrated black-tier deposits thin reality itself, making the boundary between the material and Spirit Realms permeable. Exposure can produce profound existential distress and the sensation of becoming less real while remaining physically present. Leaked reports describe effects that unmake concepts, erase bodies and the memory that they existed, and leave gaps in causality. Possession is illegal or tightly restricted across most of Aerisu, while Vantari nations such as Ereboska and Necrovia treat the most powerful forms as sacred and as deterrents against foreign aggression.

Vanta was once widely theorised to have originated with Bahamut during the Shattering, when the planetary defence tore through the mantle and exposed concentrated entropy. Comprehensive study now shows that Vanta exists within everything capable of conscious existence, making VantaBlack one of the most dangerous substances known to Aerisu.

Related: Vanta Substance, Lux Crystals, Mauri, Bahamut, The Geode, Vanta Concept, The Primal Dichotomy

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Bestiary

Bestiary Overview

Bestiary · Bestiary · also known as Bestiary

Classification by Origin

Aerisuan creatures are classified by origin rather than appearance. Each classification describes what a creature fundamentally is and where it sits within the progression from Resonance through Echo or Echoling, Yokai, Beast and the successive stages of sapience, including branches that develop outside that progression. Creatures with entirely different forms can therefore share a classification, while similar forms may belong to different ones.

Every entry carries exactly one classification. Most also carry zero or more conditions: Cursed, Chimera or Enhanced, which are layered onto the creature without replacing its underlying Type. A Cursed Yokai remains a Yokai, while a Chimera may occur across multiple classifications.

Related: Soul Resonance, Aerisu

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Echoling

Classification · Bestiary · also known as Echolings

A Pattern Without a Body

An Echoling, the Bestiary term for an Echo, is Resonance that has become coherent enough to form a recognisable pattern without entangling with a physical body. It can affect the world as a voice, shape or presence while remaining intangible.

Most catalogued Echolings are remnants of souls severed rather than released through their natural passage into the Veins. Violence, the Curse and the Shattering can leave such residue behind. The resulting Echoling carries no completed choice or continued journey, only what remains of the severed pattern.

An Echoling can advance to Yokai when it entangles with a body, element or other physical medium. Without such an anchor, it may disperse into ordinary Resonance or persist indefinitely in its existing form.

Related: Soul Resonance, Yokai, Fae, Vaentyma

Creatures: Ghost

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Yokai

Classification · Bestiary · also known as Gui

Between Echo and Body

A Yokai forms when an Echoling entangles with an element such as fire, ice, electricity, wind, plant matter, Lux, Vanta or another medium that Resonance can inhabit. The entanglement gives the Echoling tangibility and the ability to act with something resembling intent, without producing the sustained desire of a soul.

A Yokai remains fundamentally a force of nature. Its existence depends upon the element with which it has become entangled, allowing it to be extinguished, scattered or re-entangled elsewhere without the same finality as a bodily creature.

Classification depends upon this mechanism. Age, appearance or unusual abilities do not by themselves make something a Yokai.

Related: Echoling, Beast, Soul Resonance

Creatures: Kodama

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Beast

Classification · Bestiary · also known as Beasts, Animal, Animals, Fauna

Attached and Reliant

An ~~Echoling~~ becomes a Beast when it attaches closely enough to a physical body that its continued existence depends upon that body. ~~Resonance~~ remains present throughout the process, as it does in everything within ~~Aerisu~~, while the creature's existence becomes bound to biology.

The classification encompasses bacteria, fish, insects, birds, mammals and other forms of ordinary life, including species selectively bred over generations. Domestication changes their relationship with people without changing their classification.

Sapience and culture develop further along the same continuum through ~~Tribal~~, ~~Folk~~ and ~~Human~~. Most Beasts remain at this stage throughout their existence.

Related: Yokai, Tribal

Creatures: Neurochimera, Wolf

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Tribal

Classification · Bestiary · also known as Tribal Creatures

Between ~~Beast~~ and ~~Folk~~

Tribal creatures have developed beyond ~~Beast~~, gaining the ability to communicate, sometimes through speech, and organise around shared needs. Their societies lack the accumulated institutions, traditions and structures associated with a culture.

The boundary between Tribal and ~~Folk~~ is gradual, allowing reasonable observers to disagree about the classification of an individual species. Tribal creatures remain strongly influenced by instinct, even where their behaviour shows deliberation or intelligence.

Related: Beast, Folk

Creatures: Toad

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Folk

Classification · Bestiary · also known as Folk Peoples

A People

Folk occupy the stage beyond ~~Tribal~~ on the continuum of sapience. Their defining feature is established culture: systems of rule, hierarchy, tradition and accumulated social knowledge that allow a species to function as a people.

Folk cultures develop according to their own bodies, instincts and histories. Their societies share sapience and culture with Human-tier beings while retaining distinct forms shaped by their own origins.

Related: Tribal, Human

Creatures: Monkey

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Human

Classification · Bestiary · also known as Human-like, Humans

The Soul That Chooses

Human marks the point where a soul can choose for itself beyond the immediate demands of survival. Folk may possess language, culture, hierarchy and tradition, yet their lives generally remain centred around the needs shared by their kind. Humans pursue wants that exceed those necessities, creating, learning, questioning, cultivating and building things whose value exists beyond simple survival.

That freedom makes Humans unusually malleable. A soul capable of pursuing its own desires can deliberately reshape itself, while the body follows through cultivation, augmentation and other alterations. Human bodies and souls therefore vary far more readily than those of Folk, whose forms and ways of life tend to remain closer to the needs they were shaped around.

Human is still part of the ordinary pipeline. Humans carry Resonance, can wield magic, and remain subject to conditions such as the Curse or Enhancement. Draken, Lithejorm and Demon instead descend through separate recursions originating from Spirits.

Related: Folk, The Soul

Creatures: Cave Troll

—

Undead

Classification · Bestiary · also known as The Undead, Living Dead

Using the Dead

An Undead creature forms when Resonance attaches to matter that has already completed its own cycle, using bodies, dead flora or other remains rather than restoring the life that was lost. The process bypasses the Yokai stage by attaching directly to dead matter.

Undead are commonly mindless because their coherence is assembled from residue rather than developed gradually through the ordinary pipeline. With sufficient time, an Undead branch can develop greater coherence and even sapience while retaining its distinct origin.

Necromancy and Death Gardening deliberately produce this process by entangling a corpse's Resonance with living flora under a practitioner's direction. The same process can occur naturally at sites containing sufficient residual Resonance, although this is rare without deliberate cultivation.

Related: Soul Resonance, Beast

Creatures: Deadwood

—

Fae

Classification · Bestiary · also known as Fae Folk, The Fae

What Refuses to Forget

When a soul dies, its ordinary passage leads through the Spiral Veins towards the Orb of Souls. At the Toll, it must relinquish enough memory to continue. A Fae forms when a soul refuses, retaining its memories and stepping outside the ordinary recursion.

Centuries of unrelinquished memory gradually distort the Fae's recollection. Memories fragment and overlap, producing riddling speech, contradictory recollections and an awareness that can seem to span several periods at once. Their strangeness emerges from the accumulated burden of memory rather than from a single personality trait.

Fae are the counterpart to Vaentyma, which follow the opposite path from the same failed Toll. A Vaentyma relinquishes its memory while retaining the desire beneath it. A Fae retains memory while losing its place within the ordinary cycle.

Related: Soul Resonance, Vaentyma, Echoling

Creatures: Pixpsy

—

Vaentyma

Classification · Bestiary · also known as Vaentymae, Monster, Monsters

Desire, Melded and Directionless

A Vaentyma follows the opposite path to a Fae after failing the Toll. Its memory disperses while the desire beneath it remains, melding into the Veins and losing the self that once directed it. What persists is a singular remnant of want without memory to give it context or restraint.

The same phenomenon can occur in fragments of Bahamut that never find a purpose. A dissolved soul and a planetary fragment of undirected hunger therefore produce the same resulting phenomenon through different origins, which places both within this classification.

Monster is the ordinary term for a Vaentyma. A Vaentyma retains no memory or name through which it can be reasoned with, only the singular purpose around which it has formed.

Related: Fae, Soul Resonance

Creatures: Snyrm

—

Spirit

Classification · Bestiary · also known as Spirits, God, Gods, Kami, Shen

An Echo That Learned to Recur

Each stage of the pipeline describes Resonance gaining coherence. A Spirit emerges when an Echo becomes powerful enough to sustain its own recursion indefinitely and generate lesser Echoes or Echolings from itself. A Yokai expresses the same underlying phenomenon at a smaller scale, while this spirit classification is reserved for the Nine Spirits, Bahamut and beings of comparable scale.

Spirits are generally unique, named entities rather than populations of similar creatures. They therefore function more as historical or metaphysical individuals than as species.

Draken, Lithejorm and Demon descend directly from Spirits of this tier, carrying those origins forward through their own separate, self-sustaining recursions.

Related: Spirit Types, The Soul, Draken, Lithejorm, Demon

—

Draken

Classification · Bestiary · also known as Drakens

A Bloodline

Draken descend from a single event: Lady Draka's transformation, amplified by a Spirit's influence until the change became total and hereditary. The resulting lineage became a species rather than remaining an individual condition.

Full transformation passed directly through the lineage produces Drakens proper. Partial exposure through an affected parent produces Wyverns, a related and lesser expression of the same lineage. Both are established breeding populations within Aerisu's ecosystems.

Draken classification depends upon descent from Draka's lineage rather than physical resemblance. Serpentine or draconic creatures from other origins therefore remain separate classifications.

Related: Spirit, Lithejorm

Creatures: Wyvern

—

Lithejorm

Classification · Bestiary · also known as Lithejormae

Born of a Bond

Hvitara and Susanoo were both fragments of Bahamut. Hvitara froze what approached her until Susanoo found her, fought her and ultimately remained to hold her. Their bond produced new forms and descendants that established an entire lineage across the northern oceans.

Lithejormae therefore descend from a guardian's purpose rather than an unclaimed fragment of hunger. Their origin separates them from Vaentyma despite their shared connection to Bahamut: the Vaentyma emerges where nothing bonds and nothing is chosen, while the Lithejorm exists through a bond that became generative.

Sea serpents, krakens, mermaids and sirens are expressions of this lineage, carrying Hvitara and Susanoo's forms forward through their descendants.

Related: Spirit, Vaentyma, Draken

Creatures: Sea Serpent

—

Demon

Classification · Bestiary · also known as Demons, Hellspawn, Hell Spawn

Zorya's Line

Demon is a specific lineage descended from Zorya Chernaya, crowned in the hellscape that became Varkane, and Vorograv, the fragment of the Abyss who tormented her. Their suffering produced the Daughters of Vice, pride, greed, lust, envy, gluttony, wrath and sloth, along with Cerberus and the gargoyles, incubi, succubae and Hell

Hounds that carry the bloodline forward.

Like Draken and Lithejorm, Demon follows a separate recursion descended directly from a Spirit-tier origin rather than the general pipeline. Evil, hostility or an infernal appearance alone do not determine the classification; Demon refers specifically to this lineage.

Related: Spirit

Creatures: Hell Hound

—

Construct

Classification · Bestiary · also known as Artificial, Constructs

Made to Hold

A Construct is deliberately created by forcing Resonance to entangle and integrate through an external act. The process cannot occur naturally. Unlike a Chimera, which results from unstable combination, a Construct is designed to hold together from the outset.

The method does not alter the classification. A Borenfegen may develop greater sapience than a Golem without changing Type; sapience develops along the same continuum while the underlying foundation remains artificial.

Related: Spectrum of Being, Undead

Creatures: Golem

—

Cave Troll

Human · Cursed · Bestiary

A Person, Underneath

The Cave Troll was a person before it was anything else: someone shaped by ordinary contracts and ordinary work, until a collapse buried him beneath stone near where a serpent, a fallen fragment of Bahamut, had come down. Years of isolation and prolonged exposure to what the fall left behind wore down his soul's integration without fully replacing it, as occurs with a Cursed creature that remains fundamentally what it originally was.

He survived by hiding and feeding on whatever came close enough, scraps, animals, anything the caves offered. Beneath the degradation remains the person that the collapse once buried.

Related: Human

—

Deadwood

Undead · Bestiary

Root Where Flesh Was

Deadwood are Necromancy's plainest result: a body whose Resonance has been deliberately entangled with living flora rather than left to disperse, with root and wood growing through and eventually replacing much of what the corpse once was. More refined practice can produce far more coherent results. Deadwood is simply the simplest and most common form.

Related: Undead

—

Ghost

Echoling · Bestiary

What's Left, Unclaimed

A Ghost is an Echoling in its plainest form: recognisable and capable of affecting its surroundings in small ways, yet never entangled with an element or body as a Yokai or Beast would be. Most form where a soul was severed suddenly rather than released properly, through violence, the Curse or the Shattering itself, rather than through a natural death that completed its ordinary journey through the Veins.

Related: Echoling

—

Golem

Construct · Bestiary

Built to Hold

A Golem is Resonance forced into clay, stone or metal and made to integrate, rather than simply entangle as a Yokai does. Nothing about a Golem occurs naturally. Each is the deliberate result of a practitioner's work, animated for a purpose and generally kept to it.

Related: Construct

—

Hell Hound

Demon · Bestiary

Kept in Zorya's Reaches

Hell Hounds run through the burning reaches Zorya Chernaya once ruled outright, belonging to the same lineage that produced her Daughters and Cerberus, though as a far lesser expression of it. They are bred rather than born in any individual sense, kept, used and set loose as the hellscape's hunting pack.

Related: Demon

—

Kodama

Yokai · Bestiary

The Forest's Own Attention

Kodama are among the oldest magical creatures on record, appearing in surviving accounts and tradition from long before the Shattering. Bound to Aokusa's forests, each Kodama is an Echoling entangled with the tree or grove it inhabits rather than a body of its own, closer to the wood's own attention given shape than an animal living within it.

Aokusa has long treated its wilderness, Kodama included, as something owed a kind of care rather than simply territory to be used.

Related: Yokai

—

Monkey

Folk · Bestiary

Ragmu's Kingdom

The Monkeys of the eastern peaks maintain an actual kingdom under Ragmu, with the rule, hierarchy and tradition that distinguish ~~Folk~~ from ~~Tribal~~ peoples. Whatever instinct carried their ancestors remains beneath a society built through laws, succession and established customs, giving them a recognised place in the wider politics of the region.

Related: Folk

—

Neurochimera

Beast · Chimera · Bestiary

Fused, Not Integrated

The Neurochimera began as ordinary ~~Beast~~-stock before a mixture of ~~Vanta~~ excess and deliberate experimentation forced its ~~Resonance~~ to entangle across parts of several creatures at once. The parts never properly settled into one coherent whole. It holds together after a fashion, yet the failure of integration leaves both its form and nature unstable, producing the Chimera condition.

Related: Beast

—

Pixpsy

Fae · Bestiary

Stretched Thin, Never Quite Arriving

Pixpsy carry their memory as every ~~Fae~~ does, retaining what should have been surrendered and becoming stranger with every moment it remains. What sets a Pixpsy apart is how visibly stretched the effect becomes: consciousness spread across recurring moments, trapped between states rather than settled within one. Some scholars connect the faint radiance they carry to the same phenomenon that makes stars visible at all, though this remains a theory rather than a settled fact.

Related: Fae

—

Sea Serpent

Lithejorm · Bestiary

Born of the Northern Bond

The sea serpents of the northern oceans trace directly back to ~~Hvitara~~ and ~~Susanoo~~, new heads grown from their bond after ~~Susanoo~~ stopped fighting and chose to hold her instead. The ~~Norrvekt~~ still honour the pair as twin serpents wound around a central pole, a sign of healing rather than the monstrous hunger ~~Hvitara~~ carried before

Susanoo found her.

Related: Lithejorm

—

Snyrm

Vaentyma · Bestiary

Want, Without a Name Attached

A Snyrm is desire with nothing left holding it together: a soul that failed the Toll, lost its memory rather than keeping it, and melded into something driven purely by whatever it once wanted. What remains twists and drifts along the coast with no identity behind it and no reasoning to appeal to. The want is the whole of what remains.

Related: Vaentyma

—

Toad

Tribal · Bestiary

Talking, Not Building

Toads can speak and often do, gathering in loose groups through marsh and swampland rather than living entirely solitary. Their groups have no substantial hierarchy, no deliberately maintained tradition passed between generations, and nothing an outsider would recognise as a society. Instinct remains visibly present in the way they behave and make decisions.

Related: Tribal

—

Wolf

Beast · Bestiary

Pack and Territory

Wolves move in tight family packs across Aerisu's colder reaches, holding territory through scent and numbers rather than any Resonance particular to the species. Beyond their preferred range and pack structure, there is little to distinguish an Aerisu wolf from what the name suggests elsewhere.

They serve here as a plain baseline: a Beast with no classification-altering condition, representative of how most of Aerisu's animal population exists.

Related: Beast

—

Wyvern

Draken · Bestiary

A Lesser Echo of the Same Line

Wyverns descend from Draka's corruption as Drakens proper do, but at one remove, carried through a parent who was exposed to the transformation rather than transformed outright. The result remains visibly related to the original lineage while expressing it in a smaller and less complete form.

Related: Draken

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